

His heart is bewitched by the coercive prideful moves of his beloved.

تیغاً تیز نگاہ دیاں ہر دم لال لہو وچ دھانودیاں

“The sharpened swords of your eyes are always immersed in red blood.”

He falls prey to the sharpened swords of eyes immersed in red blood.

عشق ”فرید“ کئی گھر گالے سہنس پیاں تڑپھانودیاں

“Farid! Love has ruined many a household, whereby thousands are experiencing restlessness.”

Beauty ignites love. It is not possible for love to resist the magical spell of beauty. He is akin to a fish out of water without his beloved. Countless souls get rotten in love by suffering restlessness in separation and disunion from their beloved.

Kafi-122

سینہ محض لویراں دلڑی دھتیاں دھتیاں

“My chest has been absolutely torn asunder. My heart has been broken in bits and pieces.”

She experience heaviness of chest and ravishing of heart in search of her beloved.

روروا جڑیاں اکھیاں سبجڑیاں چولی چنڑی لیراں
کھلداں سینگیاں ستیاں

“My eyes have become dry and swollen due to crying. My apparel has been torn apart. My age group friends are laughing at me.”

Her plight makes her a laughing stock in the eye of her friends. It is relatively easy to bear such treatment from the strangers or outsiders than at the hands of one's friends. How tormenting it is to be made fun of by one's friends. It is love that makes these things happen.

عشق برائی جڑ کر لائی لوں لوں لکھ لکھ پیڑاں
وس سولیں دے پیاں

“Love has been fully appalling. There are countless pains, in each and every pore of my body. I am entirely in the hands of afflictions.”

She becomes a pawn in the hands of appalling love.

درد اندر روج سوز جگر وچ اکھیاں نیر وہیراں
منہ سر بُھڑ چھتیاں

“My self is burning with inner pain and passion. My eyes are weeping profusely. My head is muddy and my face is covered with dust.”

Her embodied self is shattered in course of love.

نیڑے ویڑھم سخت نہیر دم چٹڑی بجر دے تیراں
او خوشیاں کن گیاں

“Love has enveloped and stringently tightened me. The arrows of disunion have targeted me. Where those (primordial) delights have gone?”

She measures her sufferings in relation to her earlier delights. The intensity of early happiness correspondingly intensifies sufferings of her present state.

کھوٹ کماون کوڑا لاون کوڑیاں ڈیوم دھیراں
'دے سانول بیاں

“They earn what is counterfeit and speak lies. They give false consolations. My beloved! Leave my arms (I am not willing to repose my trust in you).”

Her relative consciousness is no match for the absolute consciousness of her beloved. She has a partial view of things as against her beloved who has full perspective. Her sense of serial time is characterised by past, present and future, while her beloved's sense of time is in pure eternity. The whole sweep of time for him is 'eternal now.' The contradiction between these conflicting perspectives is one of the essentiality of dynamic love. Her apparent behaviour with her beloved may be considered as atrocious but beneath it is the burning desire of realising union. The language of love is universal but its existential meanings can only be understood by the lover and her beloved. How could an outsider understand the communication of the insiders?

برہوں بھنوالی ڈیکھ فریدا سے سسیاں لکھ ہیراں
رل دیاں بوٹے لیاں

“Farid! See the vicissitudes of love. Hundreds of Sassis and countless Heers are wretchedly wandering in shrubs and marshes (wilderness).”

How embracing are the vicissitudes of love. The lovers are wandering in wilderness in wretched states. Only that person is worthy of love who chooses to become the ‘wretched of the earth’. Isn’t a little romantic love here and there enough for a person who cannot face the sufferings of true love?

Kafi-123

عشق اولڑی چال (بھلایا روے) یاریاں لانون سر منگدیاں

“Love is an intricate move, my good friend. The contracting of friendship requires bartering one’s head.”

Love is an intricate move impregnated with infinite intricacies. One has to barter his being and having for the sake of love.

زلفاں دلوں پاؤں جالی اکھیاں کر دیاں مست موالی
نازنگاہاں دے نال (بھلایا روے) برہوں بچھندیاں نہیں سنگدیاں

“The locks of hair net the heart. The eyes enrapture and detach one from attachments, my good friend. The prideful eyes do not hesitate to intensify love.”

The locks of hair, symbolising intricacies of love, net his heart. The eyes of the beloved intensify love and detach the lover from all attachments. He only remains attached to his beloved.

چشماں قہری رمزاں ویری اکھیاں ظالم دید لٹیری
ڈیون جندڑی گال (بھلایا روے) سرہوں بہادر ہن جنگدیاں

“The eyes are ruthless and the antics are inimical. The cruel eyes have capturing vision. They rot life, my good friend. They initially dare in warfare.”

The militant eyes of the beloved defeat him and make him prisoner of war.

نازک چالیں یار سجن دیاں سوہنیاں گالھیں من موہن دیاں

کرن دلیں پامال (بھلایا روے) ہر ہر آن کھڑیاں تنگدیاں

“The tender moves of my friendly beloved and the captivating discourses of my bewitching friend devastate me, my good friend. It leads to longing of him at each and every moment.”

The beloved perfectly nurtures love in his heart to the extent that it does not remain possible for him to retract love in the events of separation and disunion. His desire and longing of the beloved adds wind to the fire of love.

چہری طرز ڈکھاون اکھیاں زلفاں تیل پھلیل دیاں کھیاں
گھتدیاں جی جنجال (بھلایا روے) زورے رگ رگ نوں ڈنگدیاں

“The eyes manifest fondly styles. The locks of hair are greased and saturated with oil. They entangle, my good friend. They forcibly bite my each and every vein.”

The beloved ties him with locks of hair so tightly that each greasy hair binds his flesh and bones. The forcible biting is a happy sign that that he has been bound perfectly. It remains impossible for him to extricate himself from the grip of love.

عشق ”فرید“ کشالے گھلے آس، امید، تسلی، بھلے
کوڑا وہم خیال (بھلایا روے) ڈٹھڑیاں بیتاں دل سنگدیاں

“Farid! Love has sent me adversities, hopes, expectations, assurances and good intentions. All this is false, illusion and imaginary, my good friend. I have experienced the love of the heartless.”

He experiences adversities at the hands of his heartless beloved. He is bitten by love. He becomes distrustful and considers the package of love devoid of any reality. His consciousness shrinks to the level of his own awful experience. He dreads the expansion of his consciousness. It is so understandable. The level of expansion correlates to the

level of suffering. A higher consciousness undergoes higher suffering.

Kafi-124

عشق بھلائیاں کل طاعتاں

“Love has made me oblivious of all forms of subservience.”

Love frees him from all forms of obsequious servilities. He becomes completely in consonance with the law of things in the form of his beloved.

معمور خفی دے اندر
اے گھر میرا سکھ مندر
اتھ ہر جنسوں ملن سوغاتاں
جہ بحر محیط دابندر

“My house is the temple of peace. It is built inside the corners of my heart. It is the harbour of the encompassing sea. Here, the rare gifts of all goods (merchandise) are available.”

Man's inner being or self is the temple of peace. It lies in the inmost chambers of heart. It is the harbour of the encompassing sea of gnosis. It harbours the rare gifts of spiritual goods coming from different positions.

تھنی رفع حجب یکباری
آئی حال مقام دی واری
چ زکواتاں صوم صلواتاں
گئی زہد عبادت ساری

“The timings of state and station have arrived. The veil has been instantly lifted. All asceticism and worship, pilgrimage, alms giving, fasting and prayers have been transcended.”

The efficacy of devoutness or piety, worship and rituals fructifies in opening spiritual states and stations. It leads to the instant lifting of veil. The Reality unveils itself. Religiosity

considers the acts of devoutness or piety, asceticism and rituals as ends in themselves as against spirituality, which considers them as means to the attainment of spiritual openings. A religious votary cannot understand the essence of religion unless spirituality is wholly acknowledged as the measure of religiosity.

تھی نصرت فتح فتوحی سب سری قلبی روحی
گئی ظلمت نور صبحی کیتیاں جسم عجب پر بھاتاں

“The openings of the invisible mysteries of heart and spirit have taken place, by virtue of the Divine Grace. The darkness has vanished, giving way to pure light. My body has made strange revelations.”

The invisible mysteries of heart undergo spiritual unravelling by the Grace of God. Pure Light instantaneously dispels darkness of the embodied self, which becomes transparent in reflecting light of the Spirit.

سرانہد طبل شہانہ خوش مطرب تان ترانہ
گیا نفل نماز دو گانہ دِ سریاں ڈو، ترے، چار، رکعتاں

“The secret of percussion is being beaten on a royal drum with melodious tunes and lyrics. Gone are the supererogatory prayers of two genuflections. The prayers of two, three and four genuflections (ritual prayers) are gone in oblivion.”

The disclosing of Divine secret in the form of celestial music makes the votary transcend the level of ritual prayers. Ritualistic prayers tend to become a veil in the face of such spiritual openings. Religiosity does not know the way of handling rituals, which at times turn spiritually ruinous. Spirituality handles rituals with care. It understands their rationale and acts accordingly.

گر، بات، بتائی پوری طیفوری تے منصورِی
تھی فاش تجلی طوری ہر جا ایمن تے میقاتاں

“The master taught me the whole doctrine of Bayazid Bistami and Mansur Hallaj. The Sinai theophany became openly manifest. There is ‘aiman’ (the valley of Mount Sinai) and ‘mekataan’ (the moments of communication with the Sustainer) every where.”

The spiritual master taught him the whole doctrine of Bayazid Bistami and Mansur Hallaj founded on the metaphysics of Oneness of Being with its corresponding realisation. It led to the theophanic vision of the Reality. The whole earth became holy and the channels of communication with the Sustainer were opened for him.

اے وجدانی شطحاتاں ہن وحدت دیاں آیاتاں
کر طمس دلیں سطواتاں کر داظاہر اے کلماتاں

“These inspirational antinomies are the symbols of unity. Witness the reality of oneness by effacing everything from your heart. The words are made manifest.”

The intensity of spiritual experience became so overwhelming that the recipient started uttering inspirational antinomies so scandalous to religiosity. These are symbols of unity beneath, which lays the essential Reality. The heart purified of otherness witnesses the reality of Oneness. The words reveal the essential Truth.

کل اٹھ گئے فتن زلازل بھج پئے اغلال سلاسل
دل ہک پاسے تھی شاغل بٹھ درکاتاں تے درجاتاں

“All earth shaking nuisances have disappeared. All binding chains have been broken. My heart is engrossed on the side of Oneness. The down gradations and up gradations have lost their meaning.”

The spiritual experience of such higher intensity drives out even the quaking nuisances out of one’s mind. Man becomes free from all binding chains of the self. The heart becomes

completely attached to the Absolute or God. It does not bother about the downgradations or upgradations of its spiritual states. If the beloved is the alpha and omega of the lover's quest, then why he should be concerned with these things? Aren't these things thick veils in the path of spirituality?

تھئے بھاگ ”فرید“ بھلیے دولِ دلبر لائے دیرے
آکانِ دوارے میرے بنسی جوڑ سنایاں گھاتاں

“Farid! Fortune has started smiling on me. My beloved is dwelling in my heart. Krishan do visit my house. The flute has perfectly harped on the intricate tunes.”

Fortune starts smiling on him. His beloved unveils himself from within ‘the infinite depths of his being or consciousness’ by perfectly harping on the intricate tunes of love.

Kafi-125

گذریا وقت گندھاون دھڑیاں وِ سر یا ہار سنگار اساہاں

روگ کروپ کشالے ہر دم در دوں نالہ زار اساہاں

“The time of kneading my hair has fled. My makeup has faded away. There are malaises, difficulties and adversities at each and every moment. Pain makes me cry in distress.”

Her sufferings lead to the collapse of her habitual, rational and happy world.

سرمہ پاون، سرخی لاون سینسر، بول، تے مانگھ بناون

سہجوں پھلوں سہرے پاون سب کجھ تھیایکار اساہاں

“The affecting of antimony in my eyes and applying rouge, wearing of nose ornaments, setting my hair and fondly wearing chaplets of flowers, all seems useless to me.”

All beautifying things done in a state of nuptial happiness become irrelevant in states of separation and disunion.

تن من چہڑی سانگ غماں دی جان جگروچ چوک ڈکھاندی

وِ لڑی سولیس کیتی ماندی سینے، سو سو، خار اساہاں

“The spear of sorrows has pierced my body and soul. There is anguish of sorrow in my embodied self. My heart has become weary due to these afflictions. There are thousands of thorns in my chest.”

The states of separation and disunion are not inactive states but are highly active in ravishing her embodied self.

ہسن لھلن کجھ یاد نہ آوے روندیں کھپدیں عمر نبھاوے

جند جگھ جگھ لکھ رنج اٹھاوے ڈکھڑے تاروتار اساہاں

“I can’t remember the days of playfulness. My life is being spent in crying and making hue and cry. My life is rotting by bearing intense grief. I am drowned in the ocean of suffering.”

She loses her memory of playful days. Time becomes static for her. Her present moment of suffering seems all-pervasive. Isn’t it the precise description of hell, where one’s burning need or desire is not satiated?

پیت پُنل دی رگ رگ گھیریم یار اغیار کنوں منہ پھیریم
جھور جھرانے جڑ جڑ ویڑھیم چھٹ گیا کل کم کار اساہاں

“The love of Punnal has encompassed my each and every vein. I have turned my face away from my friends and foes. Worries have completely engulfed me. I have been detached from all works and vocation.”

The attachment with the beloved makes her detach from otherness. The degree of attachment corresponds to the degree of detachment. Absolute attachment leads to absolute detachment. Detachment from the ephemeral is one of the greatest signs of love. It is at the final stage that she becomes detached even from detachment paving way for absolute attachment with her beloved.

یار ”فرید“ نہ آیم ویڑھے ٹوکاں کر دے کھیڑے بھیڑے
سوہنے کیتے سخت نکھیڑے تول تقی تھئی دار اساہاں

“Farid! My friend has not visited me in my courtyard. The despicable ‘Kheras’ are sneering at me. My beloved has created a great void. My inept quilt seems, scaffold to me.”

He misses his beloved so much. He experiences a great void in his life. The despicable adversaries sneer at him. He can’t vile away his time even with distractions. He has no spill

channel of life. His psychic coverings are so inept that they tighten the noose around his neck, instead.

Kafi-126

کلہڑی رول ملہیر گیوں یارولاہنے ہئے واگاں

“You wretched and left me alone and went to Malheer. My friend! Quicken to turn your reins back.”

She suffers transcendence of her beloved. She is all alone without any internal or external ties.

روہ جبلڑے اوکھڑے ڈکھڑے تھلڑے جھاگاں

“The mountainous terrains are hazardous. I cross the deserts bearing great difficulties.”

The deserts of life are so difficult to cross. The mounting issues of love are very hazardous.

قدم قدم تے ڈھے پوداں دلڑی لگڑیاں لاگاں

“I fall down at each and every step. My heart has contracted love.”

She falls down at every step in steering her way across individual and social situations.

روہی وٹھڑی گھاتھئے مٹڑیں لگڑیاں جاگاں

“The desert has turned green with rain and there is plenty of grass. The curd is being prepared for churning in the vessels.”

The dormant possibilities of union in her desert of life are becoming alive.

گائیں سہنس سوانیاں سئے چرن کوراگاں

“Countless cows after giving birth to calves are ready for being milked and countless others (without milk) are having their fodder.”

Her efforts are nearing fruition.

سندھڑی ڈکھڑے گھاٹڑے روہی ملڑے بھاگاں

“The river bank areas of Sindh are full of great sufferings. Desert is in line with good fortunes.”

Transcendence is full of suffering. Immanence is impregnated with good fortunes.

لانی، پھوگ پھلاریئے رل مل چاروں ڈاگاں

“There are desert plants and bushes. Let’s herd the camels together.”

She recounts the symbols of immanence. She invites his beloved to union.

ڈینہاں، ڈوڑے ڈوار پڑے تائیں روندیں جاگاں

“My difficulties multiply by day. I keep awake crying at night.”

She suffers both in action and contemplation in her search of transcendence.

سینگیاں سرتیاں مل، ملا سرخیاں کرن مُساگاں

“My same age friends gather together and apply rouge, collyrium and twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects).”

She envies the spirit of life in her friends who have united with their beloveds.

میلے ویس سہانودے پھیری کنڈھ سہاگاں

“Only shabby dress suits me. My nuptial blessings have turned away from me.”

She loses the inner urge to be well dressed. She prefers to wear shabby dress since blessings of union have turned away from her. Could there be beautification without happiness?

درد ”فرید“ اجاڑیا ڈکھڑے ڈتم ڈہاگاں

“Farid! Pain has destroyed me. Misfortunes have made me suffer.”

He feels great desolation of life at the hands of love. He considers love as misfortune whose pain has made him suffer.

Kafi-127

گوڑھیاں اکھیاں سد امتوالیاں رت پیون کان او باہلیاں

“The red eyes are permanently drunk. They are quick
in sucking blood.”

Beauty is inseparable from love and is thereby responsive. But it requires the ‘eye of heart’ to behold it. Beauty in both its inward and outward dimensions creates love. The responsiveness of beauty corresponds to the intensity of love. A dormant beauty may or may not ignite love. But vibrant beauty does. The Most Beautiful manifests in beautiful forms and contemplates Himself. He loves Himself. Love becomes irresistible.

تن من بنھ بنھ قید کریندیاں رگ رگ وگ وگ پچ اڑیندیاں
ایسے زلفاں دلڑی کالیاں

“These black hair curls capture me. They tie my body
and soul. They hasten to knot my each and every
vein.”

He is wholly ensnared in the intricacies of beauty. The spell of beauty binds the core of his being.

جان جگر وچ پاؤن دامان عشوے غمزے ناز خرامان
واہ نازک ریتاں چالیاں

“I laud the delicate moves that entrap my embodied
self by dint of amorous glances, enticements and
prideful gaits.”

The game of love begins with bewitching expressions of the beautiful beloved.

کرن نہ ٹالے موہن مالے سینسر، بول، اتے، کٹمالے
کیا پھلوالے کیا والیاں

“My famous neck ornament, nose ornaments, a bead necklace and ornamental earrings do not abstain from seducing me.”

The inward expressions of beauty take an outward form that are highly seductive in nature.

ساڑم دلڑی ڈکھڑیں کٹھڑی جندڑی لٹڑی سکھڑیں کٹھڑی
بیاں اکھیاں درووں آلیاں

“My heart burns and is butchered by sufferings. My life has been looted due to loss of peace. And my eyes are a sore due to fresh wounds.”

His encounter with beauty is akin to his encounter with light passing through prisms. The moment he is separated from beauty or light, his whole world turns into pitch black darkness. He is completely swung to the other side of the pendulum. The intensity of his sufferings increase since he has beheld beauty, otherwise he would not have any comparison. Fall is tragic because one constantly remembers the majesties of heights. A born blind person suffers less than the one who completely loses his eyesight after enjoying it for decades. How could a person who had never an occasion to witness real beauty and fall in love with it understand the plight of the lover?

گھولے کوچے شہر برازاں سوہن ”فرید“ نول اجڑیاں باراں
ڈتیاں برہوں ملک نکالیاں

“I have sacrificed lanes, streets and bazaars. The desolate forests seem pleasant to Farid. Love has turned him out of the city.”

His sacrifice in choosing desolation in place of worldliness is not so much a rational choice than the force of beauty,

which divests him of being and having. Religiosity will never understand love. It may at times rest content in preaching love of God. It is so tragic to sermonise love. A man who falls passionately in love with a woman in the terrestrial world, for example, may readily do anything for the sake of his beloved. His love may be just an infatuation but still under its spell he may do anything even to the point of transgressing religious, social and cultural limits over a period of time. He is never sermonised to love but may be sermonised to desist from love on one score or the other. How come divine love needs to be sermonised? All those who sermonise divine love do not understand even the alphabets of love. Religiosity does not understand that the lover does not initiate love but it is initiated by the beloved. Unless religiosity understands this metaphysical truth, it will go on floating pseudo theories of love. It will not shy itself even to promote hatred in the name of love. There are many psychic lovers in the terrestrial world who continue loving even without the beloved being aware of it. Likewise, there are so many 'experts' of love in the area of religiosity who have never loved any one in their life since they have never experienced vibrant beauty but they hold themselves as champions of love. There can be no love unless the Divine Beauty unveils by initiating love itself. Love is imaginative but not imaginary. The act of forming a concept of God and then loving Him is self-defeating. The onus is on the beloved and not on the lover. People should wait and do something nice till the beloved falls in love with them. Then, love will guide them accordingly.

Kafi-128

کون کرم نروار تیغ برہوں دی کٹھیاں کٹھیاں

“Who ought to do justice in my case? I am butchered
by the sword of love.”

The one butchered by the sword of love seeks justice. It points to a conflict between love and justice. But how could love be measured on the standards of justice? It is not that love is unjust but it transcends the ordinary meaning enshrined in the rational concept of justice. The metaphysical concepts of love and justice do not contradict each other since they are completely in consonance with the ultimate nature of things. It will be nothing less than injustice if the intensity of sufferings was mitigated or finished before love ripened into fullness.

”انہد“ بین بجا من موہیس راول جوگی لٹیاں لٹیاں

“My beloved captivated me by playing the divine
flute. My beloved Yogi has completely looted me.”

The flute of inner being harped by the beloved completely transforms him.

راز حقیقی فاش ڈھوسے علم و عمل توں چھٹیاں چھٹیاں

“I have witnessed the Divine secret in manifest
openness. I have transcended knowledge and action.”

Rational knowledge and contingent action belong to the domain of individual contingencies and are thus determined and conditioned states. The gnostic is free from them once the essential Divine mystery becomes openly manifest to him. It is gnostic knowledge and not action that dispels ignorance,

‘which is the root of all limitation.’ The effects of action are only within its own realm and thereby it cannot achieve total or universal realisation. Intention (niyyah) takes primacy over action for it entirely depends on man himself. ‘As regards action, it is important to observe that it is the intention (niyyah) which counts for the most, for this alone, depends wholly on man himself, without being affected or modified by outward contingencies as the results of action always are.’ The gnostic’s supreme knowledge embraces both action and love by freeing them from their contingencies. The Reality, in the ultimate sense, loves and acts through human mediums.

عشق نہیں، ہے آگ غضب دی دھانہہ کریندی ہٹیاں ہٹیاں

“It is not the love but a terrifying fire. My beseeching has exhausted me.”

The fire of love is so terrific that she gets exhausted in beseeching her beloved for union.

کلہری ' کے کچھ سداہاویں اکھیں ملیندی اٹھیاں اٹھیاں

“You left me alone and proceeded towards Ketch. I am waking by rubbing my eyes (witnessing a world of contrast).”

Her eyes cannot behold the transcendence of her beloved.

جام زہر دے ظلم قہر دے درد پلیندا گھٹیاں گھٹیاں

“Pain gives me, sip by sip, the most terrible cup of poison.”

Like the fire of love, which at times is smouldering, pain too makes her take the deadliest cup of poison sip by sip. Love seldom gives instantaneous death. It makes the lover die by tasting death in its fullness. Doesn’t love teach the art of dying?

عشق ”فرید“ نہیں آج کل دا روز ازل دی مٹھیاں مٹھیاں

“Farid! It is not a newly contracted love. I am its captive ever since the primordial day.”

He qualifies the essential nature of his love as celestial and not terrestrial. It is since the divine beloved entered into a pre-eternal covenant with his soul (Alast...).

Kafi-129

گھائے عشق دے گھائے جاتے میں تاں بھی چم سیر اکھیاں چاتے میں

“I have realised that there are numerous losses in love
but in spite of that I have inwardly taken on this
vocation.”

He unravels the secret of love. He is conscious of the losses encountered in the path of love but he still chooses his vocation with earnestness because he knows that it is the only way to win his beloved.

کھوٹا نمینہ انوکھا دیری ہے منہ دھوڑ مٹی سر کیری ہے
ڈکھاں سولاں دلڑی گھیری ہے پلو سول کپترے پاتے میں

“The counterfeit love is a novel adversary. My face is covered with dust and my head is muddy. My heart has been encircled by sufferings and afflictions. I have gathered appalling afflictions within me.”

The novice who enters the arena of love with a sure sense of victory realises after some time that love is absolutely a different ball game. He projects his own limitations by calling love as counterfeit and strange adversary. He is thronged by afflictions and sufferings. He becomes soiled with dust. The dust of love is elixir of life.

سچی رات سنجی تڑپھاندی ہے تقی تول ستیں اگ لاندی ہے
ڈکھی ڈسک ڈسک گر لاندی ہے برے برہوں دے سہا سنجاتے میں

“The shades of evening keep the damned restless. My blazing beddings burn me when I go to sleep. The

sufferer groans by heaving sighs. I have recognized the breath (nature) of evil love.”

The shades of night fall making him fall too. He becomes so restless. He breathes love and becomes out of breath. Love inhaling is not a child's play.

بے واہی وہ واہ میری ہے ہو عزت جاہ میری
سُخ واہ ہے تکیہ گاہ میری پاتی پیت توں ایہا براتے میں

“I laud that my being without shelter is my support. Infamy is my honour. The barren plains are my habitations. I have got all these fortunes at the hands of love.”

He has to adjust himself regarding the inverse picture appearing on the retina of love sarcasm, notwithstanding. There is no shelter except the support of his beloved. Infamy in the way of love is his honour. The barren plains are his habitations where he can fully concentrate on his beloved.

لگی تیانگ پنل دی سَنگ جڈاں بھنا چوڑا اجڑی مانگھ تڈاں
اللہ کھیسم وصل داسانگ کڈاں سہرے ساڑسے گہنے لاتے میں

“When the spear of Punnal's longing hit me, it broke the set of my bangles and my head line became uneven (widowhood symbolising acute suffering). My Allah! When there would be an eventful moment of my union? I have burnt my chaplets and thrown away my ornaments.”

The spear of longing hits her by ravishes her habitual world. She destroys the old for the rebirth of the new. She invokes God's Grace in realising union with her beloved.

نہ باجھ ہے باجھ خواری دے ایسے حال تساڑی یاری دے
ڈکھے گذرن ڈینہہ ازاری دے مٹھے نین کلڑے لاتے میں

“I have no support except disgrace. It is the condition of your friendship. My days are passing in sufferings

and distress. My hapless eyes have entangled themselves in unintelligible relationships.”

It is the expression of love and friendship that it offers disgrace as the only support. Isn't such a disgrace more graceful than all the graces of the world? Love is an unintelligible relationship which entangles her. Her eyes have to pay a very heavy price for beholding their beloved.

گل زلف پنل دا پچ پیس ہتھ ہوت دے دلڑی وچ ڈتم
سٹ سیجھ فرید بعید تھیم ویساں کچھ زہساں جاتے میں

“Punnal's lock of hair is around my neck. I have bartered my heart in the hands of my beloved. Farid! I have thrown away the nuptial bed and have distanced myself from it. I won't stay here but go to Ketch.”

The mystery of love lies in the beloved's lock of hair. It locks him from all sides and throws away the key in the infinite ocean of love. Union is just finding that key.

Kafi-130

دلدار بغیر اولیاں ماہی باجھ کللیاں

“I am useless without my friend. I am worthless without my beloved.”

The absolute consciousness of love reveals to her that she is just a thing of no use without her friend. Her whole worth depends on her attachments with her beloved.

سَنَگِ ہجر دے رَلیاں ماہی جھوک لڈائی ویندا

“My beloved is going away by tying up his household. I have entered the realm of disunion.”

The transcendence of her beloved immerses her in the state of disunion.

ترس نہ آوے ہک تل تینوں سخت غماں وچ گلیاں

“You don’t have an iota of pity on me. I am rotting in great sorrows.”

The pitiable lover rots in immense sorrows and laments that her beloved does not take pity on her plight. Isn’t the beloved’s taking pity at this premature stage of love tantamount to ending the game of love?

ویڑھا کھاوے انگن نہ بھاوے اک فراق دی جلیاں

“My neighbourhood haunts me and my courtyard does not appeal to me. I have been burnt in the fire of separation.”

The fire of separation separates her from her physical and social vicinity. Doesn’t the degree of separation correspond to the degree of proximity with her beloved?

شرم و نجایم بھرم گنوائیم زلدی کوچے گلیاں

“I have cast away my honour and have lost my prestige. I am wretchedly wandering in streets and lanes.”

Isn't the casting away of one's honour and losing one's prestige indicative of righteousness in love? It is the ruling of love that anything earned by one's own hands has to go. Only that thing sustains, which is bestowed by the beloved.

عشق فرید بہوں ڈکھ ڈسیم اج کل موئی بھلیاں

“Farid! Love will give me greater sufferings. It is better that I die one of these days.”

He reaches the crossroad of love in quest of his beloved. It is an either/or. He has either to bear incoming great sufferings of love or to die early in order to be saved from them. His favouring the latter option signifies the magnitude of pain and suffering he has to undergo in his desire and longing for union.

Kafi-131

آمل ماہی میں ماندیاں بے وس برہوں دی باندیاں

“My beloved! Do come and meet me for I am weary.
I am a helpless maid of love.”

She gets weary of love in the absence of her beloved. A feeling of being a helpless maid of love shows the tremendous power of love, which completely subjugates her. The idea of conquering the universe creates pride but the idea of being conquered by love creates humility. She is thinned as a thread and straightened in order to pass through the eye of the needle of love.

عشق اوڑے دشمن ویڑھے سس ناناں کرم بکھیڑے
امڑی جڑ جڑ لاؤم جھیڑے بابل ویر نہ بھاندیاں

“It is a peculiar love and the enemies are in my courtyard. My mother-in-law and sister-in-law develop incongruities with me. My mother is pointedly picking up brawls. I am unacceptable to my father and brothers.”

The peculiarity of love is that it creates its enemies from within. The heightened antagonistic contradictions between the self (individual and social) and the Self are not imported but given in the very situation of love.

کھیڑے بھیڑے سخت ستاون نیڑے وسدے مارن آون
سینگیاں سرتیاں تہمت لاون کلہڑی پئی کر لاندیاں

“The despicable ‘Kheras’ highly vex me. My neighbours are in for thrashing me. My intimate

companions are casting allegations against me. I am groaning in loneliness.”

She faces a very hostile situation at the hands of her near and dear ones and as a consequence becomes secluded from her social relationships. There is a qualitative difference between alienation and solitude. Alienation is a ‘deficient mode of being-with-others.’ A person who is completely immersed in the world can be ‘lonely in crowd and crowded when alone’ but he can never be in solitude as against her who experiences solitude solely in reference to her beloved.

سیجھ سڑیندی لنے لیندی گانے گہنے پھل نہ پیندی
تول تلیندی چوڑ جلیندی روندی تے غم کھاندیاں

“The nuptial bed is burning and blazing me. I am not wearing colour threads around my wrist (symbolising marital bond), ornaments and flowers. The nuptial quilt is grilling me and my set of bangles is burning me. I am crying and bearing sorrows.”

All things symbolising nuptial union become the very cause of her suffering in the state of separation and disunion.

ڈکھڑے پاواں نینہ نہاواں توں بن کینوں کوک سناواں
تپدیں کھپدیں وقت ونجاواں ول ول جھوکاں جاندیاں

“I face sufferings but remain committed in love. To whom should I narrate my tale of suffering except you? I pass my time, while burning and raising hue and cry. I repeatedly keep on going to your dwellings.”

She remains true to love in spite of intense sufferings. She can only communicate the tale of her sufferings to her beloved for there is no one who can existentially understand the intricacies of her love. There is no middle man in love. The third person always remains an outsider. She desperately tries to find her beloved in the deserted dwellings. She constantly grapples with the transcendence of her beloved.

مولی جھوکاں پھیر و سہی
ساراروگ اندر دواویسی
یار فریدانگن پوں پیسی
ڈلیم بانہہ سیر اندیاں

“God will again make these habitations turn into dwellings. All my internal malaise will wither away. Farid! My friend will visit my courtyard. He will fold his arm under my head.”

He keeps treading the path of love with a ray of hope in the benevolence of his beloved. He is hopeful that his beloved will unveil himself within his being ending his inner malaise. He will realise union with him.

Kafi-132

میڈا عشق وی توں میڈا یار وی توں میڈا دین وی توں ایمان وی توں

“You are my love. You are my friend. You are my way. You are my faith.”

Love itself is polarised in the forms of the lover and the beloved. The transcendent Reality takes immanent form to make love possible. He offers his absolute, sincere and unconditional love to his beloved. Religiosity does not understand the reality of love and friendship for it remains tied to the dichotomy of master and slave. A slave's obedience arises due to the fear of his master. It is love that transforms religious consciousness into spiritual one by revealing the Reality as the beloved friend. There are many ways of life but he chooses the way of love. The axis of his whole life is love of God. He has unflinching faith in the transcendental (Nonmanifest) and immanent (Manifest) realities.

میڈا جسم وی توں میڈا روح وی توں میڈا قلب وی توں جند جان وی توں

“You are my body. You are my Spirit. You are my heart. You are the spirit of my life.”

He has no being in itself. He has ontological consciousness of his own nothingness. He has gnostic consciousness of his whole body being theophany of the Reality. The Reality is the warp and woof of his whole body (being-in the world) The Spirit or the Divine Essence, which inheres in him, does not belong to him. ‘It is in ‘him’ but is not ‘his.’ It rightfully belongs to God. His ‘heart’ contains innate knowledge. His beloved dwells in the inmost chambers of his ‘heart’. It is the abode of his beloved. His beloved is

the animating and vibrant spirit of his life. His whole life is permeated with divine love.

میڈا کعبہ قبلہ مسجد منبر مصحف تے قرآن وی توں

“You are my House of God, direction of prayer, mosque, pulpit, Scripture and the Qur’an.”

He as a lover is spiritually oriented to life. The religious symbols gain spiritual orientation. They do not remain enmeshed in religiosity but are transformed into spirituality. The lover becomes ‘the speaking Qur’an.’

میڈے فرض فریضے حج زکواتاں صوم صلوات اذان وی توں

“You are my rituals, pilgrimages, almsgiving, fasting, prayers and call to prayer.”

Rituals are not ends in themselves but are means to the attainment of union with the beloved. The rituals manifest the presence of God. They become lifeless once they cease to manifest His presence. The most authentic call is a call to inwardness. It is a call to orient one’s whole life to God.

میڈی زہد عبادت طاعت تقویٰ علم وی توں عرفان وی توں

“(You are) my asceticism, worship, obedience and piety. You are my knowledge. You are my gnosis.”

His asceticism, worship, obedience and piety absolutely belong to the beloved. They do not remain external to him but become internalised. God is the object of knowledge. All levels of knowledge manifest the corresponding levels of the Reality including gnosis (‘esoteric knowledge of spiritual truth’), which is a direct experience of God.

میڈا ذکر وی توں میڈا فکر وی توں میڈا ذوق وی توں وجدان وی توں

“You are my remembrance. You are my reflection. You are my tasting. You are my intuition (inspiration).”

He constantly remembers God. He considers even a moment of forgetfulness as sinful. He reflects on the symbols of God both within his own self and the world. He does not remain merely at the reflective level but experiences the ultimate nature of things. He has intellectual intuition of the Reality, which is more immediate than even sensory intuition. He experiences God in 'the infinite depths of his being or consciousness.'

میڈا سناول میٹھرا شام سلونا من موہن جاناں وی توں

"You are my charming, sweet, supporting, pleasant and bewitching beloved."

He is captivated by the beauty of his beloved, which evokes all finer sentiments in him.

میڈا مرشد ہادی پیر طریقت شیخ حقائق دان وی توں

"You are my spiritual master, guide and adept of the Sufi way and Gnostic with full knowledge of realities."

The Reality assumes the form of the spiritual master and guides the disciple on the gnostic path. People remain stranded in forms and fail to reach the Formless hidden within them. The spiritual master is human but it is the Divine that wholly acts through him. The infallibility of the spiritual master is essentially the infallibility of the Reality openly manifest in him. Revering his murshid is essentially revering God.

میڈا آس اُمید تے کھیاوٹیا تکیہ مان تے تران وی توں

"You are my hope, expectation and profitable earnings, reliance, pride and support."

The beloved is the ground of hope, expectations and achievements. His only pride is in his beloved. He fully relies upon the support of his beloved in all situations of life. He never banks upon otherness.

میڈا دھرم وی توں میڈا بھرم وی توں میڈا شرم وی توں میڈا شان وی توں

“You are my righteousness. You are my trust. You are my sense of honour. You are my glory.”

His righteousness is not self-styled but is rooted in the ultimate nature of things. It stems from the beloved. The beloved is the foundation of his credit, trust and prestige. He has no separate sense of honour. It is completely formed in reference to his beloved. He does not take glory in anything except in his beloved.

میڈا ڈکھ سکھ روون لھلن وی توں میڈا درد وی توں درمان وی توں

“You are my suffering, peace, crying and laughing. You are my pain. You are my remedy.”

He suffers in the path of love. He has peace in unison with his beloved. He is sad when he misses him. He is happy when he finds him. He is in pain in the state of disunion. The beloved remedies it by realising union.

میڈا خوشیاں دا اسباب وی توں میڈے سولاں دا سامان وی توں

“You are the cause of my joys. You are the cure of my afflictions.”

He experiences joy in his beloved's responsiveness. The only cure of his afflictions (separation and disunion) is uniting with his beloved.

میڈا حسن تے بھاگ سہاگ وی توں میڈا بخت تے نام و نشان وی توں

“You are my beauty and nuptial fortune. You are my prosperity and celebrity.”

His beauty, nuptial fortune, prosperity and celebrity solely lie in his beloved. He has no concern in their worldly counterparts or terrestrial dimensions.

میڈا ڈیکھن بھالن جاچن جوچن مجھن جان سنجان وی توں

“You are my seeing, caring, examining, verifying, understanding and recognition.”

He orients all his sources and modes of knowledge in deeply knowing his beloved. It leads to the metaphysical identity of knowledge and being.

میڈے ٹھڈے سلتے مونجھ منجھلی ہنجنوں دے طوفان وی توں

“You are my sighs of despair, anguishes and the flood of tears.”

The sighs of despair, anguishes and flood of tears arise due to separation and disunion from his beloved.

میڈے تک تلے سیندھال ناز نہورے تان وی توں
مانگھال

“You are my brow colour mark, mole and hair parting line on head, pride, coqueties and imperiousness.”

His expressions of beauty and love are solely for the sake of his beloved.

میڈی میندی کل مساک وی توں میڈی سرخی بیڑاپان وی توں

“You are my henna, collyrium and twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects). You are my rouge and the triangular fold of betel-leaf.”

The colourfulness of his life completely hinges on the positive response of his beloved.

میڈی وحشت جوش جنون وی توں میڈا گریہ آہ و فغان وی توں

“You are my desolation, animation and frenzy. You are my crying and lamentation.”

The varying states of his Gnostic and suffering consciousness (intentional) are attached to his beloved.

میڈا شعر عروض توانی توں میڈا بحر وی توں اوزان وی توں

“You are my verse, prosody and rhyme. You are my metre. You are my balance.”

The inward musicality of love is manifest in different forms of poetry. All poetry stems from his lovely beloved. The essence of poetry is openness-into-transcendence.

میڈا اول آخر اندر باہر ظاہر تے پنہان وی توں

“You are my first, last, inward, outward, visible and the invisible.”

The Reality manifests itself in all dimensions of his embodied self.

میڈا فردا تے دیروز وی توں ایوم وی توں آں وی توں

“You are my coming day and the bygone day. You are my today. You are my instant.”

He identifies time and eternity with Reality.

میڈا بادل برکھا لھمنیاں گا جاں بارش تے باران وی توں

“You are my cloud, rain, lightening, thundering, downpour and rainfall.”

All inward and outward openings of love are in the hands of his beloved.

میڈا ملک ملہیر تے مارو تھلڑا روہی چولستان وی توں

“You are my dominion Malheer and deadly sandy tract, wasteland and desert.”

All liveliness and deadness is in reference to the states of love. He feels animated in the presence of his beloved and feels deadened in his absence.

جے یار فرید قبول کرے سرکار وی توں سلطان وی توں

“Farid! If the friend accepts you, then you are the authority and you are the sovereign.”

If a person is accepted by God (Friend), then He manifests Himself in His Attributes of Power in that medium conferring on him authority and sovereignty. A person thereby exercises authority and sovereignty over things and events. Religiosity takes false pride in human effort. Faith and good deeds, notwithstanding the ultimate recognition of a person entirely depends upon the Grace of God.

نہ تاں کہتر کمتر احقر ادنیٰ لاشے لامکان وی توں

“Otherwise, you are the least, inferior, meanest and ordinary bereft of reality and devoid of possibility.”

A person who fails to be worthy of recognition by his friend is then brought down to the lowest of the low. He becomes bereft of reality and devoid of any possibility of development. He is reduced to a thing of no use.

Kafi-133

میڈا یار گیا پردیس ڈوں وے میاں گانے گننے کینویں پانواں (ڑی پانواں)

“My beloved has gone to a foreign land. Why should I wear jewellery and for whom should I ornament myself.”

The transcendence of her beloved does not inspire her to beautify herself.

ساڑاں سیندھ تے مانگھ اجاڑاں بوڈی کوں اگ لاناواں (ڑی لاناواں)

“I burn my hair parting line of head and make it uneven (widowhood symbolising extreme suffering). I commit the braid of my hair to fire.”

She becomes desperate in facing the intricacies of love.

بٹھ کجلا بن سرخیاں میندیاں سولیں سانگ نہاواں (ڑی نہاواں)

“I cast away collyrium and do away with rouge and henna. Now, I have to bear afflictions.”

She is not in a mood to add colours to her, while bearing the brunt of separation and disunion.

سجڑی رات کراں فریاداں ڈینہاں وین ولاواں (ڑی ولاواں)

“I beseech in the evening and tune wailings in the day.”

She suffers to the core of her being in missing her beloved.

ککڑے کنڈڑے فرش وچھا کر ڈکھ دی سیجھ سہاواں (ڑی سہاواں)

“I make gravel (small pieces of stone) and thorns as my beddings. I ornament my nuptial bed with sufferings.”

Her plight can be gauged from the fact that even her resting place makes her so restless.

ملک ملہیر نہ وٹھڑم ہے ہے روروسندھ ڈوں آواں (ڑی آواں)

“Alas, there has been no rain in the city of Malheer. Now, I am coming towards Sindh, while crying.”

She moves pitifully from one place to another in search of her transcendent beloved.

بھینیں ویرتھئے سبھ ویری امڑی مول نہ بھاواں (ڑی بھاواں)

“My sisters and brothers all have become my adversaries. My mother also does not tolerate me even for a moment.”

One of the most glaring indications of love is that the nearest and the dearest ones become one's adversaries. She loses her communication even with the most intimate ones. Isn't the blocking of these channels a prerequisite to the opening of channels of communication with one's beloved?

باجھوں یار فرید ہمیشہ رت روواں غم کھاواں (ڑی کھاواں)

“Farid! I always pour the tears of blood and bear the fruits of sorrow without my friend.”

His separation and disunion from his beloved is not an ordinary happening but is a traumatic experience. Isn't the intensity of trauma that transforms his inner being and perfects him for attaining unison with his beloved?

Kafi-134

عشق اسماڈا دین ایمان

ناصح ناہی نہ تھی مانع

“My adviser and counsellor do not stop me from it.
Love is the way of our tradition.”

He goes beyond the religious advice and counselling in committing himself to the tradition of love. Religiosity is condemned to play safe. It takes no risks. It has no inkling of the game of love. It has no strength to traverse the intricate path of love rampant with pains, adversities and sufferings. It deprives its votaries from the inward infinite space and compels them to live in an outward finite space leading to problems of religious maladjustments. Its denial of the inward inflates the outward. It romanticises fear and keeps its votaries chained to the external and the apparent. It believes in the transcendent God bereft of immanence. It is happy in placing Him in the Heavens and following His Commandments on the earth. And in attempting to follow His Commandments, its votaries start following their own vain desires. It leads to dogmatism, ritualism and sectarianism. Religious behaviour becomes constricted and elements of hatred, hypocrisy and militancy start creeping in. The denial of the spiritual dimension of religion is denial of the essence of religion. It tantamount to rejecting the Signs of God without encompassing them with knowledge says the Qur'an. The denial of spirituality veils 'the infinite depths of one's being or consciousness.' The 'Universal Man' is reduced to a mere embodied self. Religiosity becomes instrumental in the spiritual fall of man. It has no real understanding of tawhid or unity of God. It does not understand the simultaneity of God's transcendence and immanence. It

denies the Omnipresence of God and that's why it is damned to see polytheism, idolatry and infidelity everywhere. It falsely accuses the Unitarians of placing divinity beside Allah. It has no notion of saint reverence, which it falsely equates with saint worship. It stifles religious creativity by stamping its own ignorance on rightful innovations in religion. Religiosity in its zeal to weed out certain foreign elements creeping in its beliefs and practices blows them out of proportion and dupes its votaries in believing the necessity of its pseudo claims. These exercises in self-deception are spiritually so ruinous. They strike at the very roots of religion. Religiosity degenerates in projecting worship of its self-created idols without any pang of conscience. It finally ends up in misconceiving the 'Signs of God.' It is the gnosis of love, which can rid the modern man from 'learned ignorance' and the philosophies of hatred. Religion can only be handled with love.

کُنت کنزاً عشق گواہی پہلوں حب خود ذات کوں آہی
جیں سانگے تھیا جمل جہان

“‘Hidden Treasure’ testifies love itself. Originally, the Essence inspired itself with love. It caused the entire universe.”

‘Hidden Treasure’ manifested the forms of the world and appeared to the Essence itself in these forms. The entire worlds or the cosmic manifestation is understandable by the reality of Love. Divine love causes the ontological movement by virtue of which the world comes into existence from the state of non-existence. ‘Hidden Treasure’ refer to the holy tradition wherein the Divine Essence loved to be known. ‘I was a hidden treasure and I desired (ahabatu, loved’) to be known Accordingly, I created the creatures and thereby made Myself known to them. And they did come to know Me’. This tradition is fundamental in accounting for the original emergence of the principle of differentiation within the Reality. Self-Consciousness is the primordial and fundamental

polarization within the Absolute. The otherness is not absolute for in case of divine Self-Consciousness the principle of otherness is essentially for Self-realization.

عشق ہے ہادی پر مگر دَا عشق ہے رہبر راہ فقر دَا
عشقتوں حاصل ہے عرفان

“Love is the guide to the city of affection. Love steers the way to ontological nothingness. Love leads to the realisation of gnosis.”

‘Love of God is legitimate for the Divine Essence assumes the form of the personal Divinity, which in reference to man is a human aspect and in the soul of man there is an affective element which makes this relationship possible.’ Love makes him attain full consciousness of his ontological nothingness and ultimately unites him with his beloved. Love leads to the identity of knowledge and being. The realisation of gnosis takes place at the hands of love.

مال عیال دی بٹھ گھت یاری دنیا عقی توں تھی عاری
بے سامانی ہے سامان

“Cast aside the attachment with wealth and family. Be devoid of this world and the world hereafter. Poverty is richness.”

He has no attachment with wealth and family. He has no craving to possess anything of this world or the next one. His void is his plenitude. His ontological nothingness mirrors Reality itself. He realises union with his beloved.

مذہب مشرب لا مذہب دَا لب ہے سارے آرٹ عرب دَا
شاہد درس حدیث قرآن

“The religious tradition of ‘negation’ (in the connotative sense and not in the denotative one for there is nothing except Reality) is the kernel of the

entire Arab heritage. It is evident in the teachings, Hadith and the Qur'an."

The kernel of the entire Arab heritage, imbibed in the Islamic tradition, pertains to the negation (la) of any reality for there is no reality except the Reality. It is in the explication of Islamic Shahadah that one can clearly decipher the metaphysical message of tawhid. It provides a key to unlock the treasure of two assertions pertaining to the Absolute and the relative. The first Shahadah by virtue of transcendence (tanzih) and the second Shahadah by virtue of immanence (tashbih) conveys the metaphysical message of tawhid. The Shahadah becomes the doctrinal basis and the most perfect expression of Oneness of Being (wahdat al-wujud).

سکھ خلت سٹ غیر دی علت ابن العربی دی رکھ ملت
آکھیم سوئے فخر جہان

"Learn the lesson of unity and leave craving of otherness. Be in the tracks of Ibn' Arabi. The majestic Fakhr Jehan advises so."

His spiritual master advises him to learn the lesson of uniting with the beloved. He has to cease craving of otherness. He has to remain in the tracks of Ibn' Arabi, who teaches the doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al wujud).

غافل شاغل ناسی ذاکر صالح طالح مومن کافر
سب ہے نور قدیم داشان

"All is the Splendour of the Primordial Light (manifest) in the unmindful and the devotee, the neglectful and the attentive, the virtuous and the vicious and the faithful and the infidel."

The Primordial Light manifests in different forms. The distinction between light and darkness, true and false, beautiful and ugly, good and evil, perfect and imperfect and

so on arises in the process of manifestation. The negativities or privations pass through certain cosmic cycles and ultimately return to their source. Religiosity erroneously considers them as absolute whereas spirituality rightfully understands them in their relative context. Isn't everything sacred at its roots?

احد اوی ہے احمد اوی ہے میم دے اولے دلڑی مو ہے
دھیان فرید رکھیں ہر آن

“He is Ahad. He is Ahmad. He captivates the heart by being manifestly hidden (remaining immanent and transcendent) in the form of Meem (Muhammad). Farid! Keep constant watchfulness (about this Divine disclosure).”

The doctrine of the Logos considers Ahmad as the first self-determination of the Absolute. It is by virtue of the principle of Ahmad that the undifferentiated Reality (al-ahadiyah) assumed differentiated form (al-wahidiyah). It is at this stage that ‘the Essence at the level of Unity determined itself before any other forms of self-determination.’ The Prophet realized the permanent and actual synthesis of all states of Being. The Reality captivates the ‘heart’ hidden in the form of Muhammad. Islamic Shahadah enlightens us in understanding this fact by virtue of discernment and integration. The first Shahadah point toward discernment whereas the second establishes integration.

Kafi-135

نمینہ لایم کارن سکھ وے میاں پئے پلڑے ڈوڑے ڈکھ وے میاں

“I initiated love for the sake of attaining peace, my master. Multiple sufferings have fallen to my lot, my master.”

He contracts love for the sake of peace but multiple sufferings fall to his lot. He suffers at the hands of the world. He has to undergo pangs of separation and disunion. His perception of love changes with the passage of time. His theory of love does not hold ground in practice. It is dynamism of love, which makes him understand the dimensions of the beloved.”

نہ خواہش دنیا دولت دی نہ شاہی شوکت صولت دی

ہے ہک دیدار دی بوکھ وے میاں

“I have no wish of worldliness, suzerainty of power or regal status. I have only hunger of witnessing my beloved, my master.”

He has no wish of worldly pomp and show. He only desires the vision of his beloved. Religiosity takes pride in sermonising its votaries to abolish the love of worldly things and concentrate on God but it meets with a limited success. Spirituality just does the opposite with unlimited success. It provides a glimpse of the beloved to ignite love in the heart of the lover and then the wish of worldly things just withers away from his mind. Sufi doctrinal sittings are catalyst of inward transformations.

نہ قاصد نہ پیغام آیا نہ خشک جواب سلام آیا

گئی گذر عمر جگھ جگھ وے میاں

“There has been neither messenger nor message. I have not received any cold response, too. My life has been spent rotting in suffering, my master.”

He encounters the most agonising moments of love when he does not receive any form of message or any indication of his beloved. He does not get even a curt reply, which could have signified a connection though poised negatively. It makes his life rot in suffering.

وچ دلڑی درد اندوہ بھری پئی روڑی وانگے چنگ ذری
نیت سڑم تتی دکھ دکھ وے میاں

“My life is full of pain and grief. It is like a spark that flames a heap of litter. I am the inept one being consumed in fire, my master.”

He faces pain and grief in being separated from his beloved. The spark of love consumes him little by little like a heap of litter that catches fire with a spark.

کہیں خبر ڈساں میں ڈھالادی دل سبھڑی مُنہڑی مُنڈھ لادی
تھولی گالھوں ویندی ڈکھ وے میاں

“How should I narrate the state of my ups and downs? My heart is damned and ravished ever since the primordial day. It suffers even on account of a petty matter, my master.”

His heart bears intense sufferings since the primordial day to the extent that now even a petty matter becomes a source of suffering for it.

ہیوں عشق وے ملک دے میر اساں پوشاک ہے لیر کتیر اساں
ہے بستر کھتری نکھ وے میاں

“We are notables of the city of love. Our royal dress is made of countless patches. Our sleeping mat is worn out that has been made by the leaves of palm dates, my master.”

The notables of the city of love wear a royal dress made of countless patches. These patches symbolise appearance (multiplicity) beneath, which lies Reality (unity). His sleeping mat made of palm date leaves, symbolises his constant thriving to concentrate on his beloved without forgetfulness.

ایہو کھٹیا علم ہنر دا ہے کیوں وِسرے نقش پتھر دا ہے
سوئے خان پنل دکھ وے میاں

“It is the only earning of our knowledge and art.
Why should I forget the face of my beloved Khan
Punnal? It is a line carved in stone, my master?”

She considers knowledge and its realisation as her only treasure since it does not make her oblivious of the reality of her beloved, which is permanent and unaffected by the vicissitudes of time.

ہے چھوٹیں لادی دل کٹھڑی ہتھوں ناز بروچل دی مُٹھڑی

“My heart was butchered (crushed) ever since
childhood. It has become more miserable in the
hands of my prideful beloved. I have yet to give it any
peace, my master.”

She remembers the primordial ravishing of her heart. It becomes more miserable when the beloved does not respond to her because of his being prideful. Her heart has not been in a state of peace ever since it contracted love.

تھل مارو دے وچ رو گیا آیا سخت ڈکھاں دے وات جیا
تلے ریت تنی او توں لگھ وے میاں

“He has left me wretched in the deadly desert. My
heart has been gripped by terrible sufferings. There is
burning sand beneath me and the hot wind blows
above me, my master.”

She finds herself stranded in the deadly desert of life. Her heart experiences terrible sufferings. She faces severe adversities of life.

جیس ڈینہہ فریدتوں یارِ رُٹھن پٹ روروکٹ کٹ پیٹ مٹھن
ماری مک سینے گک لگھ وے میاں

“Farid! I have been mourning and crying ever since my friend snapped ties of communication with me. I have beaten my chest and boxed my ribs, my master.”

He fiercely suffers at distancing of his beloved. He is at a loss to understand the reason of his beloved snapping friendly ties with him.

Kafi-136

وچ روہی دے رہندیاں نازک نازو جٹیاں

“The tender, sublime and stout maids dwell in the desert.”

The desert maids symbolise tender, sublime and stout possibilities dwelling within the human self.

راتیں کرن شکار دلیں دے ڈینہاں ولوڑن مٹیاں

“They hunt hearts at night (contemplation) and in the morning, churn their vessels (action).”

The possibilities in the process of their realisation, lead to the integration of contemplation and action so beautifully brought forth in the Qur’anic verses of Surah Muzzamil.

لجھڑے تیر چلاون کاری سے سے دلڑیاں پھٹیاں

“They hit hard the arrows of mystery. They pierce countless hearts.”

The mysterious possibilities of love are actualised by ravishing countless hearts.

کر کر درد منداں کوں زخمی ہے ہے بدھن نہ پٹیاں

“They inflict wounds on the compassionate souls. Oh! Oh! They do not even bandage them.”

The compassionate ones are susceptible to love. They are wounded by love without being bandaged by their beloveds.

چھیڑن بھیڑاں بکریاں گائیں لیلے گاہے کٹیاں

“They graze sheep, goats, cows, lambs, calves and young buffaloes.”

Love makes possible the grazing (realisation) of different possibilities of the self in the vicissitudes of life.

کئی مسکین مسافر پھاتھے چوڑکیتونے ترٹیاں

“They have trapped many a lowly travellers. They have ruined their lives.”

Love has waylaid many a modest lowly travellers and slaughtered them at the s of their beloveds.

دھوئیں دار فقیر تھیوے نخر وڈائیاں سٹیاں

“We have become the meditative mystics. We have discarded self-conceitedness.”

He meditates on his own ontological nothingness by ceasing to be self-conceited, which arises due to the illusory notion of separate selfhood. The union with the beloved is attained by fostering mutual selfhood. A man devoid of love remains estranged from the higher possibilities of his self and is captivated in ‘the narrow circuits of his individuality.’ He is condemned to live on the psychic plane, which stultifies development of his personality. The loss of his personality correspondingly gives birth to his ‘ego’ and makes him self-conceited. He loses the taste of real freedom. His apparent freedom turns into bondage. The crisis of the modern man is the loss of his capacity and strength to love.

ہیوں دلبر دے کُترے دردے برہوں پیاں گل کٹیاں

“We are dogs at the doorsteps of our beloved and around our neck is the collar (chain) of love.”

He considers himself as canine at the doorstep of his beloved in all humility. His commitment to love impregnated with his belongingness to the beloved is symbolised by the collar of love around his neck. The modern man has lost the sense of belongingness due to the loss of spiritual love. It

leads to alienation, depersonalisation and dehumanisation. One of the greatest miracles of love is that it blesses the lover with a sense of belongingness to the beloved, which is greater than the treasures of the world. It is the sense of belongingness, which makes him face testing situations of life with sincerity, courage and hope. It gives a higher meaning to his life. A person who does not belong to God does not belong to himself.

موجھ فرید مزید ہمیشہ
آج کلھ خوشیاں گھٹیاں

“Farid! Anguish is constantly on the increase. These days’ joys have decreased.”

He passes through different states of union and disunion. The state of disunion makes him experience increasing anguish and decreasing happiness.

Kafi-137

ویسوں سنجھ صاحبیں خالی رہسن جائیں

“We will go from here in the morning or evening.
The dwellings will be deserted.”

The self (nafs) infused with the Spirit (Ruh) will go to its eternal abode by leaving bodily dwellings in the terrestrial world.

کچھی پردیسی اُٹھے سردے دودن دے خلقتائیں

“We are birds of the north coming from distant lands.
We are thirsty of two days hospitality.”

The self coming from the celestial world thirsts hospitality of embodiment for a brief period in order to realise higher possibilities of existence.

ملک بیگانہ دیس پرایا کوجھیاں کوڑ بنائیں

“It is an estranged country and an alien land. All
foundations are false and ugly.”

The self find the body estranged and alienated with false and ugly demeanour. But it is solely through the medium of the body that the self has to accomplish the task of winning immortality. The base metal has to be turned into gold.

نہ کوئی ساتھی نہ کوئی سنگتی کینوں درد سنائیں

“I have neither any companion nor any friend to
whom I could narrate the tale of my pain.”

He finds no companion or friend to share his pain of separation and disunion from his beloved. He has to carry the cross of love himself.

قسمت سانگے ڈتھم اے دھرتی آند اکون اتھائیں

“I have seen the terrestrial world by dint of fortune.
Who would have come here otherwise?”

The birth in the terrestrial world is not a misfortune but a great blessing of Divine Mercy. Symbolically speaking, the self gets embodied by primordial fortune. How could love be realised otherwise?

حسن نگر ڈوں تھیم روانہ یارب توڑ پچائیں

“I have started towards the City of Beauty. My
Sustainer! Make me reach my destination.”

The self embarks on the path of realising the Self (the beautiful beloved). He beseeches His Sustainer to fructify his efforts of realisation.

مٹگاں دعائیں اللہ سائیں وچھڑیا ڈھول ملائیں

“I pray to God, my benefactor, to unite me with my
parted beloved.”

He prays to God to transform his disunion in unison with his primordial beloved.

عشق فرید بہوں ڈکھ ڈتڑے بچھیتاں برہوں بلائیں

“Farid! Love has given me great sufferings. The
calamities of love keep track of me.”

He is tracked by the calamities of love that instil great sufferings on him.

Kafi-138

ویندیں دل کچھ ڈو پنل کیندے کان

“My Punna! You are going to Ketch for whom?”

She tries to delve on the mystery of her beloved's transcendence.

جیندیں سانول رل مل مانوں شہر بھنبھور سیوہان

“My beloved! Let us both enjoy our lives living in Bhambore and Sauhaan.”

She wants to enjoy immanence of her beloved.

توں ہیں جیون جو گاساڈی ڈکھڑی دل دامان

“You are worthy of life. You are the honour of my suffering heart.”

She considers her beloved as the very worthiness of her life. It is honour for her heart to suffer for his sake.

ناز وادادی جانی لایو جان جگروچ کان

“My beloved! You have shot the arrows of your stylish pride in my being.”

She reminisces the moment when her beloved with stylish pride captivated her in the snare of love.

ڈتڑی جہیں امڑی کھڑی غم گھڑی ڈکھ ڈان

“My poor mother gave me mouthful of sorrow and a doze of suffering at the time of my birth.”

She recounts her primordial commitment to love impregnated with sufferings.

اے جگ اوں جگ مویں جیندیں ہاں بڑی جان نہ جان

“You may realise it or not but I belong to you in this world and in the next one and in the state of life and death.”

She reiterates her unconditional love and absolute belongingness with her beloved beyond the vagaries of time. It is an all weather friendship.

توں بن گانون یار مٹھی دے دین تتی دے وان

“My friend! The songs of the hapless and the inept one are tunes of wailing without you.”

She expresses the intensity of her suffering without her beloved. One can imagine her plight whose songs turn into wailing tunes in disunion from her beloved.

جے ڈینہ بھلڑے مٹروی بھلڑے ہے مشہور اکھان

“It is a famous proverb that if the days are good then one's friends are also good.”

She takes light from a famous proverb and thinks that her days are not good otherwise she would have found a friend who would have been highly responsive.

درد موٹھا چک چوٹھیاں پاوے مارم سول وڈان

“The hapless pain cuts and bites me. It hammers me with afflictions.”

She is crushed by the pain of separation from her friend.

لیلیٰ مجنوں ہیر زلیخا سے لڑھ گئے ہیں گھان

“Layla, Majnun, Heer, Zulaikha and countless others have drowned in the whirlpool (of sufferings).”

She takes solace in the fact that it is not only she who suffers in love but there have been many before her who remained drowned in the whirlpools of sufferings. The story of Yousaf and Zulaikha has been told and narrated at

different times with different meanings. The strange case of Zulaikha and the sufferings, which she had to undergo for the sake of Yousaf, manifests the tremendous might of love. Her whole life since she met Yousaf was a tale of suffering. Her mention with Layla, Majnun and Heer brings out a spiritual dimension of her love beyond the ken of religiosity. Religiosity is not concerned with love and thereby rests content with moral dimension of her choice. It cannot unravel the mystery of her love. Zulaikha's essential faltering or existential sinfulness consists in attempting to possess the freedom of her beloved as an object, and as a consequence in reducing her own self to an object. There can be neither union of subject and object nor union of objects. It can only be union of subjects in consonance with the ultimate nature of things. Her faltering notwithstanding, her essential quest of love remains sanctified. Love itself is beyond good and evil. The expression of love can be misdirected but not love as such. This is precisely the reason that she continues to occupy an ambivalent place in the cultural consciousness of people. Zulaikha has come to symbolise a spiritual opening beneath the labyrinth of psychic love impregnated with symbiotic attachments.

جیوے کیندے تران

باجھوں یار فرید نہایا

“How can Farid, the unacceptable one, live without the support of his friend?”

He finds himself out of place with everyone and realises that he cannot live without the support of his friend. Aren't the push factors instrumental in drawing him nigh with his beloved?

Kafi-139

صوفی سمجھ سناں

ہر جا حسن پہل ہے

“Primordial Beauty is present everywhere. Sufi!
Understand it by witnessing.”

The beautiful beloved is omnipresent. Sufi understands it by witnessing Him in all forms. He is transcendent and immanent in every form in simultaneity. His Omnipresence does not negate his transcendence but affirms it.

سب شے اس نول جان

لیس کینلہ شئی

“There is no thing resembling Him. Know Him as
All-Reality.”

There is no thing, which could resemble Him. He is ‘the Metaphysical Whole.’ There is no thing outside it. There is no thing to be denoted as such. Things have only a connotative meaning. The question of resemblance does not arise. The very attempt of religiosity to compare Him with things and then declare Him as Incomparable is missing the whole point. He is Incomparable because there is no thing to be compared with Him. ‘God is, and no thing is with Him’ says the Prophet. He is the All-Reality.

باقی کل شے فان

یثقی وجہ زیک

“The Face of your Sustainer endures. Remaining all
things perish.”

The reality of the Sustainer is changeless amidst change. The cosmos is being re-created every moment. Everything is perpetually perishing. It is in the state of ‘He/not He.’ The moment it is and at the same moment it is not. It is the

recurrence of theophanies that the mind provisionally carves as things. The perception of stability of things is an illusion. The ontological descent of theophanies and their ontological ascent is so quick that the mind fails to grasp it.

لَا يَحْتَاجُ سِوَى اللَّهِ
ہے فقر و نشان

“There is no dependence on any thing except Allah.
It is the majesty of ontological nothingness.”

All things depend upon Him for their sustenance. He is ‘Al-Ghani’ and the whole creation is ‘faqr’ says the Qur’an. The majesty of ontological nothingness consists in realising that there is no dependence on anything except Allah. No one has self-subsistent reality or independent qualities. His existence or qualities are completely derived from God and are dependent upon Him. It is Allah, who in His Infinite Wisdom manifests Himself in different forms. No medium has any quality of its own because it has nothing of its own. The question of depending upon any one thus does not arise. How could one depend on anything else when there is nothing except Allah?

لَا مَوْجُودٌ سِوَى اللَّهِ
ساڈا دین ایمان

“Nothing exists except Allah. It is the way of our tradition.”

It is the way of our tradition that there is no reality except the Reality and the cosmos including Man is the manifestation of the Reality. There is nothing beside Allah. Philosophical pantheism errs in understanding the metaphysical truth enshrined in the doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al wujud). ‘The Indivisible One-And-Only’ is ‘the One- and –All.’

حق باجھوں بیو باطل
دھیان رکھیں ہر آن

“All is ephemeral except the Reality. Do keep constant watchfulness.”

One has to remain constantly watchful of the metaphysical truth that everything is unreal and ephemeral in Face of the Most Real. One has to concentrate, for example, on Reality, Truth, Beauty, Love, Perfection, Light, Freedom, Goodness, and Knowledge as against unreality, falsehood, ugliness, hatred, imperfection, darkness, bondage, evil and ignorance, respectively. The privations or negativities are born in the process of manifestation and through a system of cosmic cycles return to the source. All things come from Allah and return to Him says the Qur'an. It is a perpetual homecoming. The friends of God, however, caution humanity to remain fully concentrated on the Reality by saving itself from the snares of unreality and the ephemeral.

علم فرید ہے حاجب بے شک بے عرفان

“Farid! Knowledge is veiled. It is undoubtedly bereft of gnosis.”

There are different levels of knowledge corresponding to different levels of Reality. The modern man commits the Delimitation Fallacy in delimiting these levels and then subsequently denying them. The levels he declares as legitimate are further delimited by the delimitation of his own mental set-up. If one fails to perceive the ‘permanent essences of things,’ ‘the transparency of the phenomena’ and ‘the ultimate nature of things’ then doubtlessly his knowledge is veiled. A piece of knowledge bereft of gnosis cannot be called knowledge. The traditional concept of knowledge demonstrates the identity of knowing and being. How could humanity survive if it labels ignorance as knowledge?

Kafi-140

ہر جاذات پیل دی عاشق جان یقین

“There is omnipresence of my beloved’s essence.
Lovers! Know it with certainty.”

Love gains realised knowledge with absolute certitude. He witnesses the essence of his beloved in all forms.

ہر صورت وچ یار داجوہ کیا اسمان زمین

“My friend’s manifestation is in each form. What to talk of the heavens and the earth.”

The friend is manifest in all forms. He is manifest not only in the cosmos but in everything.

احد ہا بن احمد آیا موہیں چین چین

“Ahad emerged in the form of Ahmad. He has captivated China and other parts of the world.”

The undifferentiated Reality emerged in the form of the differentiated one by virtue of the transcendent principle of Ahmad. The immanent principle of Ahmad in the form of Muhammad has captivating influence on different parts of the world.

حاکم ہو کر حکم چلاوے آپ بنے مسکین

“He is the Sovereign, who issues the decrees. He himself becomes lowly (assumes the form of petitioner).”

He assumes the form of the Sovereign who issues decrees. But at the same time He assumes the form of the lowly one subjected to these decrees. Religiosity cannot understand any

aspect of His manifestation since it believes in the delimited God established on throne. The Reality keeps its transcendence intact while being immanent in forms. It cannot be defiled in any form.

آپ کرے بہہ وعظ نصیحت آپ بجائے بین

“He himself delivers traditional and moral discourses in doctrinal sittings. He himself plays the flute.”

He assumes serious forms of conducting doctrinal sittings. He assumes different playful forms like playing the flute. How could any form exist bereft of His manifestation or devoid of His presence? One has to metaphysically understand that every form implies a respective formlessness.

جے چاہیں توں یار دامیلا سٹ کاوڑ بٹھ کین

“If you want to have a contact with your beloved, then discard hardness and throw away malice.”

The state of anger, fury or rage arises due to hardness of heart. A few of the impurities of the heart consist in having malice: an intention ‘to cause pain, injury or distress to another.’ It is harbouring grudge against others. A person who wants to befriend God must achieve calmness and purity of heart. The moral and psychological aspects notwithstanding, the spiritual virtues and vices have deeper spiritual meanings. Religiosity has no deeper understanding of spiritual virtues or methods of curing spiritual vices. It constricts things in their religious and moral contexts. The friend of God knows the secret of meeting God, so he delves on the avoidance of anger and malice in order to have a living contact with God. A person who avoids these spiritual vices brings calmness in his life and that of others. It leads to the expansion of his self and it is somewhere in the expansion of his self that he meets God.

زاہد کوں جانبر سناؤ عشق اساڈا دین

“Go and convey the message to the ascetic that love is our religion.”

The devout remains devoted to religious obligations and piety. He remains tied to the external aspects of religion. The Sufi lives in inwardness and considers love as his religion.

ساجن سمجھ قرین پیر مغاں ہک رمز بھائی

“The cup bearer has made us realise an intricacy of understanding the beloved as absolutely near.”

The cup-bearer makes him realise the intricacy of understanding the nearness of his beloved. It is the dawning realisation of his nearness that makes it possible for him to unite with his beloved with a relative ease.

غافل نہ تھی یار تھوں ہک دم ہر جاگہ ہر چین

“Don’t be oblivious of your friend for an instant at any place or moment.”

The lover has never to fall in oblivion of his friend at any place even for a moment. It is the spiritual lesson of constant remembrance of God. Always remembering God through one’s mind and heart with all that it implies is the royal road to the beloved.

دل فریدی لٹن کیتے بنیا فخر الدین

“He has assumed the form of Fakhr-ud-Din in order to loot the heart of Farid.”

The Reality or God assumes the form of his spiritual master and wins him through him. World Spirituality unites in paying reverence to the spiritual master. Any irreverence to him is discourtesy to God. A man who has a spiritual master has surely God on his side.

Kafi-141

ہکار مزد ہم ہر چال کنوں بکورا زڈ تھم ہر گال کنوں

“I have unravelled an essential secret in each discourse. I have found an essential clue in each move.”

He realises metaphysically the Reality manifesting in every form.

ہر صورت من نوں موہندی ہے ہر صورت دل نوں کوہندی ہے
سب نسبت یار نوں سوہندی ہے ہر حال کنوں ہر قال کنوں

“Any of the forms captivates my inwardness. Any of the figures ravishes my heart. All referential befit my beloved in each state and in every communication.”

The forms are so charming because each one of them occasions transparency of his beloved. Likewise, the figures are heart-ravishing. The manifestation of his friend is befitting in all mediums. It is befitting in every act and in every word.

کتھے دلبر تھی من موہندا ہے کتھے عاشق ہو کر روندنا ہے
کتھے ربطوں فارغ ہوندا ہے غم نازدی قید و بال کنوں

“He captivates my heart in the form of beloved at times. He resorts to crying in the form of lover at times. He gets free from all attachments, sorrows and the complex chain of priding at times.”

He assumes the form of the beloved and captivates the heart of the lover. He assumes the form of the lover and undergoes sufferings of love. But He stays transcendent in

immanence and thereby remains free from attachments. It makes Him detach from sorrows and the intricacies of pride. The metaphysical truth of His transcendence and immanence in simultaneity is witnessed by virtue of metaphysical realisation.

بدنامی میڈانام ہو یا غم کھاؤں شراب مدام ہو یا
رت پیوں کام دوام ہو یا جھٹ پیو سے شرم دی جال کنوں

“Notoriety has been identified with my name. Sorrowfulness is my regular drink. My permanent task is blood-bearing. I have become free from the sense of honour.”

He accepts notoriety in love. He does not bother about his own name. He is solely concerned with the Name of his beloved, which is identical with Reality. He constantly remains in sorrows. He is permanently blood-bearing and sacrifices his sense of honour solely for the sake of his beloved.

ڈیکھو حسن حقیقی ظاہر ہے کیا اندر ہے کیا باہر ہے
کتھے ناسی ہے کتھے ماہر ہے سوہنا اپنے وصل وصال کنوں

“Witness the manifestation of the essential Beauty in the realms of inwardness and outwardness. He is forgetful at times and at times is skilful. The Beautiful manifests itself (in different mediums).”

The essential Beauty is manifest in the Inward and the Outward. The Beautiful manifests Himself in the forms of forgetfulness and skilfulness. The simultaneity of transcendence and immanence is perceived in every form. The Reality remains perfect, by virtue of transcendence, even when it manifests itself in imperfect forms as such. The Reality or Knowledge itself, for example, remains transcendent while manifesting itself in the form of forgetfulness. It is the nature and capacity of the receptacle, human medium in the instant case, which reflects or deflects

theophanies of the Reality. The Reality remains transcendent and thereby unaffected by the mediums in which it manifests itself (immanence). If Allah is the Light of Heavens and the earth, which He is, then the entire cosmos including Man is constitutive of His Light. How could it be otherwise? The cosmos demonstrates the immanence of Allah. His transcendence consists in simultaneously remaining apart from everything in the cosmos. Religiosity neither understands the immanence of God nor His transcendence. It fails to appreciate that they are simply human ways to understand the Divine. It does not understand the relative nature of both these terms. To talk of one is to imply the other. How could one talk of God's transcendence without implying His immanence and vice versa? These terms complement each other in a certain context of understanding God. They have no relevance outside this context. The negation of the one is the negation of the other.

سب علم و علم برباد تھیا	جداں عشق فرید استاد تھیا
سو وجد کنوں لکھ حال کنوں	پر حضرت دل آباد تھیا

“Farid! When love becomes the mentor of someone, it ravishes all his knowledge and action. But, it enlivens his heart with hundreds of spiritual states and hundred thousand of ecstasies.”

Love leads to end of knowledge and action, when it becomes mentor of someone. The end of knowledge consists in the end of theoretical knowledge bound to the subject-object structure of reality. It is end of veiled knowledge. It harbingers heart-knowledge. The end of action consists in the end of contingent action bound to the individual realm. It is end of the contingent realm. It harbingers non-action. Love blows the breath of life in the deadness of heart resulting in countless ecstasies and innumerable spiritual states. The heart finally does what the mind fails to do. Heart-knowledge or gnosis leads to the identity of knowing and being. He gets united with his beloved. What else one wants?

Kafi-142

ہن دل بدلا یم ٹر سائیں گیا دردوں جیڑا جھڑ سائیں

“My heart has changed its state, my master. Pain has made my self so worrisome, my master.”

The heart changes its state from union to disunion with self becoming so worrisome.

درد دے کنڈڑے سینے لگڑے ہن دیرینے
پئے نکلن بھر بھر سائیں

“The thorns of pain are in my chest. They have been pricked ever since immemorial (primordial) times. They are crumbling and finding their way out, my master.”

The celestial pricking thorns of pain become more painful in finding their outlet in the terrestrial world.

ڈکھڑے روز سوائے جیں ڈینہہ سجن سدھائے
شہر بھنجوروں ٹر سائیں

“My daily sufferings are on the increase ever since the day my beloved went to the city of Bhambore, my master.”

He remembers his increasing sufferings since the transcendence of his beloved.

ڈکھ آیا سکھ واٹم ڈینہاں راتیں ماتم
خوشیاں دے تھئے پر سائیں

“I am mourning day and night. The entry of suffering has led to the exit of my peace. It is the death rites of happiness, my master.”

The separation from the beloved leaves him in a state of constant mourning. The sufferings encountered thereof lead to the end of peace. Happiness has been cut at its roots.

یار نہ آوے، اکھیاں روروٹیاں تھکیاں

ڈینہہ راتیں دی پھر پھر سائیں

“My friend has not come and my eyes by dint of crying to have become tired and exhausted. They involuntary wink day and night (an omen of beloved coming), my master.”

He cries in vain for his beloved. His eyes continually wink as an omen of friend's coming.

چڑا ماس لویراں کپڑے لیر کتیراں

برہوں ڈٹو سے بر سائیں

“Now, my skin and flesh have been minced. My clothes have been torn to bits. Love has given me such courage, my master.”

Courage to love makes him steadfast through mincing of his skin and flesh, and tearing of his clothes. He courageously faces pain of his self peeling unto nothingness.

صبر فرید نہ آوے گھر کھاوے جیڑا تاوے

دلڑی کیتم لرسائیں

“Farid! I am at a loss to exercise patience. My house haunts me and my self makes me burn. My heart has made me crazy, my master.”

The most difficult thing for him is to exercise patience. The collapse of his everyday world or his habitual self is nothing less than a trauma. Isn't patience in adversity that ultimately makes him unite with his beloved?

Kafi-143

ہن عشق و نجایم چس سائیں لکھ وار اس اڈی بس سائیں

“Now, love has made me lose all my fondness, my master. I have firmly resolved to end it once for all (call it a day), my master.”

She distances herself from the fondness of love by firmly resolving to end it once for all. But these firm resolves prove to be walls of sand against surging waves of love.

رات ڈینہاں تڑپھاواں رور و حال و نجاواں

رحم نہ کیتو خس سائیں

“I am restless, day and night. I keep crying and worsening my condition. There has not been an iota of pity on me, my master.”

She perpetually suffers but her beloved does not take an iota of pity on her by granting her vision or union. Isn't the beloved's taking pity on her at such a premature stage tantamount to stultifying love?

کھپدیں عمر نبھاواں کلہڑی پئی گرلاواں

دھاں کراں بے وس سائیں

“I am groaning all alone. I am leading my life by raising hue and cry. I implore out of sheer helplessness, my master.”

The highest form of loneliness is the loneliness of love. It is the solitariness of love with all its sufferings that makes union possible. Her sheer helplessness is an occasion of Divine help.

چاک مہیں من بھانے
ہنیں ڈیوم ننانے
طعنے مارم سس سائیں

“The shepherd of the flock is my beloved. My sisters-in-law rebuke me. My mother-in-law taunts me, my master.”

The beloved shepherds her embodied self so pleasantly as against the animosity of her dear and near ones.

نندر سبھو ڈکھ لایم
ستریں ساتھ لڈایم
نہ کئی خبر نہ ڈس سائیں

“My sleep is the root cause of my entire suffering. I slept and the caravan went away. There is neither any news nor any indication of his whereabouts, my master.”

The transcendence of the beloved is a moment of great remorse for her. She considers her forgetfulness as the root cause of her suffering. Transcendence has no signs. It leaves no traces.

عشتوں سود نہ پایم
سارا بھرم و نجام
جو لگڑی سوکس سائیں

“I have not profited from love. All my respect has gone down the drain. All my commitments have caused me losses, my master.”

Love leads to loss of honour. Her gains are reduced to losses instead of profits.

ڈکھے پیڑے تھل دے
پور پورون پل پل دے
در دیں دی ہتھ رس سائیں

“There are suffering paths of the desert. I am having fits at each and every moment. My reins are in the hands of suffering, my master.”

His reins are in the hands of suffering. It makes him suffer in the paths of the desert. His state is worsened by perpetual fits.

درد اندوہ گھنیرے کر دے سول وہیرے
نس گیوں دل کھس سائیں

“There is intensification of my pain and grief. I am bearing the onslaught of afflictions. You have just run away after grabbing my heart, my master.”

His intensification of pain, grief and affliction increases at the transcendence of his immanent beloved.

غم فرید ستائیم ڈکھڑانیہڑالائیم
مونہہ سرپایم بھس سائیں

“Farid! Sorrow has vexed me. I have contracted love filled with suffering. I have covered my face and head with dust, my master.”

He is vexed with sorrows. He is in a deplorable state. He repents in contracting loved filled with suffering. But is love possible without suffering?

Kafi-144

ہن کیتم برہوں تگ سائیں دل نال اساڈی جنگ سائیں

“Now, love has vexed me, my master. There is a tug of war with my heart, my master.”

He is vexed by the tug of war between his reason and heart. Reason demands rationality and has no inkling of the intellectual treasures of heart. It remains contented with the visible and resists the moves of going beyond the visible into the realm of the Invisible.

غمرے سخت اوڑے جھیرے کرن بکھیرے

نہ کچھ ترس نہ سنگ سائیں

“The enticements (of my beloved) are very peculiar, brawling and incongruous without any pity or hesitation, my master.”

The enticements of the beloved with all their characteristics captivate him. They neither have any pity on him nor hesitate to ravish his heart. The beloved perfectly ensnares him in such a way that that he cannot extricate himself from the grip of love.

عشق مرلیے لٹیاں ہٹیاں مٹھیاں کٹھیاں

تن من چورچورنگ سائیں

“Ravishing love has ransacked me. I am weary, worn out and butchered. My body and soul are crushed by being targeted of doting, my master.”

Love ravishes his embodied self. It constantly targets his heart.

گزرے ویلھے سکھ دے جی جو کھدے پیا ڈکھدے

رگ رگ تے انگ انگ سائیں

“The times of peace have passed away. My heart is burning. Suffering is rampant in every vein and part of my body, my master.”

The intensity of suffering is inimical to peace. The state of peace dwindles away once he contracts love.

درد اندوہ پرانے جھردی جھور جھرانے

یار لم دل سنگ سائیں

“My pain and grief have a long history (primordial). Worries have made me so worrisome. I have met a heartless beloved, my master.”

He remembers his primordial covenant of love, which ushered in pain and grief. His life is replete with worries. He considers his beloved as heartless, who has brought him to such a wretched state.

عشق علامت ظاہر سول گھنے تن لاغر

ساوا پیلارنگ سائیں

“The signs of love are visible. The intensity of afflictions has crippled my body exhibited in greenish yellow colour, my master.”

The intensity of love affects his embodied self. The inward states of love leave a crippling affect on the body and also change its colour into greenish yellow.

نہنہ زالی ڈاتے ملی فرید براتے

گیانا موس تے ننگ سائیں

“Love is a strange gift. It has been fortunated to Farid. It has led to the ending of all my prestige and honour, my master.”

Love is a strange gift of fortune, which cuts the roots of his worldly prestige and honour. Isn't it a great fortune that the lover is pushed to the wall and ultimately he finds himself in the lap of his beloved?

Kafi-145

ہن وطن بیگانے ول نہیں آنوناں یاد کیتم دلدارنیں

“My beloved has remembered me. Now, I will not return towards this alien land.”

She becomes stranger to her world at the call of her beloved. She responds with pure earnestness.

کو لے رہساں مول نہ سہساں ہجر داباری بارنیں

“I will remain near and will never bear the burden of disunion.”

She resolves not to bear the burden of disunion but to attain metaphysical realisation in order to live permanently with her beloved in the state of nonduality.

وسر یا سار اراج باناں وسر گیا گھر بارنیں

“All my regal status in my parent’s house has been fallen in oblivion. My entire household has become oblivious to me.”

Love makes her oblivious of her parental and household ties. She has sole ties with her beloved.

بھاڑ من لسیاں مانڈ نہھسیاں گھولے عارویارنیں،

“I will inhabit the deserted dwellings of my beloved. I have gone beyond feeling ashamed of the public opinion.”

She chooses to concentrate on her heart where her beloved dwells. She goes beyond the compulsions of public opinion inimical to her love. She freely chooses her beloved in inwardness.

سرخى کجل مساگ گيو سے بٹھ پيا ہار سنگار نين

“My rouge, collyrium and twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects) have no meaning for me. I don't care a fig for my makeup.”

She does not give an iota of meaning in beautifying herself in separation and disunion from her beloved. They become relevant in responsiveness to her beloved.

پاروں ڈسدى جھوک سجن دى کيوں رهساں اروار نين

“The dwellings of my beloved are visible across the river. Why should I remain on this side?”

She has to ferry across the stream of love in order to unite with her beloved. There is no point in remaining stranded in duality when the beloved can only be realised in nonduality.

میں متارى تے نين بارى قادر نيسم پار نين

“The stream is full and I do not know swimming. The Almighty will take me across the waters.”

She finds herself unqualified to ferry across the stream of love. Human effort stands nullified. It is the Divine Almightyness, which fructifies union.

بٹھ پئي سندھڑى کيتم مولى ملک ملهیر ملهيار نين

“Why should I bother about Sindh? My Sustainer has made the city of Malheer blossom.”

She does not bother about outward but turns inward to find it blossomed by the Sustainer.

دیس عرب داملک طرب دا سارا باغ بهار نين

“The land of Arab is the land of happiness. It is in full bloom.”

The lover finds happiness in achieving the Muhammadan station in course of his spiritual journey.

روہی راوے روہیں رو لیس نس گیا کر ہوں قطار میں

“My beloved has made me wretchedly wander in the desert ‘rohi,’ rocky grounds and mountainous terrains. He has fled away with the caravans of camels.”

He encounters wretchedness at the transcendence of his beloved.

ڈینہہ ڈکھاں داڈو نگر ڈسدا رات غماں دی غار میں

“Day seems the mount of suffering and night the cave of sorrows.”

He faces constant sufferings and sorrows at the hands of his beloved.

سانول آیا روہی وٹھڑی بار تھئی گلزار میں،

“My beloved has come and there is rain in the desert. The woods have been turned into orchards.”

The unveiling of his beloved turns disunion into union.

دار مدار فرید ہے دلنوں ڈکھڑے تار و تار میں

“Farid! My heart is bearing all these all-encompassing sufferings.”

His heart has to bear unbearable sufferings.

Kafi-146

ہے صدقے گھولے یار توں ایہو جیڑا نینہ پنناں

“I sacrifice my heart soaked in love for the sake of my friend.”

He offers his heart soaked with love to his beloved. It is the most valuable offering for the sake of his friend.

مثلاً حسن جوانی مانے مٹھری دل داوناں

“I pray that God grants beauty and youth to the beloved of my miserable heart?”

He invokes Divine Grace for the perpetual beauty and youth of his beloved, in spite of the fact that his heart has suffered miseries at the hands of his beloved.

تھل بڑے چترانگ دی بڑے ملک ملہیر دا بنناں

“These deserts with plain lands belong to you. You are the suzerain of the city of Malheer.”

The beloved's almightiness is manifest both in transcendence and immanence.

ڈکھ دا حال نہ تھیوم پورا چتران سو سو پنناں

“The narration of my heart's sufferings will not end even if I go on writing hundreds of pages.”

The sufferings of love are unending. They cannot be completely reduced to writing. Words cannot capture the tale of sufferings.

جے توں آویں تن من ڈیاں پیر پر م دا چھناں

“If you visit me, then I shall make ritual offerings of my body and soul on the altar of love.”

He tenders his whole self as a ritual vow on the altar of love in case his beloved returns.

بیعت کر کے عشق کڈھایم علم و عمل توں بناں

“Love has administered me an oath of allegiance. It has made me transcend knowledge and action.”

Love administers an oath of allegiance to itself. It makes the lover transcend the realms of knowledge and action. Knowledge turns into gnosis and action is transformed into inaction (non action). The individual and contingent spheres of knowledge and action respectively merge into the realm of the universal. Love leads to metaphysical realisation.

سو نہیں دے وچ وصف وفادی میں اے گالھ نہ مناں

“I do not believe that there is quality of faithfulness in my beloved.”

He is not ready to believe that his beloved is faithful since he undergoes sufferings in love. He gauges the faithfulness of his beloved by the act of his responsiveness. He is right but his beloved is also right. The conflict between these two perspectives of love is a conflict between two shades of rightness. It is not a conflict between right and wrong. The conflict is ultimately resolved in rightness itself.

برہوں فرید تھیو سے ساتھی سب شے توں جی بھناں

“Farid! Love has become my companion. I have broken my ties from everything (detached myself).”

He lives in the company of love. It is the uniqueness of love that he detaches himself from everything. The basic contradiction of religiosity is that it preaches detachment without offering love. It is only love that makes real detachment possible.

Kafi-147

تم بیشک اصل جہان کے ہو

“You undoubtedly belong to the real world.”

Man belongs to the real world by virtue of the Spirit (Ruh) that inheres in him.

نہ تم فرشی نہ تم عرشی
ذات مقدس نور معلیٰ
نہ فلکی نہ ارضی ہو
آئے وچ انساں کے ہو

“You are neither mundane nor celestial. You are neither heavenly nor earthly. You are the holy essence and pure light embodied in Man.”

The Spirit is neither mundane nor celestial. It is not heavenly or earthly. It is the Holy Essence (Divine Essence) or Pure Light embodied in the form of Man.

روتے ہو کھہنتے ہو
اپناں بھیت بتاؤرے
کھہ عاشق تے معشوق بنو
تم کون ہو بھلا کہاں کے ہو

“You weep at times and at times you laugh. You assume the forms of the lover and the beloved at times. Do disclose your esoteric reality. Who are you? Where do you belong to?”

Man weeps and laughs. He assumes forms of lover and beloved. The esoteric reality of Man lies in ‘the Spirit, which is in him but is not his’. Man is ontologically nothing. It is the Spirit, which works in him. He is manifestation of the Absolute. He rightfully belongs to God.

روپ انوکھے طور اوپرے نازک چالیں من موہنیاں
نازناکت حسن ملاحت صاحب سب سامان کے ہو

“The forms are novel and the ways are odd. The tender moves captivate the heart. You muster all pride, delicacy and charming beauty. You are the treasury of all graces.”

It is the Spirit in Man that assumes novel forms and odd ways. It assumes the form of the beloved and captivates the heart of the lover. It musters all pride, delicacy and charming beauty. It totally enriches Man.

کچھ جاہل کچھ فاسق فاجر اپنا آپ گماتے ہو
کچھ عارف کچھ اہل حقائق واقف سر نہاں کے ہو

“You are ignorant at times and at times you are sinner. You just lose yourself. You are gnostic at times and at times you are witnessing to truth. You are familiar with the secrets of the Invisible.”

Man becomes ignorant of the Spirit. He sins against himself. He becomes oblivious of his origin and centre. But the one who knows the secrets of the Invisible Spirit becomes a gnostic and a witness to truth.

قبلہ کعبہ مسجد مندر دیر گنش سب تجھ میں ہے
صوم و صلوٰۃ کے خود ہو والی کیوں پابند گمان کے ہو

“Qibla (prayer direction), Kaabah (House of God), Mosque, Temple, Monastery, Synagogue all is within you. You are the custodian of fasting and prayer. Then, why are you the captive of delusion?”

The outer forms of religious worship and rituals are the manifestation of the inward Spirit dwelling in Man. There is unity in diversity. Man should not fall into delusion by considering these multiple forms as absolute. They are relative to the Absolute. Their strength lies in their inwardness.

غیر تمہارا محض محالے
اس جگ میں اور اس جگ میں
دنیا تم ہو عقبی تم ہو
مالک کون و مکاں کے ہو

“Your other is hardly possible in this world and in the next world. You are the terrestrial world and the hereafter. You are the possessor of the cosmos.”

The Spirit dwelling in Man makes him unique in the whole creation in this world and the next one. He becomes the possessor of the cosmos.

وعظ نصیحت رمز فریدی
سوچ سناؤ دم دم سے
اپنی عظمت یاد کرو
کیوں تھے یوسف زندان کے ہو

“Faridi symbolism is manifest in his sermons and counsels. Think and reflect on it at each instant. Remember your vocation. Why have you become Yousaf, content with prison?”

Man has to constantly think and reflect on these Sufi discourses impregnated with symbolism. He has to understand his higher place in the scheme of reality. Yousaf, without any of his fault, preferred prison against the seductive designs of women. He remained contented in prison till he was absolved of all charges levied against him. But he had finally to move out from the prison in order to realise his cosmic destiny. Likewise, Man is imprisoned ‘in the narrow circuits of his individuality.’ He cannot remain content with it forever. He has to set himself free from his own imprisonment in order to get united with his beloved in the state of nonduality.

Kafi-148

ڈٹھری یار بھلائی ہک تل ترس نہ آئیو

“My friend! I have seen your goodness. You did not even have an iota of pity on me.”

She sees no goodness in her beloved since he did not take pity on her deplorable state and just left her forlorn. He made her suffer pangs of separation and disunion.

پاگواڑی ستروں ویندیں نہ موکلائیو

“You slept with folding arms around my neck. You did not say even parting words to me, while going away.”

She reminds him of his caresses in love and then his just leaving her without adieu.

سہجوں کول بلہاکے کیوں جانی دل چائیو

“You fondly made me sit beside you. My beloved! Why have you cast me away from your heart?”

She recalls the showering fondness of her beloved and then his cooling towards her.

ہے ہے یار بروچل کیوں میں تو بھرمائیو

“Oh! Oh! My dear beloved! Who made you so distrustful about me?”

She thinks that someone has made her beloved distrustful about her. It is a cultural expression of love. Man is not only a social being but he is a cultural being as well.

جے ہادی اے نیت کیوں وت یاری لائیو

“If you had this intention (of not remaining true to love), then why did you contract friendship with me?”

She questions the intention of her beloved in contracting friendship with her. She perceives her beloved through cultural lens.

مفت ڈکھاں وچ پایو

جان فرید نکمرڈی

“Farid! You have just put your valueless life in sufferings.”

He laments that he has put his simple life in sufferings.

Kafi-149

کریار اسماں ول آون دی آج سہج کنوں اکھ پھر کے دو

“My friend! Do make haste in coming towards me.
My eye is readily quivering.”

The readily quivering of eye omens the coming of friend.
It intensifies the quest for the beloved.

گدڑی ڈکھ ڈوہاگ دی واری روہی گل بھل نال سنگاری
مد مستانی ڈینہہ مہاری باد شمالی لڑ کے دو

“The times of sufferings and misfortunes are gone.
The desert is embellishing with flowers and fruits.
The day is overcast with rain laden clouds in the
enthraling season. The north wind is blowing gently.”

The days of separation and disunion are over. The self is
flowering into fruition. There is an all-encompassing spiritual
ambience.

کیٹی بھاگ سہاگ اتا دل رت آئی کر تر ت اباہل
کن من کنیاں رم جہم بادل بارش بر کے بر کے دو

“The nuptial fortunes have hastened to descend. The
season has quickened to come early. The raindrops
are pouring from the rain laden clouds. It is
drizzling.”

The nuptial blessings have quickened. The moment of
union has suddenly arrived. It has refreshed the lover's inner
being. There is an aura of spiritual openings.

سدھڑی تھئی ول قسمت پٹھڑی آپے منزی راحت رٹھڑی
سوہنی موسم روہی وٹھڑی وحشت ڈوں دل لڑ کے دو

“My overturned fate has been turned into good fortune. Happiness has readily become agreeable. The weather is fine and the desert is blossoming. My heart is leafing towards wilderness (of love).”

The overturned fate has been transformed into good fortune. The era of happiness has ushered in on its own. Her heart becomes entranced in a state of bewilderment.

تھڈڑیاں ہبلاں پورب والیاں کجلے بادل لیسٹریاں کالیاں
سینگیاں سرتیاں نوں خوشحالیاں ہک ویرن پئی گر کے دو

“The cool winds of the north are blowing. The sky is overcast with thick and black clouds. My same age friends are happy. I am the adverse one who is murmuring.”

Her transcendent beloved is assuming immanent forms. The portents of union are imminent. She gets impatient by seeing her friends unite with their beloveds. She laments state of her disunion. The most difficult thing in life is to exercise patience in love.

آپے یار فرید سنبھالیم سوہنے سانول پتیاں پالیم
بخنیں سنجڑی سختی ٹالیم جی مکے دل مر کے دو

“Farid! My beloved friend has himself taken care of me. My charming beloved has nurtured the beautiful tradition of love. My good fortune has replaced my damned hard times. My heart is cheerful and amused.”

He becomes happy in seeing his charming beloved take care of him and nurture the lovely tradition of love. He gets fulfilment in embracing good fortune after experiencing hard times. It is a moment of great cheerfulness and amusement for him.

Kafi-150

کیس پایا باجھ فقیراں جذبہ عشق کی لذت کو

“Who found the taste of the enthusiasm of love except those who are conscious of their ontological nothingness?”

A ‘faqir’ is the one who is conscious of his ontological nothingness. He knows that his being and having are all from God. It is only the ‘faqirs’ who taste the fervour of love.

کل شے وچ کل شے ڈٹھوسے ہمہ اوست داورس کیتوسے
برکت صحبت پیراں پی کر بادہ وحدت کو

“We witnessed the Reality in all things. We narrated the doctrine of Oneness of being by drinking the wine of unity in the blissful company of mystics.”

They drink wine of unity in the blissful company of the mystics and thereby witness the Reality in everything. They narrate their experience of Oneness of Being (wahdat al wujud).

جب مدہوشی ناز ڈکھایا عریانی نے رنگ جمایا
خرقہ پاڑ لویراں پہنیم رندی خلعت کو

“The moment drunkenness manifested its prideful style (the reality of things became manifest), nudity stamped its reality. The saintly attire was torn into bits. We wore the robe of the inebriates.”

The heavy drunkenness makes the ‘faqirs’ witness the unveiling of Reality. Their saintly attire becomes tattered (outward) and they wear robe of the inebriates, instead (inward)

درد منداں کوں درد سلامت بار محبت پنڈ ملامت
دو کہ دو کہ اٹھ دیاں پیڑاں گھول گھتاں سب راحت کو

“The pain of the compassionate ones may remain intact. They may carry the burden of love and load of reproach. The pains are steadily intensifying. I sacrifice all my peace in their honour.”

He prays for the perpetuity of pain of love borne by the compassionate ones. The onerous burden of love and load of reproaches may always remain with them. They may constantly experience the intensifying pangs of love. All happiness is sacrificial at the altar of suffering.

حسن فرید کئی گھر لوٹے رل دیاں پھر دیاں جنگل بوٹے
سے سسیاں لکھ پیراں ڈیکھو عشق دی شدت کو

“Farid! Beauty has ransacked many a home. There are numerous Sassis and countless Heers, who are wandering, wretchedly in forests and marshes. Do hereby witness the intensity of love.”

The beauty of the beloved ransacks many a hearts. The intensity of love heightens so much that numerous lovers wander wretchedly in wilderness. The radiance of beauty intensifies love and the intensity of love glows beauty. The lover is sawed by beauty and love.

Kafi-151

نہینہ نہیا سخت برا ہے باراجل سرباری بھلو

“I have been bearing highly detesting love. It is better to carry the burden of death on my head, well.”

Love is so highly laden with sufferings that he prefers the onerous burden of death than bearing love.

مارو محب ملہیر سدھایا ولد اکوئی پیغام نہ آیا

پھر دی شہر آواری بھلو

“My heartless lover has gone towards Malheer. There has been no message of his coming back. I am wandering in the streets as a vagabond, well.”

The transcendence of the beloved makes him restless. Doesn't he drift like a rudderless boat in the stream of love?

کچ گیاں دی خبر نہ آئی روندیں گل گئی عمر اجائی

یار نہ کیتم کاری بھلو

“There has been no news about him from Ketch. My life has been rotten in crying for nothing. My friend did not solace me, well.”

He suffers at the transcendence of his beloved. His expectations for any solace of love remain unrealised.

ڈکھڑے ڈکھڑے آیم پھڑے تاڈے ڈکھڑے ٹوبھے سکڑے

دلڑی دردیں ماری بھلو

“Sufferings are fallen to my lot. The thatched houses are fallen and the ponds have become dry. My heart is abject with pain, well.”

His suffering has no outer supports and he finds his inner being as a dried well. His heart pains in becoming spiritless.

کمرے کنڈڑے راہ جبل دے اوکھے پنڈے مارو تھل دے
سولیں ساڑی ہاری بھلو

“There are gravelling and thorns in the mountainous ways. The difficult paths of the deadly desert have burnt me. Afflictions have given me a sense of defeat, well.”

The adversities of love bring him to the edge of losing the game of love.

ریت تھلاندی پیر پجالے جھلکن چھلکن لکھ لکھ چھالے
پلڑے پیوم خواری بھلو

“The sand of the desert burns my feet. There are countless boils and oozes that are clearly visible. Disgrace has been fallen to my lot, well.”

Love is fraught with sufferings, which make him fall in the pits of miseries.

روہ ڈونگر دیاں اوکھیاں گھٹیاں مارو تھل دیا ڈکھڑیاں پٹیاں
وہ وہ یاردی یاری بھلو

“There are difficult passages in the mountainous terrains. There is suffering inducing vast areas of the deadly desert. I laud the friendship of my friend, well.”

He resorts to sarcasm in lauding the friendship of his beloved that ravishes his embodied self.

عشق فرید نہ کیتم بھلا ہے ہے بخت نہ تھیم سولا
ویندم ہوت و ساری بھلو

“Farid! Love has not favoured me. Oh! Oh! Good fortune also did not come my way. My beloved Punnaal is now going away by deserting me, well.”

He feels being left out by love and good fortune. He considers the transcendence of his beloved as a desertion. The consciousness of love develops with its own logic. It adopts a piecemeal approach at times and at times it develops in leaps and bounds. The conflicting perspectives of the lover and the beloved essentially in reference to the beloved's transcendence are necessary for the realisation of union. The exertion of the lover in uniting with his beloved is the essential effort (jihad). All forms of effort (jihad) are its hues and colours.

Kafi-152

ہر دل جو دلدار یار مہنجو سو ہنیاں جو سردار یار مہنجو

“My friend is the object of love of each heart. My friend is the master of all beautiful maidens.”

The friend's beloved is the object of love of every lover.
The beloved rules the heart of all the beautiful maidens.

کہ ملا کہ آمرناہی کہ منصور تے دار یار مہنجو

“He is a cleric at times and at times a preacher. My friend is Mansur and the scaffold at times.”

The formless assumes all forms. The Absolute manifests Himself in every form. The whole creation is His manifestation. The friend manifests Himself in forms of the cleric, preacher (the moral preacher who moralises about performance of good and avoidance of evil), Mansur and the scaffold. He not only manifested Himself in the form of the martyr Mansur but the scaffold was also his manifestation on, which Mansur embraced his death for his so-called religious blasphemy in stating: ‘I am the Truth’. The Absolute or God wills and says ‘kun’ (to be) to His Possibilities and the things from their unmanifest state assume manifest form. How could a thing come to be without His Presence?

آپ چھپائے راز حقیقی آپ کرے اظہار یار مہنجو

“He himself hides the real secret. My friend himself makes it manifest.”

The friend is transcendent and immanent in simultaneity. He is the Absolute in his absoluteness but by virtue of being the Infinite. He manifests Himself in every form.

کہہ بلبل کہہ گل جی صورت برگ کتھاں کہہ خار یار مہنجو

“He is a nightingale at times and at times as the form of rose. My friend is a petal at times and at times is a thorn.”

The nightingale, rose, petal and thorn are different forms of friend's manifestation.

کہہ سرخی کہہ ناز ناکت کہہ کجہ کہہ دھاریار مہنجو

“He is rouge at times and at times pride and delicacy. My friend is a collyrium at times and at times is the line of the collyrium.”

The friend assumes the form of rouge, pride, delicacy, collyrium and even the line of the collyrium.

کہہ ڈھولک کہہ تان ترانہ کہہ صوفی سرشار یار مہنجو

“He is a drum at times and at times a tune and song. My friend is intoxicated Sufi at times.”

The friend's manifestation is in drum, tune and song. The friend manifests Himself in the form of the Sufi and the lover deeply steeped in love.

کہہ عابدتہ کہہ نفل دوگانہ کہہ کیفی مینوار یار مہنجو

“He is devout at times and at times supererogatory prayer with two genuflexions. My friend is in an ecstatic state of drunkenness at times.”

There is nothing even less than an atom, which is not His manifestation. The friend manifests in the form of devout, ritual prayer and in ecstatic state of drunkenness.

کہہ عاشق کہہ درد کشالے کہہ دلبر غم خوار یار مہنجو

“He is lover at times and at times bears the pains and adversities. My friend is the beloved comforter at times.”

The friend assumes the form of the lover and bears pains and adversities. The beloved friend also becomes the comforter. Metaphysically speaking, love itself assumes the forms of the lover and the beloved.

یار فرید نہیں وچ پردے خود پردہ ہے یار یار مہنجو

“Farid! My friend is not in a veil. My friend is the veil itself, my friend.”

It is one of the finest experiences undergone by him to demonstrate the metaphysical truth that the friend is not in a veil but is the veil itself. If there is nothing outside the Metaphysical Whole, then how could the veil be outside it? “The idea of the veil, however, is in reality of a more complicated structure, because it contains in itself other basic paradoxes. One of them is the following... the phenomenal world works as an impenetrable veil concealing the Absolute behind it; the Absolute is not visible because of the veil. But on reflection we easily discover that this is a very inexact description of the real ontological situation... the veil is the external epiphany of the Absolute. From this point of view we must say that when man sees the veil, he is actually seeing nothing other than the very Absolute. In other words, the veil qua “veil” does cause obstruction to man’s sight and prevents him from seeing the Absolute, but in its epiphanic form the veil is rather an immediate presentation of the Absolute itself. We must go a step further and say that the Absolute is so nakedly apparent to man’s sight that it is not visible – another paradoxical situation in which light appears as darkness. As Shabastari say: “The whole world of Being is the beams of the absolute Light. The Absolute remains hidden because it is so clearly manifest.”

Kafi-153

پرے آج نہ گیو سے کل ہی سہی ایہ وطن بیگانہ کوڑا کوڑ ٹکانہ

“If you have not gone to the next world by now, you will go there for sure. This alien land is false and an illusory abode.”

The certainty of death is absolute though its hour is uncertain. The meaning of death has been construed differently in the history of Man. Humanity is divided in negating or affirming life hereafter and there are varied shades of these negations and affirmations. Eschatology enlightens us on the ultimate destiny of mankind. It is one's concept of death, which gives corresponding meaning to one's life. The existentialists- theists and theists- have brought out existential significance of death, which is opaque to the ordinary or rational understanding of death. However, it gets enmeshed within its own modern mentality, which has no inkling of the metaphysical transcendence. It is the spiritual understanding of death that gives real meaning to life. Man has constantly to remain aware of the sureness of death and the uncertainty of its hour so that he could realise the spiritual purpose of his existence, which consists in uniting with his beloved. The terrestrial world is not an end in itself but it is a means toward the realisation of unity. It is an alien world. Our original abode is in the heavens to which we have to return. It is a false world for it gives semblance of the real. It is an illusory abode creating misperception of its finality. All those who negate the reality of the life hereafter negate the higher dimensions of the terrestrial life as well. Their negation is not based on knowledge but is an expression of their deep rooted ignorance. Their arguments are within the narrow

orbits of their own thinking, which considers human finitude as ultimate. They commit the Fallacy of Delimitation. They are no friends of humanity. They are misled and have misled large sections of mankind. The traditional literature of mankind on immortality, on the other hand, not only shows the fallacious nature of their arguments but presents eschatological world view in consonance with the law of things. Both worlds are constitutive of Man's being.

رنگ گل پھل ڈیکھتے بھل نہ ہیں سدھے راہوں سالک رل نہ ہیں
ایں جگ دی جگمگ سمجھ بہانہ

“Do not be forgetful after seeing the colours, flowers and fruits. Do not get astray from the right path, O’ traveller. The attraction of the terrestrial world is just a cloak.”

Remembrance of God is forgetfulness of otherness. One has not to be oblivious of the underlying reality and its purpose beneath the colours, flowers and fruits. Man has not to astray from the right path of finding the beloved manifest in these forms. The attractions of the terrestrial world are occasions to go beyond the manifest.

اے نگری ملک پر آیا ہے اتھ آسرا رکھن اجایا ہے
منڈھوں رہن نہ ڈینڈے کرن روانہ

“This world is an estranged place. It is useless to put one's trust in it. It makes every one move on without letting anyone have permanent abode here.”

This world is a transitional phase of life. It is useless to trust the impermanent, fleeting and ephemeral mode of life and existence. Man has no permanent abode here. He is led to the grave after the end of his transitory period in this world. He embarks upon a journey beyond the grave.

تھی غافل اصلوں ہک نہ گھڑی ہن ہتھ مل پر تاب ذری
اجھو موت نے بھجیا لکھ پر وانہ

“Do not be forgetful even for an instant. Be deeply repentant of your deeds. Your written warrant of death is just on its way.”

The uncertainty of the hour of death implies that Man should not be forgetful even for a moment about his spiritual vocation. He should deeply repent about his deeds committed in the state of forgetfulness and do good deeds (by removing rust and polishing the mirror of his heart for the Reality to contemplate itself). He should consider the hour of death so near for the completion of this task.

بٹھ دنیا فانی دیس ایہو سب مکرو فریب داویس ایہو
کیا ناز نہورے تان ترانہ

“Discard the mortal place of habitation. It is garbed by cunningness and deceit. What is (the ultimate significance of) pride, coqueties and singing a tune?”

One has to discard the ephemeral nature of the terrestrial world. He has to beware of its cunningness and deceit hidden beneath its beautiful forms, which rob him of his celestial treasures.

کر توبہ ترت فرید سدا ہر شے نوں پر نقصان کہوں
تھی محض موحد صاف یگانہ

“Repent everlastingly and seek forgiveness. Always refrain from infidelity and duality. Be simply Unitarian and purely unique.”

One should constantly repent of losing his origin and centre of being. He needs to seek forgiveness from his Lord and thereby return to his spiritual vocation. He has to always refrain from innovations that are inconsistent with the law of things and also from placing divinity beside Allah. He has to be unique in simply realising contemplative tawhid or the doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al wujud). It is the

realisation of his ontological nothingness, which opens the door of unison with the beloved.

رَبِّ باجھ فرید نوں آس نہیں ایہا عمر سبھوک پاس نہیں
کہیں نال نہ چاڑھے توڑ زمانہ

“Farid has no hope except in the Sustainer. I have my whole life before me but there is no one on my right side. Time is not faithful to anyone.”

The friend of God has no hope except in his Sustainer. Life finds no other friend. The world does not escort one to the life hereafter but robs him in the way. It is only spiritual friendship, which is beneficial in both the worlds.

Kafi-154

تھیواں صدقے صدقے آیا شہر مدینہ

“I sacrifice my life countless times. I have reached
the city of Medina.”

He offers himself in thanksgiving in reaching the city of the Prophet. It is a city that houses the Prophet. Religiosity understands prophecy in the outward sense and mainly concentrates on its outward aspects. The mode of revelation is even construed as if from the outside. It negates Muhammadan presence or a contemporaneous living contact with the Prophet. The spiritual dimensions of prophecy remain opaque to the religious consciousness. It is the spiritual consciousness, which unveils the veil of prophecy and realises the possibility of experiencing the Prophet in different modes.

شکھ دی سبجھ سہایم گیا ڈکھڑا دیرینہ

“I lay the nuptial bed of peace. My old suffering has
vanished.”

His old suffering withers away and he finds inward peace.

نہ روڈ لڑی لڑی نہ ڈکھ سبجھ اسینہ

“O looted heart! Do not cry. O chest! Do not give an
abode to suffering.”

He addresses his looted heart not to cry and his chest not to be abode of suffering since the Prophet is so caring.

سبجھ سونے دا ابھریا ڈکھڑا نیک مہینہ

“The golden sun (moment of bliss) has risen. I have
witnessed the month of blessings.”

The golden sun of prophecy is visible in the times of blessings.

حرم معلیٰ روشن ہے نوری آمینہ

“The Sanctuary of the Prophet is shining. It is a mirror of light.”

The sanctuary of Medina shines forth and acts as mirror of Divine light. The Reality contemplates itself in the prophetic mirror.

عرب دی ساری دھرتی سوہنی صاف نگینہ

“The whole land of Arabia is a beautiful transparent jewel.”

The entire land of Arabia is a beautiful and transparent jewel. God has spread his beautiful and clear message to mankind through His beloved Prophet.

ملیٰ جیڑھا رکھی صدق ثبوت یقینہ

“It will fall to the lot of the one, who shall be truthful, intuitive and absolutely certain.”

The one who is inwardly pure and has absolute certitude of the Prophetic presence will be blessed with his vision and presence (haduri).

تھی شیطان پسیدہ مر گیا نفس کمینہ

“The Satan has been cornered. The meanness of the self has been effaced.”

It is due to the blessings of the Prophet that the Satan has been subdued and the mean self has given way to the higher self.

خبر فرید سنو سے ملسوں شب آدینہ

“Farid got the news of meeting (prophetic presence) on Friday night.”

He has got spiritual news that he would be graced by the Prophetic presence (haduri) at the appointed time.

Kafi-155

ہے عشق دا جلوہ ہر جا سُبحان اللہ سُبحان اللہ
خود عاشق خود معشوق بنیا سُبحان اللہ سُبحان اللہ

“The immanence of Love is manifest everywhere. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious. The lover himself has assumed the form of the beloved. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

Love itself is manifest in each form. He has himself assumed the forms of the lover and the beloved. Allah is glorified for His transcendence and immanence in love.

خود بلبل تے پروانہ ہے گل شمع اتے دیوانہ ہے
تھی چاند چکور نوں موہ لیا سُبحان اللہ سُبحان اللہ

“He is himself the nightingale and the moth. He is crazy of the rose and the candle. He has enchanted the red-legged partridge in the form of the moon. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

The Reality manifests itself in the form of nightingale (beauty) and moth (love). It demonstrates the intimacy of beauty and love. It manifests itself in the form of rose and candle (beauty) and also in the form of passion (love) for them. It manifests itself in the forms of the red-legged partridge and moon (beauty) and also in the magnetic attractiveness of moon (love), which enchants the bird. Allah is glorified for manifesting in forms of beauty.

کڈیں موٹی تھی میٹات چڑھے دل وعظ کرے توریت پڑھے
کڈیں عیسیٰ یحییٰ زکریا سُبحان اللہ سُبحان اللہ

“He becomes Musa and climbs stations of communication with the Lord at times. Well, He narrates the sermon and recites the Torah. He is (in the forms of) Isa, Yahya and Zakariya at times. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

The Reality assumed the form of the Prophet Musa in climbing stations of communication with the Lord. He narrated the sermon and recited the Torah on the tongue of Musa. He manifested in the form of the Prophets Isa, Yahya and Zakariya. Allah is glorified for manifesting in immanent forms.

کیتھے شاد کیتھے دل ننگ ڈسے کیتھے صلح ڈسے کیتھے جنگ ڈسے
تھیہا نشان جلال جمال ادا سُبحان اللہ سُبحان اللہ

“He seems happy at times and at times niggard. He seems peace at times and at times strife. He manifests the grandeur of Majesty and Beauty. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

The Reality manifests itself in expansion (feeling of happiness) and in constriction of heart (feeling of being hard pressed); in peace and war and in the grandeur of the Majesty and Beauty. The whole creation is the manifestation of Allah. He is manifest in ideas, feelings, words and actions. Allah is glorified in His transcendence and immanence.

کیتھے راز انا الحق فاش تھیا کیتھے سُبحانی داورد پڑھیا
کیتھے انی عبد رسول کہیا سُبحان اللہ سُبحان اللہ

“The secret, ‘I am the Truth’ were unravelled at times. He recited, ‘Glory to me’ at times. He stated, ‘I am a bondsman and Messenger’ at times. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

The ‘antinomian utterances’ of Mansur Hallaj and Bayazid Bistami and the Prophet’s expression of being servant and messenger of God are beyond the ken of religiosity. What is the secret of Mansur al-Hallaj’s assertion ‘ana’ l-Haqq, I am

the 'Truth'? The Self withdraws from the 'servant-Lord' polarity and 'resides in its own transpersonal being'. The subject-object dichotomy is transcended by virtue of pure intellect or Spirit, which is identical with the Divine Essence. The second verse essentially refers to the same message but this time through Bayazid Bistami who says: 'Glory to me! How great is my majesty'. His 'antinomian utterance', or 'theophanic locutions' based on his experience of ultimate union have made him celebrated as a representative of the most intellectual form of Sufism. Again, ordinary people did not understand the metaphysical significance of these utterances for it transcended servant-Lord polarization and in the ultimate sense it was the Self-alone which said: 'Glory to me. How great is my majesty'. The third verse refers to the servant-Lord polarity and manifestation of Allah pertaining to the Prophet who is both 'abd' servant and 'rasul' messenger. As 'rasul' he is the manifestation of the Divinity. In other words, the Self polarizes itself into the 'servant-Lord' axis and ultimately reduces it to itself. Man's actualization of servanthood makes him correspondingly perfect. The most perfect servant is God's greatest locus of disclosure. He perfectly manifests God's attributes. And it is here that the axis servant-Lord is surpassed and the door from God to man is opened. The Qur'an in these words expresses the reality of realization: "Therefore, you did not kill them, but God killed them. And thou (O Muhammad) didst not shoot (at them) when thou didst it, but God did it... Surely God is Hearing, Knowing." (8:17). Knowledge is the most all-encompassing of the divine attributes and it is identical with His Essence. The Prophet identified himself with Knowledge itself. His prayer of being granted knowledge of the ultimate nature of things was granted. Allah is glorified in making possible the simultaneity of transcendence and immanence.

ہن حسن ازل دے ڈھنگ عجب
سُبْحَانَ اللہ سُبْحَانَ اللہ

ہن ہستی دے نیرنگ عجب
بیرنگ بہ ہر رنگ رچیا

“The forms of the Essence are strange. The ways of the Primordial Beauty are strange. The ingraining of the Colourless is in each and every colour. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

The Essence or the undifferentiated Reality assumes the form of the differentiated Reality so that it could know itself through the ‘other.’ It is by virtue of the principle of Ahmad that the Essence takes these forms beyond ordinary understanding. It is so strange to see different manifestations of the primordial beauty. The way it becomes a beauty and gives rise to its opposite ugliness and the return of ugliness to its source in beauty through cosmic cycles is so difficult to understand. It is equally strange to see the colourless manifest in every form. The colourless light assumes different colours in the process of manifestation. Allah is glorified in manifesting Himself in different modes and colours.

ہے محض مقام تحیر دا بٹھ حیلہ درک و تفکر دا
ہیں ڈونگھڑے ڈیہہ ڈوں ہتھ نہ پا سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ

“It is simply a station of bewilderment. Discard the effort of comprehension and reflection. Do not try to traverse these deep ways. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

The intricacies of the Essence and Divinity take the lover to bewildering heights. Discard the rational mode with its tools of comprehension in understanding these subtleties. Do not try to delve deep in these mysteries with ordinary modes of knowledge. Allah is glorified in devising different layers of knowledge and being.

تقدیس کتھاں تزیہہ کتھاں تقیید آتے تشبیہہ کتھاں
ہے حیرت سکھ تسلیم و رضا سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ

“There is holiness, at times and at times, is transcendence (Nondelimitation). There is delimitation and immanence at times. It is

bewilderment that teaches acceptance and resignation. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

The Reality is the holy Essence. It is transcendent or Nondelimited. It assumes the forms of delimitation and immanence otherwise pure transcendence itself becomes delimitation. Religiosity has to understand the metaphysical truth that Allah is not only in the heavens but He simultaneously dwells on the earth. Religiosity commits the cardinal error in placing Him solely in the heavens and thereby delimiting the nondelimited One. It is so bewildering to understand these mysteries. One should keep an intellectual poise and be content with God, who confers knowledge according to His will. Allah is glorified in keeping His transcendence and nondelimitation intact in spite of His manifestations in the forms of delimitation and immanence and conferring the stations of knowledge according to His will.

تھی عمر تلف برباد سبھو
مردے تیں نہ بیٹم سنا
ہیہات سبھو فریاد سبھو
سُبْحَانَ اللّٰہِ سُبْحَانَ اللّٰہِ

“My whole life has been ruined and destroyed. I have immense remorse and great beseeching. I got no disclosure (of the holy essence) even in my last moments of dying. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

It is a moment of great remorse for him to find his life wasted without finding his friend in the last hours of life in spite of great beseeching. Allah is glorified as the Infinite, who cannot be totally absorbed by the finite.

ہے پیت فرید دی ریت عجب
سن سبھو سارے اہل صفا
ہے درد تے سوز دی گیت عجب
سُبْحَانَ اللّٰہِ سُبْحَانَ اللّٰہِ

“The tradition of Farid’s love is strange. It is a strange song of pain and passion. All the followers of Purity! Do listen and understand. Glory is to Allah, the Glorious.”

All the puritans must listen and understand that the Faridi tradition of love is strange. It is a song of pain and passion beyond the ken of human understanding. Allah is glorified for purifying the heart of the lover and making it possible by the alchemy of suffering to unite with the beloved.

Kafi-156

آپہنتم جیندیں گے ایہیں شہر مبارک گئے

“I have reached Makkah during my life time. It is the city of blessings called Bakkah.”

It is moments of spiritual rejoice to reach the city of Makkah. It is the city of blessings also called Bakkah by the Qur'an. The crowning jewel of this city is the House of God, the source of constant blessings for humanity. It is the birth place of the Prophet, who revolutionised mankind.

واہ دلیں عرب دیاں چالیں خوش طرحیں خوب خصالیں
گیاں و سروطن دیاں گاہیں کیا خوش قبیلے سگے

“I laud the styles of the Arabian land. They are pleasing and highly qualitative. I have forgotten the characteristics of my own native town, my close relatives and kith and kin.”

The traditions of Arabia are highly laudable. The transcendent and immanent aspects of the beautiful tradition confer so much happiness that the visitor forgets his homeland and his near and dear ones.

ہے لذت وادھو وادھی ہے ہر دم ڈوڑی شادی
ہر ویلھے تانگھ زیادہ کئی ہارے تے کئی تھکے

“The pleasantness is on the increase. Here, each and every moment is filled with multiplying joys. There is an ever increasing longing. Many of them have been lost and a number of them have drained out.”

The joy of living in the sacred land is ever on the increase. Happiness multiplies every moment. There is a constant longing to have a direct contact with God. The insatiable quest of the beloved is never satiated. The path of love is so arduous that some lovers have been lost in the way and some others have drained out.

ہے دھوڑی تول گلاں دی ہن پتھر سیچھ بھلاں دی
تا صبح جھلندی کھٹے شب باد صبا من بھاندی

“The stones are my nuptial bed of flowers. The dust is the nuptial quilt of roses. The zephyr fair wind of night is pleasing to the self. It fans till morning.”

The ambience of the holy city is such that even the stones and dust impart spiritual meaning and thereby are so likeable. The zephyr wind of contemplation pleasingly integrates action.

انگور ہزار متیرن خربوزے پنڈ کثیرن
رُٹان صغیر کبیرن چن دانے ماروں کھگے

“There are numerous bunches of grapes, countless watermelons, melons and plenty of dates. There are small and big beads of pomegranates that we are eating in a mouthful.”

The pilgrims enjoy the fruits of civilization in plenty.

ہے ملک مقدس نوری ہے جنت حور قسوری
بن عاشق پاک حضوری بیا کون قدم اتھر رکھے

“This land is holy and shining. It is a paradise of beautiful houries. Who can step in without love and pure presence?”

The light of Divinity shines in the holy land, which is a paradise full of bounties symbolised by pure heart. The spiritual bounties are reserved for those who enter the presence with love and purity. Religiosity remains at the

peripheral and has no access to the corridors of spirituality. It is the spiritual dimension, which makes possible vision of God.

وَنَجَّ دُكْهُم مَدِينَةَ عَلِيٍّ
ہے دھرتی عیبوں خالی

جِہ کون و مکان داوا لی
پیانور رسالت چھلے

“I went and saw the majesty of Medina. There lies the custodian of the universe. The place is free of any imperfection. The light of prophecy is shining forth.”

He sees the majestic city of the Prophet, which houses the custodian of the universe. The shining forth of the light of prophecy leaves no darkness in any corner of life. Symbolically speaking, it is the ‘Muhammadan Station’ of the soul.

کیوں و سرن یار دے دیرے
دم جیندیں کر سوں پھیرے

تھیاں اکھیاں رور و بیرے
یا لڈ بہسوں آئیے

“Why should the dwellings of my beloved fall in oblivion? My eyes have become pieces of red flesh by constant crying. I shall continue coming here during my life or I will come here to dwell on permanently.”

He does not want to be oblivious of his beloved’s dwellings. He bears great sufferings in love. He desires continual visits or permanent dwellings with his beloved (the outward symbolising the inward).

توڑے لگدے دھلے دھلے
تن آگ محبت بکھلے

اکھول ول یار ڈوں تلے
دل در دوں لذت چکھلے

“Although, there are the numerous physical pushing (hazards) but my eyes are constant in looking toward my friend. The fire of love is burning in my body. My heart, by virtue of pain, is enjoying this taste.”

He remains unmindful of physical pushing (due to rush of pilgrims) during circumambulation ‘of the Holy Ka’aba as a

religious rite' but remains absolutely mindful of his friend. He burns with the passion of love. His heart enjoys the pain of suffering. The tastes of suffering in divine love keeps him remain in the tracks of love. The taste of love has to be earned with great efforts in face of sufferings.

ہے سخت شدید آزاری کرے کون فرید دی کاری
تھئے تیلے نالے جاری دل سوزوں بھج بھج پکے

“It is a terrible and great distress. Who would share the lot of Farid? There is flow of tears from my eyelids. My heart is being grilled with passion.”

Love sufferings are so terrible and distressful that no one can share his lot. He has to carry the cross of love on his shoulders amidst his crying eyes and passions grilling his heart. Isn't it the only way to reach the destination of love?

Kafi-157

آپے بار محبت چاؤم ٹری ونج آپ کوں آپ اڑاؤم ٹری

“I have taken upon myself the burden of love. I have myself entangled my being.”

The metaphysics of love helps in understanding the metaphysics of freedom. Love is a relationship of pure freedom. It has no psychic entrails, which qualitatively differentiates it from all sorts of infatuations. She accepts the responsibility of contracting love with all that it entails. She takes the liability of entangling her being in the state of love.

سب ڈکھاں سولاں دی تات ملئیم غم درد اندوہ برات ملئیم

بھیڑی دلڑی مار منجھائیم ٹری

“I have been invested with the robe of sufferings and afflictions. I have been gifted with sorrows, pain and grief. The despicable heart has ravished me.”

The path of love has its own dynamics, which he cannot escape. He has to encounter sufferings, afflictions, sorrows, pains and grief. Is her heart despicable in ravishing her by being completely subservient to her beloved?

سوہناں ہوت پنل کیچ گیا گل سوز فراق دا پیچ پیا

جو لکھیا پلڑے پائیم ٹری

“My lovely and charming Punnaal left and went to Ketch. The collar of passion and separation is around my neck. My destiny has fallen to my lot.”

She suffers when the immanence of her lovely and charming beloved becomes veiled in transcendence. It is not an ordinary separation but a passionate one, which shakes the fabric of her being. She realises that it is destined

(symbolically written on the forehead) or law of things that pure heart is hunted in the sanctuary of love and that love and suffering are inseparable.

دُکھا تھل مارو آپیش گیا دل جان جگر تن ریش تھیا
تقی عشق اولڑا ایم ڈی

“I am encountering deadly desert with sufferings. My whole embodied self has become a sore. I am the inept one who has embraced such an intricate love.”

Love is not a simple romance. The deadly desert of sufferings awaits her. The contracting of the intricate love sores her whole embodied self.

مہنجا یار پُئل گیا کیچ رُٹھا سر ظلمی نینہہ جو مینہہ وُٹھا
رَب ایڑھے بار سہا ایم ڈی

“My friend Punnal went to Ketch by being cool towards me. There is down pouring of the cruel love on my head. I am bearing these heavy burdens due to my Sustainer.”

She perceives transcendence as a reaction of her beloved, which pours down cruelties on her. The Sustainer succours her to bear these onerous burdens of love, since it by virtue of these sufferings that the Divine Grace transforms duality into nonduality.

ہک وار فرید نوں یار ملے سروں پنڈ جبر دابار ملے
جیندے کارن عمر گنوا ایم ڈی

“Farid! I wish an encounter with my friend. The load of disunion on my head may wane. It is for his sake that I lost my life.”

He stakes his entire life for the sake of uniting with his beloved. He wishes an encounter with his friend in order to get rid of the pangs of disunion. It is the light of union, which can dispel the darkness of disunion.

Kafi-158

آپے کیتوئی یاروے کیوں تھی کھڑیوں آواز روے

“You yourself cultivated friendship with me, oh.
Now, why you have been disgusted and gone aside,
oh?”

She beautifully questions the transcendence of her immanent beloved.

اینویں نہ ہالاق پُئل کلہڑی دی ول لدھڑونہ کل
ونج کچ لایو عیش گل میں گل موئی وچ یاروے

“Punnal! It was unbecoming of you not to ask about the welfare of the forlorn one. You embraced all pleasures at Ketch. I got rotten and spiritless in wilderness, oh.”

She points to the transcendent aspects of her beloved that pertain to his responsiveness. She compares her deplorable plight with the happy state of her beloved and seeks justice.

دِلڑوں نہ سُنجڑی کوں چہیں شرموں کثر مومں آہیں
شالاسد اتو خوش رہیں اصلوں نہیں اے کاروے

“You do not love the damned one from the core of your heart. It is merely your courteous demeanour to sit with me. I pray that you remain happy forever. It is not the true way, oh.”

She considers the polite behaviour of her beloved just a face saving bereft of real love. She questions its propriety while wishing her beloved happiness. The communication between the lover and the beloved is at a level, which cannot

be deciphered by ordinary or rational standards. The words and forms of expressions are unique. The language of love cannot be used or understood outside the situation of love.

مُست مینہ وساونی جڑ جڑ گلی آسانونی
میں سر ڈوہاگ داباروے موسم سہاگ سہاونی

“Rain has poured heavily. The enthralling rainy season is in full swing. The weather of union is lovely. But, I am bearing the burden of misfortunes on my head, oh.”

Her solitude deepens both in the inward and the outward ambience of union. Doesn't the deepening awareness of solitariness pave the road to union?

سُرخ تے کجہ دھاروی گئی مفت چیتز بہاروی
کر یاد قول قراروے مہندی تے ہار سنگاروی

“The joyful spring, rouge, the line of a collyrium, henna and makeup have gone just for nothing. Do remember your commitments, oh.”

She laments the passing away of spring without union with her beloved. Her beautification and ornamentation have not succeeded in evoking a single glance of her friend. She makes her beloved remember the vows of love. Love consciousness is dynamic but it has no steady pace. It develops with leaps and bounds.

دو کھ درد قہر کلور ہے مایہ بُتی توں دور ہے
ہک توں نہ تھی بیزاروے سانول سبھو منظور ہے

“I am the inept one whose parents are far away. The sufferings and afflictions are terribly severe. My beloved! All things are acceptable to me. But do not get fed up from me, oh.”

She accepts the parting of her parents, sufferings and afflictions for the sake of love but beseeches her beloved not to get cool towards her.

آیاں رتاں من بھانویاں لالیاں لون تے کاو نیاں
دل تا نگھ چاوے چاویاں دل رس وسوں ہک واروے

“There is ushering of a pleasant season. The voice of starlings and the ravens is audible. My longing for you is again awakening within me the deeper feelings of love. Let’s dwell together in happiness, oh.”

She finds a qualitative pleasant change within herself. The language of birds is audible. The sprouting feelings of love crave for unity with her beloved.

گیوں رول مٹھڑا ڈھول وے سارے بھلے نک ٹول وے
وسرے الول مخول وے ڈکھ سول ناسیں تاروے

“My sweet beloved! Why you wretched me by going away? All my enchantments have been forgotten. All our fun and pun fell in oblivion. I am fully drowned in sufferings and afflictions, oh.”

She faces afflictions and sufferings while wretchedly experiencing transcendence of her beloved. She remembers the moments of joy with her friend in the state of immanence.

دل شینہ نہینہ دے وات ہے ہیہات ڈینہاں رات ہے
اے مونہ نہماندی بات ہے دل ہک تے لکھ آزاروے

“My heart is in the jaws of the lion of love. My day and night is spent in lamentation. It is not a befitting utterance but my heart is one and the distresses it has to face are countless, oh.”

She expresses the deadly grip of love, which ravishes her bones and flesh. The unity of her heart is distressed by the world of multiplicity.

قسمت پٹھی دیاں گالیاں مارونہ پیتاں پالیاں
ڈے گیوم ملک نکالیاں گھر بار بر، گھر باروے

“It is my overturned fortune that my ravishing beloved has not nurtured love. He has banished me. Now, my abode is in the desert and the desolate places have become my dwellings, oh.”

She considers it her misfortune that her beloved has not responded with love and has banished her in wilderness.

ڈکھ پیا پٹی دے پیش ہے غم صبح شام ہمیش ہے
دل زخم زخمی ریش ہے توں بن تھیوم لاچاروے

“I am the dejected one facing sufferings. Sorrow is constantly with me in the morning and evening. My heart is hurt and there are sores in my wounds. I am utterly helpless without you, oh.”

The consciousness of sorrows, sufferings and utter helplessness without her beloved, shows that she has no fallback position. Isn't she reaching the threshold of union?

بائل دی شفقت کھٹ گئی ماما راتے ہٹ گئی
بھینیں دی سنگت تڑ گئی ویرن دانیت تکراروے

“I lost the love of my father. My mother has got fed up after thrashing me. The company of my sisters has been severed. My brother keeps quarrelling with me every now and then, oh.”

The untying of her primary ties signifies increasing hostility of her dear and near ones. One of the mysteries of love is the nurturing of love in the environment of animosity. It brings the best out of a person. Love transforms negativity into positivity.

جے تیں نہ ڈیکھاں ول تیکوں اصلوں نہ ٹک رہساں منڈھوں
رکھیں جے اتنی تاگھ توں ہن پار نیلا پاروے

“I will not get real peace unless I see you again. If you also develop the similar longing, then I will be able to achieve my fulfilment, oh.”

She finds no real peace without the vision of her beloved. She thinks that if her beloved has the same longing as she has about him, then she can certainly find fulfilment in love (union).

ہن ہٹ دی کوڑی بچ گئی نیڑے کنوں دل رنج گئی
ڈکھڑیں توں دِلڑی بھیج گئی بس یار گیوسے ہاروے

“Now, I am shattered. My heart is fed up from love. My heart fled away from sufferings. My friend! I ultimately lost, oh.”

There are hard times in love, when she even loses her face. She feels that she has lost the game of love. The beauty of these symbolic expressions consists in understanding the waning of self and the unveiling of the Self. It points to the hazardous path of love and the steadfastness of the lover in spite of all odds.

آپ کیتو بیاروے چائیر تے ڈوہ ہزاروے
گلڑے، پچار، ویاروے ٹھہندی نہیں ہن عاروے

“You yourself cultivated the ties of love. You took upon yourself countless censures, complaints, and objections. Now, it is unbecoming of you to be ashamed of me, oh.”

She addresses her beloved and makes him remember his initiative in contracting love. It was love itself, which took the forms of the lover and the beloved. The transcendent had to delimit itself in order to manifest itself in immanence. There is nothing to be ashamed of this cosmic reality. The Reality assumes the form of Divinity, in order to realise the possibility of love, and maintain its transcendence in spite of its immanence.

ستیزیں کوں کلھڑا چھوڑ گیوں واگاں وطن تے موڑ گیوں
سُج بردی چھل وچ بوڑ گیوں لُٹ دھاڑ ظلم اندھا روے

“You left the lonely one asleep. You turned the reins towards your native place. You have drowned me in the sea of wilderness. It is loot, offensiveness, cruelty and darkness (darkness at noon), oh.”

The transcendence of the beloved becomes so overbearing that she hurls accusations of injustice against her friend. She loses her composure in experiencing the splendour of immanence turned into wilderness of transcendence. The dwindling of the self also leads to the dwindling of calm and poise. Love is so strange.

ہیں ظلم توں کر بس کڈیں رلڑے فرید دے وس کڈیں
وس رس اتے کھل ہس کڈیں جیون دے ڈینہہ بن چاروے

“Now, end this cruelty. Do dwell in togetherness with Farid. Let's spend these four days of life in joy, happiness and fraternity, oh.”

He offers a friendly advice to his beloved to shun cruelty of separation and disunion, and unite with him to enjoy the short span of life. What if the beloved accedes to his demand there and then? The seed of love would not flower or bear fruit. It is the wisdom of the beloved that fructifies love.

Kafi-159

اج بن مومں برجن بنسری بجائی بنسری بجائی اگم گیت گائی

“Krishan Maharaj played on the flute today in his native place. The playing of the flute orchestrated a celestial song.”

The beloved's attuning of the self orchestrated celestial song.

ت سہاگ بھاگ پھاگ داگ تگ پیاگ بھو آنند انگ انگ ہر مومں ہریائی

“It is the season of happiness. My good days have dawned. I am in a state of musical festivity with my beloved. There is peace and every part of my body is alive with freshness.”

The nuptial season of happiness leads to the dawning of good days. He enjoys musical festivity with his beloved. He experiences joy in every pore of his being. It is rebirth in the world of love.

کون چنگلی مومں بھلی کرشن سے کھیلوں ہوی پریم نیم کی گلال کو اڑائی

“I play holi with Krishan in the lovely street. I spread red colour signifying my happiness in love.”

He plays the celestial game of love with his beloved. It symbolises commitment and happiness of love.

عین بین چین میں بین بھو نہیں بین انہد گھن گھور شور جور سے مچائی

“The happy note of my heart is comfortable and soothing, without any fear. The celestial music is like the thundering of the raining clouds.”

The celestial music is like thundering of clouds but it does not instil fear in his heart. The note of his heart is joyful, serene and calm.

سن مینہ سادھ سادھ دالکھ لاگ رہو مہاں گھٹ دھٹ پٹ جوت ہیں جگائی

“True concentration ultimately led to my beloved.
The annihilation of my self led to the identity of spirit
and light.”

His full concentration on the Real led to realisation. The effacement of self unveiled the enlightened Self.

کہاں گنگ گو متی جمنا اور رام گنگ دل جل مول ٹوب ٹوب تیر تھ پر سائی

“Where is the Ganga, Gomti, Jamna and Ram gang? I
have plunged myself in the waters of my heart and
attained realisation.”

The rite of bathing in the sacred rivers or holy waters for purifying oneself has been transcended. He dives inwardly in the waters of gnosis and attains realisation.

کاشی، متھرا، پراگ، برما، بشن، مہیش سب ہی اپنے بھیس کیوں پدیس جائی

“Kashi, Mithra, Praag, Barma, Bishan and Mahesh are
all my forms (manifestations). Why I should I alienate
myself in a search of otherness?”

He finds no necessity in visiting the sacred places of Kashi, Mithra and Praag and worshipping the manifestations of the Absolute in the lordship forms of Barma, Bishan (Vishnu) and Mahesh (outwardness) since the Self is within Man (inwardness). It is by delving deep within the infinite depths of one's being that one can attain union or 'the Supreme identity.'

پر م کی فرید کھیل بری جگت مول نیل درمٹ کے پھول کو پھلا کے پھل کھائی

“Farid! The one, who lost the game of love, wronged
himself by eating from the creeping plant, sprouting
evil in the world (symbolically eating from the
forbidden tree).”

The one, who tastes the fruits of otherness, loses the game of love.

Kafi-160

آج پہلوں سے سڑیندی ہے تہی تُول سڑی چک پیندی ہے

“My nuptial bed is burning my sides today. My inept nuptial quilt is biting me with its teeth.”

The very things, which give comfort, become a source of torment for him in the absence of his beloved. Things remain the same but the freedom of consciousness gives them meaning. No one can deny the objective meanings of nuptial bed and nuptial quilt but he confers existential meanings to them in the state of suffering.

ڈینہہ فراق اسماں سر کڑ کے دلڑی پھڑ کے چھاتی تھڑ کے
سول نویں نت ڈیون دھڑ کے سخت ستیندی ہے

“The days of separation are weighing heavily on my head. My heart is fluttering and my chest is palpitating. The incoming afflictions are threatening me. Hardship is highly vexing me.”

The situation of separation is overbearing for him. His embodied self falls in a deplorable state. He is overwhelmed by the state of dread.

آئے وقت وداع سجن دے سونے سانول من موہن دے
سنجڑے سینے بیت حزن دے دلڑی جھوک ڈکھیں دی ہے

“The parting time of my beloved friend has come. He is lovely, charming and bewitching. My wild bosom is the abode of angst. My heart has become the abode of sufferings.”

He faces the moments of angst and suffering in the parting of his charismatic beloved. He experiences peeling of his self.

اُجڑی رنگت پھٹے پھٹے
ہار حمیلاں سہرے تڑپے
اے ڈکھ کھڑے سکھڑے کھڑے
پل پل پیڑ مومجھندی ہے

“The brightness of colours has disappeared and the colourful bridal coverings have faded out. The necklace, neck ornaments and chaplets stand broken. The flocking of sufferings has displaced peace. My constant pain gives me anguish.”

His whole world collapses in the state of separation from his beloved. The everydayness of existence has no meaning for him. The colourful life becomes colourless. The ornamentations break in pieces. The day of peace turns into night of suffering and painful anguish. His midday sun of love becomes totally eclipsed.

وطن پیاسا چایاں خشکیاں
خوشیاں ڈسکیاں مونجھاں مسکیاں
سانوں ڈوڑیاں ڈوڑیاں خشکیاں
قسمت رخ بدلیندی ہے

“My longing for the native land is reviving. My delights are sobbing and my anguishes are smiling. I am feeling highly dry and oppressed. It is destiny that takes such turns.”

The quest of finding the origin and center of one's self, on the spectrum of time amidst oppressiveness, becomes so challenging for him.

پاس نہ کیستی آس دلیں دی
یاری تروڑی یارچہیندے
مان ونجایم مان مہیں دے
جندڑی کھتر کریندی ہے

“He has not cared for the hope of my heart. My beloved friend has snapped his friendly ties with me. It has lead to the breaking of my vanity. My life is regretful of it.”

He perceives the transcendence of his beloved in different ways. He holds his beloved responsible for dashing his hopes; snapping friendly ties with him and ruining his faith in love. He is regretful of his life, which has brought him to such a tragic end.

مستک لکھڑی پیش پیو سے یار فرید نہ کھڑ مکیو سے
بیدرداں دے ساتھ رلیو سے سب کئی ہنیں ڈیندی ہے

“I got what was destined for me. Farid! My friend did not stay to bid me even good-bye. I am being rebuked by every one, on account of having been wretched at the hands of the heartless.”

He tries to understand his plight in the context of cosmic destiny. It at least gives him some solace in placing his suffering in a wider context. He recalls the suddenness of parting, which leaves him unprepared. He faces rebukes for cultivating friendship with his heartless beloved who has turned him into ‘wretched of the earth.’ Isn’t it the beauty of love that the lover hardly blames himself in the game of love?

Kafi-161

آج ڈوڑی سک دیدار دی ہے متاں آئی نگری دلد ار دی ہے

“My desire for witnessing is doubly on the increase today since the dwellings of my beloved are nigh.”

The nearness of beloved's dwellings increases his desire of vision.

ارض مقدس ملک عرب دی ہر ہر وادی فرح طرب دی
منزل منزل طرح عجب دی ساری وضع سنگار دی ہے

“The Arabian land is holy. There is a state of blooming, happiness in each and every valley. The beauty of the way is being strangely reflected at each and every stage.”

The land of Arabia is holy by virtue of the House of God and the Prophetic presence. The valleys manifest thriving happiness. The steps of journey amazingly reflect the beauty of the way.

ہر ہر قطرہ آب ہے کوثر گرد و غبار ہے مشک تے عنبر
کرڑ کنڈا شمشاد صنوبر خاروی شکل بہار دی ہے

“Here, each and every drop of water is blessed. The cloudy dust is perfume and ambergris. Thorny shrubs and thorns are bon-tree and a bearing tree. The thorn (autumn) looks like spring.”

The land symbolises blessings of Divine revelation, which is guidance to mankind. Both the outer and the inner stand transformed.

عرب شریف ہے سوہنی ساری نازک نازوتے متواری

تھیواں واری لکھ لکھ واری دار نبی مختار دی ہے

“The sacred Arabia is all beauties. It is tendered, elegant and graceful. I may sacrifice myself countless times on it. It is the dwelling of the sovereign prophet.”

The sacred land is so beautiful. It mirrors the tender, elegant and graceful tradition of love. He resolves to completely sacrifice himself at the altar of the living Prophet, who bestows mercy on mankind.

آئے حج عمرے دے وارے سبھ رل مل لبیک پکارے
جیندیں ڈیکھاں رب نہ مارے و سیری حُب گھر بار دی ہے

“The times of Hajj and Umra have ushered in. All have gathered together in proclaiming their presence (receptivity before God). I may witness it, while living before the Sustainer calls me back from this world. All loves of my household have dwindled into insignificance.”

People proclaim their receptivity before God in togetherness (collective self) in times of Hajj and Umra. He becomes oblivious of his everydayness of existence and he longs for the vision of his beloved before his exit from the terrestrial world.

انگن نہ بھاوے تے گھر کھاوے ساڑے تول نہالی تاوے
کئی شے اصلوں محض نہ بھاوے سک پک سانول یار دی ہے

“The courtyard of my house is not pleasant and my house haunts me. My nuptial quilt burns me and the mattress parches me. There is nothing that really enchants me. I have the sole desire of my charming friend.”

He is completely immersed in the desire of union with his charming beloved. The outer claims of his self hold no ground for him.

عشق فرید خرید کیتو سے کل کاروں آزاد تھیو سے
 سُرخِ سیندھ مساک گیو سے نہ کل کجلے دھاردی ہے

“Farid! Love has bought me. It has freed me from the contingent realm of the action. My rouge, collyrium and twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects), is no more. I have no concern even for the line of the collyrium.”

He is sold out to love and thereby frees himself from the contingency of action. Action is bound to individuality and the ceasing of individuality leads to the cessation of the contingent realm of action; metaphysically understood as nonaction or ‘inaction’. The Divine fully acts through the human medium. It is the stage of metaphysical or universal realisation. When the individual ceases to be; he no more requires beautification to attract his beloved (symbolising transcendence from the contingent realm of action).

Kafi-162

آج رنگ رخ تے ولایا ہے متاں ماہی مانھوں گھلایا ہے

“The colour of my face has brightened today.
Perhaps, my friend has sent some courier.”

The expectation of his beloved’s message, at the hands of a courier, ends the period of separation and disunion, which restores colour on her face.

جنگل پیلے سبزی چائی رونق روز بروز سوائی
رل مل ستیاں ڈیون ودھائی رانجھن لُوں لُوں رلیا ہے

“The forest and the marshes are green. The bloom is on the increase each day. My friends in togetherness are congratulating me. Ranjhan has been knitted in the fabric of my being.”

The deadness of forests and marshes turns into an ever increasing liveliness. Friends congratulate her in togetherness at the unveiling of her beloved in the infinite depths of her being.

کانہہ کیلے ختنکی چائی چائی لیاں دے بور لائے
گل پھل کر دے حسن نمائی سکھ ملایا ڈکھ ٹلایا ہے

“The riverine reeds and plants have become fresh. The plants (jhao) have turned red. The flowers and rose buds are manifesting their beauty. Peace has ushered in and sufferings have withered away.”

There is enveloping freshness, happiness and beauty. The ushering of inward peace leads to the withering away of sufferings. Doesn’t light make darkness vanish?

رانجھن جوگی میڈاماہی میں بے واہی داہے واہی
روز ازل توں اس دی آہی جیں دلڑی نوں ملیا ہے

“Ranjhan Yogi is my beloved. I am without shelter and he is my shelter. I belong to him ever since the primordial day. He has captivated my heart.”

She has no shelter except the recurring shelter (symbolised as Yogi) of her beloved. It is her primordial love commitment in the pre-eternal covenant.

ڈھولن ڈتی بانہہ سر اندی سس ننان تھئی درماندی
کھیڑیں بھیڑیں حسرت آندی کوئی گلیاتے کوئی جلیا ہے

“My beloved has folded his arms under my head. My mother-in-law and my sister-in-law have become disheartened. The despicable ‘Kheras’ are in a state of wistfulness. It makes some of them rot and others jealous.”

The beloved’s responsiveness of love in owning her elicits negative responses at the hands of her in-laws (secondary ties). There is disheartenment, wistfulness, rottenness and jealousy amongst them. Doesn’t happiness create loneliness? There is hardly any one to share happiness except a sincere friend.

ماہی کیتے جھوکیں دیرے تھئے ہن میرے بھاگ بھلیرے
ہتھ گانے سر سوہندے سہرے باغ خوشی دا پھلایا ہے

“My beloved has settled in my dwellings. Now, my fortune has started smiling on me. There are colourful threads around my wrist (symbolising marital bond) and adorning chaplets on my head. The orchard of my happiness has flowered.”

He has the feeling of being so fortunate in winning his beloved on his side. His inward state of happiness blooms forth.

تھیو سے سول کنوں جی واندا
 گذریا ویہلا وقت ڈکھاں دا
 یار فرید ملیم دل بھاندا
 بخت اتاں ول ڈھلیا ہے

“My heart has become free of afflictions. The times of sufferings have passed away. Farid! My heart is pleased to meet my friend. Good fortune has turned towards me.”

Time is not static. The times of sufferings pass away freeing heart of afflictions. Time turns into eternity when his heart finds contentment in meeting his beloved. It is the turn of fortunes, which makes him smile. The smiles of fortunes or the smiles of the lover are identical. All human effort is ultimately subject to fortune. Good fortune or misfortune is beyond the ken of human endeavour. The results are in the hands of the Divine, says the tradition. The message of union or hope encourages the lover to remain steadfast in traversing the path of love without falling in despair.

Kafi-163

آج فال فراق ڈسیندی ہے متاں یار کنوں نکھڑیندی ہے

“There is an augury of separation today. May be it separates me from my friend.”

The omen portent indicates separation from friend.

سختیاں ودھیاں سکھ تھئے تھو لے رنج و الم غم سوز سمو لے
چرکھا ڈکھڑی روں روں بو لے تند ڈنگی ول پیندی ہے

“There is an increase in my hardships and my peacefulness has decreased. Grief, torments, sorrows and passions have all flocked together. The spinning wheel is uttering notes of suffering. The threading is bending and not following its straight course.”

The act of separation from the beloved is beset with hardships, grief, torments, sorrows and unfulfilled passions. The spinning wheel uttering notes of suffering symbolises the human self undergoing suffering in love. The twisting of thread symbolises the nullity of human effort in the face of Divine Grace.

سیندھاں کجڑیاں میندیاں پکھڑیاں کجلے اُجڑے سرخیاں بکھڑیاں
یا ساں ملیاں آساں نکھڑیاں لوں لوں وین ولیندی ہے

“The parting line of hair on my head is untidy and henna is faded. The collyrium has worn out and rouge has been swelled. I am in despair with unrealised hopes. There is a tune of wailing in my each and every pore.”

The outward reflects the inward. The state of separation or disunion leads its marks on the outward. The unrealised hopes lead to despair. It is a state of “dark night of the soul” and has to be qualitatively differentiated from ordinary despair. It can be understood as an eclipse of hope. Isn’t the inaudible song of love beneath the inward tune of wailing?

تول نہالیاں دارڈ سیجن ہار پھلانڈے خارڈ سیجن
صحن، حویلیاں بارڈ سیجن سب شے مونجھ ودھیندی ہے

“My nuptial quilts and mattresses seem as gallows. The garlands appear as thorns. The courtyard and mansions look like wilderness. All things are increasing my anguish.”

Her separation or disunion from her beloved is a terrible experience. The things, which once gave peace, beauty and homeliness, have now turned to be the instruments of increasing anguish. She perceives everything through the eye of anguish.

بھاگ گیا بد بختی جاگی بانہہ چوڑیلی تھیوم ڈوہاگی
جیندیں ڈیکھاں سانول ساگی جندڑی مر مرویندی ہے

“Fortunes have gone away and misfortunes have awakened. My arm covered with bangles exhibits misfortune. I may see my beloved in my life time. My life is ending spiritlessly.”

The dormant misfortune has activated by banishing good fortune. The ornamented arm seemingly conveys a stroke of bad luck. She yearns for her beloved’s vision before her spiritless life comes to an end.

ٹوٹے پیلین کڑیاں نیور ٹکڑے بینے بولے سینسر
کٹمالے تھئے ناگک برابر چوہنب کلی چک پیندی ہے

“My bangles, bracelets and anklets are broken. My forehead and nose ornaments are reduced to pieces.

My bead necklace seems like a snake and the champak necklace is biting me. All my ornaments are reduced to bits and pieces.”

The jewellery and ornamentation symbolise delight of belongingness. She finds them as a source of torment since she is separated and disunited from her beloved.

نظر نہ آوے رانجھن ماہی کیتس بے کس تے بے واہی
مونجھ مونجھاری گل دی پھاہی صبر آرام ونجیندی ہے

“My Ranjhan friend is no where to be seen. He has made me helpless and without any shelter. Anguishes are a rope around my neck leading to the loss of my patience and peace.”

The veiling of the beloved makes her helpless and shelterless. The multiplying anguish tighten the noose around her neck making it overbearing and discomforting.

درد کنوں مونہہ ساواپیلا چولا کالا بوچھن نیلا
توں بن ساڈا کو جھاحیلہ ہر کئی سخت الیندی ہے

“My face has turned green and yellow due to pain. My cloak is black and my head covering is blue. All my efforts are fruitless without you. People talk bitterly with me.”

The inward sufferings cast their shadows on her face (reality) and the attire (coverings). People discourse with her so bitterly, instead of sharing her sufferings. Her efforts to attain or realise union do not fructify without the responsiveness of her beloved (Divine Grace).

سون شگون سبھے تھے پُٹھڑے وصل وصال دے سانگے ترڑے
نین نہ بھائے روروہڑے دلڑی کیس کریندی ہے

“All omens of my marriage are overturned. The ties of my union have been snapped. My despised eyes are exhausted by crying. My heart is drowned in woe.”

The omens of happy union with her beloved have turned into sad states of disunion. It has snapped the ties of union. The dried eyes reflect the heart drowned in woe.

چیتز بہار خزان ڈسجے جھوک سبھو ویران ڈسجے
نہ کوئی علم نہ بان ڈسجے روہی ڈین ڈریندی ہے

“The spring season of April seems autumn to me. All dwellings look so deserted. I have no knowledge or a way out. The haunted desert frightens me.”

The seasons of spring and autumn are relative to the union or disunion of the beloved, respectively. The dwellings seem deserted without her beloved. The contingent realms of knowledge and action do not fructify. The haunted wilderness of her self is so frightening.

یار فرید نہ کھڑ مکلایا باری بارِ ہجر سر آیا
سک ساڑیا تے تا نگھاں تایا قسمت رو دھے ڈیندی ہے

“Farid! My friend did not bother to bid me a goodbye. The heavy burden of disunion is fallen on my head. The desire has burnt me and the longing has set me aflame. It is my destiny that creates hardships for me.”

There are no mental preparations in love. The suddenness of the beloved's transcendence makes him feel being thrown in a situation. He has to bear the onerous burden of disunion. The desire and longing of union with the beloved burns the lover and reduces him to ashes. Destiny engulfs one in trying circumstances. Isn't it the law of things that union is realised out of ashes of the lover?

Kafi-164

اج کل اکھ پھر کاندی ہے کئی خبر وصال دی آندی ہے

“My eye is quivering these days. May be there is a message of union.”

Waiting for the beloved is the most taxing art of love. The quivering of eye is taken as the news of the friend's arrival. It is a cultural expression of her desire and longing for union.

وقت ملن دی موسم آئی لذت روز بروز سوائی
خوشیاں کردی مایو جانی کیا بردی کیا باندی ہے

“The time of realising union has come. There is a constant increase in happiness. My sister is happy with me. What to talk about my maid and bondwoman (who are happy too).”

The times of union have ushered in leading to day by day increase in happiness. Good times bring positive changes in the attitudes of people. She finds her sister happy to know facts about her intimacy. Even the maids and bondwomen share this happiness.

درد و الم برباد تھیو سے جنگل بیلہ شاد تھیو سے
ویرانہ آباد تھیو سے فرحت مول نہ جاندی ہے

“My pains and torment have been uprooted. The forests and riparian shrubbery have become fresh. The desolate areas have turned into dwellings. Happiness will never depart.”

The eye of happiness sees the world happy. It gives a fresh meaning to things. She considers the state of her happiness as permanent.

ہر ویلھے ہر آن ہے شادی ڈیون لوک مبارک بادی
ہر آزاروں تھی آزادی سول کنوں جند و اندی ہے

“There is happiness at each and every moment. People are conveying their greetings. There is freedom from every distress. My heart has become free from all afflictions.”

She experiences perpetual joy in the situation of love. She is greeted by people for her realising union. Her life becomes free from every distress and affliction.

رانجھن جو گی آیم ویڑھے سڑدے مردے کھیڑے بھیڑے
ہُن وِت سانوں کون نکھیڑے پلپل بانہہ سراندی ہے

“Ranjhan Yogi has come to my courtyard. The despicable ‘Kheras’ are dying of jealousy. Now, who will part us? Your arm is folded under my head all the times.”

The beloved unveils from within the infinite depths of her being. The adversaries are jealous to see her good fortunes in realising love. The beloved’s intimate responsiveness leaves no chance for anyone to create disunity between them.

تھیا فرید سہاگ سوایا مولی جھوک نوں آن وسایا
رانجھن میڈا میں گھر آیا جیں کارن دل ماندی ہے

“Farid! My union has become auspicious. My Sustainer has turned the place into dwellings. My Ranjhan has come to dwell with me. My heart was suffering from weariness (sickness-unto-death) without him.”

His love and gnosis lead to metaphysical realisation. Heart weariness withers away with the unveiling of his beloved, by the Grace of God.

Kafi-165

آج مانگھ مہینے دی نانویں وے ول آویں آگل لانویں وے

“It is ninth of Mangh (the month that comes before the spring season) today, oh. Do come and embrace me, oh.”

The advent of spring deepens the desire of union with her beloved.

زرت رنگیلی تے ساعت سوہنی موسم گل پھل دی من موہنی
مد مستانی ڈکھڑیں کوہنی سانول صحن سہانویں وے

“The season is colourful and the moments are lovely. The spread of flowers is enchanting. These enthralling times eliminate sufferings. My charming friend! Do beautify my courtyard by your presence, oh.”

It is the ambience of love, which eliminates sufferings of separation and disunion. She beseeches her charming friend to unveil himself for the sake of realising union.

ستیاں ناز نواز کریندیاں کجلہ سُرخِ مانگ بنیندیاں
چیتڑ سہیندیاں ور گل لیندیاں میں گھروں پوں پاویں وے

“My friends are displaying their pride and elegance. There are applying the collyrium, rouge and setting their hair. They are enjoying the season by embracing their beloveds. Do step in my dwellings as well, oh.”

She sees her friends pridefully and elegantly realising union of love. She entreats her beloved to affect union with her.

مٹھڑی روپ انوپ و سارے ڈکھڑی روندیں عمر گزارے
سوہنا ڈے کر کوڑے لارے آندیں نہ مڑ جانویں وے

“I am the miserable one who has become oblivious of beautifying forms. I am sufferer who is spending her life in crying. My beloved friend! Do not just leave me by giving false hopes, oh.”

She becomes oblivious of her beautiful forms. She suffers in crying. She does not want to spend her life in false hopes of union at the hands of her beloved.

کھیڑے بھیڑے ر لھن بکھیڑے سس نناناں لا نوم جھیڑے
چاک مہیندا آوڑ ویڑھے تترئی نوں ناتا نوں وے

“The despicable ‘Kheras’ are fanning their incongruities. My mother-in-law and sisters-in-law are picking up brawls with me. The shepherd of my flock! Do come in my courtyard. Do not make the inept fiery, oh.”

She finds herself in miserable plight at the hands of her adversaries. The unresponsiveness of her beloved makes her fiery.

ستیاں جگتیاں نوکاں کر دیاں مہنے ہاپ کریندیاں بر دیاں
مل ماہی ہن بھٹ گھت سر دیاں نہ دھوتیں لاج لجاویں وے

“My friends are laughing and making fun of me. The bondwomen consider me fit for rebuking. My beloved! Meet me and cast aside indifference and apathy. Do not let the backbiters dishonour me, oh?”

The transcendence of the beloved (exhibited in his indifference and apathy) makes her helpless in facing hostile environment. She wants her beloved to manifest in immanence in order to save her from being dishonoured at the hands of the backbiters. Her individual and social self is almost peeled out and she finds no refuge except in her beloved. Doesn't such vulnerability bring her to the threshold of union?

توں بن میرا ہور نہ کوئی طعنے مارم خلق سبھوئی
روز ازل دی تیری ہوئی لگڑی توڑ نبھانویں وے

“There is no one who belongs to me without you. All the people are taunting at me. I belong to you ever since the primordial day. Do realise this primordial commitment, oh.”

She has no friend except her beloved. Otherness is so despicable. Her love is primordial. She beseeches her friend to honour his commitment of love till end (to absolutely honour the commitment of love).

سالاہوں بھنڑا اکھیاں نیرے چولی چڑی لیر کتیرے
لوں لوں سیڑھاں لکھ لکھ چیرے الڑے زخم مٹانویں وے

“My nuptial shawl is wet with tears rolling from my eyes. My dress has been torn to bits. There are countless cuts and profuse bleeding in my each and every pore. Do heal my fresh wounds, oh.”

The wounds of love are always fresh. Who can heal these wounds except her beloved?

نینہ فرید فقیر دی موڑی باجھ برہوں دے گل کوڑی
مردیں جیندیں نیویں پوری دل نوں داغ نہ لانیویں وے

“Farid! Love is the treasure of the faqir (one who is conscious of his ontological nothingness). All talks except love are false. Do remain committed to it at all times. Do not stigmatize your heart, oh.”

He reiterates the traditional wisdom of love. Love is the treasure of the one who is conscious of his ontological nothingness in Face of the Beloved. The reality of love is the sole reality and it exposes the fakery of all things. One should remain committed to love through thick and thin and never stigmatise his heart by being drowned in otherness. It is the Divine, which is loved in all forms— knowingly or ignorantly. All love is sacred at its roots. Loving human for the sake of human is falling to the lowest of the low in the pit of otherness.

Kafi-166

آج مانگھ مہینے دی یار ہی وے کیوں بیٹھیں یار و ساری وے

“It is the eleventh of the Mangh month today, oh.
Why are you being oblivious of your friend, oh?”

She suffers the transcendence of her beloved with the
nearing of the spring season.

آئی موسم چیتز بہاراں سینگیاں سرتیاں ملیاں یاراں
جو بھن لہریں تار متاراں ہک میں مفت ازاری وے

“The season of spring has come. My same age friends
are meeting their friends. The tides of their youth are
in full swing (animation). I am the one who is
distressed for nothing, oh.”

She sees lovers uniting with their beloveds, in their
youthfulness, during the spring season but finds herself
bearing the distress of separation from her beloved.

سیاں دھانوں گانوں گانوں سہجوں ہار سنگار سہاون
مانگ بناون دھڑیاں گندھانوں میں سر ڈکھڑے باری وے

“My friends are bathing, while singing songs. They
are fondly accomplishing their makeup. They are
drawing a parting line of hair on their head and
kneading the locks of hair. I am loaded with heavy
burden of sufferings on my head, oh.”

She witnesses joys of lovers and their preparations in
accomplishing union but she finds herself condemned to
overbearing sufferings.

سرخ کجہ میندی سُہندی ہر ہک اپنے ڈھول نوں ہندی
میں مٹھڑی غم لٹڑی لہندی کردی لکھ لکھ زاری وے

“The rouge, collyrium and henna look so pleasant. My every companion is captivating her beloved. I am the miserable one who has been destroyed by sorrows and is experiencing an anxious desire (of my beloved). I am making countless calls of distress, oh.”

The lovers are enjoying the moments of love with their beloveds but she is left out and making innumerable calls of distress to her beloved.

زیور پانوں بیڑے لانون کنتھر جھاوَن سبجھ سہاون
بانہہ سراندی وُر گل لانون میں ہاں سولاں ماری وے

“They are wearing jewellery and complete set of bangles. They are being intimate with their beloveds and dwelling in the nuptial beds. They are embracing their beloveds with folded arms. I am the one dying with afflictions, oh.”

The lovers are ornamented and uniting with their beloveds but she is victim of afflictions in disunion from her beloved.

رُت سوہنی تے وقت سکھیلے انگن سپیلے گھر الیلے
میکوں وی رب رانجھن میلے قسمت ڈیوم واری وے

“The season is beautiful and the times are comfortable. The courtyard is beautiful and the house is lively. My Sustainer! Make me also unite with Ranjhan. Let fate give me my turn, oh.”

She wishes a turn of fortune in these happy times, in order to unite with her beloved, by the Grace of God.

گل بھل دھجراں جوڑ ڈکھاوم بلبل بھونرے خوشیاں پانوم
ول ول حسرت ساڑے آنوم پل پل چُپچم کٹاری وے

“The rose buds and flowers are in heightening blooms. The nightingale and the moth like insects (black beetle) are radiating happiness. My wistfulness

is burning me perpetually. The dagger is piercing my heart at each and every moment, oh.”

She finds herself so miserable without her friend and more so amidst the singing birds in the orchard of spring.

اُجڑے سہرے ہار کمانے ناز نواز دے ٹول وہانے
گزرے سارے مانے ترانے لگڑی شہر خواری وے

“The chaplets have been crushed and the garlands have lost their freshness. The company of priding and elegance has passed away. All vanities have vanished. I have earned notoriety, oh.”

She has lost all colour and freshness of love. She has no more any pride, elegance and vanity but has earned notoriety, instead.

راتیں مندر نہ ڈینہہ قرارے ہر ہر ویلے دار مدارے
تول نہالی دُسدی دارے تترئی اوڑک ہاری وے

“There is no rest at night or peace in the day. There are irritating situations at each and every moment. My nuptial quilt and mattress seem, scaffold to me. I am the inept one who has finally lost (the game of love), oh.”

She is in such a terrible condition that she perceives losing the game of love.

بانہہ چوڑیلی سک سک ہٹھڑی گل نہ لاوے ڈیند اُبٹھڑی
پیت کلڈی ریت اُبٹھڑی ڈٹھڑی یاردی یاری وے

“My arm decorated with set of bangles has been worn-out due to perpetual desiring. My beloved does not embrace me but walks away. My love is unintelligible and the tradition of love is overturned. I have experienced the (so-called) friendship of my friend, oh.”

The effortful desire to unite with her beloved does not fructify. The unintelligibility of love and the intricacy of its tradition are beyond the ken of rational understanding.

She questions the friendship of her friend (in such a sweet way).

ماہی مٹھڑا گل نہ لاؤم گانے گہنے کھاؤن آؤم
باس گلاندی سہا منجھاؤم ساڑے باد بہاری وے

“My sweet beloved does not embrace me. My colourful threads around my wrist (symbolising marital bond) and my ornaments haunt me. The fragrance of flowers anguishes my breath. The cool breeze of spring burns me, oh.”

Union with the beloved is the measure of all things. All inspiring things become perspiring in separation and disunion from her beloved.

درد اندوہ تے روگ کشالے سوز پچالے اکھتیاں نالے
شالایا فرید سمبھالے ٹالم مونجھ مونجھاری وے

“My life is characterized by pain, grief, malaise, adversities, burning passion and tearful eyes. Farid! I pray that my friend takes care of me and ends my anguishes, oh.”

He is fully conscious of the fact that it is only his beloved who can end his distresses and mounting anguishes by gracing him with union.

Kafi-167

آچنوں رل یار پیلوں پکیاں نی وے

“My friends! Let’s pick together. The pilus is ripe,
oh!”

The tree of the desert laden with ripened fruit symbolises the essential vocation of Man in realising the possibilities of his existence. Pilu harvest in its natural and cultural context notwithstanding, the picking of pilu in the company of friends symbolises realisation of possibilities in society. It is a message of integrating the inward with the outward. It is integration and not segregation from community that helps her attain metaphysical realisation.

کئی بگڑیاں کئی ساویاں پیلیاں کئی بھوریاں کئی پھکڑیاں نیلیاں
کئی اودیاں گلنار کئی رتیاں نی وے

“Some are white, green and yellow; some are
brownish and light bluish while some are red, mauve
and grey, oh!”

The traditional symbolism of colours helps in understanding the nature of different existential possibilities realisable on the spectrum of time.

بار تھئی ہے ریشک ارم دی نیک سڑگئی جڑھ ڈکھتے غم دی
ہر جا باغ بہار ساکھاں چکھیاں نی وے

“The paradise is envious of the desert. The roots of
sufferings and sorrows have been dried and burnt.
There is blossoming spring everywhere. The recently
plucked fruits have been tasted, oh!”

The desert of the inner self becomes paradisaal state leading to the uprooting of sufferings and sorrows of individuality. Tasting symbolises realisation

پیلوں ڈیلھیاں دیاں گلزاراں کہیں گل ٹوریاں کہیں سرکھاریاں
کئی لایٹھیاں بار بھر بھر پچھیاں نی وے

“Pilus and other fruits are flowering. Some (pilus pickers) are bearing neck baskets and some are bearing small baskets on head. Some has gathered heaps of fruits by filling on hawker’s baskets, oh!”

The beautiful art of realising existential possibilities varies from individual to individual. It is the manifestation of the inward in different modes of the outward.

جال جلوٹیں تھئی آبادی پل پل خوشیاں دم دم شادی
لوکی سہنس ہزار گل نے پھکیاں نی وے

“People have gathered at the site of the pilus trees. There is happiness and rejoice at each and every moment. There are hundreds and thousands of people over there. They are chucking pilus in their mouths with the palms of their hands, oh!”

The realisation of existential possibilities in the community sets such a beautiful pattern. The society of selves is a happy society where play and work become identical.

حوراں پریاں ٹولے ٹولے حسن دیاں ہیلاں رہوں دے جھولے
راتیں ٹھڈیاں ٹھار گوئیں نتیاں نی وے

“The beautiful and lovely maidens are visible in groups. They are the breezes of beauty and the gusts of love (in the desert). The nights are cool and chilly. The day wind is hot, oh!”

The integration of beauty and love is the integration of contemplation (night) and action (day); hot day wind symbolising the testing times of love, which are necessary for the realisation of union.

رکھدے ناز حسن پروردے ابرو تنگ تے تیر نظر دے
تیز نگھے ہتھیار دلیاں پھٹیاں نیوے

“These maidens keep prides and nurture themselves in beauty. Their eyebrows are swords and the arrows of their eyes are sharp and pointed weapons. Hearts have been ravished, oh!”

The magnetism of beauty attracts the lovers and their hearts become ravished in return.

کئی ڈیون ان نال برابر کئی گھن آون ڈیڈھے کر کر
کئی وچن بازار ٹلیاں تلیاں نیوے

“Some is bartering for wheat. Some is bartering for one and half wheat. Some is measuring by the eyes keeping in a view the market price, oh!”

The realisation of possibilities takes place by virtue of freedom. It is not a mechanical affair but a creative one, which makes every individual choose his own mode of realisation.

کئی دھپ وچ دی چندیاں رہندیاں کئی گھن چھان چھنیرے بہندیاں
کئی چن چن بیاں ہار ہٹیاں تھکیاں نیوے

“Some remain picking pilus even in sunshine. Some has picked these and sat under the shade. Some by constant picking have become exhausted, tired and worn out, oh!”

The act of picking pilus even in sunshine symbolises the resolve to attain universal realisation, whereas the sitting of the pickers in shade symbolises the inferior stage of individual realisation. The realisation of the doctrine is free but it is so hard. Some may even ultimately fail to attain realisation (union and deliverance).

ایڈوں عشوے غمزے نخرے اوڈوں یار خراپتی بکرے
کُسن کان تیار رانداں رسیاں نیوے

“There are amorous glances, enticements and blandishments, on part of the beautiful maidens. There is the spirit of sacrificial animals on part of the lovers, readily available for being slaughtered. The game of love is in full swing, oh!”

There is inseparability of beauty and love. Beauty attracts the lovers and the lovers like iron filings get attracted to it. It is the game of realisation, which is in full swing.

پیلوں چُنْدیں بو جھن لیراں چولاوی تھیالیر کتیراں
گلڑے کرن پچار سینگیاں سکیاں نی وے

“The shawl has been torn apart and the shirt has also been torn in bits, while picking pilus. The youthful companions and relative girls are making complaints and objections (being critical and making them ashamed), oh!”

The difficult act of realisation is essentially inward leading to the dwindling of individuality into universality and going beyond the ordinary standards of society in simultaneity. The lover is a rebel who, in the act of realisation, casts away his self and at the same time sets higher standards for the community.

آیاں پیلوں چنن دے سانگے اوڑک تھیاں فریدن وانگے
چھوڑ آرام قرار ہکیاں بکیاں نی وے

“They came for the sake of picking pilus. Ultimately, they became Farid like. They left peace and rest and fell in a state of rapture, oh!”

The possibilities inhering in the Divine Essence were in the state of calm and repose (nonexistence). They were manifested in the state of existence in individual forms. The individuals embarked on attaining realisation (symbolised in the act of pilu picking). The individual realisation gave way to his universal and bewildering stage of metaphysical realisation.

Kafi-168

آج ویڑھا پیا بھاندا ہے کوئی وصل سنہیرا آندا ہے

“My courtyard seems pleasant to me today. Some message of union is in the air.”

Love heightens the sense of intuition. The ambience of love makes him intuit the unveiling of his beloved.

مل مل آئے باد رکارے بجلی چمکے مینہ پھنگارے
گج گج گج کرے دھدکارے جھوک سہاگ سہاندا ہے

“The black clouds are gathering. There are flashes of lightning with drizzle. The thundering of clouds is loudening. The merriment in my dwellings is looking so good.”

He finds himself on the threshold of meeting with his beloved, which causes merriment in the inmost chamber of his being.

ٹوبھے اچھلن مال نہ ماوے راتیں یار اسان گل لاوے
ہر کوئی فرحت نال نبھاوے ہک ڈکھ ڈکھ پیا کھاندا ہے

“The ponds are overflowing with water and the place of a herd has become constricted. My beloved embraces me in the darkness of night. Every one is realising his possibilities in happiness. It is only suffering that is obliterating suffering itself.”

The water of life starts overflowing. The frontiers of the habitual self cannot constrict the higher possibilities of existence. He experiences his beloved in the state of contemplation. Suffering is obliterated at its roots. He goes beyond the clutches of suffering. The era of suffering withers away.

کوئل کو کے مور چنگھاڑے اغن پیہیے کرن ہلارے
ہر وحشی کر لکارے گیت خوشی دے گاندھے

“The cuckoo is cooing and the peacock is sounding wild. The crested cuckoos are voicing calls. Here, each and every wild animal is also loudly voicing the songs of delight.”

The language of the birds is the language of love. The songs of delight are being loudly voiced even by wild animals. Love is making the soft and hardened possibilities of the self become vibrant.

دشت بیاباں ڈسن بہاراں بوئے بوئے سہنس تواراں
راحت ہوئی ہے تار متاراں چولے انگ نہ ماندھے

“The forests and desolate places seem to be lively. The herds with bells around their necks are gathered around each and every plant. The depth of happiness is overflowing its bounds. All is immensely happy.”

Deadness has been transformed into liveliness. The development of the inner self is so musical. Joy knows no bounds. It is a state of ecstatic happiness.

چنگے کر دے چنگ سہیلی ویہلے آن سنبھلیم بیلی
سیندھ فرید رکھاں کیوں میلی ناز نواز سبھاندھے

“The tinkle of bells around the necks of the herds sounds so musical to my ears. My beloved has taken timely care of me. Why I should keep the parting line of my head dusty? It looks so nice to display pride and elegance.”

The realisation of existential possibilities sounds so musical. The friend has given a timely response. He resolves not to remain contented with his untidy appearance since it is so heartening to display pride and elegance. He is not

independent or autonomous since he takes all his cues from his beloved and acts accordingly.

Kafi-169

دل ناں ماندی تھی اچھو مارو ملیو

“My heart! Do not be so weary. You will soon unite with your beloved.”

She consoles her weary heart by giving it hope of union with her beloved. Her solitariness reaches such heights that there is no one to soothe her heart burning in passion except herself.

سو ہے سچ کوں ساڑتے ونج متراں دی تھی

“Burn your nuptial red head covering and the nuptial bed. Go and realise identity with your friend.”

She has to discard the formal rites and delve deep within herself in order to realise identity with her friend.

بردی باندی یاردی بردی باندی تھی

“You are the handmaid and bondwoman of your friend. Become his bondmaid and bondwoman (remain completely subjected to him).”

She has to constantly remember that she is completely subject to her beloved and thereby has to act accordingly.

غیروں اُلفت یار دے دلڑی واندی تھی

“My heart! Do empty yourself from the love of everything except my friend.”

She counsels her heart to empty itself from the love of otherness. She has to love her beloved in absoluteness.

نینہ نہ بھیندیں مرگیم پُئل کاندھی تھی

“I have died while remaining true to love. Punall! Now, you should come to accomplish my funeral rites.”

Her vocation is to remain true to love till the last moment of her breath in spite of all odds. She may die and leave it for the beloved to accomplish her funeral rites. There is no logical necessity between her efforts and the beloved's response. Love rises higher than the horizontal concept of justice. Love is not a trade off. It is a mystery.

تا نگھ فریدنوں آکھدی برڈوں پاندھی تھی

“The insatiable longing asks Farid to travel to the world of wilderness.”

His insatiable longing for his beloved makes him resolve to reach the wilderness of his self with the hope that the autumn of life will certainly have its spring. His despair is qualitatively different from ordinary forms of despair. There is an invisible ray of hope buried beneath his darkness of despair. It is this ray, which keeps him moving in the tracks of love. Isn't love and hope identical?

Kafi-170

الف کہو ہم بس وے میاں جی

“Alif (the alphabet symbolizing Allah, the Reality) is simply and solely enough for me, my respected teacher.”

The imagery of letter Alif is of an independent vertical straight line. The symbolism of letter Alif (A) stands for the Absolute. She attaches herself to the root of Knowledge and needs nothing else.

ہو رکھانی مول نہ بھانی الف گیم دل کھس وے میاں جی

“There is absolutely no other narration that has touched me. It is Alif that has grabbed my heart, my respected teacher.”

She distances herself from the narrations of religiosity. She is bewitched by the letter Alif (A) that contains all love and gnosis.

بے تے دی بئی کل نہ کائی الف کیتم بے وس وے میاں جی

“I have no knowledge of ‘bay’ and ‘tai’ (alphabets symbolising formal learning). Alif has made me helpless, my respected teacher.”

She is overpowered by the inward reality and transcends the domain of formal learning.

ٹھپ رکھ فقہ اصول دے مسئلے باب برہوں داڈس وے میاں جی

“Shelve the issues of jurisprudence and its principles. Open the chapter of loving for me, my respected teacher.”

Jurisprudence and its principles do not offer taste of love. She asks her master to shelve them and make her drunk deep in love and gnosis.

جے کر لگڑو چاٹ برہوں دی جابیاں کول ڈیسیں ڈس وے میاں جی

“Once you get the taste of love (get existentially involved in love), you will even caution your descendants (about the sufferings of love), my respected teacher.”

The taste of love warrants such heights of sufferings that no ordinary being could ever think of contracting love.

جے ناں سبق برہوں دا ڈترو آج کل ویساں نس وے میاں جی

“If you do not teach me the lesson of love, then I will one of these days flee from you, my respected teacher.”

She has no tolerance for religious discourses. She is only interested in attending doctrinal sittings steeped in love.

برہوں سکھیں تے برہوں سکھائیں ہنجی شابس شابس وے میاں جی

“Learn love and teach love. Bravo! Bravo, my respected teacher.”

It is so commendable to learn the art of love and teach the same to votaries.

جیندیں موئیں ہک یار دے رہسوں و سہری ہور ہوس وے میاں جی

“We shall remain committed to the one beloved in life and death. All other craving has been fallen in oblivion, my respected teacher.”

Loving the beloved with absoluteness leaves no room for craving of otherness. She will remain committed to her beloved through thick and thin.

منتر پریت دا پھوک شکاریں لنگنیں ہم آلس وے میاں جی

“Blow over me the incantations of love since there is indisposition in parts of my body, my respected teacher.”

She asks for blowing the incantations of love on her so that she could overcome the temporary indispositions of her body and hasten to reach the destination of love. It is requesting the freshening of her spirit to unite with her beloved.

اُلفت زردی گھردی وردی نہ رہ گئی ہک خُس وے میاں جی

“No attraction of wealth, household and husband has remained in me even to the extent of a straw, my respected teacher.”

The absoluteness and universality of love for one's beloved does not leave any room of love even to the extent of a straw for one's wealth, household or spouse.

رانجھن میرا میں رانجھن دی کھیڑیل دے مونہہ تھس وے میل جی

“Ranjhan is mine and I belong to Ranjhan. I wish dust in the mouths of the ‘Kheras’ (signifying contempt for one's adversaries), my respected teacher.”

Her deep and intimate relationship with her beloved warrants contempt for the adversaries of love.

سٹ گھر بار تے بار و سسیاں بدلیں کیتی لَس وے میاں جی

“I will leave my household and shall dwell in desolate forests. The clouds have shown flashes of lightning, my respected teacher.”

She resolves to leave her everydayness of existence and delve in the desolate forests of herself for there are signs of unveiling of her beloved in the inmost chambers of her being.

علم عمل بھل، ویسی جے کر عشق پیو کن رُس وے میاں جی

“You will become forgetful of knowledge and action (transcend), once the tune of love enters your ears, my respected teacher.”

The universal tune of love played within the infinite depths of her consciousness makes her forget the contingent realms of knowledge and action. Knowledge is transformed

into gnosis and action is transcended to the realm of nonaction.

اُوڑک عشق اندر جند ڈیسوں نہ سمجھیں کھل ہنس وے میاں جی

“Ultimately, I will sacrifice my life for the sake of love. Do not take it as a joke, my respected teacher.”

Reason needs to take her seriously in her claim of sacrificing her life for the sake of love. Reason cannot measure the abysmal depths of love and thus, is at a loss to understand that how could she sacrifice her life just for the sake of her beloved.

نہیں کڈو کناں پیو سے پگھڑے نہ ہی قلم تے مس وے میاں جی

“Love fell to our lot before there was the pen and ink, my respected teacher.”

‘Hidden Treasure’ testifies love itself. The Reality loved to know the possibilities of His Essence in the forms of His Names or Attributes. It was before the Reality created Pen (al-Qalam) to ink ‘the realities of all things (al-haqa’iq) upon the Guarded Tablet (al- Lawh al-Mahfuz).’

نہ آج کل دی یار دے ول دی روز ازل دی ہنس وے میاں جی

“My intimate bond with my friend is not recent. I am with him ever since the primordial day, my respected teacher.”

Her intimacy with her friend is not merely a temporal affair. It is a pre-eternal covenant of friendship with him.

عشقوں مَول فرید نہ پھر سوں روزنویں ہم چس وے میاں جی

“Farid! I will never turn my face from love. I have creative taste each day, my respected teacher.”

He resolves never to turn his face from love. He is drowned in its recurring creative taste.

Kafi-171

اللہ میلے ول سنگ یارا بردی توں دلبر دی

“Allah may unite me with you, my friend for I am the
bondmaid of my beloved.”

She prays for transcending the servant –Lord axis by the
Grace of God.

ناز نزاکت حُسن ملاحِ ت کیا چالیں کیا ڈھنگ یارا
سوہنی طرح نظر دی

“You have prideful tenderness and charming beauty.
You have great moves and unique expressions, my
friend and a lovely style of seeing.”

He is bewitched by Beauty. He describes the beauty of his
beloved with its captivating antics.

عشوے غمزے کرن لڑائی چشمیں کر دیاں جنگ یارا
ڈاڈھے ظلم قہر دی

“The amorous glances and enticements are battling.
The eyes are in a state of warfare, my friend, with
severe cruelty.”

The striking beauty of eyes ravishes his heart.

ہر ہر کا کل ناگ وار دھا زلف مریندی ڈنگ یارا
لڑدی مول نہ اڑدی

“The hair with each and every lock is like an
overpowering snake. The tress bites me, my friend,
without any reservations.”

He is capitulated by the tresses symbolising intricacy of love. He has no exit from love.

قامت یار قیامت ساری سہنس فریب فرنگ یارا
کردی جو جو سردی

“The height of my friend is so captivating. It has countless forms of deceit, my friend, doing all that is possible.”

He tries to encompass the terrific beauty of the magnificent build and stature of his beloved. The beloved succeeds in enticing him at will.

تیر نگہ دارِ گِ رِ چیا سارا بدن چورنگ یارا
لکڑی نوک ہنردی

“The arrow shot from the eyes has pierced my each and every vein. My whole body is a target dot, my friend, with the point of an arrow shot so perfectly.”

The eye targets him perfectly. It ravishes his embodied self. It plays on the game of beauty and love.

عشق فرید ز لایم بروچ ہڈتے انگ انگ یارا
کھڑیم کونج ولہردی

“Farid! Love has made me wretched in wilderness affecting my every bone and each part of flesh, my friend and I am a heron separated from my flock.”

He experiences the separation and disunion of his beloved in his bones and flesh. It is likened to a heron flocking together with other herons and once separated dies alone. The lover and the beloved having the same feathers of love ‘flock’ together. He tends to lose his identity in face of the transcendence of his beloved. He suffers crisis of identity because the formation of his mutual selfhood cannot sustain his evaporating isolated self.

Kafi-172

ہر وقت یار تے دیدوے اَیُّوم بصرِ حدیدوے

“My vision is very sharp today, oh. I am witnessing my friend at each and every moment, oh.”

It is beyond the ken of religiosity to understand that his sharpness of vision (spiritual) makes him constantly witness his friend.

تھے لُجھڑے رازِ پدیدوے کھولی عشقِ قلبِ کلیدوے

تھیابُعدِ سختِ بعیدوے ڈینہہ رات ساڈڑی عیدوے

“Love has opened the key of my heart, oh. The deeper secrets have been unravelled, oh. It is our day and night festivity, oh. The distances have greatly distanced themselves, oh.”

Love opens his deeper mysteries of heart (innateness of knowledge or the ‘immanent Qur’an’). Doctrinal realisation confers perpetual spiritual happiness. Absolute proximity banishes the concept of distance from the gnostic consciousness.

ہٹ کھٹ گئی تقلیدوے غیروں ہے قطعِ بُریدوے

ہے حالِ روزِ مزیدوے دلِ کل گھدی توحیدوے

“The relation with otherness has been severed, oh. The state of servitude has finished, oh. My heart has embraced unity of God, oh. My state is progressing each day, oh.”

The illusory nature of otherness falls to the ground. The state of religiosity crumbles like the house of sand. There is no reality (ilah) except the Reality (Allah). The realisation of Oneness or Unity deepens in every situation.

ہر آن ذوق جدیدے ہر لحظہ شوق شدیدے
 کر صلح تھیم مریدے اٹارہ نفس عنیدے

“My fondness is intensifying at each moment, oh. My taste is renewing at each instant, oh. The carnal self is a deadly enemy, oh. It has made peace with me and has become my disciple, oh.”

The fondness of witnessing the unveiling of the Reality is on the increase. How could religiosity tame the carnal self (al-nafs al-amarah) and transform it into realised self (al nafs al mutma'innah) without spirituality?

وہ فقر دی تمہیدے وہ جذب دی تائیدے
 گئے و سر وعد و عیدے تھی جو گفت و شنیدے

“I laud the mystic state of absorption, oh. I laud the preamble of faqr (consciousness of ontological nothingness), oh. I was engrossed in doctrinal sittings, oh. I became oblivious of all promises and threatening, oh.”

The state of spiritual absorption is the preamble of attaining consciousness of one's own ontological nothingness. The deep involvement in doctrinal sittings makes the illusory nature of self vanish and thereby the votary transcends the promises of paradise and threats of hell. The spiritual experience of God (communication with the Lord) makes one transcend the realm of action.

کاوڑا تے تہدیدے ٹھہندی نہیں تشدیدے
 آزلوں ہے دید خریدے ایہو ادنیٰ عبد فریدے

“Harshness is not befitting, oh. Anger and punishment too (are not befitting), oh. Farid is a humble servant, oh. He has been bought for the sake of the vision of my beloved ever since the primordial day, oh.”

The whole drama of cosmic existence is unfolded on the stage of love. How could he bear harshness, anger and punishment, when he has primordially bartered himself for the sake of his beloved's vision in all humility and subjection?

Kafi-173

اُتھ دردمنداں دے دیرے جتھ کرڑکنڈا بوئی ڈھیرے

“Here, are the dwellings of the compassionate ones with widely spread out thorny shrubs, trees, plants and bushes.”

The loving hearts dwell in Nature, which pacifies them against the humdrum of city life.

اے اچڑے & اے عالی اے سوہنی کلڑی والی

ہن مشتاقاں دے والی بیاکون قدم اتھ پھیرے

“These high and majestic sand dunes and lovely brownish sand is the custodian of the people eager of vision. Who else can step in here?”

The lovers eager for the vision of their beloveds step here in the lovely sand and mounting dunes. It provides a calm atmosphere for contemplation.

کھپ کھاراں تے لئی لانے سنھ پھوگ بہوں مَن بھانے

تھل تھلے ڈھیر لگانے ہر بھٹ بھٹ نال بسیرے

“The desert grass, plants and bushes are appealing to the lovers. They have their dwellings in the desert, sand dunes and the areas between dunes. They have their habitations on the top of every sand mound.”

The lovers are happy in the habitat of the desert with its natural growth. The sand dunes are instrumental in providing them occasions to contemplate on the higher realities of life.

مڈ جھوکاں تے تڑتاڈے رس چھڑے کھیلاں کھاڈے

واہ تکیہ گاہ اساڈے ہن ہووے کون نکھیڑے

“Who can separate us from the thatched huts, dwellings, river beds and transitory habitations,

cultivable land amongst sand mounds, water drains and pools, when these are our abodes?”

The lovers do not wish to be displaced from their dwellings in the desert amongst plantation and water.

ٹب ٹوبھے باہیں سوہندے وچ چٹکے دل نوں موہندے
جی ہر ویلھے پیالوہندے ہے ہر دم ہوؤں نیڑے

“The big sand dunes and ponds create such a pleasant atmosphere. They captivate my heart in broad day light. My heart is yearning that these always remain near me.”

He is fascinated by the desert, which creates a sense of spaciousness in him. He wishes to remain near the lovely sand dunes that give him calmness, serenity and tranquillity.

جھڑ گا جیاں بجلیاں بادل کیا چڑے گورے سانول
سک سانول کرے اُباہل لڈ ہوت وسم آویرھے

“The sky is overcast with whitening and black clouds with flashes of lightning and thundering clouds. My longing for my beloved is intensifying. I wish that my beloved packs up and reach my courtyard.”

There are visual and audible signs of the unveiling of the beloved. His longing to unite with his beloved intensifies.

ولھ لکڑیاں رہیہڑ کچریاں کئی سبز متیرے لکھڑیاں
کئی گد ریاں پیلیاں ککڑیاں سر روہی سوہندے سہرے

“The creeping plants of different sizes and colours of melons are enhancing the beauty of the desert.”

The possibilities of the self (desert) symbolised in plants (growth) and fruits (fruition) enhance its beauty.

خوش قطرن عطروں بھڑی گز لائی ساوی سنڑی
کھاساگ پوسی دی پنزئی نہج ویندے وقت سکھیرے

“My time passes in peace in the desert by living amidst sweet-scented grass, riverine green and fresh plants and by eating potherbs and turnips.”

He is at peace to contemplate the higher possibilities of his existence. He embarks on the vocation to realise these possibilities symbolised in eating of vegetables.

دل ہر ویلھے پی تاگھے ونج ڈیکھاں مال دے لاگھے
گنیں بکریاں بھیداں چاگھے لنگھ پوندیم قدم اگیرے

“My heart perpetually longs to see the passages of the herd. I step out to see cows and flocks of goats and sheep.”

His heart perpetually longs to see the passages of the herd and he steps out in the hope of meeting the shepherd of the herd (beloved). It is a hope of witnessing his beloved in immanence.

سنج واہ آساڈیاں جھوکاں سن کملے کردے ٹوکاں
کچھ خبر نہیں انہاں لوکاں دل بٹھڑے سخت اوڑے

“Our dwellings are desolate. These naive folk resort to sneering. These people have no awareness. Their hearts are overturned and are highly odd.”

The lovers dwell within. They are beyond the understanding of ordinary people, who have nothing to do but resort to sneering. The heartless outsiders are precluded in principle to understand the wisdom of love

بٹھ شہر بزار عمارت بے واہی برہوں بشارت
پر بے شک عشق اشارت 'جھگڑے کوڑے جھیرے

“Cast aside market places, city and mansions. Our inspiration of love is to be without any support. Undoubtedly, these are signs of love. Leave aside wrangling and pseudo- brawls.”

These are doubtlessly the educative signs of love that the lover has to cast aside all things, which distract him from his beloved; needs no external support in the path of love and has not to get involved in wrangling and pseudo-brawls. Isn't it one of the greatest gifts of love that the lover is saved from the pettiness of life?

تہیاں روہی مینگھ ملہاراں
وچ سوہندیاں گھنڈ تواراں
کُل گل گلزار بہاراں
ہر ٹوبھے چھانگاں چھیڑے

“The desert is overcast with rainy clouds. All the flowers and the orchards are blossoming. I like the tinkling of the bells around the necks of the herds while grazing every pond.”

The visual and audible signs of the beloved indicate that the beloved is nigh. It symbolises sprouting of inwardness.

سو کمرے کنڈڑے کاٹھیاں
سب ڈنگڑے وٹڑے چاٹیاں
لکھ ڈونگر اوکھیاں گھاٹیاں
جتھ تھیوم فرید وہیرے

“The feet of Farid are pierced by hundreds of gravels, thorns and small broken wooden pieces along with curved sharpened stones and slabs during his travel through countless mountains and arduous passes.”

It is not easy to realise union with the beloved. The path of love is filled with pains and sufferings.

Kafi-174

اے عشق نہیں سر رو ہے ڈکھیں صولیں دا آنو ہے

“It is not love but a mountain of sufferings and afflictions that has befallen me.”

To fall in love is so easy but to remain steadfast in love is so difficult. Love is impregnated with sufferings and afflictions.

نہ تو لہا ناگ سندی میں من تاری تے نیں باری
میںہ بوری رات اندھاری بیا خاص مہینہ پو ہے

“I lack different means of ferrying across the waters. The waters are running fast and are deep and I do not know how to swim. It is a dark night and there is continuous drizzling. It is a month of extreme cold.”

Love strands him on the bank and makes him face downpour in the chilly dark night. He has neither means to ferry across the waters, which are running fast and are so deep, nor knows the art of swimming. It is an eye opener for a novice in love to have a glimpse of the intricacies of love.

تھی یار رکھے ہم رازی ہے کوڑی حیلہ سازی
ہے پچا تے ٹھگ بازی اے لطف نہیں کوئی درو ہے

“He should become my friend and deeply share with me. (Otherwise) It is a false stance. It is pretence and swindling. It is not love but act of dubiousness.”

He becomes desperate in love. He challenges his beloved to become his friend and share deep aspirations with him, and in case he does not respond, then it means that his stance is false. His desperateness is visible in interpreting the behaviour of his beloved as pretence, swindling and dubiousness. He makes his own criteria of love and judges his

beloved accordingly. His reaction to the repose of the beloved brings to light the subtle distinction between the human and the Divine. He continues to bear the brunt of love and does not sever relationship with his beloved in spite of hurling accusations against him. Love is such a great mystery.

پیاں کھوج پُئل دیاں خبراں گیاں روگ اندر دیاں ڈمراں
جڈاں عاشقاں بدھیاں کمرآں تھئی دلی ڈھائی کوہے

“I have got a track of my Punnaal. It has reduced the intensity of my malaise. When the lovers make choice to remain steadfast in love, the destination seems so near.”

Her success in tracking her beloved ends her malaise and inner stagnancy. When the lovers resolve to march on the road to love, the destination of love seems so nearby. The static state of the lover turns dynamic making the beloved seem so close at hand.

رورنگ رنگ کھم کر پہل بٹھ ڈکھ سکھ رج بکھ دی گل
دم جیندیں تو نیں گیہل جتھ جوہ جتن دی تھوہے

“The camel of my beloved in the state of crying asks me again and again to discard the thought of peace or suffering or of his being fed or hungry. He would keep his striving till he lives to reach the signs of the dwellings of the camel riders.”

His self (symbolised by the camel of the beloved left behind) inspires him not to bother about its physical or mental deprivation but continue his journey to the abode of his beloved (Self). Isn't love a journey of the self to the Self?

نہ یار فرید ملیو سے ناں در دیں واند ڈتو سے
پندھ کر کر ہٹ پیو سے سندھ سندھ دی نکھتی موہے

“Farid! I have neither met my friend nor have pains given me any respite. I have become tired of this long

journey. There have been twists in each and every part of my body.”

The inward journey of the self to the Self seems so long. Time, as such, has no ‘objectivity.’ It lengthens and shortens in reference to disunion and union, respectively. Love unfolds the existential dimensions of time. His embodied self has no respite from continuous pains and bodily twists in the absence of his friend. Love involves his whole being. He suffers in his flesh and bones.

Kafi-175

آئے مَسْتُ ڈھاڑے ساون دے وہ ساون دے من بھانوں دے

“The enchanting days of a rainy season have come.
These good days of raining are so pleasing.”

The beauty of the enthralling days of rainy season in the desert notwithstanding, rain in the desert symbolises the process of the unveiling of the beloved within the lover's being, which makes the lover experience self-fulfilment. It is unveiling of the beloved, veiled within the symbols of Nature (Cosmic Book), which is also understood as going beyond the symbols, discovering behind the veil or going beyond the manifest.

بدلے پورب ماڑ ڈکھن دے کجے بھورے سو سوؤن دے
چارے طرفوں زور پون دے سارے جوڑو ساون دے

“The clouds have come from the West, Marwar and North. These clouds are black, brown and of hundreds of colours. The rain-laden winds are blowing on all sides. All these are signs of rain.”

The direction of the incoming clouds, their colours and the blowing of the rain laden winds are the vibrant signs of the transformation of the beloved's transcendence into immanence. These are the openings of Self-realisation.

چکویاں چکویے اغن پیہیے کوئل مور چچونے چہیے
سہنس چکور چنڈور پیہیے شاغل گیت سناون دے

“The birds are engrossed in singing songs (language of the birds).”

The birds symbolising the tender and musical feelings of love (language of the birds), within his self long for union close at hand.

ڈینہاں پیٹنگھاں ساویاں پیلیاں راتیں لھمنیاں لھمن رنگلیاں
گج گج گاجاں گجن رسیلیاں وقت سنگار سہاون دے

“There are green and yellow rainbows in the sky at daytime. There are flashes of coloured lightning at night. The thundering of the clouds seems so pleasant. This is the time to embellish one self.”

The visual and audible signs of Nature symbolising inwardness inspire him to embellish his embodied self for affecting union with his beloved. The outward is transformed into the inward. It is a shade of integrating contemplation with action symbolised as night and day, respectively. The beauty of action (embellishing oneself) has to correspond to the beauty of contemplation (flashes of coloured lightning at night).

روہی راوے تھیاں گلزاراں تھل پتر انگ وی باغ بہاراں
گھنڈ تو اراں بارش باراں چرچے دھانوں گانوں دے

“The barren and hardened earth has been turned into orchards. The deserts and small white piece of lands flowered and bloomed. It is raining and at the same time the tinkling of the bells around the herds is sounding so musical. The rain is inviting us to sing and bathe.”

The deadness of the self becomes enlivened. There is colourfulness of life spreading its fragrance all around. The celestial music is so audible. The heavenly blessings are sending messages of participation in the ambience of love.

چاندنی رات ملہاری ڈینہہ ہے ٹھڈڑیاں ہیلاں رم جھم بینہہ ہے
سوہنی موسم لکڑا نیہہ ہے گئے ویہلے غم کھانوں دے

“There are moonlit nights and cloudy days. The cool and pleasant breeze is blowing and there is continuous rain. We have contracted love in such a beautiful season. The days of sorrows have gone away.”

The manifestation of the beloved does wonders. It initiates love in beautiful season (the spiritual moments of contact between the human and the divine). Days of sorrowful separation are displaced by happy times of union.

مُستانی تے خوش دنڑے سالہوں سو ہے کیسر بھنڑے
سہجوں مینہ برساتوں سنڑے جھڑ گے لانگھے لانون دے

“These are happy days in the enthralling season. My wedding dress is soaked in perfume. It is readily raining heavily. The corners of the dress of my beloved are exhibiting beauty.”

He experiences the joy of love during the immanence of his beloved. The nuptial dress spreading the fragrance of love gives such a lovely look. The forms of the beloved seem so beautiful in the rain of love.

دیہہ فرید آباد تھیوے مال مویشی شاد تھیوے
دل دردوں آزاد تھیوے چولے انگ نہ مانوں وے

“Farid! My dwellings have enlivened. My cattle are grazing to the fill. My heart has become free from pains. My happiness knows no bounds.”

His static self becomes dynamic (deserted places are transformed into dwellings). His wild passions of love get satiated. The pains of separation and disunion wither away. He experiences proverbial happiness (boundless happiness).

Kafi-176

ایسے ناز ادا سانو لڑے دے ہن باعث عشق او لڑیدے

“The prides and style of my charming beloved is the cause of my odd love.”

He finds himself thrown in the situation of love by virtue of the beautiful expressions of the beloved. There are many shades of the intimate relation between beauty and love. He considers love as odd because it is beyond rational understanding. The oddness of love obliges him not to understand love from the habitual perspectives. He has to develop the style of ‘lived participation’ with the mystery of love.

گئے ویلے بھاگ سو لڑے دے آئے دورے درد کھلڑے دے
ڈتے پیش فراق پٹنلڑے دے ڈکھے پیٹڑے مارو تھلڑے دے

“The times of good fortune have passed away. I have been held up by unintelligible fits. The separation of my beloved has made me step in the suffering paths of the deadly desert.”

His good fortune is tied to the vision of his beloved. The separation from his beloved is an inward shaking experience. It is traversing the suffering paths of the deadly desert of his self.

گئے گذر ڈھاڑے رلڑے دے ترسلڑے عیش سو کھلڑے دے
ہن پر بھت روہ جبلڑے دے سکھ پال تھئے دل جلڑے دے

“The times of meeting my friend have whisked away. The moments of joys, peace and ease have fled.

Now, these mountains and mountainous ranges are comforts of my burning heart.”

He experiences the whisking away of the times of vision and union. They lead to the end of reassurances, joys and ease at the hands of his beloved. His burning heart has no way but to find solace in the meaningful suffering of love.

جڑ کیتی برہوں چھول مٹھی گیا بار سنگار داتول انھی
لگی پھکڑی ہو ہو وول پٹھی واہ بھلڑے بھاگاں بھلڑے دے

“The discourse of the beloved has ravaged the hapless one. The glimmer of my makeup has faded out. There is ill-repute and infamy chasing me. What goodness has been done to me by the blessed one?”

Religiosity has to understand the magnetism of beauty in attracting heart of the lover. How could love be initiated without vision and intimate discourse with the beloved? Sermons are no substitute for a living communication with her beloved. The beautiful discourse of her beloved is so bewitching that it ravages her. Doesn't goodness consist in the blessings of love that fade away her glimmer of make-up and confer ill-repute and infamy on her?

سب مصری کھنڈ نبات بھلیم اعجاز مسیح دی بات بھلیم
مے کوثر آب حیات بھلیم سن شوخ نخن راو لڑیدے

“I have forgotten the sweetness of sugar and sugar – candy. I have forgotten the miracles at the hands of Messiah (Syedna Isa). I have become oblivious of the pure wine and the eternal water of life after listening to the sweet discourse of my beloved.”

His listening to the lively discourse of his beloved takes him to such heights of love that he becomes oblivious of the sweetness of life, the miracle of Syedna Isa (of infusing life in the deadened self), pure wine (drinking from Hauz-i-Kausar or special fountain in paradise at the hands of the Prophet, which will quench the thirst of the spiritual thirsty) and Ab-i-

Hayat (Water of life or immortality 'supposed to give eternal youth and sempiternal (everlasting) life to him who drinks it; esoterically (representing) the universal self and life's principal substance'). Religiosity denies love and gnosis and thereby fails to touch the inner chords of the human. It can never understand the immense engaging power of the communication of love, which makes the lover oblivious of even the greatest things of life.

لگانینہ نیارڑی پیڑا ساں دل چبھڑے برچھے تیرا ساں
سو نشتر لکھ لکھ سیڑھ ساں نبھ وقت چکے در لڑے دے

"I have contracted a painful novel love. The spears and arrows have pierced my heart. There are numerous cuts and countless fountains of blood oozing out. The times of healing have long passed away."

The open wounds of love make him experience peculiar pains. The wounds could be healed at the initial stages with timely stitches but with the passage of time the wounds have deepened and the possibility of their healing has ceased to exist. How can love last or union realise if the wounds are stitched in time? His open wounds can only be healed in unison with his beloved at appropriate times.

لگی نوک نظر گیا ہوش ہنر رہے درد اندر سد اسول جگر
ڈوڑے ظلم قہر ڈہاں منہ دے بھر ڈکھے روہ ڈو نگر راہ و لڑے دے

"The piercing gaze of the eye has made me loose my sense and sensibility. I am having inward pain and lasting afflictions within me. I fall down with my face on the ground due to torment, cruelty and severity. These are the sufferings of traversing the mountainous paths and intricate ways."

Love is contracted by eye contact. The loss of sense and sensibility is the sure sign of love. It is further confirmed by inward pain and perpetual afflictions. The lover's falling

down with face turned to the ground with torment, cruelty and severity leaves no doubt that love has done its work so perfectly. The sufferings encountered by the lover in traversing the intricate and hazardous path of love are attestations of his following the Straight Path (sirat al mustaqeem). Love straightens. How it could be otherwise?

سٹ بچمل ململ رنگ محل گئے سانگ بدل کوئی ہم نہ کل
رچھ راخس گھل ممیں ڈینیں دل آئے پیش سنبھل سر کلہڑے دے

“Now, cast aside silky and muslin clothing and colourful mansions. The times have changed and there is no one to take care of me. I am the solitary one against flocks of bears, giants, man eaters and witches.”

He discards the comforts of life in course of love. There is no one to take care of him except love. And love takes care by pitching him against flocks of inner and outer demoniac forces. Love is so considerate.

دل ول پیازلف پنل داگل پئے سوزا چھل پئے روگ اٹل
گئے سکھڑے ڈھل گیل خوشیوں ٹل دل چلڑے نیش اجلڑیدے

“My neck has been rounded by each and every tress of my beloved. The passions have leaped and the malaise has crossed the limits. Peace has passed away and the delights have been burnt. The arrows of destiny have pierced my being.”

How could he bear separation after undergoing the experience of his neck being rounded by every tress of his beloved? His unrealised leaping passions throng him with malaise. He loses the moments of peace and happiness, which he spent in the intimate company of his friend. He experiences the piercing of his being by the arrows of destiny that have disunited him from his beloved.

گل کاروں عشق فرید کیتا گھر باروں برہوں بعید کیتا
ہر پل پل شوق جدید کیتا مونہ نور بھرے زلزلے دے

“Farid has left all works and has accepted love as his only vocation. Love has made me distance myself from my household. The witnessing of lighted and a tender face of my beloved has kindled in me the desire of vision at each and every moment.”

His sole vocation is the vocation of love. Love makes him oblivious of everything. All his acts are acts of love. Love becomes the measure of all things. The vision of his beloved's tender and shining face enkindles in him the desire to creatively envision it at every moment. Religiosity has to understand that sermonising hardly prepares a man to leave his entire work and household for God unless he is inspired by the love of God to do so. One may die for God due to psychic necessity but one can only live for God by freedom of love. It is so easy to die for God than to live for Him. Beauty and love act as catalysts in divesting the lover of his 'having' and 'being.' Love goads him into the lap of his beloved.

Kafi-177

بٹھ گھسیانہ راج بانہ واہ بھانے من بھانے اساڈے

ستر دھوئیں کا نہہ کیلے بیشک مانے ترانے اساڈے

“I don't care of Maghiana (the birth place of Heer) and the regal status of my father. I really like the cowsheds made of thatches. This is my pride and honour.”

She rejects her royal birth and abode and takes pride and honour in the thatched cowsheds, instead since they relate to her beloved. Love is essentially commitment with inwardness and the royal outwardness as such loses its meaning. Love gives higher meaning to things.

سنو سہیلیاں سینگیاں سیاں برہوں ڈتیاں ڈکھڑیں ہتھ بیاں

چولہ بوجھن دھیاں دھیاں خون جگر تھئے کھانے اساڈے

“Do listen to me! My same age friends and companion! Love has given my arms in the hands of sufferings. My shirt and head covering have been torn to bits. My vital blood is my food.”

She warns her friends about the sufferings undergone at the hands of love. The ordinary self is peeled into nothingness and blood becomes the food of love.

ہار ہنجوں دا گل وچہ پانوواں سولاں دی نت سیجھ سہانوواں

ماپیو بھاواں مول نہ بھاواں ویری دوست پورانے اساڈے

“I wear the necklace of tears in my neck. I hereby prepare the nuptial bed of afflictions. I am completely unpleasant to my parents and brothers. My old friends have become my adversaries.”

She constantly weeps profusely in the state of separation and disunion. She has no resting place except her laid nuptial

bed of afflictions, which tantamount to sleeping on thorns. She is deprived of the tendering care of her parents and brothers. She immensely suffers to see her old friends becoming her adversaries. Isn't the inner and outer plight of the lover an eye opener for the novices in love, who consider love as a bed of roses?

ضعف بدن وچ سرت نہ تن وچ بھا جگر وچ دود دہن وچ
دلڑی غرق اندوہ محن وچ رور و نین کمانے اساڈے

“My body is fragile and my bodily senses have lost their strength. My self is burning and my mouth is emitting smoke. My heart is drowned in grief and woes. My eyes have lost their lustre by constant crying.”

Her body becomes fragile with waning strength. She burns and heaves sighs (emit smoke). Her heart drowns in grief and woes. Her shine of eyes lose their lustre by continuous weeping in the states of separation and disunion.

تھل مارودی کلڑی والی گیا کچ شہر دا والی
ڈلھ سلھ پتھر وھانے اساڈے ککرے کنڈڑے تول نہالی

“The custodian of the city of Ketch has left me forlorn. Now, the brownish yellow sand of the deadly desert, gravels and thorns are my nuptial quilts and mattresses. The stones, pebbles and bricks are our pillows.”

The transcendence of the beloved leaves the lover forlorn in the deadly desert of her being. The things of comfort become highly vexing.

گانے گہنے سہرے بھل گئے مینگھ پیپل ماکانے بھل گئے
پڑپے یار ایانے اساڈے گھر در جاہ ٹکانے رُل گئے

“Such amateur friends have fallen to my lot that I have forgotten my swing on the ‘peepul’ tree, colourful threads around my wrist (symbolising

marital bond) ornaments, chaplets, flowers, my house and various abodes.”

She remembers the times of her carefree childhood and the colours of her youthfulness, which fell in oblivion since she contracted love with her amateur friend. Isn't it the beauty of love to call ones beloved as amateur?

مفت فریدِ امت چاہم سمجھ سنبھل کر نینہ نہ لایم
ساری پت پر تیت و نجایم تھڑ گئے عقل سیانے اساڈے

“Farid! I have taken upon myself regrets for nothing. I did not contract love with understanding and carefulness. I have lost all my honour and credibility. It has led to the fall of my rationality.”

He becomes regretful of contracting love without resorting to understanding and carefulness. He laments that it has led to the loss of his honour and credibility, while earning him nothing. He thinks that it is the slip of his rational wisdom, which has brought him to such a deplorable plight. The wisdom of love exists beyond rational understanding and so-called watchfulness (tools of rationality). Love is not a dark leap but it is certainly a leap in the dark, which contains within itself thousands of suns and moons that blind the lover by the brilliance of their light. It is in the higher stages of love that he realises that the leap he took was not a leap in the dark but was essentially a leap in the light. Reason abhors the very act of leaping in the dark and rests content in remaining as an outsider. It is deprived of the real treasures of life. It is the law of things that one has to take a leap in the dark in order to find light. Once a person plunges in the ocean of darkness, he finds it an infinite ocean of light and is bewildered to witness darkness consisting of veils of light. The lover takes this leap and eventually finds the beloved as veil itself.

Kafi-178

برہوں پیو سے پگھڑے بے کل دھندڑے چکڑے

“Love has been fallen to my lot. I have become forgetful of all other activities.”

He experiences himself thrown in the situation of love. It is a whole time affair, which engages him wholeheartedly and in wholeness.

پیت پر م دی چاشنی چکھڑیم دوسرے ڈکھڑے سکھڑے

“I have tasted intense love. I have forgotten all sufferings and comforts.”

The one who tastes love goes beyond the pettiness of life.

عشق دی بات نہ سمجھن اصلوں اے ملوانے رکھڑے

“These exoteric clerics essentially do not understand the reality of love.”

The reality of love cannot be understood by the clerics who never taste esoterism and are condemned to remain tied to lifeless exoterism.

ادبئی ربی جب ہو یا شرع مسائل مکڑے

“The Prophet’s saying: “My Lord has taught me and made me aware of secrets” has come to light. It has led to the settlement of all issues of jurisprudence and its principles.”

The Prophet’s allusion to inward knowledge of God makes a person aware of secrets unknown to ordinary people. It leads him to understand that the letter of the law is peripheral in nature. The enlightened person does not raise

the ‘dust of multiplicity’ because he has obtained spiritual knowledge of unity.

ہمہ اوست داسبق گھدوسے فاش تھے کچھ لکڑے

“I have learnt the doctrine of Oneness of Being. All mysteries and secrets have become openly manifest to me.”

The mysteries and secrets of the principle of unity in diversity become openly manifest to a person who learns the traditional lesson of Oneness of Being (wahdat al wujud).

ہیں راہوں نہ پھر سہاں تو نیں سر ھیسیم سو نکڑے

“I shall not turn away from the path till the end even if my head is smashed to bits.”

He is committed to the realised path of gnosis and resolves to remain steadfast even at the cost of his life like Mansur Hallaj who did not relent from his statement: “I am the Truth” and embraced martyrdom at the hands of the clerics. The clerics have remained ignorant of the spiritual dimensions of religion. Their ignorance, at times, has sprung in the form of violence against peace loving Sufis.

محض فرید نہیں کئی حاجت ہیوں ہک نیںہ دے بکھڑے

“Farid! I have absolutely no need of any thing. I am only hungry of love.”

He is only hungry of love and nothing else can satiate his hunger. The whole world with all its bounties has no worth in his eyes since his eyes are fixed on his beloved. Love of God is absolute, wholly and total. It is expression of the whole heart. It leaves no room for anything else. It integrates both inward and the outward.

Kafi-179

بن یار مٹھل میں ویساں مر جیں باجھوں ہک پل کونہ سرے

“I will die without my sweet beloved. I cannot spend a moment without him.”

The transcendence of the sweet beloved is so overbearing for her.

ہوت اکھڑی کیچ گیا سو پیڑا اٹھی لکھ پوریا
پٹی پٹ پٹ ہٹڑی شام سحر پٹی بیت دے ڈسدے بندھ پرے

“My beloved left me alone and went to Ketch. I experienced hundreds of pains and countless fits. I am the crushed one who got tired by mourning day and night. The ways of love seem beyond my reach.”

She undergoes acute pains and sufferings in grappling with the problem of transcendence. She mourns day and night but mourning does not succeed in transforming transcendence of her beloved into immanence. She mourns on that very account. The ways of love are beyond her rational understanding.

مٹھمارو محب ملہیر سے رت روواں سارالوک ہے
تھیساں برڈورانی سٹ گھر در تو نیں یار قبول کرے نہ کرے

“My sweet and enchanting beloved is dwelling in Malheer. I cry intensely and people laugh at me. I will leave my household and become traveller on the road to wilderness. My friend may accept it or not.”

She is aware of the transcendent aspect of her beloved but her knowledge does not help her to remain calm. She cries

wildly giving occasion to people to laugh at her. She chooses to leave her household and go to wilderness whether her friend approves it or not. She does know that her beloved appreciates patience in adversity but this knowledge again, does not benefit her in the painful and suffering state of separation and disunion. The lovers of God, who attain gnosis through love, know how difficult it is to exercise patience in adversity of love. Love opens up certain vital dimensions of gnosis, which remain opaque even to the ordinary gnostics.

کٹھی ناز نگاہ اوڑے دی مٹھی لذت عشق بکھیرے وی
مومیں جیندیں تادم روز حشر اللہ دل توں مول نہیں و سرے

“I am a victim of the prideful and elegant gaze of the peculiar one. I am miserably subject to incongruities by virtue of tasting love. I pray to Allah that my heart never becomes oblivious of my beloved till the Day of Resurrection, while living or dying.”

He is captivated by the beautiful expressions of his beloved. The taste of love eventually makes him miserable in facing its incongruities but it does not let him detest it. Rather, he beseeches Divine Grace to succour his heart so that he does not get oblivious of his beloved even for a moment in this world or in the life hereafter. Divine love is absolute and all-embracing. It unfolds various dimensions of the temporal and the eternal by integrating time and eternity.

واہ دلبر بڑی یاری ہے لگی پھکڑی شہر خواری ہے
دل سڑدی جلدے جان جگر سر ٹوٹے پرزے سہنس ذرے

“My beloved! I laud your friendship. I got ill-repute and notoriety. My heart is burning and my embodied self is being grilled. My head has been smashed into parts, pieces and bits.”

He questions the nature of his beloved's friendship, which has ravished his social and individual self. Doesn't the beloved's sincere friendship consist in such ravishing?

شالا تھیوم وصل داسانگ کڈیں مٹے لڑوی دل دی تانگ کڈیں
ٹلے سخت پہر کرے بخت و ہر سوہنا صحن سنجی دے پیر دھرے

"I pray that I may succeed in uniting with my beloved some day. The longing of my looted heart may find its fulfilment. My hard times may end and good fortunes may start smiling on me in multitudes. My handsome beloved may step in the courtyard of the damned one."

The beauty of love is that its flame does not die down even in the most adverse circumstances. He remains enkindled with hope, which does not let him fall in the pit of despair. He prays for self-fulfilment of his ravished heart and the ushering of good fortunes displacing misfortunes leading to the ultimate union with his beloved.

آانگن فرید دے یار مٹھل ساری عمر گئی جو کھ جو کھ دیں گل
کر لطف مہر بٹھ ظلم قہر دل ڈکھڑی ٹھڈڑے ساہ بھرے

"My sweet beloved! Do step in the courtyard of Farid. My whole life has been worn out by rotting in suffering. Be kind and merciful to me by eschewing severe cruelty. My suffering heart heaves cold sighs."

He beseeches his beloved to unveil himself in the infinite depths of his being. He communicates to him the sufferings he has undergone in life in the state of separation and disunion and the present deplorable state of his suffering heart. He implores his beloved to shun cruelty and harshness and be kind and merciful, instead. The shades of the human and the Divine, true in their own right, come into conflict with each other. The partial knowledge of the lover as against the absolute knowledge of the Divine causes a clash of perspectives. The sincerity of the lover in accusing his beloved of cruelty and harshness cannot be called in question.

His rightness consists in expressing the perspective of his love in a truthful, frank and candid way. The perspective of the beloved, on the other hand, is universal and what is understood as cruelty and harshness by the lover is, in fact, kindness and mercy. Is it cruelty and harshness to let love ripen into ultimate fruition? Isn't it kindness and mercy not to make Divine intervention at such a premature stage that could cease the lover's possibility of union with his beloved? Love is so great a mystery.

Kafi-180

بھان وسایا یار چہیندے بیٹ سہایامان مہیندے

“My beloved friend has enlivened the cow-shed. The grand shepherd of the herd has made the area on the side of the river so attractive.”

She is happy to experience the immanence of her beloved. She is attracted by the purity of the waters of life.

اصلوں مول نہ ویساں روہی کانہہ کھیلے دلڑی موہی
رانجھن دی سرچھیاں ڈوہی تن من ملک تہیندے

“I will not go to the desert at all. The riverine reeds have captivated my heart. I will become a maidservant to Ranjhan and milk his cows. My body and soul belong to him.”

She resolves to forsake wilderness and dwell with her beloved in the ambience of love. She chooses to subject herself completely to the demands of her beloved's immanence.

گائیں ویچ تے منجھیاں لیاں نیں چندن تے جھوک بنیاں
بیلا بلی نال سوہیاں جیر ہاچاک سڈیندے

“I will sell my cows and buy buffaloes. I will make my dwellings on the Chandan stream. I will thrive in the riparian shrubbery with my beloved. He is known as Chak.”

The selling of cows and buying of buffaloes symbolises her attempt to realise the higher possibilities of her existence. She resolves to dwell on the stream of love in the riparian

shrubby (fertility of love) with her beloved, who is the shepherd of her heart.

ماراں ڈھالے پاواں فالان ساری عمر بے سنگ جالاں
رنگ پور ساڑاں ساڑاں پچالاں بٹھ کھڑے موئے جیندے

“I resort to different omens. I want to spend my whole life with you. I want to burn Rangpur and reduce it to ashes. I have no concern with the life and death of ‘Kheras’.”

She resorts to omens to know the possibilities of meeting with her beloved on the spectrum of spatio-temporal order. She wants to spend her entire life with him without any jerks or breaks. Heer demonstrates the will to burn and reduce to ashes the city of Rangpur where she was forcibly married and taken to the city of her in-laws. She attains such great heights of love that she discards any concern about the fate of her adversaries. Isn't it the height of detachment to become unconcerned even about one's adversaries?

جاں جاں کنڑیں رنگ سنیدی جنڈی صدقے گھولے تھیندی
پاہنباہ تے دھوڑ مہیں دی ڈسدے نور اکھیں دے

“I hear the voice of the herd. I sacrifice my life to it. The dung of the herd and its dust is the light of my eyes.”

She is committed to the unveiling of her beloved in forms of sound and light. The Reality may will to manifest itself in any small, lowly and unclean medium. Religiosity considers it blasphemous and thus despises such mediums. It fails to realise that the mediums do not affect the Reality. The Reality keeps its transcendence intact, in spite of simultaneously manifesting itself in various mediums. It is by virtue of the simultaneity of immanence and transcendence that the whole cosmos is “He/not He.” Aren't all things attached to the Absolute?

ہر دم یار دے نام سڈیواں شالانہ بے واہی تھیواں
 باجھ ٪ی دے باجھ نہ جیواں بیا کوئی کون کہیندے

“I want always to be identified with the name of my friend. I pray that I never remain without your support. I do not want to live without you. There is no one who cares for others.”

She merges her identity in the identity of her beloved. The identity of the individual self plunges in the identity of mutual selfhood. She prays for Divine Grace in affecting the support of her beloved (identity). She yearns for the supreme identity and has no desire of self-identity. There is no one except her beloved, who can affect this identity.

ہیر سلیٹی چوچک بیٹی ناز بیٹی میک لپیٹی
 آ تقدیروں چاک چکیٹی ہن ڈیکھو کیا تھیندے

“Heer! The daughter of Choochak has been nurtured with great pride and her fragrance is spread all around. She has been destined to fall in love with the shepherd of the herd. Now, let’s see what happens.”

Heer, born in royal mansions, having prideful nurturing, and spreading fragrance of her beauty became an instrument in the hands of Providence to fall in love with Ranjha, appointed by her father to shepherd his herd. The love story of Heer and Ranjha met such a tragic end. Isn’t it better to die in love than to live without it?

چاکی اڑے چاک چکائے و سر یا ماہیو ماہیو جائے
 مامے چاچے تے ہمسائے ان سو نہیں نظر بندے

“The shepherd has inflicted fresh wounds. It has led to the obliviousness of my parents, brothers and sisters, my maternal and paternal uncles and my neighbours. Now, they seem to me as strangers.”

The wounds of love inflicted by the beloved are ever fresh. They lead to the obliviousness of her primary and secondary ties. The intimate ones seem outsiders.

جھنگ سیالیں پھیرا پیا پار چنا ہوں رانجھن آیا
کینویں چھپ چھپیں دے ہیرے نوں جڑ جادو لایا

“My Ranjhan came from the other side of the Chenab River. He came to meet the Sial of Jhang. He completely bewitched Heer. How can a secret remain hidden?”

The transcendent beloved assumed immanence to make love possible. Heer became totally bewitched by the might of love. The love story of Heer and Ranjha, among other things, demonstrates the indubitable fact that the secret of love cannot remain hidden. The fragrance of love spreads far and wide. The ordinary consciousness develops antagonistic contradictions with love consciousness and the first thing it does is it to denounce it publicly. The ignorant ones ravish the gnostic lovers in public interest. Doesn't the multitude worship idol of the public?

گھڑے وکڑی ٹوبھے تاڈے سب و سرائے نیڑے تاڈے
آوس سانول کو لے ساڈے بٹھ گھت دروہ دیں دے

“Your love has made me forget arduous passes, water- storing fields, ponds and transitory dwellings of the desert. My beloved! Come and dwell with me. Remove dubiousness from your heart.”

He recounts the peeling of his self for the sake of his beloved. He hurls accusations of dubiousness (of love) against his beloved and beseeches for union with him. The human cannot understand the infinite ways of the Divine. It interprets Divine behaviour from the human standards. The rightness of each, absolute in its own right, comes in conflict with the other. The dynamics of love inspire different shades

of rightness to clash with each other. The clash of perspectives ripens love. How great!

موسم مست ڈھاڑے بھلڑے ڈاگاں ملڑے ساوے تلڑے
بھاگ سہاگ فرید سولڑے اکھتیاں نال ڈسیندے

“Farid! It is an enchanting season and the days are good. The herd has nearby found green pastures. My nuptial happiness is so near that I can see it with my eyes.”

The process of Self-Realisation makes him traverse different stages in the path of love. The moments of union cast their happiness before. The herd feeding on nearby green pastures symbolises his sentiments, in process of realising love in inwardness. He witnesses the ushering of good fortune in the imminent act of union.

Kafi-181

بے صورت صورت اولے کرنازا دا گھنڈ کھولے

“The formless is hidden in the form. He unveils himself in the pride and style.”

The transcendent formless Reality assumes prideful and stylish immanent forms. It is hidden beneath forms and unveils itself from within. There is essential continuity between the formless and its manifested forms.

ہر ہر جاوچ را نجن مای آیاناں صفات کماہی
سب سرانہد مرلی واہی رمز حقائق چولے

“My beloved Ranjhan is omnipresent. He has truly manifested himself in attributes. He plays all tunes on the divine flute. He touches the chords of realities.”

He witnesses the omnipresence of the beloved as a metaphysical truth. Metaphysical understanding of the Essence and the Divine demonstrates the manifestation of the Essence in Attributes. The Essence manifests itself in immanent forms, while keeping its transcendence intact. There can be no form without the formless. The formless is veiled in every form. He plays tunes on the divine flute, touching the chords of realities, and thereby the reality of things becomes manifest.

و فی افسکم بھیت بتاوے نحن اقرب بین بجاوے
لو دلیتم گیت سناوے لفظ انا الحق بولے

“ ‘I am within your selves’ is the secret that he discloses. ‘I am nearer to man than his neck vein’ is

his harping tune. He sings the song of his omnipresence. 'I am the Truth' is his uttering."

The Reality or God discloses the secret of His dwelling within human selves. He is nearer to man than his jugular vein. He sings the song of his presence in every nook and corner. He says: I am the Truth through human tongue (as in case of Mansur Hallaj). The Reality discloses the secrets of its dwelling, nearness, omnipresence and utterances to the gnostics. The gnostic's peeling of his last layer of self finds nothing but the Reality itself. He realises the metaphysical truth that the Reality is more near to man than man is to his own self. The Reality is nearer to him than nearness itself. He understands that the metaphysical concept of nearness simply means the transcendence and immanence of the Reality in simultaneity. He witnesses the omnipresence of the Reality at every place and moment. He understands that the Reality in its attribute of Speech, utters: I am the Truth. The ignorant ones do not understand the metaphysical truths for they are bereft of knowledge.

جو کوئی دل ڈوں دھیان رھیبی سارے لچھڑے رازنوں پیسی
اشنیت کل اٹھ ویسی بھج پوسن سبھ بھولے

"The one, who concentrates on his heart, shall unravel the deep secret (of unity or oneness) in entirety. All the duality (multiplicity) will wither away. All doubts will be removed."

Heart houses the Reality itself. The one who fully concentrates on his heart shall unravel the deep secret of Oneness. He will attain metaphysical realisation of the principle of unity in multiplicity, unity in diversity or one and many. He will realise that the very concept of duality is based on sensuous and rational misgivings for there is no thing in the self of man or in the cosmos, which is independent or autonomous. The absolute certitude of his gnostic experience will make the illusory separateness of existence vanish like a mirage.

ہک جاہن احکام شریعت ہک جاہن اسرار طریقت
تھیوے کیا درفت حقیقت کون اے پھولے پھولے

“Now, at one level are the obligations of the Shariah and at the other level are the mysteries of the Way. Who could discover the Reality? Who would unravel these intricacies?”

There are different levels of understanding the Reality, generally considered as four namely, Shariah, Tariqah, Haqiqah and Marifah. The first three levels have their own respective dynamics to unravel the intricacies of the Reality but it is only marifah (gnosis) or metaphysical realisation, which successfully unravels the Reality in fullness. It realises the identity of knowledge and being and leads to the attainment of “the Supreme Identity.”

نہ رل ڈکھڑی روہ جبل وچ نہ تھی اوکھی مارو تھل وچ
پہلو دوش کنار بغل وچ یار پنل ہے کو لے

“Do not be wretched in the mountainous way. Don’t face arduousness of the deadly desert. Punna friend is in proximity with you (nearer to you than you are to yourself).”

The arduous attempts to find the Reality in the outward do not succeed, in spite of all efforts, for the beloved is found in the inward. He is not found as object but as Subject. Love and gnosis demonstrates the dwelling of the beloved in the inmost chambers of one’s heart.

فخر جہاں ہک ریت سکھائی اصلوں حاجت رہی نہ کائی
دل جڑ جڑ دھم دھام مچائی تھئے گن گیان سمو لے

“Fakhr Jehan has taught me a tradition. It has essentially made me free from every need. My heart has integrated virtuousness and knowledge (by dint of inspiration).”

The doctrinal knowledge of the Reality (beloved) residing within the infinite depths of one's being bears no fruit unless it is transformed as realised knowledge at the hands of one's spiritual master. The realised lesson of metaphysical realisation taught by his spiritual master leaves no room for any other teaching. The integrated or pure heart attains gnosis.

رنگ پور دے ہن پنتھ نیارے ہک نوں بوڑے ہک نوں تارے
ہک پیا جیتے ہک پیا ہارے تھلے ماسے تولے

“The ways of the colourful are unique. They let some ferry across the waters and let the others drown. One wins while the other loses. Here, ‘masha’ (weight equivalent to 16 grains) and ‘tola’ (12 ‘masha’ weights) are measured.”

The ways of the Divine are manifest in unique colours or modes. But they are not arbitrary, whimsical or capricious. A lover wins the game of love, while the other loses it. It is all in consonance with the Divine scheme of things by the Almighty Wise. Any big or meagre effort of the lover is measured on the scale of love. Who knows what?

فاش فرید اے وعظ سنا توں عالم جاہل شاہ گدا کوں
جے کوئی چاہے فقر فنا کوں اپنے آپ کوں گولے

“Farid! Openly narrate this spiritual discourse to the knowledgeable, ignorant, king and beggar that any one who wishes to attain the consciousness of his ontological nothingness and annihilation should search within himself.”

He reiterates the ‘Primordial Truth’ current in all the great metaphysical and religious traditions of the world that any one desirous of attaining consciousness of his ontological nothingness and annihilation should delve in the inmost chambers of his heart. He will find God in finding himself. Isn't finding one self and finding God identical?

Kafi-182

پٹی پیت دے پندھ پریرے برے برہوندے باربریرے

“The path of love is quite distant. The loads of dreadful love are very heavy.”

The path of love is so transcendent. The onerous burden of transcendent love is overbearing.

جانے مول نہ جانے بھانے یار دے من نوں بھانے
گانے گہنے میوے کھانے دسرے تول وہانے
راج بھانے حسن دے مانے گذرے بھاگ بھلیرے

My friend cares for me on not but his cowsheds are close to my heart. The colourful threads around my wrist (symbolising marital bond) ornaments, jewellery, delicious foods, a nuptial quilt and mattresses have all fallen in oblivion. The good days of regal status in my parental home and the vanity of my beauty have all gone away.”

She rests content only with the ways of her beloved in obliviousness of many things including her marital bond and regal status. She has to accept the fact that the times of good fortunes have passed away.

ٹول خوشی دے رول ڈتے وہ سولائ لائی کانی
ڈھول نہ نیتم کول مٹھی گیا جو بن جوش جوانی
بار سنگار نہ کھڑ مکلا یا ترڑے پھلوں سہرے

“The afflictions shot such arrows that it wrecked all situations of my happiness. I am so miserable that my beloved did not take me along leading to the withering away of my bloom, animation and youth.

My makeup did not wait to bid me a farewell. The flowers of my chaplet have been broken into pieces.”

She loses all happiness in the state of affliction. She feels miserable in finding her lively youth deadened without affecting union. The possibility of uniting with her beloved seems so remote.

نالے بادشمالے	بادل کالے پورب والے
موسم روپ ڈکھالے	بارش نالے وقت سکھالے
یار نہیں ہے ویڑھے	سوز اکالے پون ابالے

“The black clouds from the east along with the eastern wind, rain and the times of comforts manifest the weather in its lovely forms. My passion is burning and is grilling me from within. My friend is not in my courtyard.”

The ambience of love heightens her insatiable quest of union with her beloved. The sentiment of flowering love within her being becomes unbearable without fruition. The stage is all set but how could the drama of love unfold without the beloved. The absence of the beloved is felt more in such situations of life.

ٹوبھے تار متاراں	چیتر بہاراں لھیتر ہزاراں
کنزیں پون تواراں	گل گلزاراں لکھ لہکاراں
دوست نہ وسدانیڑے	جو ہپڑ ساڈاں جھوک اجاڈاں

“It is the season of spring and the melons are in plenty. The ponds are full of water. There are flowers and orchards all around. The long tune songs of the shepherds are reaching my ears. I like to burn my hut and leave my dwellings since my friend is not nearby.”

She encounters the visual and audible signs of her beloved in the outward and the inward but they do not offer her any solace since her beloved remains veiled (transcendent).

تائنگھاں یار دیاں سانگاں کتڑیں برہوں سنایاں بانگاں
 کجڑے وال تے اجڑیاں مانگھاں لکھدی ہجر دیاں کانگاں
 کر دی چانگاں سمجھن نہ ٹانگاں نکھ دے بُڈ گئے بیڑے

“The spears of longing of my friend have pierced me. The calls of love have reached my ears. My hair is dirty and my lines of head have become dusty. I am lettering a long tale of my disunion. I try my utmost but I can't find a way out. The rafts of my peace have sunk.”

She longs for her friend so intensely that her embodied self becomes ravished thereby. She tries to find out a way out from the labyrinth of disunion but does not succeed. She finds peace nowhere. How could she find peace except in unison with her beloved?

راہ جبل دے مارو تھل دے سانگ کسانگ اجل دے
 آون یاد پیل دے رلڑے پور پون پیل دے
 ڈکھڑے ولول پکھڑے ڈھل دے درد اندوہ گھنیر دے

“The mountainous ways and the passages of deadly deserts, whether good or bad are my destined ways. I recall the moments of togetherness with my beloved and constantly undergo fits. My destined lot perpetually sends me sufferings and heightened pains and grief.”

She accepts the fact of her being thrown in hazardous love. The passed moments of joyfulness in togetherness with her beloved, give rise to proportionate suffering, pain and grief during the passing moments of disunion, nay more. A lover who has experienced ecstasy with her beloved suffers deeply in separation than an ordinary lover. A king who is reduced to a beggar obviously suffers intensely than an ordinary beggar.

وئیس وئیس دئیس چھڑیاں	جو گن تھی گزریاں
خاک رمیاں دھونی لیاں	نازک نینہ نہجیاں
شرم لڑھکیاں بھرم بڑیاں	کیجو کھلسن کھیرے

“I will change my attire and leave my native city and lead my life by becoming a Yogi. I will rub dust on my body and burn incense and remain true to my tender love. I will leave my honour and do away with my prestige. I won't care if 'Kheras' laugh at me.”

She is ready to abandon the comforts of her ordinary self and choose the hard path of renunciation. It is renouncing her prestige and honour for the sake of remaining true to her tender love. She ceases to care for the scorns of her adversaries. Isn't it one of the greatest blessings of love that it makes the lover keep a respectable distance from things and events, by renouncing the ordinary for the sake of the extraordinary?

نوک غماندی چوک دکھا دی	دم دم دل درماندی
رات ڈینہاں تڑپھاندی	کٹھڑی مہنیں سٹھنیں کھاندی
سیجھ نہ بھاندی پی گر لاندی	مٹھڑی عشق اوڑے

“The spear of sorrows and the prick of sufferings make my heart dejected at each and every moment. I am the crushed one who is restless day and night by facing rebukes and satires. The nuptial bed does not please me and I keep groaning. The peculiar love has made me so miserable.”

The sign of peculiar love is that it makes her so miserable and restless at the hands of her inner and outer circumstances that she constantly undergoes sufferings, sorrows, dejections, rebukes, satires and groans that lead to the effacement of her self. Doesn't the dying of habitual self give birth to the non-habitual one for the sake of union?

دلڑی حرمل اکھیاں بل بل
پیریں چھل چھل چھالے
نرمل درد اندر دے درمل
ڈٹڑے روگ کشالے
جلبل تے ہتھ ملل کوکال
زخم پئے وچ زیرے

“My heart is burning like wild rue (noise produced by the burning of a seed) and my eyes are itching by crying. My feet are full with oozing boils. The creeping pains have fully settled within me. They have inflicted malaises and adversities on me. I am burning and calling by rubbing my hands. Now, my inner wounds have become a sore.”

The sufferings undergone by her, at the hands of her beloved, are not psychic, which engage a person partially but are spiritual that engage her wholly. They ravish her embodied self and can be likened to an innocent person being skinned alive, nay more terrible. The grip of love increasingly tightens her amidst her hues and cries. Love has entry point. It has no exit. How wonderful!

لالی لوے تے کانگا بولے
تھیواں اولے گھولے
مرغ ممولے کرن چبولے
نہ ڈے راول روولے
سارے سون شگون سمولے
وڑویڑھے بٹھ جھیرے

“I am sold out after listening to the local bird’s singing and the crowing of the crow (for they are the omens of your coming). The fowl and a wag tail (birds) are gambolling. My beloved! Do not make me wretched. All rites and omens have been combined to augur your presence. Enter my courtyard and cast away brawls.”

The sentiments of love, symbolised by the language of the birds, intensify inwardness. She considers them as rites and omens auguring the presence of her beloved. She beseeches her beloved to unveil himself by casting away brawls. Aren’t brawls necessary milestones in the path of love?

کیا دوری مہجوری اوڑک
پوری نیساں سک سانول دی
ونجناں جھوک ضروری
پوری جھوری خاک پٹی دی
ہم ایمان دی موڑی
کرسم کچھ وھیرے

“What are these distances and separations? I have necessarily to go to my dwellings. I will remain faithful to the longing of my beloved. It is the real treasure of my commitment. I will reach Ketch in a mud-covered state and face people’s ridicule.”

She resolves to dwell within her being without caring for the veils of distance and separation. She resolves to remain faithful in the longing of her beloved since it is the real treasure of her commitment to love. She ultimately longs to ‘reside in her transpersonal being’ in spite of facing all odds in the path of love.

اگ لائی بھڑکائی رنگت
دیدیاں کرن لڑائی
چشماں چوٹ چلائی
رمزماں جڑ کر چاٹ چکھائی
بے واہی دے نال اجائی
غمزے رکھن بکھیرے

“The colourful face of my beloved has kindled a great fire of love within me. His eyes have knocked me. His visions are in a war like state with striking expressions. I am without support against enticements, which fan incongruities.”

Beauty ignites love. It intensifies the fire of love by its bewitching expressions. Static beauty cannot create the dynamism of love. It is exciting beauty, which creates vibrant love. Love becomes defenceless at the hands of beauty. How could love prosper without being defenceless?

اللہ راسی مانا ماسی
طرح اوداسی سخت پیاسی
شہر بھنبھور دی واسی
کھوساں پھاسی تھی بے آسی
بدن بھنبھوت سناسی
پل پل موت کھیرے

“I am powerless without my mother and aunt. I am the inhabitant of the city of Bhambore. I am wandering in sadness and I am feeling very thirsty. I am an ascetic with my body covered with dust. I will tie the noose around my neck and die in the state of despair. Death is challenging me at each and every moment.”

She finds herself powerless without her inward ties. She is trying to find her transcendent beloved, while dwelling in immanence. She is saddened not to find him. Her eyes are very thirsty of his vision. She is becoming lowly in order to find the higher one. She envisages the possibility of death, which shall end her despairing life. Doesn't her deplorable plight take her to the threshold of her beloved?

ڈوڑے ڈکھ ڈوپیلے	جنگل بیلے شینہ مریلے
نبھ گئے ہسن کھلن دے ویلے	کپڑے میلے کچیلے
آوس ہوت اڑیرے	ویلے میلے کرالیلے

“There are forests, riparian shrubbery, fierce lions and multiple sombre sufferings. My dress is shabby. The days of my playfulness have gone away. My beloved! Hasten to meet me. My dear Baloch! Do come and dwell near me.”

She faces arduousness, dangers and sombre sufferings in the path of love. Her appearance is at the stage of disappearance. The times of romance in love have whisked away. She entreats her beloved to instantly unveil himself within the infinite depths of her consciousness and remain unveiled everlastingly. Doesn't this beseeching manifest her innocence pinned against the power of her beloved?

اوکھے وصل دے سانگھے	پندھ اڑانگے دلڑی تانگھے
چولا بوچھن گھانگھے	ملن مہانگے کو جھے لانگے
ناکھارے نہ چھیڑے	جوہ جتن وے ڈسم نہ چانگے

“The stations of the way are intricate and my heart is longing. The chances of meeting my beloved are so remote. It is so difficult to meet for the ways are hideous. My shirt and head covering have been torn to bits. I cannot see any signs of dwellings or herds. The treading paths of the animals or flocks of the grazing buffaloes are not visible.”

She gets lost in the way of love. She finds her ordinary self ruptured. She sees a contradiction between her longing and the attainment of union with her beloved through the intricate, hideous and sign less path of love. All are the signs of immanence. There are no signs of transcendence. Isn't love a dangerous game of transcendence and immanence?

نیراں نیر و ہیراں	تیر جگ روچ پیڑ اند روچ
دل د لگیر لویراں	پیر مناواں دہیر نپاواں
پے تقدیر نکھیرے	مارو چھوڑ ملہیر سدھایا

“I am having inward pain by the shot of an arrow. The tears are flowing from my eyes. I make vows in the name of the saints. I do not find any solace. My aggrieved heart is in pieces. My ravisher deserted me and went to Malheer. Destiny has parted us.”

She undergoes pains and sufferings. She vows in the name of saints as a prelude to finding her beloved but does not succeed and thereby she does not find any solace. Her grief becomes so heart-breaking. She feels herself to be deserted by her beloved who has assumed the form of transcendence. Destiny plays the game of love with rules of transcendence and immanence.

وٹیاں پٹیاں پٹیاں	سٹیاں مٹیاں بٹھیاں کٹیاں
بٹیاں سکھ دیاں رتیاں	گھٹیاں خوشیاں پاڑوں پٹیاں
لٹیاں ناز نویرے	مٹھیاں تیغ برہوں دیاں کٹھیاں

“I have thrown away the earthly jars of milk and have left caring the calves. I have instead exchanged the long ways of love. My happiness has decreased and has been uprooted. The traditions of peace have passed away. I am the miserable one who has been slaughtered by the sword of love. I have been looted by youthful pride.”

She discards her everydayness of existence and chooses the hardest path of love. (She wants direct vision of her beloved without any intermediary or medium). Happiness does not merely decrease but is subsequently uprooted while traversing the way of love. The modes of peace pass away. She finds herself in a miserable state in being slaughtered by the sword of love in the prime of her youth. Real love is real suffering.

در دجید مزید ہمیشہ	ریت پریت سوائی
پیت پر م دے گیت سکھایم	نیت اسماں سرچائی
عید فرید بعید سینوسے	غم کیتے دل دیرے

“Farid! My instant pain is permanent and is on the increase. The tradition of love is deepening. It is my commitment of love that makes me sing the songs of adoration. I have heard that the days of Eid are far away. Sorrows have taken an abode in my heart.”

He finds the perpetual re-creation of pain as permanent. It leads to the deepening of love in his bones and flesh. No pain, no love. The commitment of love inspires songs of adoration. He is conscious of the fact that he has to bear sorrows of separation and disunion for quite some time for he has heard that it takes ample time to affect union with one's beloved.

Kafi-183

پر دہی یار او پورب دی گھلے

“My friend of alien lands! The eastern wind has started blowing.”

His friend of alien land symbolises transcendence of his beloved. The blowing of eastern wind is a symbol of transcendence turning into immanence.

سہانوں مینہ برسات دی واری پھوگ پھلی کھپ بھلے

“The rainy season has set in. The desert plants have started flowering.”

The times of inward blessings of unveiling have set in. The sentiments of love have started to flower. The desert of his barren self has started turning into orchard.

گا جاں لجن بجلیاں لکھن ذوقوں دلڑی چلے

“There are flashes of lightning and thundering of clouds. My heart by virtue of this tasting is in ecstasy.”

His heart experiences flashes of illumination and celestial music that makes it ecstatic.

دھامن کترن سنھتے سہجوں چتر سہاگ دا جھلے

“The heads of the desert plants are fondly waiving with happiness.”

The sentiments of love, by virtue of inner urge, are sprouting with happiness.

جے تیں پانی پلہر نہ لھٹسی کون بھلا سندھ مچلے

“Well, who will go to Sindh unless the rainwater gathered in the low lying areas gets dried.”

He does not want to experience the ‘dark night of the soul’. He wants to remain recipient of the blessings of union.

روز بروز فرید ہے لذت طبع ڈینہو ڈینہہ کھلے

“Farid! My taste is increasing day by day. I am experiencing expansion within myself.”

He enjoys the ever increasing flavour of love. He experiences expansion within his self. The degree of transformation of the self into the Self corresponds to the degree of expansion. It speaks of the dynamism of the self leading to the beautiful integration of permanence and change.

Kafi-184

اے دل دیوانی موہی پروحشت سنجڑی روہی

“My heart has been spiritlessly frantic in the dreadful
and desolate desert.”

Her heart is spiritlessly frantic in the dreadful and desolate
desert of her self.

واہ داروں درد دلاں دا واہ یار پنل من بھاندا
چم چاتم پڑی ڈوہی ہاں بردا پڑے ناں دا

“I laud you my friend Punnal for you are so appealing
to me. I laud you also because you are the balm of my
heart pain. I have been sold in your name. I have
willingly accepted the blame of your love.”

She lauds her beloved for being so appealing to her and
being remedial measure of her heart pain. She totally and
wholeheartedly subjects herself freely to her beloved and
willingly accepts the blame of love. Freedom is the ascending
spirit of love. Love deepens freedom. There can be no love
without freedom. Pure love is pure freedom. Romance is
psychic and oppressive but love is always spiritual and free.
Love is not mechanical. It is highly creative.

وچ آکھیں قاصد بھلڑا ہے سانوں سخت سولڑا
مل یار تھلاں وچ کلہڑا ہئی قسم خدا دی دروہی

“O good messenger! Go and deliver my message. The
rainy season is so near. Do meet me alone in the
desert. It's a vow of God on you.”

She sends message to her beloved for unveiling himself within her barren self since the nuptial times are so nigh by the binding Grace of God.

تھی راہی بر ڈوں جلاں دل راہوں مول نہ ولساں
ونج ساتھ پریں دے رلساں وچ روہی کر سوں پوہی

“I will become a traveller of desolate places. I shall never return. I will go and join the company of my friend. I will spend my life in the desert.”

She resolves to look within and never resort to rational mode of consciousness. She will unite with her beloved and achieve mutual selfhood.

بٹھ توں بن چیتز بہاراں سر سول آون کرواراں
دل ڈکھڑے درد ہزاراں اندوہ کرن انبوہی

“What will I do in the spring season without you? The afflictions are striking my head. My heart is suffering with countless pains. Grief has gathered all around.”

She has nothing to do in the spring season since her friend is not there. She suffers afflictions, pains and grief in his absence. How could deadness turn into liveliness without one's beloved?

کیا زیور ہار چنبیلی کیا پھلوں سیجھ سہیلی
تھیا عشق فرید آبیلی سبھ بھل گئے ابھی اوہی

“What to talk of my jewellery, necklace and champak necklace. What to talk of my nuptial bed covered with lovely flowers. Farid! I have become forgetful of all these ever since love became my companion.”

The company of love makes him lose meaning of his ornamentations and nuptial belongings. He transcends these realities and reaches the realm of supernal consciousness, which finds everything worthless except love.

Kafi-185

گیل پل سول سوا یا ہے جی مفت ڈکھاں وچ آیا ہے

“My afflictions are increasing at each and every moment. My being has been engulfed in sufferings for nothing.”

The increasing inflictions make her feel that her being has been engulfed in the sufferings of love for nothing. The axis of her whole life is vision or union of her beloved, which can only satiate her hunger of love. She considers her suffering as of no account if it fails to make her achieve her object of love. Her rightness in the situation of separation and disunion cannot be challenged. Although, it is relative to his situation yet, in a certain sense, it is also absolute. Love manifests the simultaneity of the relative and the absolute. Also, the reality of her suffering at the level of the relative cannot be brushed aside from the viewpoint of the absolute. The relative has its own legitimate sense of absoluteness.

دور گیا منظور دلیں دا تن من دھن ہے مال جہیندا
شالا ڈھولن مل چہیندا درواں سخت ستایا ہے

“The cherisher of my heart has gone far away. My body, soul and wealth are his dominion. I pray to God that I unite with my beloved friend. The pains have highly vexed me.”

She experiences vexing pains to find her beloved withdrawing in the realm of transcendence after cultivating love in immanence. She recounts surrendering her body, soul and wealth for him. She prays for uniting with her beloved by the Grace of God.

دشت بیاباں جال اساڈی سوز اندوہ دی چال اساڈی
ما تم حال تے قال اساڈی عشق بہوں ڈکھ لایا ہے

“I am leading my life in wilderness. My gait is of passion and grief. My state and discourse are the state of mourning. Love has given me great sufferings.”

She finds herself stranded in wilderness in the state of separation and disunion from her beloved. Her suffering knows no bounds.

چاک کیتے دل چاک مہیں دے کون کلڑے زخم کوں سیندے
مرہم وصل وصال تہیں دے کھیڑا کوڑا جایا ہے

“The shepherd of the herd has broken my heart in pieces. Who will stitch my unintelligible wounds? It requires balm of unity with my friend? The ‘Khera’ is false and useless.”

The unintelligible wounds of love can only be stitched by the beloved who inflicts them in the very first instance. The healing of wounds requires the balm of unity. The adversaries of love being false (privations) and useless (of no ultimate consequence), do not figure in over here. Doesn’t the doctor (beloved) administer the medicine of unity to his patient (lover) without their being any one (adversary) in between?

رانجھن جوگی میں جگیا نی بے زراوس دے راہ وکانی
مٹھڑی ماری پھراں نمائی نام نشان گنویا ہے

“Ranjhan is my Yogi and I am completely subjected to him. I have been freely sold out to him. I am ravished by miseries and condemned to roam bereft of vanity. I have lost my identity.”

She is completely subjected to her beloved in whose name she has been sold free of cost. She is ravished by miseries in the state of lowliness. She loses her identity. Isn’t the loss of

one's identity imperative for attaining "the Supreme Identity"?

برہوں النبی جڑ کر لائی سڑ دیں بلدیں پھر اس لُکائی
لوک کیا جانے پیڑ پرائی جو لکھیا سو پایا ہے

"Love has set me aflame with great perfection. I am burning all alone. How can people understand the excruciating pain of others? I got what was written in my destiny."

Love sets her aflame with great perfection and makes her bear the burns within her own self. No one can share the pain of others. Isn't it the uniqueness of a self that no other self can share its pain? She is an innocent instrument in the hands of love, destined to play the cosmic game of love.

اُگیا رانجھن سردا والی کیٹس حال کنوں بے حالی
ساڑاں سیجھتے تول نہالی سب کچھ ہجر بھلایا ہے

"The custodian of my being Ranjhan left me forlorn. He has led me to a deplorable state. I burn my nuptial quilt and mattress. Disunion has made me oblivious of everything."

The beloved leaves her stranded and becomes transcendent, in spite of being her custodian. She is led to a deplorable state, where she casts away things signifying nuptial happiness. She becomes oblivious of everything. Isn't the remembrance of the beloved the forgetfulness of everything?

دل نوں لُٹیا عشق مریلے پھری دی شہر تے جنگل میلے
متاں فرید کرے رب میلے تانگھ آرام و نجایا ہے

"Farid! My ravishing love has looted my heart. I am wandering in cities, forests and riparian shrubbery with the hope that the Sustainer unites me with my

beloved. My longing has been instrumental in the loss of my comfort.”

The ravishing love loots his heart and he wanders in wilderness with the hope that the Sustainer unites him with his beloved. The longing of the beloved banishes him from his comfort zone. Isn't it the graciousness of love to snatch comforts from his hands and ultimately invest him with peace, instead?

Kafi-186

پرانی پیڑ پئی گل دی نہ گدی دال در مل دی

“The primordial pain has fallen to my lot. There is no way out of it.”

The pain of ontological love is primordial and there is no way out of it. But it has to be borne for attaining ontological consciousness of one's nothingness and thereby uniting with the beloved.

سدا جلدی تے ہتھ ملدی اجل دی تاگ پل پل دی
وتاں زلدی پئی تھل دی نہ ٹل دی سک برو چل دی

“I am perpetually burning and rubbing my hands. I am awaiting death at each and every moment. I am wandering wretchedly in the vast passages of the barren desert. The desire of my beloved does not satiate.”

It is so difficult for her to bear the burning pain of love. She laments at contracting love in the first instance symbolised by her rubbing of hands. She prefers death to wretchedly stranding in wilderness. Her efforts do not fructify in uniting her with her beloved. The insatiable desire of her beloved does not satiate.

سڑیندی سیچھ بھمل دی تکیندی تول نرمل دی
سجی نوں سانگ سانول دی ازل دی ہے نہ آج کل دی

“The velvet nuptial bed burns me. The nuptial quilt of soft cotton fries me. The damned one is longing

for the charming beloved not only in these times but ever since the primordial day.”

Things associated with nuptial happiness grill her in state of separation and disunion. Her imagination damns her by longing for her charming beloved ever since the primordial times. It makes her consciousness undergo deeper suffering.

ڈکھاں ڈکھڑے ڈتے ڈاڈھے ہڈاں داماس غم کھا دھے
بہمشہ درد بہن وادھے پُئل وُلدیں کریں جلدی

“The anguishes have given me great sufferings. Sorrows have eaten the flesh of my bones. My pains are constantly on the increase. My beloved! Do hasten to come to me.”

Anguishes are source of great sufferings. Sorrows invade the depths of her being. The increasing pains make her entreat her beloved to come soon for ending anguishes, sorrows and pains.

اویراں ہے چنی چولی اویرا عشق پیا جھولی
ڈتی گولی ہلاہل دی نہ جہریں وقت ماگھولی

“Peculiar love has befallen me. My dopatta and shirt have been torn to bits. My mother did not give me a tablet of poison on my birth.”

The ways of love are peculiar and they are beyond rational understanding. The peeling of the self is a painful process. She feels that it was better to be poisoned to death at her birth than to die in love with such great sufferings.

سجن رُٹھڑا تے سُکھ مُٹھڑا خوشی داسانگ سبھ تَرُٹڑا
نہ ڈکھ کُٹھڑا نہ جی پُٹھڑا اُپٹھڑی مونجھ ول ول دی

“My beloved has turned his face and has snapped ties with me. All ties of happiness have broken. I have not got free from my grief. My devastating anguish is ever recurring.”

She is completely dependent on the responsiveness of her beloved. The cooling of her beloved leads to the end of her peace and happiness. She does not get free from anguishes. She faces ever recurring overturned anguish of love. Who can experience the working of the Divine in the human more than the lover?

سڑ پیندا سوز چھاتی ہے مر پیندا روگ کا قاتی ہے
نہ پیندا یار جھاتی ہے کراں کیا کچھ نہیں چل دی

“Passion is burning my bosom. The malaise is striking me with knives. My friend does not cast glance at me. What should I do for none of my efforts fructify?”

Her deplorable state does not succeed in eliciting response from her beloved. Her efforts do not succeed in affecting union with her beloved and she does not know what to do. Her reaching the point where she does not know what to do is understood as the ablution of love which she has to undertake at the hands of her beloved. Religiosity with its underlying tall claims is absolutely unfit to enter the realm of love. It has not done even the ablution of love. The mystery of love consists in the absence of any relation of causal necessity between the lover and the beloved. Aren't there some who spend their whole lives in search of God but do not find Him and some who walk just a few steps and find Him standing in the way?

ڈکھی دادر دویری ہے مٹھی دی ماویڑی ہے
تقی داویرویری ہے سروں سختی نہیں ڈھل دی

“The pain of the sufferer is primordial. The mother of the hapless one is so peculiar. I am the inept one whose brother is her adversary. The hard times do not give me any sigh of relief.”

She as sufferer considers pain as her adversary. It is a pain born out of primordial love. She finds no support in love

even from her near and dear ones; rather, they detest her for contracting such a meaningless love.

فرید آیا نہ ماہی ہے ڈٹی سولاں نہ ساہی ہے
جگر وچ جرح جاہی ہے لگی جڑ نوک راول دی

“Farid! My beloved has not come. The afflictions have not let me even breathe. My self is seriously wounded. The arrow of love has been perfectly shot by my beloved.”

He realises that the transcendence of his beloved is a source of great suffering for him. The constant pouring of afflictions does not let him rest even for a moment. The wounds have been well grounded in his self. His beloved has perfectly captivated him in love. He has been caught in the impasse of love. If the arrow of love would have been shot imperfectly by the beloved, then he could have found a way out from love. Isn't it gracefulness on the part of the perfect beloved to let the imperfect lover play the game of love; what to talk of the lover winning it?

Kafi-187

پتالوں پانی آوے پورب لبھاوے تے

“The blowing of the east wind moistens the earth by attracting deep water beneath it.”

The blowing of the east wind and the rainfall in the desert with all its liveliness notwithstanding, it symbolises the breeze of love moistening self by attracting deep water of life beneath it.

مچھلے پیلے گوڑھے ساوے میٹنگھاں ونوں ون دیاں
بجلی اکھ مارے مُسکاوے بدلے درووں روون

“The rainbow is manifesting many colours. The clouds have figured in small sizes in yellow and dark green colours. The clouds are crying in pain. The flashes of lightning are winking and smiling.”

It is the manifestation of the Colourless in many colours. The different layers of the self burst out to unveil different behavioural patterns of the Self.

چک کھپ ہار حمیلاں پاوے روہی رنگ ر نگیلی
گیت پر م دے گاوے بوٹے بوٹے گھنڈ سہاگوں

“The desert has become multicoloured. The desert herbs (during rain the red flowers sprout) are wearing necklaces and neck ornaments. The song of love is being sung by each and every plant in a nuptial veil.”

The desert of her self has become colourful. The sentiments of love ornament and sing songs of union.

ول ول مینہ پساوے کیسر بھنڑی چولی پٹنڑی
کوئی آوے کوئی جاوے پورب ماڑڈ کھن دے بادل

“The desert shrubs are in garments of fragrance. They are being drenched in rain. There are incoming and outgoing clouds from the east Marwar and the north.”

The possibilities of her self are in the process of fragrant realisation due to recurring Divine blessings.

سانوں میں گھڑ ملہاراں سہجوں تھلڑیں مال نہاوے
پیسوں پانی دھارو دھاری ڈیسوں جھوک تراوے

“The rainy season in the desert has gathered the flock in plenty. We will also drink the rainwater at different places. We will water our dwellings.”

The water of life gathers different possibilities and soaks them afresh.

وٹھڑے پالے تھے خوشالے مال مویشی گاوے
سبھ کئی پا کر چوڑے بیڑے بہہ ٹیاں گھکاوے

“The desert plains have blossomed due to rainfall. The cattle are in tune with it. Women have worn full set of ornamental bangles and are churning the vessels.”

The desert of her self has blossomed by heavenly blessings. It animates various possibilities in it. The tender and beautiful possibilities thrive to realise themselves.

سوہنی کو جھی گہنے گٹھڑے پاوے پاٹھم کاوے
سیندھاں مانگھاں تنک تلوے کجل مُساگ سہاوے

“The beautiful and the ugly are wearing ornaments and are displaying them. The parting line of hair on head, the brow - coloured mark and moles coupled with a line of the collyrium and twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects) are looking so beautiful.”

The beautiful and ugly possibilities of the self are realising themselves in the best forms possible. Ugliness is

transforming itself into beauty. Isn't ugliness a privation and absence of beauty?

ریشکِ خوئید ڈسے سنھ دھامن
تھئے چو گوٹھ پلاوے
نندنہ ماون کھیر گئیں دے
پر تھئے جھاب ڈواوے

“The dry and hard shrubs of the desert are outweighing the soft and green plants of wheat. There are ponds full of drinking water for the herd all around. The cows ooze_out milk in plenty beyond all measures.”

Even the harder possibilities of the self symbolised in the dried and hard shrubs of the desert are susceptible to the waters of life as compared to the yielding ones symbolised by the soft and green plants of wheat. Her self overflows with knowledge.

کونجاں گر کن مور چنگھارے
کونل کوک سناوے
آون رلڑے یاد سجن دے
ظلمیں برہوں ستاوے

“The herons are cooing and the peacock is sounding wildly. The cuckoo is singing a song. I recall the times passed with my beloved. Love vexes me so cruelly.”

She is vexed by understanding the language of the birds. It recalls the moments of union with her beloved.

سوہنی موسم سوہنیاں مدتاں
سوہنا آن ملہاوے
باقی عمر فرید دی شالا
سانول سانگ وِہاوے

“It is such a lovely weather and such fine times that I wish my beloved to unite with me. Farid! I pray that my remaining life is spent in togetherness with my beloved.”

The pleasant and lovely changes within his self intensify his longing to unite with his beloved. He prays for his ultimate union.

Kafi-188

تاکھ پنل ول تیندی ہے سانوں ہک پل رہن نہ ڈیندی ہے

“My longing for my beloved has intensified. It does not let me live in peace even for a moment.”

Her intensified longing of her beloved does not grant her even a moment's peace.

عشق اُجاڑی جھوک امن دی پاڑوں پنج پٹیس ہڈ تن دی
ہک سک رہ گئی یار سجن دی جو سب بار سہیندی ہے

“Love has destroyed the city of peace. It has uprooted my flesh and bones. There remains only a longing of my beloved friend, which is bearing all these burdens.”

Love and peace remain antagonistic to each other. Love destroys her state of dwelling in peace. It turns her flesh and bones into pieces. The vocation of longing is to bear these onerous burdens of love. No longing. No burden.

مونجھ منجھاری درد و چھوڑا لکھیا باب تی دے ڈوڑا
اے غم مول نہ تھیوم تھوڑا جند جکھ جکھ مکیندی ہے

“The increasing anguishes, pains and separations have been destined for the inept one. My sorrow does not decrease at all. My life bids me good bye, while rotting in suffering.”

Her condition is not static. The intensity of anguishes, pains and separations that fall to her lot are not still but intensify with the passage of time and make her wretched.

تغ طمانچہ بانگ کٹاری خنجر پکاں تیر شکاری
بھٹ کیتے تن من وچہ کاری پیڑ قرار و نچیندی ہے

“The eye lids of my beloved are daggers and hunting arrows, sword, gun, dagger and double edged knife. They have seriously wounded my embodied self. Pain leads to the loss of my peace.”

The affect of ravishing beauty is so immense that it pierces her embodied self. She loses her peace by bearing painful wounds of love.

درد اندوہ ہزاراں دل نوں ڈکھ ڈیون لکھ ماراں دل نوں
سولاں دیاں تلواراں دل نوں حسرت بر جھی لیندی ہے

“My heart has countless pains and grief. Sufferings give hard blows to my heart. The swords of afflictions hit my heart. Wistfulness spears my being.”

Her heart has to bear countless pains, grief, hard blows of sufferings, cuts of the swords of afflictions and spears of wistfulness. Isn't love so gracious in conferring these rare gifts?

مہنہ نہ لیندے سکے بھائی مہنیں ڈیوے مایو جانی
خویش قبیلے کرن لڑائی سس ننان مریندی ہے

“My real brothers are not on speaking terms with me. My sister rebukes me. My kith and kin fight with me. My mother- in- law and my sister- in -law thrash me.”

The ordinary consciousness is highly antagonistic to the consciousness of love. The ‘familial’ consciousness goes to the extreme in resorting to criminal intimidation and even physical violence against the lover for the sake of their so-called family and cultural values. Isn't the the lover a rebel who sets high standards of value for her family, culture and society by standing for the development of social, cultural and spiritual consciousness of the people of her times, and

inspite of being beaten by her near and dear ones exercises patience in adversity and does not get beaten in love?

شوق فرید شعور لڑھایم حال و نجایم قال گنوا یم
دھوڑی پام خاک رما یم دل سبھ کیس کریندی ہے

“Farid! My fondness has made me drown my consciousness. I have lost my inner poise and ability of discourse. I have put dust on my head and rubbed it on my body. Heart makes such woeful things happen.”

The first sign of his fondness of love (his beloved) is getting rid of his ordinary consciousness. The cessation of this level of consciousness makes his habitual self crumble. The crumbling of this level of self or consciousness leads, among other things, to the collapse of his value system. He loses his inner poise (by being so much excited in love), and ability of discourse (because the informal discourse of love displaces all forms of discourse). The things do not end here for these are merely the humble starters of love. He puts dust on his head and rubs it on his body, while feeling the pain of anguish at the transcendence of his beloved. It also symbolises his realisation that appearance has no value as compared to reality. It is his heart as against his mind, which makes such woeful things happen.

Kafi-189

تینا عشق بہوں گزریو سے ایہو قہر نہ پیش ایو سے

“I have been bearing the inept love but I have never experienced such severity.”

He bears the ineptness of love but the increasing severity of sufferings become unbearable.

بھاہ برہوں دی ساڑ پچالیا ہڈ تن کیتس کیری
یار لدھو سے جانی ویری لکھیا واہ ملیو سے

“The fire of separation of my beloved has burnt me. It has burnt my flesh and bones to ashes. I found a friend who turned out to be my sworn adversary. I laud what was written in my destiny.”

The fire of separation burns and reduces to ashes the inner layers of his being. He laments that it was his destiny to cultivate friendship with the one who proved to be his deadliest enemy. Religiosity cannot understand his loving discourse where his bosom friend is being called as his sworn adversary. It is the intensive state of love and suffering that makes such discourse possible. Isn't he so lucky in reaching this stage?

جان جگر تن پارے پارے سینہ محض لویراں
لوں لوں رگ رگ وچہ سو پیڑاں ہجر برات ڈھیو سے

“My embodied self has disintegrated. My chest has been torn to bits. There are countless excruciating pains in each and every pore and vein of my body. Disunion has infested me with this rare gift.”

Disunion invests him with the rare gift of ravishing his embodied self. He suffers the birth pangs of giving birth to his higher self. Isn't it a rare gift that reduces being to nonbeing and prepares it for union with the beloved, notwithstanding the pains and sufferings?

ہنجرٹوں ہاراں واٹ نہاراں
بیٹھی کانگ اڈاراں
جان جگر ہے جیندا دیرا
تنہا چھوڑ گیو سے

“I am looking at the paths of my beloved with tears in my eyes and shooing the ravens. It is all for him, whose dwellings are in the inmost chambers of my being. He has left me all alone.”

She resorts to omens to seek her beloved who dwells in her being. The beloved assumes transcendence by making her lonesome in the vicissitudes of time.

پیت پرانی من نوں بھانی
لذت بہوں ڈکھالی
مثل سمندر آتش اندر
سوسو عیش لدھیو سے

“It is a primordial pain, which is pleasant for my being. It has made me experience its great taste. I have found hundreds of treasures in the fire of love as one finds treasures in the sea.”

He considers the primordial pain of love pleasant for his being. He experiences its great taste, which is opaque to ordinary consciousness. He finds hundreds of treasures in the fire of love likened to the treasures found in the sea. The alchemy of suffering turns the base metal into gold. The fire of love with its ensuing pain purifies the self by removing the dross of otherness. It polishes the unpolished mirror of the heart and makes it worthy of the beloved to contemplate himself in it.

سَر گیم جل گیم مر گیم گل گیم
سکدیں تپدیں مردیں کھپدیں
یار فرید نہ آیا
نازک نینہ نہ بھیو سے

“I have been burnt, grilled, ravished and rotten. Farid!
My friend has not come. I will remain true to my
tender love in desiring, burning, dying and in raising
hue and cry.”

He gets burned, grilled, ravished and rotten during the period of his beloved's transcendence. But he resolves to remain true to his fragile love even in the terrible states of pain and suffering. Love of freedom turns into freedom of love. His choice to remain true to his love is essentially the exercise of his freedom in the most trying circumstances. Freedom is absolute or it is nothing. Partial or relative freedom is no freedom. Reason cannot decipher the mystery of freedom. It is caught in the snares of finitude. It lacks transcendence. It never tastes freedom. Freedom is truly understood by virtue of spiritual phenomenology, which understands it in the simultaneity of transcendence and immanence. The 'existential' renderings of freedom take us to the heart of the matter. The metaphysics of freedom is revealed in the situation of love and gnosis. Man is manifestation of the Freedom itself. No freedom. No love.

Kafi-190

تتے نینہ تترئی دے اوتے
حیران سارا لوک ہے
اے دل نہیں کچڑی گھدی
ماہی و جائی ٹھوک ہے

“All people are surprised at the burdening love of the inept. My heart is not raw and that has been perfectly tested by my beloved.”

She amazes people by her capacity and strength to bear sufferings in the path of love. The beloved perfectly tests her heart to see whether it is raw or strong enough to play the game of transcendence and immanence. It is only a stout heart that can bear the burden of love.

چٹ تھی جو بن دی تاروے
گئے کم بھلے کل کاروے
توں بن تتی دایاروے
جیون نہ جیون بھوگ ہے

“My youthfulness has been wasted. I have become oblivious of all my activities. My friend! I am such an inept one that living or not living with you is equally an ordeal for me.”

She feels that the prime of her youth has fled without affecting union with her beloved. She becomes oblivious of her everydayness of existence. She considers herself such an inept one for whom it is equally an ordeal to live with her beloved or without him. She faces the ordeal to live with her transcendent beloved in the state of separation and disunion with all that implies or to abandon the path of love once for all. She finds no exit. She has to remain committed to her beloved in all pressing circumstances.

اوپنی جاتے خوش وسن
اتھ نین تھی بے وسن
کیوں لوک نہ میں تے ہسن
مٹھڑی کوں چاتا بوک ہے

“There, he dwells happily at his place and here, the tears are helplessly flowing from my eyes. Why not people should laugh at the miserable one, whose youthfulness of heart has made her suffer?”

The beloved happily dwells in transcendence but she cries in failing to find her. The animation of her heart contracts love, causing people to laugh at her miserable state. What would people do if they had no such cause of laughter?

روپٹ اساڈی کار ہے ڈو کھ سول گاہناں ہار ہے
بر بار چٹ گھر بار ہے مارو تھلاں وچ جھوک ہے

“My vocation is crying and whining. Sufferings and afflictions are my jewellery and garlands. My household is in desolations, plain lands and forests. My abode is in the deadly deserts.”

She lives in the deadly desert of her self. She is housed in wilderness. It is her vocation to cry and whine. She is ornamented by sufferings and afflictions. The transcendence of her beloved makes her inward and outward overbearing.

تھیا بخت میں تے تنگ ہے سکھ دی ہمیشہ جنگ ہے
بکھڑا مساک دارنگ ہے اُجڑی سہاگ دی نوک ہے

“My fate has constricted me. Peace is in constant war with me. The colour of twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects) has faded out. The bridal line of a collyrium has flawed.”

Her fate (ontological love), subject to cosmic design, constricts her in lonesomeness. She is not at peace with herself. The beauty of her life fades out. Love pushes her to the wall. Doesn't the one who is lucky in love find the “door in the wall”?

بچھڑا فرید دا حال ہے سمانول نہ تتیم نال ہے
نظر م وصال محال ہے ڈکھ دی نویں زیت چوک ہے

“Farid is in a deplorable condition. My beloved has not taken me along with him. Union with my beloved seems impossible. There are ever new strikes of sufferings.”

His condition becomes deplorable. The beloved assumes transcendence by stranding him in the state of selfhood. It is not possible for him to have union with his beloved in the “servant-Lord axis.” “Nothing removes man farther from God than a desire of union with Him.” He faces novel and fresh strikes of sufferings since his beloved does not facilitate him to “reside in his transpersonal being.”

Kafi-191

توں بن حضرت یار ہر دم پھراں حیرانی

“My sacred friend! I perpetually wander in
bewilderment without you.”

He communicates with his sublime friend about his
disoriented state without him.

ماہی با جھوں سول کھنیرے جیون ہے بیکار

“There are countless afflictions without my beloved.
My life is useless. My sweetheart knows about it.”

He knows that his dearest beloved is aware of the
countless afflictions of love faced by him and his viewing life
as useless thereof. The difference between psychic love and
the spiritual one, among other things, consists in the beloved
being entirely aware of the state and station of the lover. The
divine beloved has absolute knowledge of things and events.
The lover's knowledge is relative (piecemeal) and therefore he
has problems in understanding certain patterns of his
beloved's behaviour. He hurls accusations on his beloved,
which manifest his lack of perfect knowledge but his
communication never breaks down even when he gets
negatively related to him. However, he remains traversing the
path of love and with increasing knowledge starts
understanding some of the ways of his beloved. How great it
is to have omniscient beloved!

دلبر جیہاں ہو نہ کوئی خوبی داسر دار

صورت وچ لائمانی

“There is no one resembling my beloved. He is the epitome of all virtues. He is matchless in his form.”

He finds no one resembling his beloved, epitome of all virtues, and matchless in form. He is without resemblance and matchless in his form and conduct not because others are inferior to him but because there is no one beside him. The very act of denoting and then negating someone is anti-metaphysical. How could any thing be denoted and then negated? The metaphysics of love demonstrates the omnipresence of the beloved.

پنل کے کچھ سدھایا کیش زار نزار
رورو تھیم دیوانی

“Punnal left and went towards Ketch. He has distressed me (worsened my state). I am becoming frantic by crying profusely.”

The beloved assumes the transcendent form. It worsens her state. She becomes frantic and cries profusely. Aren't her condition and behaviour in response to the transcendence of her beloved ultimately conducive to the attainment of union?

عشق اوڑا پیش پیو سے دل نوں دار مدار
تن من سو سوکانی

“Peculiar love has engulfed me. My heart is in complexities. Countless arrows have stuck my body and soul.”

Peculiar love, characterised by heart complexities and ravishing of his embodied self, has fallen to his lot.

درد فرید ہے چیز مہانگی تھیندے ونج وپار
جنڈی کر قربانی

“Farid! Pain is a valuable product. Do barter your life in this trade.”

He realises the value of pain suffering at the transcendence of his beloved. He resolves to barter his life in the trade of love. Painfulness of love purifies him of otherness and makes him unite with his beloved. "Those who live more lives than one, more deaths than one must die". He lives many lives (unions with his beloved), therefore he must be prepared to die at least as many times (separations and disunions).

Kafi-192

توں بن موت بھلی ویندم شالا مری نکساں ک نہ ذری جیساں پل نہ گھڑی

“Death is preferable to me without you. I pray not to stay here but die without bearing separation for a moment. I will not live for a moment or instant in this situation.”

She prefers death than living without her beloved. The situation of separation and disunion is so testing that she prays for her death than bearing it for even a moment.

پو رب طرف ڈھوں مینگھ ملہار ڈتھم بجلی لک ڈتی گج گج گانج سنیم
رہساں اتھ نہ اڑی ویساں وطن وری

“I have seen the rainy clouds and the overcast atmosphere from the east. There are flashes of lightning and huge thundering of clouds. I will not stay here but go back to my native land.”

She finds within her signs of the unveiling of her beloved. She wants to delve deep within the infinite depths of her being in order to unite with her beloved.

کنڑیں ووڑ پیم روہی وٹھڑی دی ڈھولا کل نہ لدھو ڈکھڑیں کٹھڑی دی
پھاڑیم چولی چنی رورو تھیم چری

“The news of rain in the desert has reached my ears. My beloved! You have not asked about the one, who has been butchered by sufferings. I have torn my shirt and dopatta and have become frantic by crying.”

She receives the news of rain (freshening of his sentiments of love) within the desert of her self. She communicates with

her beloved, referring to his heartlessness in not saving her from being butchered by suffering, and not taking pity on the plight of her embodied self.

اپنے دیس وںجاں دل نوں تانگھ تھئی ڈیکھاں تاڈے ٹوبھے لائے کھار بوئی
برٹوں رہی تھیواں سڈیں سول سڑی

“My heart is longing to reach my native abode. I wish to see the transitory dwellings, ponds and desert plants. I want to travel in wilderness after having been burnt with afflictions.”

She longs to reach the inmost chambers of her heart. She is burned with afflictions and wishes to delve deep within her self (wilderness) in order to realise its higher possibilities.

اونگاں بونگ اوٹھن بدلیں کیتی لس گھن گھن نام ۛاروندی تھئی بیوس
سانول تینوں ملاں یا سرپووم مری

“The sound of thundering clouds is so audible. The swinging clouds are joining together. I am helplessly taking your name, while crying. My beloved! I meet you either/ or death overtakes me.”

The visual and audible signs of unveiling of her beloved within herself make her desperate in affecting union with her beloved. She helplessly cries by taking her name at the threshold of union. She makes an absolute choice: either union or death. She reaches the state of either/or after undergoing great pains and sufferings. And it becomes efficacious in realising union with her beloved.

سرخی میندی مٹھی کجہ دھار گیم ناز نواز بھلیا ہار سنگار گیم
مینسر بول بھٹاں اجڑی مانگھ دھڑی

“Rogue and henna have been spoiled and the line of a collyrium has been washed away. Pride and elegance have gone in oblivion and my makeup has disappeared. My nose ornaments have been broken

into pieces and the parting line of hair on my head
and my kneaded locks of hair have all been ravished.”

She loses her pride and elegance in the course of love. The
beauty of her appearance fades away. Isn't the fading away of
appearance an occasion for the appearance of reality?

کھین کڈن گیا سکھ داٹول گیم ڈکھڑے کھڑے پئے خوشیل دل گیم
جڑ کر راول جوگی لائی پر م جڑی

“My playfulness has gone and my sittings of peace
have withered away. The sufferings have fallen to my
lot and all my happiness has turned into
wretchedness. Rawal Yogi (my beloved) has perfectly
ignited the spark of love in me.”

The beloved perfectly ignites the spark of love in her
heart. The test of its perfection consists in her losing
playfulness and peace; bearing onerous sufferings and the
state of happiness turning into wretchedness.

کھمدی لہمن فرید جھوکاں یاد پوون اکھتیاں نیر ہنجوں کر برسات وسن
لکھ لکھ دھاتہہ لوٹھ جہل جہل دسم جھڑی

“Farid! I remember the dwellings during the flashes
of lightning. The tears are flowing from my eyes like a
rainfall. My self beseeches countless times (for uniting
with my beloved), when I see any rainy cloud.”

He recounts the ripening states of his love sentiments
within his self, symbolised by the rainy cloud and flashes of
lightening. These moments intensify his inward fire of love,
tracking him to the threshold of union with his beloved. A
flash of light (vision and union) breaks the spell of darkness
(separation and union).

Kafi-193

تو بن ہمیں داچاک وے دلڑی غماں دی جھوک ہے
جو جو خوشی سر سبز تھئی صرصر دکھاں توں سوک ہے

“My shepherd of the herd! My heart is the abode of sorrows without you. All my happiness that was green has dried up due to the autumn of sufferings.”

She addresses the shepherd of her heart and communicates with him the state of her heart, which has become an abode of sorrows without him. The spring of union has turned into the autumn of sufferings. Doesn't love teach the sufferer such beautiful expressions?

گئی ریت بھت ڈت گھت منڈھوں اصلی نہ نکسوں اتھ منڈھوں
ساڑے نہ سہاں نت منڈھوں اے گالھ روک دی روک ہے

“My cultural and social relationships have been uprooted. I will not stay here even for a moment. I will essentially not bear burnings every now and then. I am stating the truth.”

Her inward suffering, in the act of desiring and longing for the beloved in the state of separation and disunion, is intensified by the hostility of her social and cultural environment. She firmly decides to peel away her social self in order to get rid of painful social contradictions.

رل مل تتی نوں تیندیاں رکھ ویروین الیندیاں
ہکڑیاں اُلا نہجے ڈیندیاں ہکڑیاں دی نوک تے ٹوک ہے

“They combine in burning the inept one. They detest and give me maledictions. Some of them are accusing me. Still others gambol and sneer at me.”

She suffers intensely at the hands of her companions who in togetherness make her fiery with their behaviour. She faces detestations, maledictions, accusations, gambols and sneering. The companions are outsiders who neither understand the reality of love nor the inherent dignity conferred by it on the lover. They are ignorant of love and gnosis. Isn't their being negatively related to love ultimately proving to be strength for her?

کل مردی شالاج مراں	رورواکھیں وچ پیال چراں
گیا یار تر وڑ سنجوک ہے	یا ونج بڈاں یا بھونیں وڑاں

“My eyes have become a sore by constant crying. I pray that I die today than tomorrow. I may drown or be buried. My friend has gone by severing relationship with me.”

The transcendence of the beloved makes her dejected because she feels that her friend has broken ties of love with her. Her eyes become sore by constant crying. She prays for the end of her life before time and does not bother about the mode of her burial. It is easy for the human understanding to understand the sufferings one undergoes at the hands of one's deadliest enemies but it is so difficult for it to understand the sufferings undergone by her at the hands of her bosom friend. Doesn't higher suffering require higher consciousness to understand it?

آئے سرتے سخت رنڈ پیڑے	ڈکھ سول ہار ہنڈ پیڑے
کیا ملیا تھوک کوں تھوک ہے	بد بخت ضعف بڈ پیڑے

“The sufferings and afflictions are my garlands, clothing and jewellery. Hard days of widowhood have befallen me. What an ‘ideal’ combination of misfortunes, weaknesses and old age?”

She is clothed and ornamented by sufferings and afflictions. The unfortunate widowhood of transcendence pushes her against the wall. The infirmities and old age mirror each other.

قسمت فرید دی تھی پٹھی گیارول سانول ڈے پٹھی
چٹڑے پدھرتے میں لئی خوش وسدا سارا لوک ہے

“The destiny of Farid is overturned. My beloved has wretched my existence by turning his back. I am the only one who has been looted in openness (broad daylight). All people are dwelling in happiness.”

He feels his destiny overturned because it does not shower good fortunes but strikes misfortunes, instead. It does not follow the standard patterns of life. He grapples with the question of destiny as one of the mysteries of love. He hardly unravels it since it starts deepening in the very act of unravelling. He construes the transcendence of his beloved as turning back on love. The mystery of transcendence remains folded for him. He recounts his being ravished by the cruelty of love. He singles himself out as the wretched one as against others who have attained permanent state of happy union.

Kafi-194

تیرا نینہ نہ بھیساں زورے سانوں ہنگے کون تے ہوڑے

“My beloved! I will remain steadfast in love. There is no one to caution me and there is no one to stop me.”

She resolves to remain steadfast in love against those who try to prevent or stop her from loving her beloved.

جان جلیساں سسیں سڑیاں سہجیوں سوز سہیساں
سارا شرم شعور لڑھیاں ساری عار و یار اٹھیاں
تن من دھن سبھ ملک سجن دے تو نے کیجو کرم و چھوڑے

“I will burn my self and aflame my head. I will most heartily bear the passion. I will leave my honour and won't be ashamed of public opinion. I will sacrifice my whole being for the sake of my beloved even if he parts ways from me.”

Love is an unconditional commitment. The absoluteness of love does not admit of any conditionality. She faces intricate inner and outer contradictions but reiterates her commitment to remain sincere in love even if her beloved parts ways from her. She offers her whole being and having to her beloved in the spirit of wholeheartedness and wholesomeness. Love is total offering. She wilfully surrenders her right of being and having without expecting anything in return. She does not withhold anything (qualitative or quantitative) from her beloved. The essentiality of love is indivisibility. It is only her undivided self in its unity, totality and wholeness, which is worthy of being offered to her beloved. How could the divided self realise indivisible unity?

عشق اجاڑیم سولاں ساڑیم
درداں لائے دیرے
روگ کروپ کشالے ہر دم
گانے گہنے سہرے
راج بنائے تول وہانے
وسرے زورے تورے

“Love has ravished me and the afflictions have burned me. Pains are dwelling in me. Malaises, difficulties and adversities at each and every moment are colourful thread around my wrist (symbolising marital bond), ornaments and chaplets. I have become oblivious of my parental regal status nuptial quilt and pillows. My radiant might has fallen in oblivion.”

Her vocation is to freely divest herself from her being and having in order to attain ontological consciousness of nothingness, and thereby achieve unity with her beloved. The process of divesting oneself from the contingencies of being and having is replete with pains and sufferings. There is transvaluation of values. The nuptial colours of life fade away and the radiant might falls in oblivion. Aren't these positive signs of reaching the threshold of union?

پیکے نوکاں کرم، سورتجے
مارم جگتاں نوکاں
کٹھڑی دلڑی لٹڑی دا
ہے قبلہ یار دیاں جھوکاں
ماپو خویش قبیلہ مل مل
ڈیندے دھکڑے دھوڑے

“My parents sneer at me and my in-laws laugh and make fun of me. The dwellings of my beloved are the axis of my miserable and ransacked heart. My parents, kith and kin join together in pushing and knocking me with their feet.”

It is not an easy exercise to divest herself from her being and having for the sake of her beloved. It leads to the snapping of her primary and secondary ties, which is so painful and violent. The pangs of rebirth and the cutting of the social umbilical chord turn into a traumatic experience.

She is ultimately reduced to nothingness. Wasn't everything created from nothingness?

چشماں جادو جوڑ جگائے ہوش قرار بھلایا
ڈکھڑے پکھڑے آئے غم ہم دم دم نال سوا یا
غزے خوب دھوڑے ڈیون، رَمزاں گھت دیاں گھوڑے

“The eyes of my beloved have become so magical that these have led me to lose my sense and sensibility. The sufferings have fallen to my share with breathtaking sorrows on the increase. The enticements greatly imbalance me and the stylish expressions ravish me.”

She cannot accomplish her mission of divesting herself from her being and having unless she loses her sense and sensibility. But she cannot lose these unless she becomes bewitched by beauty characterised by enticements and stylish expressions. It makes her face sufferings and increasing breathtaking sorrows. Beauty seeds love and love flowers beauty.

یار فرید نہ و سرم ہر گز رور و دھا نہیں کر ساں
جیندیں مردیں اوکھیں سوکھیں ساہ محبت بھر ساں
دوہری سکدی سانگ جگروچ جے ڈکھ ڈیوم ڈوڑے

“Farid! I can never be oblivious of my friend. I will beseech, while crying. I will always breathe love in the state of hope or despair and in the state of ease or discomfort. The spear of longing doubly pierces my being in proportion to the double sufferings given by my beloved.”

His passionate commitment of love consists in never being forgetful of his friend. He resolves to remain constant in love in the state of liveliness or deadness and in the situation of ease or discomfort. The intensification of suffering proportionately intensifies his longing of the

beloved. The principle of sincerity in love makes it exceedingly imperative for him to remain steadfast in the path of love by exercising patience in adversity. He has to remain committed to his beloved in the most trying circumstances and in the most testing times. How could he mature if he falls from the nest of love without flying? The nest of love, at times, may turn into hornet's nest but still it is his vocation to amass courage to face the ordeals of love. His leaving half-way makes him neither here nor there. He should not become the arbiter of his own fate but let the destiny unfold itself. The lover need not be passive but he is certainly required to be receptive. All great things in life are received in the state of receptivity. How unfortunate is the lover who abandons the path of love when his beloved is just a few steps away? The dimension of future exists as an open possibility. The inept lover tends to close it by mistakenly considering his wretched situation as permanent in the world of change. Time is dynamic and not static. Things change on the spectrum of time. There is no room for despair in the creativity of love. The tendency to take results in one's own hand is the root cause of despair. It is really tragic to be despaired of God's Mercy. Hope is our best friend. The lover should struggle and leave the results in the hands of God. Let the beloved have the last word.

Kafi-195

تیرے بناں سانول بہوں دلڑی الگ بے آس ہے
جندڑی جلے سینہ سڑے سرچور ہے تن ناس ہے

“My beloved! My heart is stranded hopelessly without you. My life is burning and my chest is sizzling. My mind is exhausted and my body is worn out.”

She communicates to her beloved the deplorable state of her heart, which is hopeless without her. The transcendence of her beloved has ransacked her embodied being.

جیر اغماں دے وات ہے ہیہات ہے ہیہات ہے
ہک ڈکھ تتی دے ساتھ ہے نکھ دی نہ بونہ باس ہے

“My self is in the jaws of sorrows. I beseech! I beseech! There is all suffering accompanying the inept one. There is no aroma or odour (a sign) of peace.”

The self is in an unending sorrowful state. She implores her beloved regarding her sufferings, which leave her with no chance of peacefulness.

جیں ڈینہ پنل گیا کچ ول سٹ سیجھ کھٹ رنگیں محل
جھاگاں جبل گھاٹیاں تے تھل ہک مونجھ ہے نئی پیاس ہے

“I am traversing mountainous ranges and desolate places since Punnal went back to Ketch after casting away his nuptial bed and abandoning colourful mansions. I am in anguish and thirst.”

Sassi (lover) describes her wilderness, state of anguish and thirst since Punnal (beloved) transcended his immanence, symbolised in leaving her nuptial bed and colourful mansions.

The transcendent and colourless beloved withdraws from his nuptial and colourful forms leaving her in the lurch.

وِسرے نہالی تول سب پوپاتے سینسر بول سب
نہن سوز ہے یا سول سب یادرد ہے یا یاس ہے

“All my mattresses, nuptial quilts and all my nose ornaments have fallen in oblivion. Now, there is passion or afflictions and pain or despair.”

She loses interest in those very things, which symbolised union and were the source of attracting her beloved. The beloved is the measure of all meanings. Things and events attain meanings in reference to the vision and union of the beloved. Transcendence turns everything elusive.

کیڈے فرید آج بھیج نسوں جتھ رچھتے باندردی وسوں
ڈینیں ممیں راخس بہوں سوغول لکھ نسناں ہے

“Farid! Where should I run away from the dwellings of bears and monkeys? There are numerous witches, man eaters and giants. There are dreadful creatures in wilderness.”

He encounters dreadful ideas, feelings and sentiments in the wilderness of his self, while caught in the impasse of love. There is no escape from dread. Aren't love and dread identical?

Kafi-196

ٹوبھ بنواڈے پکا تر تارتے سندھڑوں دور اُتاڑتے

“Make a pond for me at an upper place in the desert with full care. It should be far away from the low-lying areas of Sindh.”

The reality of the pond in the desert with its physical, social and cultural dimensions notwithstanding, it symbolises gnostic consciousness or becoming conscious of the spiritual reservoir in the desert of one's self far away from the vicissitudes of religious life.

صبح سحوریں لھیکن ٹیاں جھوپڑ دے اگواڑتے

“There is the sound of churning vessels in the desert at the early hours of the morning.”

The contemplative aspects of being are integrated with action (symbolised by the churning of vessels). Spirituality integrates contemplation and action.

روہی راوے روہیں دھماں ہوک پووے ونج ماڑتے

“The eminence of this pond may reach the deserts, plains and mountainous areas. Its fame may spread till Marwar.”

The spiritual dimension of religion should widespread and permeate other forms of religious life.

اُچڑے & لکھ ساگر دے چڑھنا پووم پہاڑتے

“My pond should be placed higher like the ponds of ‘Sukh Sagar’ even if I have to climb a mountain to reach it.”

He desires his spiritual reservoir to be placed higher like the gnostic reservoir even if he has to mount it hard.

چو طرفوں ویہہ پانی آوے سوئے صاف چھاڑتے

“The rain water from all sides may settle in pure and lovely low lying areas due to this pond.”

The heavenly water (spiritual liveliness) from all sides may settle in the pure and lovely spiritual reservoir.

پاک ڈہروچ ٹوبھاروں نہ جھٹ جھاڑ کھاڑتے

“I want to dig this pond at a clean and plain land that is free from the piles of thorny herbs and hideous places.”

The immensity of the spirit knows no bounds.

روہی واس سبھے لڈاوسن اپنیاں جھوکاں ساڑتے

“All the dwellers of the desert will abandon their temporary dwellings and will have an abode on this pond.”

The ideas, feelings and sentiments within the self will leave their ephemeral abodes and permanently cluster around spirituality.

پھلوڈھے تے منت لیسوں تھوراچڑھیسوں دینے لاڑتے

“I shall vow at phullu dhey and shall bestow favours on Dina Lar.”

He makes a vow to pay reverence to unique stages he encounters in the desert of his self, during the course of his nuptial journey.

آن فرید سہ میساں چنورے شہر بزار اُجاڑتے

“Farid! I will beautify my shady hut dwellings. I will abandon the city and its market places.”

He resolves to beautify his inwardness by transcending his outwardness.

Kafi-197

ٹوبھا کھٹاڑے سوہنی جاتاڑتے او جھانہ ہووے ساری ماڑتے

“Dig a lovely pond for me at such a site that it has no parallel in the city of Mar.”

He desires to uncover lovely spiritual reservoir at such a point in his higher self that remains matchless in the desert of his being.

ٹوبھے باجھوں مول نہ ٹھہساں ناگھتے نہ پاڑتے

“I will never be satisfied without a pond. I don’t want to build it on an unsuitable land.”

He is not satisfied without spiritual love. He does not want to nurture love on shifting foundations.

ڈینہاں پیسوں لسیاں گاڈیاں راتیں کھیر کوں کاڑھتے

“We will take beaten curd in the morning and at night we will take boiled hot milk.”

He resolves to integrate action and contemplation in quest of his beloved.

توں بن سانول اگ اڑیاں چولہ بوچھن پاڑتے

“My beloved! I will commit my clothing to blazing up fire without you.”

He has no desire to remain content with mere appearance without reality. He is in search of ‘kernel of the kernel’.

جے نہ اوسیں توں ول جھوکاں لڈسوں جھوپڑ ساڑتے

“If you do not visit our dwellings, then we will burn our huts and move away with our households.”

He explores the possibility of abandoning his dwellings in search of transcendence in case his transcendent beloved does not become immanent (does not unveil himself).

جھوپڑ جوڑ: نیسوں کھپ دے تھل دے صاف پھاڑتے

“We will build our huts with desert grass branches on the clean and open spaces of the desert.”

He chooses to dwell within the pure and spacious greenery of his self.

گائیں سہنس سوائیاں سوہنیاں ڈبھن آن اکاڑتے

“Hundreds of lovely buffaloes will be milked on a hard and high place.”

His dwelling within his self opens higher possibilities of realisation (gnostic knowledge).

ٹوبھا بنویسوں دل دے سانگے منت چڑھیسوں لعلولاڑتے

“We will build the pond with great fondness of our heart and vow at the shrine of Laloo Lar.”

The uncovering of spiritual reservoir within one's self is possible by virtue of the fondness of heart and reverence of saints (dead or alive).

آوم راحت ڈوڑی چوڑی لانے پھوگ دے وار تے

“My happiness multiplies in dwelling with the desert plants and shrubs.”

He is increasingly happy in dwelling amidst fresh possibilities of his higher self.

فرح فریدنوں روز سوائی سنج بر سخت اُجاڑتے

“The happiness of Farid is increasing day by day in desolate, barren and deserted places.”

His happiness multiplies in seizing possibilities of realisation within the desert of his self

Kafi-198

ٹوبھا کھٹاڑے ملک ملہیر تے پتھر پہاڑ کوں چیر تے

“Please gift me a pond in the area of Malheer by cutting the hard mountain.”

He beseeches his beloved to dig spiritual reservoir for him in the infinite depths of his being or consciousness by melting the hardness of his heart.

ملک ملہیر دی ناز و چالی بوئی لانی دار تہ عالی
ٹوکاں کردی دھوڑی والی کیسر مشک عنبر تے

“The prideful moves of the city of Malheer are such that the desert plants enjoin a high status. Its dust and sand are saffron, musk and ambergris (sweet smelling).”

The desert of the self is impregnated with higher possibilities. The outer coverings of the self (dust and sand) are saffron, musk and ambergris for they contain beneath the sweet and fragrant beloved of his heart.

منجھیاں رنکسن گائیں ڈھکسن بھیداں بکریاں چانگے نکسن
اکھتیاں آڑ سن دڑیاں بکسن دھرتی دی تاثیر تے

“The buffaloes will voice with joy and the cows will make callings for their calves. The sheep and goats along with their calves will come to their appointed places. The eyes will contract love due to the loving environment of the place.”

The higher possibilities inherent in the desert of his self are in the process of realisation in the ambience of love.

برہوں دے ٹھوہ تے جوہ نیسوں جھوکاں جوڑ سنجوک چھکیسوں
سسی تے سے تھورے لیسوں مَنّت چڑھیسوں مائی ہیرتے

“I will make my dwellings in the suitable station of love and foster the ties of love. I will confer a favour on Sassi and also fulfil a vow on Mai Heer.”

She enjoins to reach the unique station of love and foster ties of love. She resolves to strengthen the tradition of love lived by Sassi and Heer.

بیعت کریسوں کل تھل برکوں ساگر پریم تے سکھ ساگر کوں
گجھڑے رچھنے جو دھاسر کوں رکھ تکیہ گر پیرتے

“I will take oath of allegiance from all those living in the deserts, desolations and adjoining areas by the grace of my spiritual master. (I will make them my disciples and bring people of these areas to my fold).”

He desires, by the grace of his spiritual master, to take oath of allegiance from the possibilities of his self unto vision and realisation.

جاں جاں وٹھ دی وہو سینوے سندھڑوں دل اوچک ڈسیوے
ڈینہاں لسرڈی تے روح تھیوے راتیں گاوے کھیرتے

“The more I hear the news of rains in the desert, the more my heart gets alienated from Sindh. I am so fond of churned curd mixed with water in the day and milk of the cow at night.”

He hears the calls of his inner self, which distances him from his ordinary being. His heart yearns to integrate action and contemplation.

ٹوبھے باجھوں مول نہ ٹھہساں نہ وکڑے نہ بندتے بہساں
نہ گھٹے تے نہ پاڑتے رہساں نہ وت کھوہ وہیرتے

“I will be never satisfied without the pond. I will not sit on any piece of the field or any bank. I will not dwell on the cultivable land.”

He resolves not to be satisfied at all without the spiritual reservoir (spirituality). He firmly rejects the outside view of things. Doesn't he prefer spirituality over religiosity?

آپے آکر دِلڑی لا تو حال میڈا سبھ مجھیو جا تو
ہن کیوں مٹھڑی توں دل چا تو دھو تیں دی تقریر تے

“You yourself came and contracted love with me. You understood me fully. Now, why have you distanced yourself from the miserable one on the sayings of the backbiters?”

He recounts the beloved's initiative in contracting love and his being omniscient. He assigns different reasons while grappling with the reality of his beloved's transcendence. He thinks that the backbiters have prevailed upon his beloved, which has led to his distancing from him. The meeting of the human and the Divine creates such anomalies, which deepen the passion of love. Aren't paradoxes and anomalies instrumental in keeping love vibrant?

عشق فرید لکھیا پروانہ گھر باروں تھی بار روانہ
کر سر صدقے پڑھ شکرانہ ہیں مٹھڑی تحریر تے

“Farid! Love has sent me a decree that I should leave my household and move towards the forest. I ought to sacrifice myself and offer thanksgivings in compliance with these sweet written orders.”

He receives the decree of love to abandon his everydayness of existence and delve within his inner self. He resolves to sacrifice his self and offer thanksgiving, in compliance with these orders, carved on his heart. Isn't he fortunate enough to be chosen by his beloved as sacrificial in the arduous path of love?

Kafi-199

کروین ڈٹی مالولی

جڈاں جائمُ پا کر جھولی

“When I was born, my mother took me in her lap and sang the tune of moaning.”

She recounts her birth in the orbit of ontological love. Her mother took her in her lap and sang the tune (lullaby) of moaning symbolising suffering in the path of love.

پچھے ہوت بلوچ نہ رادھی
ہم بخت سڑی ڈکھ رولی

پہلوں پیٹ نہ پئی پومادی
میں مُٹھڑی جاون لادی

“I did not get love of my parents in the first instance and then my Balochi beloved did not remain true to me. I am the miserable one who is suffering wretchedly ever since birth.”

She feels herself miserable in suffering wretchedly since birth for being deprived of parental love in childhood and of being roughly treated by her beloved in maidenhood.

آجڑی جھوک وساوے
وس ہس رس کھیدوں ہولی

گھر فخر پیاپوں پاوے
رل چیز بہار سہاوے

“My beloved Fakhr may step in my house and enliven my deserted dwellings. We may enjoy the spring and celebrate holi with happiness.”

He desires that his spiritual master may step in his deserted house and start dwelling there. They may enjoy the season of spring and celebrate holi with happiness. The inward realisation of one's spiritual master is a vital stage in

the spiritual voyage. It facilitates the attainment of 'the Supreme Identity'.

تو نہیں درشن مول نہ پیساں تاں وی نازک نینہ نہ بھیاں
وچ کوٹ شہر مرویاں تھی درد لبردی گولی

"I will remain true to the sensitivities of my love in spite of never witnessing my beloved. I will become the maidservant of my beloved. I will die in the city of Kot."

He resolves to remain true to his tender love even if there were no possibility of his beloved's vision. He will remain completely subject to the will of his beloved and die at his altar.

سارا چولا بوچھن گھاگھے گئے زیور تریور لاگھے
سرماتگ مریندی سانگے تھئی سرخی زہر دی گولی

"My clothing has been worn out. My jewellery and apparel have gone in oblivion. The parting line of hair on my head is striking spears. My rouge is like a poisonous tablet."

The transcendence of the beloved is overbearing for him. The embellishments and ornamentations fade away into nothingness. The effects of nuptial happiness become source of torment.

بن یار نہ بیچ سہیاں بچھل سہرے تروڑ سٹیاں
بھن سینسر بول سٹیاں بٹھ چندن ہار نبولی

"I will never be happy on the bed of flowers without my beloved. I will pull down the flowers and chaplets and throw them away. I will commit my nose ornaments to flames. I don't care a fig for my spangled necklaces."

The transcendence of his beloved makes all things signifying nuptial happiness lose their meaning. The

passionate rejection of all these things implies the sole acceptance of the beloved. There is nothing beside the beloved, which is acceptable to him.

سیاں رَل مل مہنیں ڈیندیاں کھل ہاسے کس کریندیاں
ما بھینیں وین الیندیاں سس مارم سو سو بولی

“My youthful companions join together and rebuke me. They laugh at me and make me feel embarrassed. My mother and sisters give me maledictions. My mother in law hurls hundreds of insults at me.”

She faces animosity at the hands of her primary and secondary ties. Isn't she strengthened in facing rebukes, funs, embarrassments, maledictions and insults?

جند جلڑی جندڑی جھولی جتھ کرڑ کنڈ اسب سولی
ڈسے کمرے ریتڑ کولی ول درد چلائی گولی

“My life has been burnt and my spirit is restless. The thorny shrubs and thorns seem as gallows. The particles of soft sand seem gravels. My heart pain has shot a bullet.”

Love ravishes her embodied self. She is crushed by the onerous load of love.

ہر پل پل پیت پل دی سک سانول بارو چل دی
ہے ڑی روز ازل دی ایہا کو جھی کملی بھولی

“My love for Punnal is constant. I am desirous of my charming Barochal. I am ugly, naïve and simple belonging to you ever since the primordial day.”

She remains constant in love and desirous of her charming beloved in spite of pains and sufferings. She considers herself ugly, naïve and simple but merits a sense of belongingness to her friend since the primordial day.

سر سولیں سا نگ رسایا
گئی ناز نواز دی ٹولی

وَل یار فرید نہ آیا
سب ہار سنگار و ہایا

“Farid! My friend did not return to me. Heavy afflictions have fallen on my head. All my embellishments have fallen in oblivion. The times of my pride and elegance have ended.”

He misses the recurrent immanence of his transcendent friend, which weighs so heavily upon him. His embellishments fall in oblivion leading to the end of his pride and elegance. Isn't he stripped of his self-image in order to mirror the Divine Image in the mirror of his heart?

Kafi-200

جگ وہم خیال تے خوابے سب صورت نقش بر آبے

“The world is illusion, imagination and dream. All forms are marks on water.”

The sensible world around us is not-self, imagination and dream. Ordinary understanding considers the sensible world or phenomena as real and ends up in the ‘materialization’ and ‘solidification’ of the world whereas phenomenal ‘reality’ has no Being (wujud). ‘All men are asleep (in this world); only when they die, do they wake up’ (the Prophet). ‘The world is an illusion; it has no real existence. And this is what is meant by ‘imagination’ (khayal). For you just imagine that it (i.e., the world) is an autonomous reality quite different from and independent of the absolute Reality, while in truth it is nothing of the sort...Know that you yourself are an imagination. And everything that you perceive and say to your self, ‘this is not me,’ is also an imagination, so that the whole world of existence is imagination within imagination’. Does this metaphysical position lead us to say that since the world is dream, illusion and imagination therefore it is vain, groundless and false? The answer to this question is not in the affirmative. The world is not the Reality itself but it ‘vaguely and indistinctively reflects the latter on the level of imagination’. It is ‘a symbolic reflection of something truly real’. It is in other words, a symbolic representation of the Reality. All it needs is that we should interpret it in a proper way just as we usually interpret our dreams in order to get to the real state of affairs beyond the dream---symbols’. Man does not see in a dream the Reality itself but an ‘imaginal’ form of the Reality and by interpretation he has to take back

this symbol to its Origin. The real or absolute Reality, which is the Absolute ‘hides behind the veil of the phenomenal’ and the latter constitutes ‘a grand-scale net work of symbols, vaguely and obscurely pointing to that which lies beyond them.’ ‘Thus, the so-called, ‘reality’ is but a dream, but it is not a sheer illusion. It is a particular appearance of the absolute Reality, a particular form of its self-manifestation (tajalli). It is a dream having a metaphysical basis. ‘The world of being and becoming (kawn) is an imagination’, but ‘it is, in truth, Reality itself’. However, these forms and properties are not real in their own right but are manifestations of the Reality. Thus, ‘reality’ is not a subjective illusion, whim or caprice but is an ‘objective’ illusion. It ‘is an unreality standing on a firm ontological basis’. Aren’t all forms mere marks on water?

جے پیچھیں حال حقیقت سن سمجھ اُتے رکھ عبرت
جیویں بحر محیط ہے وحدت کل کثرت شکل حبابے

“If you ask about the state of reality, then listen, understand and take a note of the fact that the sea encompasses unity. All the multiplicity is bubble-faced.”

The essentiality of things is analogous to sea with bubble-faced multiplicity.

نہیں اصلوں اصل دوئی دا خود جان ہے نسل دوئی دا
گیا پھوکا نکل دوئی دا دل اوہی آب دا آئے

“Duality has no essential reality. Know yourself that duality is not everlasting. The airy duality vanishes. The water essentially remains the same water.”

Duality is not essentially real and thereby ephemeral. The airy duality of bubbles in the sea vanishes and there is the same water. The unreality of multiplicity is grounded in the reality of unity.

نہ کافی جان کفایہ نہ ہادی سمجھ ہدایہ
کر پرزے جلد و قایہ ایہا دل قرآن کتابے

“Do not consider ‘Kifaya’ (a book of jurisprudence) as sufficient. Do not consider ‘Hidaya’ (a book of jurisprudence) as the guide. Just tear to bits the pages of ‘Wiqaya’ (a book of jurisprudence). Our heart is the immanent Qur’an (corroborated by the earthly Qur’an).”

The spirit of the law takes precedence over the letter of the law; nay heart is the ‘immanent Qur’an’. Heart is attributed vision and ‘this corporeal centre gives access to, namely the centre of the soul, which itself is the gateway to a higher ‘heart’, namely the Spirit’. Sense perception and reason do give us knowledge of the visible aspects of Reality but are inherently limited in giving us a direct knowledge of the ultimate. They need to be supplemented by the perception of the heart.

ہے پر مگیان دی دلڑی ہے بید پُران دی دلڑی
ہے جان جہان دی دلڑی دل بطن بطون داباے

“Heart is love and gnosis. Heart is the essence of life as portrayed in Hindu Scriptures: Vedas and Puranas. Heart is the artery of the universe. Heart opens to infinite depths of interiority.”

The metaphysical and traditional understanding of the Intellect or the Spirit points out to heart, which is the source of love and gnosis. It is the seat of intellectual intuition. Hindu Scriptures have also brought out the structural and functional aspects of heart in the attainment of knowledge and its realisation. Heart stands for interiority, which is the essence of Man.

دل لب ہے کون مکاں دا دل غایت اصل جہاں دا
دل مرکز زمین زماں دا بیا کوڑ پلاں تجاے

“Heart is the quintessence of the universe. Heart is the *raison d’etre* of creation. Heart is the centre of the heavens and the earth. All else is false, deceptive and veiled.”

The Reality reveals itself on human heart. It contemplates itself in the mirror of heart. The negation of heart-knowledge or heart-perception is nothing less than falsity, deception and veiling.

وچ معنے دے لکوتی	وچ صورت دے ناسوتی
دل اندر سب اسبابے	جبروت اتے لاہوتی

“It is terrestrial in form. It is celestial in meaning. It is omnipotent and beyond space and time. All possibilities of knowledge inhere in the heart.”

Heart is man’s intellectual essence wherein all the possibilities, which are unfolded in the world, are contained in it. Knowledge is innate. It also marks the threshold of the Beyond by being as isthmus of Heavens and the earth. And it is in it that man meets God.

سٹ سلھنی پیر مُریدی	رکھ انتر دھیان فریدی
جی نکھرٹیں کان عذابے	ہے دوری سخت بعیدی

“Farid! Meditate within the infinite depths of your own being. Leave aside the empty profession of becoming a spiritual master and having disciples. Distancing (from concentrating on one’s heart) is being greatly remote (from one’s destination). It is a curse to lead a life of comforts (for it makes one oblivious of his basic vocation).”

The Faridi tradition is to delve deep within one’s being. One has to discard mere formalism even in spiritual life. Forgetfulness in concentrating on one’s heart distances one from inwardness. A life of worldliness is a curse.

Kafi-201

چندڑی اُچا کے جیڑا اُداسے جا پے تنی کوں کیندی پیاسے

“My life has become empty and I am sad. I am the inept one who is thirsty of God knows what?”

The sad feeling of being an outsider to everydayness of her existence makes her question her insatiable quest.

پیکیں سور مجھیں گڑے ویکھو ہے ڈیندی مٹھی نوں مابھین ڈو ہے
قسمت دیاں گا، لہیں دلبروی درو ہے ایڈوں گیوسے اوڈوں گیا سے

“There are complaints and accusations against me in my own house and in my in-laws. I am the hapless one whom my mother and sisters censure. It is my destiny that my beloved is unfaithful. I have lost on both sides.”

She faces hostility of her primary and secondary relationships. She is destined to face the unfaithful behaviour of her beloved. She considers to have lost love on both sides.

تھئی آس پاسے آئی یاس پاسے زربفت ڈورے لمل تے خاصے
کھنڈڑیاں نباتاں مصریاں پتا سے کچڑے اوڈا ہے کوڑے دلا سے

“My hopes have gone far away and despair has come near me. My costly garments and sweets have lost their significance. They are just imaginary things and false consolations.”

Hope of vision and union with the beloved recedes far away by her being thrown in the situation of despair. The precious and sweet things of life are ephemeral. They are

devoid of reality and merely give psychological satisfactions. The real significance of things lies in unison with the beloved.

لکھڑی متھے دی پلڑے پیا سے وہ واہ خدا دے کم بے قیا سے
جیرھیں کوں منہ وی لیندے نہ ہا سے مل مل کریندیاں کھل ٹوک با سے

“The writings on my forehead (my destiny) have fallen to my lot. I laud the ways of God that are beyond human understanding. Those people whom I considered of no significance have now joined together and are scorning, sneering and laughing at me.”

She realises that it is her destiny, which unfolds itself in the vicissitudes of time. The laws of things or the ways of God are beyond human comprehension. People whom she considered insignificant have ganged up to scorn, sneer and laugh at her. The process of attaining consciousness of her ontological nothingness divests her of her individual and social self. It shatters her self-image. The fabric of her being is torn asunder. It is from the ruins of her self that she sees ‘door in the wall.’ Now, she is incapacitated, thinned and straightened like a thread, which passes so easily through the eye of the needle. How could it be otherwise?

منہ ویڑھ ٹھڈ ہڑے پئی ساہ بھر دی ویندی نبھائی ڈینہو ڈینہہ نجر دی
چس رس نہ مانیم گھر دی نہ وردی ہک پل نہ ڈترم سکھ سچ پاسے

“I hide my face and heave sighs of grief. I am becoming enervated each day but still I am true to my love. It is a matter of great concern that I have neither found peace in my house nor found conjugal happiness. I did not get a moment of peace in my nuptial bed.”

She experiences immense suffering. She finds neither domestic peace nor conjugal happiness. The nuptial bed symbolising marital happiness ceases to be peaceful for her. However, in spite of all adversities, she remains true to love.

She does not abandon the path of love in face of terrible blows. Aren't these blows instrumental in blowing the spirit of love in the heart of the lover?

برہوں بچھیندا لکھ لکھ بلائیں تھی تھی ڈکھاری منگدی دعائیں
شالا کہیںدیاں یارب کڈا ہیں دیداں نہ اکٹن و لڑی نہ پھاسے

“Love inflicts countless calamities on me. I keep on praying in the state of suffering. I pray to God that the eyes may never contract love and the heart may never be hunted in the sanctuary of love.”

Love paves her path with countless adversities. She being engulfed in the pool of suffering prays that no one may fall in love and no heart may be ensnared by such a wild passion. Doesn't these warnings of love fall on deaf ears? Hasn't Intellect been forthright in not paying any heed to the cry of reason? Isn't it better to have loved and lost than not to have loved at all?

سانول سلونا مارو مرید نکھر پانہ ڈٹھڑس کوئی وقت ویلھا
سُرخی ڈوہاگن کجلہ ڈوہیلا گل گیا فرید اجو بن نراسے

“My charming and enchanting beloved did not appreciate the moment of separation. My reddening of lips is a misfortune and my collyrium has become sombre for me. Farid! I could not enjoy my youthfulness that has just gone wasted.”

He complains that his charming and enchanted beloved chose to assume transcendence without understanding its adverse affects on him. He narrates his misfortune and sombreness in the absence of his friend. He finds his youth rotten and wasted without affecting union with his beloved.

Kafi-202

جھوپڑ جوڑوں چک کھپتے اسجھاں نہ ہووے سارے ڈتے

“I will build a hut after cleaning the ground from the desert grass and shrubs. It will have no parallel in any habitation.”

It is unique and matchless dwelling within one's heart after cleansing it from otherness.

نہ وکڑے نہ بندتے بہاں نہ گٹھ پاڑوی کھڈتے

“I will not choose water-storing fields, dams, roots of plants and ditches for building a durable hut.”

The durable dwelling has to be free from imperfections of the self.

سانوں آن سوہیاں روہی سندھڑوں سکھری لڈتے

“I will dwell in the lovely deserts during the rainy season. I will shift from Sindh with my bag and baggage.”

He likes to dwell in the desert of his self during the times of heavenly blessings by transforming his outwardness into inwardness.

جے پانی کھٹ ویسی بہسوں ڈھائے تے کل اڈتے

“If there is shortage of water in the desert, then we will have our temporary dwellings on the ends of the desert.”

The desert of the self is watered by the Self, which enlivens everything. The lover envisages the possibility of having his provisional dwelling at the end of the desert,

anxiously awaiting heavenly blessings. It symbolises search of transcendence.

شہر بھنبھوری کھاؤں اوسم ہوت نہ جاویں 'تے

“The city of Bhambore will haunt me. My beloved!
Do not desert me.”

She entreats her beloved not to assume transcendence (understood by the lover as desertion) since it will be so haunting for her self.

تیغ فرید برہوں دی ویہہ گئی چم چم تے ہڈ ہڈ تے

“Farid! The sword of love has very aptly cut my flesh
and bones.”

The sword of love, in the hands of the beloved, perfectly pierces his flesh and bones. He cannot extricate himself from the tightening grip of love. How great!

Kafi-203

جوسی توں پوتھی پھول وے و سسی کڈاں سوہنا کول وے

“Fortune teller! Open the book, oh. Let me know when my beloved will come and dwell with me, oh.”

She asks the fortune teller to omen the timings of her beloved's return and his dwelling with her. The ordinary and rational ways of thinking offer her no knowledge in the state of distress. She prefers the omens of the fortune teller as against the dry logic of a logician and the barren reasoning of a philosopher. Her going to the fortune teller for getting omen or augury is a form of rebellion against rationality and other allied forms of thinking. What is the use of knowledge if it does not provide gnosis?

رورو تھکی پٹ پٹ ہٹی کیڈے ویساں ڈکھڑیں کٹھی
سولاں لٹی درداں مٹھی ماہی پنل گیم رول وے

“I have become tired by constant weeping and have weakened by mourning. Where should the one go, which is butchered by sufferings? I have been looted by afflictions and made miserable by pains. My beloved Punnaal has gone away leaving me in a wretched state, oh.”

The transcendence of her beloved leaves her in a wretched state. She faces pains and sufferings in search of her beloved. Isn't the weakening of the embodied self a positive sign in path of love?

پاندھی پنچھاں واٹیں تکاں ستر ستر بھجاں بھج بھج پکاں
ٹر ٹر بھجاں بھج بھج تھکاں سنج بر لایم ڈھول وے

“I ask the way from the travellers and keep on looking at different tracks. I walk on burning sand and am grilled by scorching heat. I walk and run and by running I get exhausted. My beloved has made me wretchedly wander in wilderness, oh.”

No traveller or track can give any clue to her beloved's transcendence. She wretchedly wanders in wilderness in its search. She may have to deplorably wait for a life-time and then even may not succeed. There is no casual nexus between the seeker and the sought. The mystery of love deepens with the passage of time.

دکھ اڑ گیا نیکھ لڑ گیا
سو جھول لکھ لکھ چھول وے
چیرا غماں وچ وڑ گیا
دریا غضب دا چڑھ گیا

“My self has entered the realm of sorrows. Suffering has entangled me and peace has turned into my enemy. The river of wrath is in fullness with hundreds of waves and hundred thousands of whirlpools, oh.”

Her self faces sorrows. It suffers to see peace that was once his bosom friend now turned into his deadliest enemy. The full river of wrath (transcendence) mounts with hundreds of waves and creates hundred thousands of whirlpools. She finds herself drowning in the sea of love in search of transcendence.

دردوں نہ تھیوم دل جدا
جندڑی گھتاں میں گھول وے
سک ساتھ سانول دی سدا
شالا پنل میلیم خدا

“The longing of my friend is always with me. My heart is never separate from pains. I pray to God to unite me with my Punnaal. I am ready to sacrifice my life for his sake, oh.”

She constantly longs for her beloved. Her heart experiences constant pains at the separation and disunion. She invokes Divine Grace, in order to transcend servant-Lord

axis, and get united with her beloved for whom she is readily available to sacrifice her life.

زاهدوٹا، ہن جول وے برہوں چپولا بول وے
پتری پر م دی کھول وے دلڑی اساڈڑی چول وے

“Ascetic! Relocate your style, oh. Discourse with loving, oh. Open the book of the love, oh. Awake the higher consciousness of unity within my heart, oh.”

She counsels the ascetic to change his style of piety and learn from the book of love. The art of loving consists in awakening the higher consciousness of unity lying in the infinite depths of one’s being.

ڈکھانینہ انوکھاراز وے تناسوز دے ہتھ ساز وے
موٹھی دھانہ فرید آواز وے ہو ہو ملامت دول وے

“Love impregnated with suffering is a strange mystery, oh. The instrument is in the hands of the inept passion, oh. Farid! I am imploring in a hapless voice, oh. It is bringing me trumpeted infamy and reproach, oh.”

Suffering in love is a strange mystery. The inept passion of love is instrumental in making him undergo heightened suffering. He implores in a hapless voice that love has brought him infamy and reproach. Aren’t sufferings in love meaningful in making him worthy of love in the eyes of his beloved?

Kafi-204

چوڑے بیڑے کینویں پانواں (ڑی پانواں) میڈا یار گیا ملہیرتے

“My youthful companion! Why should I ornament myself? My friend has gone away to Malheer.”

She shares with her youthful companion the fact of not ornamenting herself during the transcendence of her beloved.

ڈے کر کوڑیاں آس امیدیں تھوڑے چاڑھ ڈکھانواں (ڑی ڈکھانواں)
ہیں ڈکھڑے دل دلیگرتے

“I give false hopes and expectations. I oblige my sufferings and aggrieved heart.”

She gives false hopes and expectations of her beloved's return or a message from him, in order to solace her suffering and aggrieved heart.

گئے برباد لکھو لکھ وعدے ہن کیوں پھٹکی کھانواں (ڑی کھانواں)
کھوٹے توں ویری بے پیرتے

“All the countless commitments have been falsified. Now, why should I be deceived by the one who is a counterfeit, adversary and unruly?”

She boldly declares that her beloved has not honoured his countless commitments with her. She resolves not to trust the one who is counterfeit, adversary and unruly. The lover and the beloved are poised differently on the spectrum of love. She accuses her beloved in the spirit of sincerity and rightness. Her perception is absolute but is essentially relative from the universal point of view. The beloved, in his all

mightiness and wisdom, desires the lover to exercise patience in adversity during transcendence in order to realise union.

رات بجزردی رتڑوں روواں رتڑیاں مِرچاں لاناواں (ڑی لاناواں)
تقی سو من ہک ہک چیرتے

“I cry intensely in this night of disunion. I am the inept one who applies hundreds maunds of red chillies on my each and every wound.”

She cries intensely during the period of disunion. She intensifies her pain by heightening the consciousness of her separation from her beloved. Doesn't suffering intensify love?

صدقے صدقے اُولے گھولے واری واری جاناواں (ڑی جاناواں)
مِٹھی قاصد دی تقریرتے

“I sacrifice my self many a times over the sweet discourse of the messenger.”

She becomes immensely happy with the messenger for bringing sweet message of union. The inward discourse with the beloved ushers in vision and union.

یار نہ آوے کچھ نہ بھاوے بھینیں نوں نت تاناواں (ڑی تاناواں)
تھیواں کاوڑا پُویرتے

“My friend does not come and nothing seems meaningful to me. I keep my sisters fiery and remain angry with my parents and brothers.”

There is nothing meaningful for her during transcendence of her beloved. Her behaviour creates animosity with her near and dear ones. The natural communication with her parents and siblings breaks down with bad taste.

کھیڑیں بھیریں دے ہتھ آئی جیں ڈینہہ لدھیل لاناواں (ڑی لاناواں)
ڈوڑی ترپوڑی سختی ہیرتے

“There are double and triple oppressions on Heer ever since she came in the hands of the despicable ‘Kheras’ through the rite of marriage.”

She undergoes awful oppression at the hands of forces inimical to love.

اَو کھیں سو کھیں مُول نہ پھر سہاں کیوں نینہ فرید لجانواں (ڑی لجانواں)
مُٹھی کل کم رکھ تقدیر تے

“I will never renounce my love in situations of hardship or ease. Farid! Why should I dishonour my love? O’ hapless one! Leave all activities in the hands of destiny.”

He resolves never to renounce his love even in varied circumstances for the renouncing of love tantamount to dishonouring it. He is an instrument in the hands of Providence, and he wants his destiny to unfold itself on the spectrum of time. Love does not teach passivity but it does teach receptivity, which consists in identifying oneself with the law of things. Destiny of love (measures of love) is the inner reach of love. It is not imposed, as if, from the outside. It is inherently ingrained in the nature of love. Metaphysically speaking, the one who acts in consonance with the law of love ultimately transcends the contingent domain of action and reaches the universal realm of nonaction.

Kafi-205

درد پئے ول پیٹے ڈتڑے یار رنجھٹے

“Well, pain has fallen to my lot that has been bestowed upon me by my friend Ranjha.”

Pain falls to her lot. She is bestowed the pain of love by her beloved.

میں بیٹھیں گئی عمر نہ آئے لائیں لہن دے نیٹے

“It is since long that I have been in a state to get readily married. But the moments to accomplish my nuptial rites have not ushered in.”

She contracts love and awaits final union with her beloved. The period of anxiously awaiting crushes her soul by becoming so overbearing.

ہتھڑیں پیریں غم دے گانے سر سولاندے ریٹے

“The colourful threads of sorrow are around my hands and feet. My head is covered with the colourful shawl of afflictions.”

The colourful threads of marriage rite signifying happiness and expansion become the source of sorrows and constrictions. The colourful shawl, worn as head covering or around shoulders to accomplish a marriage rite, turns into a covering of afflictions.

سینگیں سرتیں لگڑے جھگڑے سکڑیں سورہیں پھٹے

“There have been brawls with my youthful companions. I have developed contradictions with my blood relationships and in-laws.”

Her primary and secondary ties become a noose around her neck. The very relationships, which stand for peace, become so warlike. Isn't it a natural consequence of loving the beloved in wholesomeness?

سانول آوے آگل لاوے سبجوں سبجھیں لیٹے

“I wish that my beloved comes and embraces me and lies on the nuptial bed with an inner yearning.”

She yearns for her beloved to unveil himself and realise union.

دلڑے سوسوز خم کلڑے سینے سخت چپٹے

“My heart has hundreds of unintelligible wounds. My chest has been severely hurt at different places.”

She has to bear intricacies of love, which are beyond the ken of reason.

یار فرید سنبھالم جیندیں رب ڈکھ ڈکھڑے میٹے

“Farid! My friend may take care of me during my lifetime. My Sustainer may free me from sufferings.”

He desperately wants his beloved to take care of him well in time. He prays to the Sustainer to free him from the sufferings of separation and disunion, by affecting union with his beloved, by virtue of Divine Grace.

Kafi-206

دلڑی دردوں ٹوٹے ٹوٹے پُزے پُزے ڈڑے دودڑے

“My heart by virtue of sufferings has broken into bits and pieces.”

His heart is crushed by the pain of love.

عشوے غمِ ناز نہورے نخرے نخرے زورے تورے

خون کریندے ذرے دودڑے

“The amorous glances, enticements, pride, coquetries, blandishments, disdainful airs and radiant might are butchering me intermittently (ravishing the lover).”

The bewitching beauty and ways of the beloved ravish him now and then. He cannot build any defence against the perpetual onslaughts of his friend.

آپے اپنا سوہاں کیتو آپے اپنی جاتے نیتو

ہن کیوں تھیدیں پرے دودڑے

“You yourself acquainted with me. You took me to your abode. Now, why do you remain far from me?”

He is at a loss to understand the transcendence of his beloved who, in the first instance, familiarised with him in immanence. Isn't love a game of transcendence and immanence?

گوڑھے نین تے زلفاں کالیاں سوہنیاں رمزاں موہنیاں چالیاں

جیں بن مول نہ سرے دوسرے

“You have shining eyes, long black hair, lovely expressions and enchanting moves without, which I can't spend my life.”

He becomes completely enchanted by the lovely expressions of his beautiful beloved that he cannot live without them.

پل پل تیرنگہ دے پھلڑے ول ول پیچی زلف دے ولڑے
بیوس کینویں کرے دو کرے

“The pointed arrows of your eyes are striking me at each and every moment. There are involving intricate locks of your hair. What should the helpless do?”

He becomes powerless in face of the radiant might of his beloved's intricate and striking beauty.

مُونجھ مونجھاری درد اندیشے ڈینہاں رات فرید دے پیشے
ہجروں جندڑی ڈرے ووڈرے

“The constant vocation of Farid is to bear anguishes, pains and anxieties. His life fears disunion.”

He fears the transcendence of his beloved, which makes him constantly bear anguishes, pains and anxieties. Isn't the road to union characterised by the milestones of disunion?

Kafi-207

دلڑی نہانی کوں روز منجھاری گہیا ڈھولایا رازاری

“My modest heart is daily experiencing anguish. My friend has left me in distress.”

He regularly experiences anguish. The transcendence of his friend leaves him in distressful situation.

عشق نہیں کئی نار غضب دی سڑدی جلدی جان و چاری

“It is not love but a devastating fire in, which my pathetic soul is flaming and burning.”

The devastating fire of love flames and burns his poor soul.

عاشق پھر دے مست موالی سر قربان کرن لکھ واری

“The enraptured lovers wander, care free. They sacrifice their heads countless times.”

The lovers enraptured by love spend their lives in the spirit of care freeness. They sacrifice everything for the sake of their beloveds.

درد اندوہ تے سول ہزاراں لا کر یاری یار و ساری

“He contracted friendship and has forgotten his friend. There are pain, grief and thousands of afflictions.”

He faces pains, grief and afflictions during the transcendence of his beloved. He suffers in thinking that his friend after contracting friendship has become oblivious of him.

صید کریندے مرغ دلیں دے ناز واداہن باز شکاری

“The prides and style of my beloved are like the hunting falcons. They hunt the birds of my heart.”

The prideful style of the beloved hunts his heart. How could birds escape the eye of the hunting falcons? Love has no defence against the bewitchment of beauty.

چشماں شوخ بہادر جنگی پلکاں دھر دیاں دست کٹاری

“The sprightly eyes are courageous and martial. The eyelids have dagger in their hands.”

The beautiful eyes of the enchanting beloved pierce his being.

جند فرید بچے ہن کیوں نیناں خدنگ چلائی کاری

“Farid! How could my life be saved? The eyes have shot perfect arrows.”

The captivating beauty of the beloved is so perfect in arousing love in his heart that he finds no refuge except in his beloved.

Kafi-208

دلیں تے دیدل سونہل بٹیرے ہر دم وسیں پیا توں ساڈے نیڑے

“My lovely friend! My eyes and heart are your dwellings. You may always live near me.”

Her eyes and heart signifying vision and union are the abodes of her beloved. She desires permanent immanence of her beloved.

سینگیاں سرتیاں حق ہمسائے گلڑے کرن دکھوئے
مایو ویرن بھین بھنیجیاں جڑ جڑ لانون جھیڑے

“My youthful companions, friends and nearby neighbours complain and accuse me. My parents, brothers, sisters and nieces are picking up sharp brawls with me.”

She faces indictment of love at the hands of her near and dear ones. The consciousness of love is essentially higher than ordinary consciousness, which makes her face the antagonistic contradictions of society.

جگتاں مارن پیکے پتنے ہاسے کرن سورجے
اٹھدیں ہندیں ٹردیں پھر دیں سس ننان کہیڑے

“My own housemates laugh at me. My in-laws make fun of me. My mother-in-law and my sister-in-law provoke me every now and then.”

She faces ridicule and provocations for the sake of her beloved. The society imposes levelling process, which fails to level her down since she experiences consciousness of love. The individuals with higher consciousness are generally at the

mercy of average people. They have to pay heavy price for awakening before time. But it is the sacrifice of such individuals, which ultimately raises the societal consciousness both at the horizontal and vertical levels.

چوچک چاک % اتوں مالک سر سرواہ دا وارث
منجھیاں % یاں جھوکاں % یاں کوڑے چھوڑ کھیرے

“Choochak is your servant and you are the master. You are the custodian of my honour. Herd and dwellings belong to you. Leave aside meaningless incongruities.”

Heer considers her father Choochak as servant of her beloved master. He is the custodian of her honour. He is the shepherd of her heart. She wants him to leave aside meaningless incongruities (transcendence) for the sake of her sincere, absolute and committed love.

کون ہے قاضی رشوت راضی کون سیال تے کھیرے
باجھ خدا دے جھگڑے جھیرے ساڈے کون نہیرے

“What about the judge who is satisfied by taking a bribe? Who is Sial (the family of Heer) and Kheras (the family of Ranjha)? Who can resolve our wrangling and brawls without God?”

She refers to the forced marriage of Heer, which was illegally solemnised by the cleric after taking a paltry sum, which led to contradictions between the two families. How could love be imposed, which only sprouts in pure freedom? There cannot be false or imposed union. It is the Divine Grace, which affects real union between the lover and the beloved.

ڈوں ڈینہیں دے ناحق دعوے اوڑک ناحق تھیندے
رانجھن تے میں ہس رس و سسوں سڑ سڑ مر سن کھیرے

“These are momentary false claims. They will ultimately prove false. Ranjhan and I will happily pass our lives and the ‘Kheras’ will keep dying with jealousy.”

She declares the falsity of the ephemeral claims in the same vein, which will ultimately prove to be groundless. She will unite with her beloved by leaving her adversaries in state of ‘green eyed’ jealousy. She sends a message to the adversaries of love to desist from opposing love, which has ultimately to succeed leaving them defeated disgracefully.

جو جو لیکھ متھے دے آہے
جنڈی چھٹن فرید ہے مشکل
آخر وہ بلیو سے
ویڑھیا عشق اوپرے

“I got what was written on my forehead (destined for me). Farid! It is very difficult to extricate my life from the peculiar love that has encompassed my being.”

He does not consider his love as accidental or coincidental. It is a trans-historical phenomenon. It does take place in the temporal world but it is rooted in the eternal. It is a pre-eternal Covenant (alasti) between him as lover and his beloved. The destiny of love refers to the primordial love. He has to face the dynamics of love. He has no escape from intricate ontological love, which is constitutive of his being.

Kafi-209

دلے دارم بے آوارہ طبعے وحشت آرائے
برہوں بارے بروچل دے بیاباں دشت رلوائے

“I have a rover heart and wild temperament. The love of my Brochal (beloved) has made me wretched in the forests and the deserts.”

His primordial nature attracts him to his beloved. It makes him pass through the process of wilderness.

کیہاں غمدیاں کیہاں باتیں ڈکھی ہم دل ڈینہاں راتیں
خدارا حال زارم ہیں کہ بے وسستم و بے پائے

“What tales of sorrows should I narrate for my heart is suffering day and night? Do notice for God’s sake my distressful state of utter helplessness.”

He constantly faces inexplicable sorrows and sufferings in the state of separation and disunion from his beloved. He beseeches his beloved to unite with him, by virtue of Divine Grace.

بماطالع شدہ پر کیس نزارم بے دل و غمگیں
نہ پندار یار ہے جھاتی اجن ڈکھڑے نہ پاندائے

“The star of my fate has become inimical to me and I have become distressed in the state of melancholy. My friend does not cast a glance at me and my sufferings do not end.”

He feels that he is not fortunate in love. He is distressed in the state of melancholy. His beloved is not responsive in love,

which perpetuates his sufferings. The unresponsiveness of the beloved is a form of transcendence. Every lover is uniquely poised in facing transcendence of his beloved. He has to accept the black night of transcendence, in his own way, in order to experience the bright day of immanence. The law of things is permanent, absolute and universal. How could one impose dawn on midnight?

سجّن وس رس ڈکھایم چس سورجی پیکڑیں بس بس
دل دیوانہ باہر کس ندر دیکھ پر وائے

“My beloved dwelled with me and gave me such a taste that I have forgotten my in laws and housemates. My frantic heart has no concern with otherness.”

The taste of love makes all other tastes fall in oblivion. His frantic heart has no concern with his primary and secondary ties. Religiosity makes fruitless efforts in transforming man. How one could be transformed without love. The spiritual dimension of religion gives primacy to contracting love. Doesn't, then love takes care of everything else. It is the taste of love, which works wonders and miracles in distancing the lover from all tastes of otherness. It is for the religiosity to understand that Man cannot cease to taste otherness, until and unless he tastes love.

ہمیشہ مونجھ وادھی ہے سنجی سختی زیادہ ہے
سدا سولاندی شادی ہے میں اپنے بخت آزمائے

“My anguish is always on the increase and the damned hardship is exceedingly great. The afflictions are happily mounting in togetherness and I have tested my fate.”

He faces tremendous hardship of increasing anguish. The afflictions are happy in subjecting him to pains. Destiny has always bestowed misfortunes on him.

ڈیہاں ڈوڑی خرابی ہے قلق ہے اضطرابی ہے

تماشاں جی عذابی ہے نہ آپ آئے نہ بلوائے

“There is acute worsening (of my state) at daytime with grief and uneasiness. I bear torments in the evening and neither my friend comes to meet me nor does he call me.”

His embodied self remains highly deplorable in the state of grief and uneasiness during the whole day. He faces torments in the evening. He is bereft of vision and union of his beloved.

ز عشق عارض رنگیں چولالہ داغ ہادیریں

کیتیاں ہن دل اندر جاہیں کڈیں رب یار ملوائے

“The old marks like a tulip have found a place in my heart due to my love of red cheeks. God will sometimes make me unite with my friend.”

His heart places his beloved in the inmost chamber of his being. He is hopeful of uniting with his beloved, by the Grace of God. The light of hope keeps shining in his heart even during the pitch dark night of transcendence. Hope vitally links him with his beloved during these testing times. The end of hope is the end of love.

بغیر از من کرا شاید فرید ایں مر مر اباید

ڈکھ پینڈے تے تھکھ سجد میں ماخس تے چھ سائے

“Farid! Who is fit and capable except me to bear sorrowful journey replete with arduous paths, sufferings, man eaters, giants, bears and evil spirits?”

He testifies his strength in remaining steadfast, while facing inner and outer adversities in the path of love. A weak person can hate but cannot love. Love requires special strength of the spirit. All people, in principle, have the possibility of love but very few realise it.

Kafi-210

دل دم دم درمندی ہے سک ڈٹھڑیں باجھ نہ لہندی ہے

“My heart is weary due to pain at each and every moment. My desire is not satiated unless I see him (my beloved).”

Her heart is weary due to constant pain. Her desire remains insatiable without vision of her beloved.

ہجردیاں گزریاں ڈکھیاں راتیں مایہ خویش نہ پہنچدے باتیں
سینگیاں سرتیاں لہن نہ تاتیں مٹھڑی پئی تڑپھاندی ہے

“The nights of disunion have been spent in suffering. My parents and relatives do not discourse with me. My same age friends do not enquire about my welfare. I am the miserable one who is in a state of restlessness.”

She suffers during the nights of disunion. Her near and dear ones have broken channels of communication with her. Her friends do not share with her. She faces misery and restlessness.

چاک ہمیں دامن نوں بھاناں بھل گیا سارا راج بھاناں
گھولاں تیجے تے تول وہاناں بیٹ دی ریت سوہاندی ہے

“The shepherd of the herd became appealing to my heart. I forgot all the regal status of my parents. I sacrifice my nuptial bed and a nuptial quilt. The sand of desert seems so pleasant to me.”

Heer fell in love with Ranjha. Her entire regality fell into oblivion. The sand of the river bed seems pleasant to her as

against the nuptial bed and nuptial quilt, which have no meaning without her beloved.

دل نوں جس نے جادو کیتا رانجھن جوگی میرا بیتا
رگ رگ مول نہ واندی ہے عشق تہیں دالوں لوں سیتا

“Ranjhan Yogi is my friend. He has bewitched my heart. His love has knit the whole fabric of my being. There is not even a single vein that has not been knitted.”

She contracts friendship with her beloved, who has bewitched her heart. Love knits the fabric of her being without leaving a single thread out. Love is absolute and wholesome, which leaves no room of otherness. Love is not a relative concern. It is the ultimate concern permeating relative concerns. The unity of love is reflected in the world of multiplicity.

ساڑاں جھنگ تے شہر گھیا ناں بھانہ یار دامن نوں بھاناں
چنڈڑی جھوک غماں دی ہے پامسکینی سٹساں ماناں

“The cowshed of my friend appeals to me. I torch Jhang and the city of Maghiana. I will attain lowliness and cast away my pride. My life is the abode of sorrows.”

Heer prefers the cowshed of her friend to her royal mansions and abodes. She shuns her pride and attains lowliness, instead. Life is love and thereby abode of sorrows. Love embraces lowliness at the expense of outward royalty. But this lowliness is inward royalty, which cannot be matched even by the whole treasures of mankind. The one who loves the king solely for his sake is not bothered by his treasures. Religiosity makes its votaries merely concentrate on the treasures of the king. Spirituality opens the possibility of loving the king purely for his own sake.

گدڑیا ویہلہ ہسن لھلھن دا آیا وقت فرید چلن دا
اوکھا پینڈا دوست ملن دا جان لباباں تے آندی ہے

“The times of playfulness have ended. Farid! The time has come to depart (from the terrestrial world). The path of uniting with my beloved has been so arduous. I am just breathing my last.”

He recounts initial playfulness of love with his beloved, while departing from the terrestrial world. The subsequent path of realising union with his beloved had been very arduous since it was characterised by separations and disunions. The adversities of love notwithstanding, he gives the final message of hope in realising friendly union.

Kafi-211

دم مست قلندر مست قلندر مست و مست استی

“The enraptured qalandars are in ecstasy. They are deeply drowned in the reality of the pre-eternal covenant.”

The qalandars are enraptured and in the higher state of ecstasy. They are lost in the reality of the pre-eternal covenant (alasti). They are drowned in the infinite depths of love.

نفس مقدس اہل سعادت علم عمل و بچ رکھن سیادت
اکروردتے زہد عبادت نیت کردے درد پرستی

“They are the sacred selves. They are the people of virtue who keep heights in knowledge and action. They transcend daily recitals, asceticism and worship. They are drowned in the reality of love.”

They are sacred and virtuous. They integrate knowledge and action. They transcend the realm of rituals. They are immersed in the reality of love.

صاف مبرا غیر خیالوں پاک عیالوں آلوں مالوں
راخ وجدوں ذوقوں حالوں وہ وہ مستیں دی مستی

“They are purely clean from the thought of otherness. They are free from a household, family and wealth. They are grounded in ecstasy, tasting and witnessing. Laudation to those who experiences such ecstatic enraptures.”

They witness ‘God Everywhere’ and are thus pure from the thought of otherness. Their absolute concentration on the

Real makes them detached from their households, families and wealth. Their spirituality is at such heights that they have direct experiences of the ultimate Reality, which plunges them in ecstasies. They deserve laudation in undergoing ecstatic ruptures.

ازل ابد ہک جانن واقف لعنت رحمت سمجھن عارف
سمجھن مکاشف محض مرادف کیا بالائی کیا پستی

“They are familiar and knowledgeable from the primordial day to eternity. The gnostics understand a curse as blessing. They recognize illuminations as everyday happenings belonging to the higher or the lower realms.”

They understand the dynamics of time and eternity. The gnostics perceive curse as blessing at its roots. It is in the process of manifestation that blessing itself is polarised in the form of blessing and curse. Curse is privation and ultimately it returns to its source in mercy or blessing. They are constantly in touch with the source of illuminations without measuring the higher or lower degrees of these illuminations.

جے توں چاہیں قرب حقیقی ورثہ علوی تے صدیقی
ریت جیندی رسم شفقتی بٹھ ہستی وٹ ہستی

“If you are seeking real proximity and the inheritance of Ali and Abu Bakr and the tradition of Junayd Baghdadi and Shaiq Balkhi, then negate your being (become consciousness of your ontological nothingness) and let the Being shone itself through your nothingness.”

The real proximity can be attained by following the Sufi tradition of becoming conscious of one's ontological nothingness and letting the Being itself shine through one's mirror of nothingness. It is metaphysically understood as the stage of Self-realisation. The difficulty in understanding the

metaphysical concept of real proximity arises due to the rational attempt of capturing it in the net of spatial categories. Metaphysics teaches us that the concept of real proximity is not spatial. The proximity of the Absolute and its shadow; the Essence and the Divinity; Allah and His Attributes; Ahad and Wahid and transcendence and immanence is non-spatial and unquantifiable. Likewise, the proximity between nothingness (man) and Being (God) is neither spatial nor quantifiable. It is purely non-spatial and qualitative beyond the ken of rationality. The Reality is nearer to man than man is to himself. Here, the question of spatial proximity between man and God does not arise. There is no space intervening between man and God. Nothingness is no thing. How could it be some thing with Him? If it were so, then it is polytheism or placing divinity beside Allah. Reason has no access to the realms beyond the manifest. It is the Intellect, which apprehends the metaphysical notion of non-spatial and qualitative proximity. Unfortunately, it has been the spatial approach to proximity blown out of proportion, which has created the problem of pantheism, unknown in pure or traditional metaphysics. Real proximity means union of the lover and the beloved or 'the supreme identity.'

سٹ صحبت رکھ خلت عزلت موت ارادی توں پانزہت
جے سر ڈیسیں ہی بے شبہت اتھ سودا دست بدستی

“Leave worldliness and have solitude by maintaining a respectable distance from things and events. Die to your self before dying. If you sacrifice your head, then doubtlessly you will reap the benefit.”

One has not to immerse himself in the world. He has to leave worldly attachments. He has to delve deep within the

infinite depths of his being or consciousness. He has to die to his self before dying by attaining consciousness of his ontological nothingness. Once he attains this consciousness he will find the Reality there and then.

سنو پریتا حال فریدی	مذہب ملت ہس توحیدی
میل کچلا شکل جریدی	خوش و سدا پر م دی وستی

“My friend! Listen about the condition of Farid. His religious tradition is that of unity. He is shabbily dressed with a frenzied face. He happily dwells in the City of Love.”

The religious tradition of Farid is contemplative tawhid (unity in diversity). His shabby appearance and frenzied face reflects his happy dwelling in the inward city of love.

Kafi-212

دن رین دل حیران ہے آسائش نہ پامیم کھڑی
سر ٹکڑے ٹکڑے ہو گیا تن من جلیالوں لوں سڑی

“My heart is surprised day and night. I did not get peace even for a moment. My head has been smashed into pieces. My body and soul has been burnt and each and every pore of my body is aflame.”

She remains constantly bewildered. She does not find even momentary comfort. She is ravished by the thoughts of her beloved. She burns in flames at the transcendence of her beloved.

دریا برہوں داتا رہے ہر موج آدم خوار ہے
نہ پار نہ اروار ہے اوکھی اڑا ہیں آڑ ہی

“The river of love is in heights. It's each and every wave is man-eater. The river is without any bank. I have been engulfed in such whirlpools.”

The river of love is in high flood. The mounting waves tend to drown her. She is engulfed in whirlpools without any bank (support) in sight.

ایہا ہے حقیقت حال دی ساری عمر رہی بھال دی
کئی کل نہ پی مہینوال دی بے وس تنی لہریں لڑھی

“It is my real state. I have spent my whole life waiting for him. I found no clue of Mahinwal. I am the helpless and the inept one who has been fighting with waves.”

Her whole life has been spent in waiting for her beloved without any clue. She finds herself helpless and inept in wading through the waves of love.

ساتھی پنل 'گیا پرے جیس باجھ بک پل نہ سرے
پھر پھر ڈونگر گھاٹیاں درے سک ساتھ ونج بھونیں وچ وڑی

“My Punnal friend left me and went far away. I cannot pass a single moment without him. I have wandered in mountainous terrains, arduous passes and mountain passes. I have at last been buried in the ground along with my desire.”

The beloved assumed transcendence beyond her reach. It is not possible for her to spend even a moment without him. Her wandering in wilderness has borne no fruit. She is sure to die at last in longing for her friend.

ہن عشق آدل موں پیا ہوش و ہنر ضائع تھیا
سب محو منی ہو گیا جو کجھ سکھی جو کجھ پڑھی

“Now, love has dwelled in my heart. All my awareness and skill has been destroyed. My formal education has all been erased and forgotten.”

She finds her heart full of love. She realises the uselessness of her awareness and skill. Her formal education falls in oblivion. It is love, which leads to gnosis.

تھی دل فرید آگاہ ہے ہر جا جلوس شاہ ہے
بادل موں ظاہر ماہ ہے جب جھڑ گئی من کی جھڑی

“Farid! Now, my heart has achieved complete knowledge. The Sovereign is Omnipresent. The moon is visible after the clouds have passed away. My heart has attained purity (of unity) after being cleansed from the dust (of multiplicity).”

He attains heart-knowledge, which bestows absolute certainty. He witnesses the Omnipresence of the Sovereign. The moon of realised knowledge becomes visible after the clouds of formal knowledge pass away. His heart attains purity from otherness.

Kafi-213

دل نوں مار منجھایم نت دے درد اندیشے

“The constant pain and anxieties have ravished my anguished heart.”

Her anguished heart is ravished by constant pains and anxieties. Isn't it the ground-breaking ceremony of love?

وس نیڑے چاک ہمیں دا توں باجھ اے حال سنجیں دا
زخمی سینے چکدے ریشے

“The shepherd of the herd! Do come and dwell near me. The condition of the damned one is such that the chest wounds have become a sore.”

She beseeches the shepherd of her heart to shun transcendence and dwell in immanence with her.

ڈکھ ڈولہیاں ڈوڑ ڈوڑا پے سئے ساڑے سول سڑا پے
وین سیا پے ساڑے پیشے

“It is my vocation to bear sombre sufferings, torments, sarcasm, hundreds of burnings, hundred thousands of blazing up afflictions, lamentations and chest beating.”

Her vocation is to bear all forms of adversities in the path of love. Doesn't the vocation of love consist in clearing of the ground for vision and union with her beloved?

اے غمزے ناز، نہورے اے عشوے زورے تورے
سر سائگاں تن من تیشے

“These enticements, pride, coqueties and the radiant might are spears hurt on my head and spades hurt on my body and soul.”

The radiant and vibrant beauty of her beloved elicits love from her ravished heart.

بٹھ برہوں برابر ویری چاکیتس کو لے کیری
ظلمیں مذہب کافر کیشے

“I cast aside love that is constantly inimical to me. It has burnt and reduced me to ashes. Its religion is cruelty and its ways are highly oppressive.”

She reacts at the inimical, cruel and oppressive love, which burns and reduces her to ashes.

کیا دھانہ فرید سناواں کیا رورو جگت رداواں
مستک لکھڑی آئی پیشے

“Farid! What tale (of love’s oppression) should I narrate? Why I should I make the world weep by my crying. I got what was written on my forehead (what was destined for me).”

He is at a loss to narrate the tale of oppressive love, which would make the world cry along with him. He does not want to find fault with any one. He realises that it was his destiny to fall in love and undergo the pains and sufferings for the sake of his beloved.

Kafi-214

دُٹھا عشق عیان بازار گلی سبھور مز خفی ہُن بھیم جلی

“I have evidently witnessed the omnipresence of love.
All hidden intricacies have become manifest to me.”

Religiosity, as a fall from the true spirit of religion, denies the possibility of experiencing God. It fails to witness the Signs of God in the human selves. The spiritual dimension of religion, true to the spirit of the Qur'an, demonstrates the possibility of experiencing the ultimate Reality. It is not merely doctrinal truth but is realised in the infinite depths of one's being or consciousness. The gnostic openly witnesses the omnipresence of love itself (Reality). All hidden intricacies become manifest to him.

سبھ جلوہ نور ظہور ڈ سے یا ایمن تے یا طور ڈ سے
گئی غیبت عین حضور ڈ سے دل و نج دلبر دے ساتھ رلی

“All splendours are witnessed as the manifestations of light. They are witnessed as Aiman or as Tur. All absences have vanished and presence has become openly manifest. My heart has become united with my beloved.”

Allah is the light of the Heavens and the earth. The gnostic witnesses the splendours of the manifestation of light as holy. The veils of separation are removed and everything becomes openly manifest. The heart unites with the beloved (heart knowledge identifies knowledge with being).

ہے کشف کمال دی بات عجب ہے وجد تے حال دی گھات عجب
ہے وصل وصال دی رات عجب مٹھی غیر دی ذات صفات جلی

“The talk of perfect illumination is strange. The way of inspiration and a spiritual state is strange. The night of nuptial union is strange. The existence and attributes of hapless otherness have plunged into nothingness.”

Ordinary or rational understanding cannot understand the reality of the perfect illumination, which is without any shade of darkness. It has no inkling of the modes of inspiration and spiritual states, which spring from the inmost chambers of heart. It cannot go beyond servant-Lord axis in order to comprehend the realisation of unity. The existence and attributes of hapless other burn into nothingness. The Reality shines with full splendour without any trace of otherness.

کڈیں سیر نزول دی چال بنے کڈیں طیر عروج دا حال بنے
سارے سول سڑے ساری مونیجھ ٹلی جو ہر ہے عین وصال بنے

“It is a state of ascending heights at times and at times it is a way of descending to the lower strata. Separation becomes a manifest union. All afflictions have been burnt and all anguishes have been cast away.”

Spiritual experience has its unique heights and depths. The ordinary distinction between separation and union ceases to exist. The very thought of the beloved is identical with vision and union. He becomes free of afflictions and anguishes borne by him in the state of separation and disunion.

گم ہو گیا غیر دا نام نشاں جل خاک تے کھوٹ کھوٹ گماں
گھر بار گلی بازار ملی تھیا نور و جود شہود عیاں

“All falsehoods and doubts have been burnt. The signs of otherness have simply vanished. The light of being and existence has become manifest in house, a lane and street.”

The revealing of the Absolute Truth in absolute certainty totally burns falsehoods and doubts. The misleading signs of

otherness disappear too. The ephemeral nature of otherness vanishes like a mirage. The light of being and existence manifests in every nook and corner.

جستھاں بھال ڈیکھاں تھے راز ڈے سبھ حُسن تے ناز نواز ڈے
سبھ سوز فرید نوں ساز ڈے ہمہ اوست سجھائی ریت بھلی

“I discern mystery in seeing everywhere with my searching eyes. All the beauty, prides and elegance are visible. Farid! All passions are seen as instrumental to the realisation of my basic vocation. The doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al Wujud) has made me realise a noble tradition.”

His Gnostic consciousness sees the Glory of God everywhere. It witnesses the beauty, pride and elegance of his beloved in all things. The passion of love is instrumental in playing the tune of unity. Oneness of Being is not merely the metaphysical truth but has corresponding means of doctrinal realisation. It makes the gnostic realise the noble tradition of unity in diversity.

Kafi-215

دکھ سینے تے موگ ڈالے سک تڈی تڈی تیل ڈکھالے

“Suffering is inducing intricate pains in me. The desire is meaninglessly pushing me in the jaws of death.”

She suffers intricate pains in the path of love. Her desire of union with her beloved does not fructify. It tends to push her meaninglessly in the jaws of death.

غم دردالم بدیتے پئے ساڑن سوز پلےتے
تھئے میں مٹھڑی دے کیتے سب رانی خاں دے سالے

“Sorrows, pains and torments have evil intentions. The impure passions keep burning me. All these ineffective ones have become cruel for the miserable one.”

The sorrows, pains and torments are ill-intentioned and impure in burning her passionate self. They have no power except on her who has to bear their cruelty. Isn't it the force of love that she is victimised even by the powerless?

کئی ڈینہہ ناں رل گزریوئے ساری آس امید و نچوئے
ہے خبر نہیں کیا تھوئے تھئے پیچی کچ اُبالے

“My beloved did not spend a few days with me. All my hopes and expectations withered away. I have no knowledge of the event. My dubious beloved was in such a haste to go to Ketch.”

She recounts that her beloved did not spend even a few days with her. She has no hope and expectation of his return.

She had no knowledge of the event of transcendence. Her beloved dubiously assumed transcendence so quickly.

”ہم سگت“ سارے کھوٹے چنچ باز اُبھڑے ڈوٹے
رُل مل بے درد کھوٹے پئے کرن کھلاں ہاں کالے

“All my companions are counterfeit. They are funny, lacking understanding and vagabonds. They are personified pitiless people who gather together and with blackened hearts make fun of me.”

He distances himself from his companions by accusing them of insincerity. He brings out the negativities of their personality and character. His consciousness reaches such heights that he finds faults with his friends. He faces social contradictions, which become antagonistic at times. Doesn't the consciousness of love develop by virtue of these contradictions?

تتی سوز اندوہ وچالے سے واقعے فاقے گھالے
نیت روہ پتھر پڑتالے ہتھیں لپٹھاں پیریں چھالے

“The inept is caught in passion and grief. She is bearing hundreds of incidents and is being worn out by hunger. Her daily vocation is to wander in the mountainous ranges. Her hands have roughened and there are boils on her feet.”

She is enveloped by passion and grief. She bears countless events of hardships and is in the state of acute hunger. She constantly wanders in wilderness. The strain of her quest for the beloved is visible on her hands and feet.

کر صبر فرید نبھیاں پئی سولیں ساگک جلیاں
دم جیندیں تیں پکریاں متاں قادر سختی ٹالے

“Farid! I will patiently bear all this. I will remain in the company of afflictions. I will continue beseeching till

I live. The Almighty may free me from these hard times.”

He resolves to remain true to love by exercising patience in adversity. He will continue beseeching the Almighty, till the last breath of his life, to free him from the hard times of separation and disunion by granting him vision and union of his beloved.

Kafi-216

ڈکھی دلڑی دردیں ماری ہے ہر ویلھے آزاری

“My suffering heart is ravished by pains. It is always in distress.”

Her suffering heart is ravished by pains and is continuous in distress.

سوز اندر وچ سول جگروچ آیم بروچ روہ ڈونگروچ
سخت سفر وچ ظلم قہروچ ہوت نہ کیتیم کاری

“I have inward passions with inner afflictions. I have been caught in desolations and difficult mountainous terrains. I am having hardship in travelling in a severely cruelly environ. My beloved has not seen me through (these difficult situations).”

Her deplorable state creates intense suffering by the very consciousness that her beloved has not granted her vision and union.

دار مداراں سنجڑیاں باراں پر بت دھاراں غمدیاں ماراں
پر م پوکاراں جندڑی واراں یار و ساری یاری

“I am amidst desolate forests, long mountainous ranges and blows of sorrows. I call my beloved and make sacrifices for his sake but my friend has become oblivious of my friendship.”

He suffers and sacrifices everything for the sake of his beloved but his beloved does not grant him a friendly response. He does not care about his friendship.

شان شرم گیا بھیم بھرم گیا دین جرم گیا دیر دھرم گیا
لطف کرم گیا نیک رحم گیا لکڑی شہر خواری

“My glory and respect have been lost along with my honour and prestige. My way, tradition and forms of religious worship have disappeared. The subtle blessings and virtuous actions have withered away. I have earned notoriety.”

He discards his glory, respect, honour and prestige in the path of love. He goes beyond the forms of his religious tradition. He is deprived of the possibility of formal blessings and virtuosity of actions. He has got widespread notoriety. Isn't it the clearing of the way for vision and union with the beloved?

اوکھیاں گھٹیاں لکھ لکھ گھاٹے کھڑ بن بھاٹے سہنس گپاٹے
تتزی والی ڈکھڑے گھاٹے کر کر پیت پیاری

“There are narrow and countless mountainous passages and hazardous ways. There are cavities, mounds and countless uneven patches of land. There are sufferings of burning sand and losses. All these have to be borne by keeping love so dear.”

The one who keeps love close to his heart has to bear pains, sufferings and adversities. He has to suffer loss of everything in order to win his beloved.

نہ نہ بھایا روز سوا یا پور پر ایا مفت اجایا
دید مسایا زلف اڑایا گھت گھت پیچ دی گاری

“The unsuitable love is on the increase each day. The concern of others is valueless and meaningless. The eyes of my beloved have beguiled me and the locks of hair have entangled me by weaving countless knots.”

He is ensnared by the intricacies of love. He considers his concern for his beloved as valueless and meaningless. The incompatibility of love keeps on growing.

سازن چھاتی مارن کاتی سوز ہے ساتھی روگ ہے بھاتی
ہجر دی جھاتی کھسم حیاتی پل پل موت تیاری

“Passion is my companion and malaise is my intimate that are burning my chest and are striking me with a knife. A glance (moment) of disunion squeezes my life. I am all the times preparing for death.”

He finds himself in the throes of death while his embodied self suffers the disunion of his beloved.

درد فرید جدید جدیدے عید بعیدے بخت عنیدے
شوق شدیدے مونجھ مزیدے باربر ہوں سرباری

“Farid! My pain is novel and original. The days of happiness are far away and the misfortunes are hostile to me. My fondness has heightened and the anguish is on the increase. The burden of love has fallen on my head.”

The pain of love, in being fresh and original (spiritual), is qualitatively different from all forms of psychic pains. He finds happiness so remote since terrible misfortunes have befallen him. The fondness of love heightens with corresponding increase of anguish. He finds love so overbearing. Love is not a mechanical affair. It is creative act, which finds no parallel in any other human activity. Doesn't he like to perpetually taste the pain of love, which gives him a sense of belongingness?

Kafi-217

ڈینہہ راتیں عشق ستاوے زر گھر و روگ و دھاوے

“Love vexes me day and night. My wealth and household increase my malaise.”

He is constantly vexed by love. His wealth and household increase his malaise by obstructing the contemplation of his beloved.

تھل ریخاں جھر بر دیرے ہر بھٹ بھٹ نال بسیرے
سر سولاں جھکدے سہرے گل ہجر دا بار سہاوے

“My dwellings are in desolations, deserts and forests. We are living amidst the high dunes. My head is honoured by the chaplets of afflictions. The necklace of disunion in my neck seems so pleasant.”

He spends his life in uneven circumstances. He remains afflicted by the state of disunion. Aren't the chaplet of afflictions and necklace of disunion his distinguishing marks demonstrating possibility of union with his beloved?

دل لٹ گیا جوگی راول سے پور ڈکھاں دے پل پل
ہر وقت کہاں ہتھ ملل مٹھانیڑ اکوئی نہ لاوے

“My beloved Yogi has captivated my heart. I am continuously undergoing countless fits of sufferings. I always say by rubbing my hands that no one should contract unfortunate love.”

Her heart is captivated by her beloved. She suffers transcendence of her beloved to such an extent that she counsels others not to contract such an ill-fated love.

روہ کو جھمکالیاں دھاراں
پوں چو بھن بول ہزاراں
سر قہر کلور دیاں ماراں
ڈکھ ہر ویلے تن تاوے

“There are hideous mountains and terrains in my way.
Hundreds of thorns are pierced in my feet. The cruel
severities strike my head. Sufferings always keep me
fiery.”

He faces pains, severities and sufferings in the arduous
path of love. His embodied self remains fiery.

دل دود غماندے ڈکھدے
جی ہر ویلے پیا جکھدے
گئے گذر ڈھاڑے سوکھدے
موئی چندڑی سوز نبھاوے

“The smokes of sorrow are emitting from my heart.
My self is always bearing tribulations. The days of
peace have gone away. Now, my spiritless being is
remaining true to the passion of love.”

His heart burns with sorrows. His self bears tribulations.
The era of peace has gone away from his life. His spiritless
life is being faithful to the passion of love. Isn't it the glory of
love that he remains true to love even in being so spiritless?

ہے درد اوڑا بٹھڑا
کیوں پیش پیم اے کٹھڑا
کچھ گھٹے نہ گالے تڑا
ہتھوں مر ہم زخم پھٹاوے

“Pain is intricate and overturned. Why such a
disfigured one has fallen to my lot? This neck
breaking does not decrease. The balm instead of
healing the wound makes it sorer.”

The pain of love is intricate and has its own peculiar logic.
He is scared by its origin and intricate growth. The wound of
love cannot be healed by ordinary balm for it makes the
wound sorer, instead. The vision and union with the beloved
is the only balm which heals the wounds of love.

جن رَاخس سنجھیاں جاہیں رچھ باندر بوز بلائیں
تھئے ساتھی سنجھ صاحبیں مٹھی اوکھی عمر دھاوے

“There are fiery creatures, giants, bears, species of monkeys and demons in the desolate places. I am the hapless one who is passing her life with great difficulty.”

He faces psychic forces in the desolation of his self. They create negative ideas and feelings in him. He passes his life with great difficulty

آئے پیش فرید گپاٹے انگ ترٹن تے سر پھاٹے
لکھ روڑاں سہنس چکاٹے تتی بے وس تھی کر لاوے

“Farid! I have encountered uneven patches of land leading to the breaking of my bones and injuries on my head. The countless noises of wild animals and numerous shrieks are audible. The inept is desperately crying in helplessness.”

He faces intricacies of love, which ravish his embodied self. The dark forces of his psyche are let loose on him. He desperately cries in helplessness. Isn't such crying in helplessness a sure sign of nearing union with his beloved?

Kafi-218

رانجھن انگ لگایا ہے سب غیر داوہم بھلایا ہے

“Ranjhan has marked me as his slave. He has freed me from the illusion of otherness.”

The beloved confers the identity of love on him that makes him oblivious of otherness.

رانجھن میر انور الہی مظہر ذات صفات کماہی
سر لولاک کلنگی پائی طہ چتر جھلایا ہے

“My Ranjhan is the Light of God. He truly manifests the Attributes of Divinity. He is crowned with the *raison d’etre* of the whole creation. The laurel of ‘ta’ waves over his head.”

His beloved is the Light of God. It is through the Muhammadan light that the Reality manifests the Attributes of Divinity. He is crowned with the *raison d’etre* of the whole creation. His creation is the metaphysical, cosmological, traditional and symbolical meaning and purpose behind the origin of the cosmos. He is the Perfect Man whom humanity emulates for realising the cosmic purpose of human existence. The laurel of ‘ta’, signifying qualities of the Universal Man, waves over his head.

رانجھن میڈے ویڑھے آیا کھیڑیں بھیڑیں شور مچایا
آیا ولد انہیں ولایا بے شک بخت بھڑایا ہے

“Ranjhan entered the inmost chambers of my being. The despicable ‘Kheras’ created a lot of fuss. But once he came, he did not turn back (remained

steadfast with me). Undoubtedly, my destiny has favoured me.”

The beloved has unveiled himself in the inmost chambers of her being. Her psychic forces, in the forms of despicable adversaries, have created great upheaval. It is her good fortune that the psychic forces have not succeeded in thwarting her spiritual vision and union.

پاکر جھاتی لائیں چھاتی	ماہی میں ول پائی جھاتی
لوں لوں وچ سما یا ہے	ہر ویلے ہر جا ہے ساتھی

“My beloved shot a glance at me. Thereafter, he embraced me. He is with me at all places and at all times. He is dwelling in each and every pore of my being.”

The beloved took initiative and blessed her with his vision. He embraced her. He is with her everywhere and at every time. He dwells in her bones and flesh. Her proximity with her beloved is not bound to spatio-temporal order. It is non-spatial and non-temporal. The beloved does not come to dwell as if from the outside. He is the root of her being. He unveils within the infinite depths of her being or consciousness. She ceases to be or has consciousness of her ontological nothingness. The beloved is all-embracing.

ڈیکھن آیاں سینگیاں سیاں	حسن رانجھن دیاں دھماں پیاں
ڈیکھو کیا رنگ لایا ہے	ہیر دا بو چھن دھتیاں دھتیاں

“The beauty of Ranjhan created a great stir. My same age friends have come to see him. The shawl of Heer has been torn to bits. Witness these ecstasies of love.”

The beauty of the beloved has dazzled everyone. Her friends have come to witness her beloved. The ecstasy of the lover (Heer) in the state of love has dropped all her coverings. Appearance has given way to the Reality.

فخریہاتوں بل بل جاواں جیندے نال میں لدھیاں لاواں
اس دی ہو کر کیوں غم کھاواں سب کچھ یار سمجھایا ہے

“I sacrifice myself for the sake of Fakhr. I have accomplished my nuptial rites with him. Why should I be in the state of sorrowfulness, when I belong to him? My friend has made me realise everything.”

He sacrifices everything for the sake of his spiritual master. He has taken oath of allegiance at his hands. He has completely offered himself to him so there is no question of being sorrowful about any thing. His friend has made him understand all the subtleties of the path of love.

یار فرید نہیں مستورے ہر جا اس داعین ظہورے
ظلمت بھی سب نور حضورے اسم فقط بیا آیا ہے

“Farid! My friend is not hidden. He is openly manifest at each and every place (Omnipresent). Darkness too is the pervasive presence of Light. It has just been named differently.”

The friend is not hidden. He is manifest everywhere. The so-called darkness is essentially the immanent light. It has been named differently in the world of contrasts or polarisations. If darkness were not the pervasive presence of light, then we could not even perceive darkness, says a friend of God. The doctrinal formulation of the Omnipresence of God as light does raise certain reservations in the minds of the theoreticians but once this doctrinal truth is metaphysically realised, it imparts absolute certitude. He realises his beloved and thereby openly witnesses him everywhere.

Kafi-219

راںجنھن ماہی تخت ہزاروں میں کارن اتھ آئے

“My beloved Ranjhan of Hazara should come here for my sake.”

She wishes her transcendent beloved to become immanent for her sake.

سوہی سیچھتے سانول سہجوں سِکدی کوں گل لائے

“My beloved should readily embrace the one desirous of him on the colourful nuptial bed.”

She desires that her beloved realises the bright possibility of union with her.

ڈکھڑے کھا کھیا رلدھوسے ڈکھڑے مھیم سجائے

“I have found my friend after ongoing different sufferings. My sufferings have borne fruit.”

She has found her friend after undergoing sufferings. She realises that it is through the medium of sufferings that she can have vision and union with him. The sufferings are not meaningless but are highly meaningful. The knocking of sufferings is instrumental in opening the door of the beloved.

ایں جہیں پک ڈکھتوں سئے سکھڑے گھول گھمائے

“Hundreds of comforts are to be sacrificed for such individual sufferings.”

A life full of comforts is to be sacrificed for the sake of uniting with her beloved in spite of sufferings now and then.

بختیں بھاگ سہاگیں سگھڑیں میں ول منہ ولائے

“My nuptial fortunes and happiness have turned their face towards me.”

She is happy and fortunate in finding her beloved.

راتوں رات نسو کڑ ڈکھڑے کالے روہ سدھائے

“My sufferings fled towards the black mountains during night.”

Her sufferings due to separation and disunion have stealthily fled far away.

سیندھاں مانگھاں سر چڑھ بولن والیں سوول پائے

“The parting line of hair on my head is so distinct. My hair has got hundreds of curls.”

The unruly hair has been well knitted. The curls of hair are so distinct.

گانے ناز نواز دے گاہے پائے پاٹھم گائے

“I have worn and displayed the colourful threads around my wrist (symbolising marital bond) and the ornaments of priding and elegance.”

She experiences pride and elegance in wearing her nuptial ornaments. The company of her beloved is so inspiring.

ہجر فراق نہا تھی ہک چائے سہنس لوڑھائے

“Disunion and separation are crying with low spirits.”

The union with the beloved has banished disunion and separation.

پاکجلا لائے رخِ دلیری ڈیکھے تے مسکائے

“Apply a collyrium and rouge so that my heart sees and smiles.”

Beautifying makes the heart smile. It becomes happy in witnessing the blessings of love.

مُدتاں کچھے شام سلونے جھوک نوں آن سہائے

“My charming beloved after a long time has made my dwellings lively.”

She had to wait for a long time before her charming beloved unveiled himself.

سو سو حمد تے لکھ شکرانے مولے ماڑو سائے

“I will highly praise God and offer infinite gratitude to Him for making Marwar green.”

She highly praises God and offers Him Infinite Gratitude for turning her deadness into liveliness. Self-realisation is affected by the Grace of God.

سانول سوہنا سانوں بدرہ ساڈے آن ملہائے

“My lovely beloved has spent the months of Savan and Bhadoon, while dwelling with me.”

She is happy that her beloved has remained in immanence with her during the rainy season. She recounts the blessings of her beloved in granting her vision and union.

ڈیون ودھایاں سینگیاں سٹیاں رل وسدے ہمسائے

“My same age friends and companions are congratulating me.”

Her friends, companions and neighbours congratulate her in enjoying the nuptial blessings of love.

لجھڑے راز فقر دے سارے فخر الدین سُبھائے

“Fakhruddin made me realise all the deeper mysteries of the way of ontological nothingness.”

The spiritual master made his disciple understand the subtleties of the Sufi way. He has made him realise the deeper

mysteries of ontological nothingness. Isn't the face of the beloved reflected in the mirror of nothingness?

حال مقام دی رتق فتق سب شر حیں کر فرمائے

“He made me fully understand the states and stations of the soul and the ensuing contractions and expansions.”

He made him understand the states and stations of the soul with their closures and openings on the path of gnosis in order to save him from the pitfalls of illusion.

یاریاں باشیاں رلڑے داریاں وس وسیب و ہائے

“My friendly associations, sittings and relationships with my neighbours have all ended.”

The concentration on the Real makes one oblivious of the unreal. It leads to the end of all attachments.

یہم فرید بر ہوندے پند ہڑے بے دھندڑے مکلائے

“Farid! I bade goodbye to all other activities ever since I took the way of love.”

The way of love leaves no room for any thing else. He detaches himself from the domain of action. He essentially contemplates his beloved.

Kafi-220

روندیں عمر گزار ڈتو سے یار پُئیل دی کل نہ پیو سے

“I have spent my life in crying. I got no access to my friend Punnal.”

She spends her life in crying for her transcendent beloved.

لائی دِلڑی چوٹ اندردی وِ سری سیجھ رنگیلی گھردی
رُلدی ریت تتی تھل بردی اُوڑک موت نصیب تھیو سے

“My heart has hurt me from within. I have forgotten the colourful setting of my home. I am wretchedly wandering in the desert on burning sand. Ultimately, I have suffered death.”

Her heart is wounded by love. It leads to forgetfulness of her homely comforts. She wretchedly wanders in wilderness- unto-death.

چچ پیا دل کچ شہر دا مشکل پینڈا روہ ڈو گمردا
آیا پھرہ سخت پھر دا رُلدے پھر دے مَر بھر گیو سے

“Well, Ketch city entangled me. I have to go across difficult routes and traverse the intricate mountainous terrains. The period of difficult times has come. I will die in a state of wretchedness.”

She has got entangled in transcendence. She has to struggle a lot to affect union with her beloved. She is apprehensive of dying wretchedly in the trying circumstances.

رَل مل ڈکھڑے آئے پکھڑے اجڑیاں خوشیاں نبھ گئے سکھڑے
گانے گہنے سہرے سُکڑے سنجڑے غم دے سانگ رُلیو سے

“Sufferings in togetherness have fallen to my lot. My happiness has been deserted and the state of peace has gone away. The colourful threads around my wrist (symbolising marital bond), ornaments and chaplets have lost their freshness. I had to wander along with damned sorrows.”

She faces numerous sufferings. She loses peace and happiness. All those things signifying nuptial happiness for her turn into damned sufferings.

اوکھیاں گھاٹیاں ڈونگر کالے تترے & یں پیر پچالے
ڈکھ کھا کھا سنج واہ وچالے تھی بے واہ ڈوہاگ چھکیو سے

“There are arduous passes in the black mountains. The burning sand dunes have made boils on my feet. I have borne sufferings in the desolate places. I have shouldered my misfortunes in spite of being without any support.”

She recounts the misfortunes and sufferings she has faced in the arduous path of love without any internal or external support.

رکھساں دم دم نال سنبھالے سہساں روگ کروپ کشالے
بھالے یار فرید نہ بھالے جیں زورے جند جان لٹو سے

“I will honour my commitment at each and every moment. I will bear malaises, difficulties and adversities. Farid! My friend, who has forcefully captivated my being, may take care of me or not.”

He reiterates his unconditional commitment to remain sincere in love in spite of experiencing malaises, difficulties and adversities of the way. Love is an absolute commitment.

Kafi-221

روندیں عمر بھائی یار دی خبر نہ کائی

“I spent my life in crying but I did not find any trace of my friend.”

She spends her life but does not find a trace of her transcendent beloved.

بھاگ سہاگ سنگار و نجامیم دلوں و ساریا مہی

“I forgot my nuptial fortunes and beautification. My friend has erased me from his heart.”

Her nuptial fortunes and beautification are meaningful in reference to her beloved. She becomes oblivious of them in the wake of her beloved erasing her from his heart.

دور گیا دل آیا ناہیں مرساں کھا کر پھائی

“He went far away and did not come back to me. I will die by tightening noose around my neck.”

Her grappling with the transcendence of her beloved becomes so overbearing that she wishes to die.

عشق نہیں کئی نار غضب دی چنگ چوانتی لائی

“It is not love but a devastating fire that has burnt me with a spark and burning wood.”

It is not simply love but a raging fire that burns her to ashes.

جو بن سارا روپ گنوا ایم درویں مار مسائی

“I lost my youth and its bloom. Pains have severely ravished me.”

Pain severely ravishes her. She laments that she has lost her animating youth for the sake of her beloved but has not succeeded in affecting union with him.

فخرالدین مٹھل دے شوقوں دم دم پیڑ سوائی

“My pain of loving sweet Fakhruddin is perpetually on the increase.”

The love of the spiritual master with its ensuing pain is on the increase. The moments of separation from him are so painful.

یار فرید نہ پائیم پھیرا گل گئیم مفت اجائی

“Farid! My friend has not revisited me. I am rotten for nothing.”

He awaits the immanence of his beloved. He considers himself rotting for nothing. Isn't this 'nothing' harbinger of everything?

Kafi-222

روہی وٹھڑی ٹوبھاتاروے آمل توسینگا یاروے

“The desert has come to life after the rainfall and the ponds are full of water. My youthful friend! Do meet me.”

The desert coming to life with the rainfall, notwithstanding it symbolises ushering of the happy times of vision and union with his beloved. The inward ambience craves for meeting with his friend.

تھئے تھلڑے باغ بہاروے چودھار گل گزاروے

“The sand dunes have turned into orchards and gardens. There is spring everywhere.”

The barrenness of his self is ending and he has started flowering from within. It is the era of widespread spring.

کتھے چنکیں دے چھنکاروے کتھے مٹاندے گھنکاروے

“There is the musical sound of tinkling of bells around the necks of the herd at a place and on the other there is the sound produced by churning of milk in the vessels.”

The musical sounds are audible, which makes the atmosphere melodious.

ڈینہ رات مینگھ ملہاروے وچ پکھیان دے چھنکاروے

“The sky is day and night overcast with rainy clouds. The chirping of the birds is also audible.”

It is ambience of heavenly blessings. The language of the birds symbolise spiritual openings.

کتھے گاج دے دھدکاروے کتھے لہمن دے لسکاروے

“There are flashes of lightning at times and at times there is thundering of clouds.”

He is transposed from the terrestrial sphere to the celestial one by virtue of sound and light

پئے ٹھہندے ہار سنگاروے سُرخِی تے کجد دھاروے

“My makeup, rouge and the line of a collyrium are looking so lovely.”

His inward happiness makes beautification look so lovely.

آئے ٹکھ سہاگ دے واروے گئے ڈکھ وی آرتے پاروے

“The days of peace and happiness have come. My sufferings have fled away.”

The dawn of peace and happiness makes sufferings wither away. Doesn't light make darkness vanish?

سینگیاں وسن گھر باروے لاگل سمہن دلداروے

“My same age friends dwell happily in their abodes. They are lying with their beloveds in the postures of embracing.”

The lovers and the beloveds are dwelling happily in their abodes. They are enjoying the fruits of union.

ہک میں زلی اڈازاروے ڈکھ سول نال وپاروے

“I am the one who is wandering in a wretched state. I have traded with sufferings and afflictions.”

She wanders in a state of wretchedness for not affecting union with her beloved. She suffers afflictions at the hands of love.

توں بن فرید خواروے رت ہنجڑوں روون کاروے

دل جلد موڑ مہاروے نہ تاں مرویاں وارو واروے

“Farid is disgraced without you. His activity is to drop the tears of blood from his eyes. Now, instantly turn the reins towards me. Otherwise, I will die within a week.”

He is wretched in pains without his beloved. He beseeches his transcendent beloved to assume immanence otherwise he will soon die in separation and disunion.

Kafi-223

ساڈی دل پھیر ڈے جیویں کھس نیتی کیوں چا قابو کیتی

“My friend! Return my heart to me in its original state. Why have you overpowered it?”

She beseeches her friend to return her heart in its pre-love state. She questions the overpowering of her heart by her beloved.

ڈوہ ورائیں وین الیندیں ڈیکھن سیتی تریڑھی پنیدیں
ڈے دڑکے رت پیٹنی

“You censure and give me maledictions without any rhyme or reason. The moment you see me, there is a frown on your forehead. I become scared to the last ounce of my blood.”

She does not decipher any reason for her beloved's transcendence. The forms of transcendence scare her to the marrows of her bones.

ویرنہ لہناں ہاوی ماہی کھس کر زورے دل بے واہی
سانگ ڈکھاں دے سیتی

“Which type of revenge you took from me that you forcefully captivated my poor heart and sewed it with sufferings?”

She considers it a form of revenge that her beloved used his might to capture her helpless heart and sewed it with sufferings.

تو نے لکڑی ہو ہو پھلڑی دلڑی تکرڑی دردیں پکڑی
توڑ پچا جو نیہی

“My heart, in spite of being subject to infamy and ill-repute, remains stout and bears these pains and remains steadfast till an end in consonance with its primary commitment.”

Her heart remains stout and bears the pains of infamy and ill-repute at the hands of adversaries. It reiterates its primary commitment of remaining steadfast in love.

ناہیں مڑن مناسب تھک تھک جے سر ڈلیں ہے پک پیشک
برہوں دی بازی جیتی

“It is not desirable to retrace the steps as a reaction against the tiredness of the way. It is doubtlessly certain that if you sacrifice your head you will win the game of love.”

She resolves to manifest sincerity in love by remaining in the tracks of her beloved. She considers it undesirable to betray love on account of getting tired by traversing the path of love. She is absolutely certain without an iota of doubt that the one who sacrifices his head (life) for the sake of his beloved is bound to win the game of love.

آیا وقت فرید ملن دا بھورل جانی یار سجن دا
رین غماں دی بیہی

“Farid! The times of having union with my charming beloved have dawned. The Night of sorrows has ended.”

The times of union with his charming beloved draw well-nigh. The acts of exercising patience in adversity bear their fruits. The difficult times of separation and disunion come to an end. Doesn't hope of union keeps him firmly saddled in the tracks of love?

Kafi-224

ساون بوندڑیاں جھرلاوے

“Savan is making the drops of rainfall.”

The rainy season notwithstanding, it symbolises the era of the unveiling of her beloved.

کوک کوک پانی ژے پیہا پھوک پھوک تن آگ جگاوے

“The crested cuckoo is cooing and sinning by awakening the fire of love within my being.”

The cooing of cuckoo (calling her beloved) is likened to sinning, for it makes the fire of love burn her from within.

کوئل کوچ مہر واولے دل دکھاری نوں ڈکھلاوے

“The cuckoo, heron and peacock are calling. Suffering is making the suffering heart fiery.”

The language of the birds is the language of love. The cuckoo, heron and peacock (sentiments of love) call their beloveds. It makes her suffering heart suffer more by being fiery. She misses her beloved so intensely.

نین چین سے جھگڑت جھگڑت تڑپھت تڑپھت رین بہاوے

“My eyes are in constant warfare with the state of peace. My whole night is spent in increasing restlessness.”

Her eyes struggle to keep awake awaiting their beloved at the cost of her peace of mind. The whole night passes in increasing restlessness.

چھتیاں دھڑکت جیڑا لرجت توں بن کاری گھٹن ڈراوے

“My chest is vibrating and my heart is shaky. The black clouds are frightening without you.”

Her embodied self is adversely affected in the state of separation and disunion. She dreads the black clouds in the absence of her beloved. She is gripped by existential dread at the very possibility of union with her beloved.

روم جھوم رت برکھا سو ہے انگ ڈھنگ رس راند رچاوے

“The dancing clouds have made the weather pleasant. They are playing the game of pleasantness.”

The ambience of love is conducive to the pleasant game of love.

بیت گئے دن رین ڈکھاں دے کہوری پیا کو سبجھ سہاوے

“The times of suffering have ended. Go and invite your beloved to dwell in the nuptial bed.”

The times of suffering due to separation and disunion have ended. She invites her beloved to realise union.

پیٹم پیت فرید نہ پالی انگ انگ برہن مُرجھاوے

“Farid! My beloved did not remain true to love. The unresponsiveness has deadened each and every part of my being.”

His embodied self becomes ravished and deadened in the absence of loving responses from his beloved.

Kafi-225

سب سراسر ارقدم داہے اتھ محض نہ دخل عدم داہے

“All secrets and mystery are of the eternal essence.
Here, there is no question of nothingness as such.”

The Essence itself or the Beginningless Essence encloses the entire mystery. It manifests itself in the form of Divinity or Divine Presences. There is no essential reality of nothingness. It is another name of the unrealised Possibilities of the Essence. The plenitude of Being itself leaves no possibility or room for the existence of nothingness, otherwise it tantamount to accepting the reality of otherness. The very concept of nothingness is not absolute. It is polarisation of being and nothingness. The attempt to consider nothingness as absolute commits the fallacy of turning it into a self- subsisting reality (ilah), which has been connotatively negated by the Islamic Shahadah (there is no reality except the Reality).

دلڑی سگھر بُجان سیانی آکھے ہر دم سمنجھ بلیانی
مظہر ذات حمد دا جانی تو نے روپ صنم داہے

“My heart is pure, knowledgeable and wise. It constantly wants me to know as a friend that all is the manifestation of the essence though it may be in the form of an idol.”

Metaphysically speaking, there is only the Principle and its Manifestation. It is also understood as the Absolute and the Infinite; the Essence and the Divinity; the Universal Possibility or the Metaphysical Whole. The Intellect, Spirit or ‘Heart’ in purity, knowledge and wisdom counsels the lover

to realise that the whole cosmos is the manifestation of the Essence. There is nothing outside it. The Reality manifests itself in all forms. There cannot be any idol unless the Reality shines through it. To place an idol confronting the Reality (God) is worst form of blasphemy. It is placing divinity beside Allah, which is the unpardonable sin of polytheism. No form has reality in itself. It is theophany or tajjali of the Reality (God).

علوی سقلى دا ہے ماہر جو ہے نفس مقدس طاہر
والی عرب عجم دا ہے کل دامظہر کل دا ناہر

“The sacred and pure self with its heights and depths manifests totality in fullness. He is the custodian of Arabia and Persia.”

The metaphysical dimensions of prophecy bring to light the essential aspects of the prophet of Islam, which are opaque to ordinary understanding. The prophetic self, by virtue of its sacredness, purity and mastery of heights and depths, manifests the cosmos in its entirety. The cosmos manifests in totality in his medium. He is the custodian of the corners of the world. He is the perfect mirror through which the Reality contemplates itself in fullness, perfection and in wholeness.

اس نوں قال تے حال مہیا جس نوں ذوق خیال مہیا
وارث باغ ارم دا ہے گلشن جشن جمال مہیا

“The one, who has been bestowed with taste and imagination, has been blessed with spiritual discourse and experience. He has been endowed with the majestic beauty of a garden. He is the inheritor of the garden of paradise.”

The one who is blessed with the faculty of imagination, experiences the ‘Imaginal Worlds’ and has the art of communicating the imaginal realities. The gift of imagination makes him orchard of majestic beauty. His imagination is constitutive of its objects. He achieves identity of his imaginal

forms and content and becomes the custodian of the paradisaal garden. How could one understand the deeper realities of life without coming into grips with the levels of imagination within the self and the world?

بیولایعنی تے نادانی دل دلدار تے دل دل جانی
دل اخلاص تے سبع مثانی مبداء قدم قدم دا ہے

“All else is useless and imperfect. The heart is the beloved and the heart is the friend. The sincere heart is the gateway to seven openings. It is the *raison d’etre* of the universe.”

All faculties or forms of knowledge in comparison to the ‘Heart’ (the intuitive aspect of the mind) are useless and imperfect. The ‘Heart’ is one’s beloved and friend. The sincere ‘heart’ purified of otherness is the gateway to numerous spiritual openings. It is the *raison d’etre* of the cosmos. It is through the mirror of the heart that the Reality contemplates itself. It is the cosmic purpose of human existence.

دیکھو شوکت شان پسارا محور گردش سبع سیارا
مرکز دور محیط داسارا نقطہ دل آدم دا ہے

“Witness the widespread splendour and grandeur, the axis of seven revolving around planets and the all-encompassing centre: the point of Adam’s heart.”

The point of Adam’s heart, with its widespread splendour and grandeur, is axis of seven revolving planets and the all-encompassing centre of the cosmos. Man has to realise the infinite treasure he carries in the infinite depths of his ‘heart’.

سینہ صاف صفا بے کینہ نور حقیقی دا آئینہ
دل لڑی خالص پاک نگینہ نقشہ بیت حرم دا ہے

“A clear and pure self without any malice is the mirror of the supernal light. A pure heart is a sacred jewel figuring the House of God.”

The human self, clear and pure of sinfulness, otherness and maliciousness mirrors the supernal light. The sincere heart is a crystal jewel, which reflects the dwelling of God. Isn't a heart purified of otherness the real abode of the beloved?

باند ابردا اس دے دردا	خاص فرید غلام فخر دا
تکلیہ دوست دے دم دا ہے	بٹھ پیا آسرا علم و ہنر دا

“Farid is a special bondsman of Fakhr. He is the servant and slave of his house. The trust in knowledge and art is valueless. My only trust is in my friend.”

To know a metaphysical doctrine is one thing but to realise it is another. The gnostic realises the doctrinal truth in the infinite depths of his being or consciousness. All the great metaphysical and religious traditions of the world, in their unique ways, assign a pivotal role to the spiritual master in the understanding and realisation of doctrinal truths. The reverence of the spiritual master consists in considering one self as his bondsman, servant and slave. He manifests his nothingness in front of his spiritual mentor. He loses trust in his own knowledge and considers his art of no value and consequence. His only trust is in his friend. He turns himself into a pure receptacle in the hands of his spiritual master, who is his friend. The friendship with one's 'murshid' falls to the lot of the lucky ones. The disciples may be many but the friends are a very few. The friends are bestowed knowledge of the inmost esoteric mysteries and become recipient of certain spiritual blessings, which are not blessed to ordinary disciples. The whole treasures of mankind are not worth a straw in comparison to friendship with one's spiritual master.

Kafi-226

سب صورت وچ ذات سنجانی حق باجھوں یو غیر نہ جانی

“Discern the essence in all forms. Do not consider any other reality except the Reality.”

One has to discern the Essence manifest in all forms. The Reality is Omnipresent. There is no otherness. There is no reality except the Reality.

نہ کوئی آدم نہ کوئی شیطان بن گئی اے کل کوڑ کہانی

“There is neither any Adam nor any Satan. It has become a totally fabricated story (bereft of symbolism).”

The Possibilities inhering in the Essence are realised in the forms of Names and Attributes. The degrees of the Reality or the Divine Presences account for the manifestation of the Principle in different forms. The first part of the Islamic Shahadah, ‘there is no reality except the Reality’ negates all other forms of reality. The second part of the Shahadah, ‘Muhammad is the manifestation of the Reality’ makes everything as theophany (tajjali) of the Absolute or the Reality. The Shahadah implies that no thing has self-subsistent reality (ilah) except the Reality and all things are manifestation of the Reality. Manifestation, by definition, is devoid of self-subsistence. It has no being in itself. It derives its ‘reality’ from the Reality. The human has no reality in itself. It has no independence or autonomy. It is absolutely dependent on the Divine. There is essentially neither Adam nor Satan. The mind falters in fabricating the ‘autonomous’

existence of both Adam and Satan. It is in the process of manifestation that Adam and Satan come to limelight. It is the Divine Freedom manifest in Adam that envisages the possibility of Satan. The Divine works through these mediums. The birth of freedom for the creation of good necessarily gives rise to the possibility of evil symbolised in the form of the Satan. The dark ignorance and false pride of the Satan in not prostrating before Adam consists in his failure to perceive the presence of the Divine in the human. His persistent error has been to create an unbridgeable gulf between the Divine and the human. He had knowledge of Allah's transcendence but he had no inkling of His immanence. It is precisely this reason that He failed to perceive the Reality clothed in the form of Adam. The Divine command to prostrate to Adam was essentially a command to prostrate to the Divine in the human form. Religiosity accepts the transcendence of God but errs in denying His immanence. Oneness of Being (wahdat al-wujud) rightfully worships God in transcendence and serves Him in immanence. It accepts the transcendence and immanence of God in simultaneity.

دل نا کر غیریت ہانی باجھ خدا دے محض خیالے

“It is just your imagination to see anything except God. Do not make your heart intimate with otherness (God is everywhere).”

It is a mere illusion to see anything except God. One must refrain one's heart from intimating with otherness. Isn't the constant concentration on the Real that makes one realise the Omnipresence of God?

مطلب وحدت ہے ہر چالوں سبک نہ رکھ بئے پاسے تانی

“Oneness is manifest on all sides. Do not be desirous of the other sides (for they are not).”

The metaphysical principle of unity in diversity is universal and thereby applicable in all realms and at all levels. One has

to concentrate on unity without being desirous of multiplicity.
Man has to attach with the Real and not with the ephemeral.

جانوں لاوی دل داناؤں اثنینیت مول نہ بھانی

“My wise heart has not appreciated duality ever since
my primordial birth.”

It is sense-perception aided by reason, which creates the illusion of duality. Religiosity fails to correct the cardinal error. However, his heart is wise in not accepting duality since the primordial day. Heart-knowledge creates identity of knowing and being.

سوہنا کو جھاصرف بہانہ بکڑوہی دل سمجھ سنجانی

“The distinction between beauty and ugliness arises in
the process of manifestation. Posit your
understanding on Oneness.”

One has to concentrate on the doctrine of Oneness. The polarisation between beauty and ugliness like all polarisations is provisional and not permanent. Beauty in itself does not have its opposite. But ‘once it is reflected in the manifested order, it appears in a particular form and this particularism necessitates the possibility of a given opposite.’ It is in the process of manifestation that the beauty appears in the form of a given beauty, which implies the possibility of a given ugliness. ‘It can be---in a relative sense---can be produced only in a world of contrast.’ Metaphysically speaking, ugliness is a mere privation and it has no being in itself. However, ‘it has the positive function of highlighting its counterpart a contrario.’ It is by passing through certain cosmic cycles that it returns to its original source in beauty itself.

روزازل دی یارپنل دی پی گل ساڈے پیت پرانی

“The traditional love of our friend Punnal has fallen
to our lot ever since the primordial day.”

Love itself polarises in the forms of the lover and the beloved. It is ontological love, which captivates him since the primordial day.

یار فرید ملیو سے جیندیں سوہنی ساری عمر وہانی

“Farid! My friend met me during my life time. My whole life remained beautiful.”

The union with the beloved in one's life time is such a heavenly blessing that he finds his whole life spent beautifully. The ugliness of pains, sufferings and adversities, he experiences during the separation and disunion with his beloved are not only forgotten but integrated in the beauty of his life. His thought transforms ugliness into beauty. The pure objectivity of things notwithstanding, the consciousness determines the meaning of things. It is free to interpret the past in reference to present and future projects. Love of freedom leads to freedom of love.

Kafi-227

سب صورت وچ وسدا (ڈھولاماہی) دل اساڈی کھسدا (ڈھولاماہی)

“He dwells in each form, my beloved friend. He captivates our heart, my beloved friend.”

The beloved friend dwells in every form. He wins hearts in friendly ways.

رنگ بے رنگی اس دے دیرے آپے رانجھا ہیرتے کھڑے
لک چھپ بھید نہ ڈسدا (ڈھولاماہی)

“He dwells in different colourful forms. He is himself Ranjha, Heer and Kheras. The Invisible (transcendent) does not unravel his mystery, my beloved friend.”

The transcendent colourless Reality manifests in colourful forms. Its immanence is so colourful. He assumes the forms of the lover, the beloved and the adversaries of love. He hides himself within His manifestation without unravelling the mystery of his hiddenness to the ordinary eye or human reason. He is hidden in the eye and thereby cannot be seen by the eye. People try to find him behind the form of things whereas he himself is the form. The doctrine of his dwelling in all forms is experienced in the act of realisation. The metaphysical truth remains elusive to ordinary and religious understanding. There can be flashes or pointers to truth, which a person may catch if he is blessed with good fortunes. If the Reality is considered as law itself, then there cannot be anything bereft of the law. Rather, it is by virtue of law that things come to manifest their relative existence (ontological nothingness). No pure or impure thing is exempted from the

operation of law. Rather, it is the working of the law that makes such distinctions and differentiations possible. Now, the law is not affected by the purity or impurity of things, which can be understood as the transcendence of the law. By stretching the analogy further, we can say that the law is both transcendent and immanent in simultaneity. The law is hidden but its working is so openly manifest. The identification of God with the law itself, among other things, helps in imparting some idea of the Reality manifesting in all forms.

آپے ہجرتے آپے میلا آپ ہے قیس تے آپ ہے لیلا
آپ آواز جر سدا (ڈھولامانی)

“He is himself disunion and he is himself union. He is himself Qays and he is himself Layla. He is himself the tinkling of a bell tied around the camel’s neck, my beloved friend.”

The beloved friend is not only manifest in all things but characterises the states of all things as well. He takes the human form of feelings of union and disunion. He is both the lover and the beloved. He is himself tinkling of bell tied around the camel’s neck of his beloved heralding her presence. He is manifest in all things by assuming the forms of His Names and Attributes, which warrant perfect and imperfect, beautiful and ugly, good and evil actions otherwise some of His Names and Attributes will become inoperative. How could He manifest in His Attributes of forgiveness, for example, if there were no sins of the sinner to be forgiven? Thus, Names and Attributes are the characteristics of the law operative in all things.

آپ موحد صوفی صانی آپ ہے مطرب مجلس کافی
منکر ہو کر ہسدا (ڈھولامانی)

“He is himself the musician and he is himself the singer of kafi amongst the audience. He is himself Unitarian and pure Sufi. He himself negates

(transcends these forms) and then laughs (for he cannot be captured in any form), my beloved friend.”

He is the musician and the kafi singer (divine poetry sung on musical instruments) amongst the audience in simultaneity. He is himself Unitarian and himself in the form of Sufi, who is pure of otherness. He himself negates, that is, becomes transcendent and then laughs for he cannot be captured in any of these immanent forms. Who is the other who could hear the last laughter at the subtleties of his manifestations?

راول یار بروچل سانول آکر ہر آن اسان ول
دل کھس کھس ول نسدا (ڈھولامی)

“My lovely and charming friend Barochal perpetually manifests himself to us in different forms. He flees after grabbing our hearts every now and then, my beloved friend.”

His lovely and charming friend perpetually assumes immanent forms. He grabs his heart and becomes transcendent every now and then. Isn't love a game of transcendence and immanence?

بطن بطون توں ظاہر ہویا عربی تھی کر ملک نون موہیا
رسم رسالت رسدا (ڈھولامی)

“He manifested from the most invisible realm. He manifested himself in the form of an Arab (Arabian prophet) and captivated the dominion. He has perfectly conducted the tradition of prophecy (in the form of Muhammad as messenger), my beloved friend.”

The Essence, the most Invisible Realm, manifested itself in the form of Ahmad or the principle of differentiation within the differentiated Reality. He assumed the form of Muhammad and won the hearts of mankind. My beloved friend perfectly conducted the tradition of prophecy, in the

form of Muhammad, as the Messenger of God. He perfectly manifested Himself in the perfect medium of Muhammad.

دل نوں تا نگھاں لکھ لکھ چاہیں نکلن آہیں سو جھن نہ واہیں
ہنجرٹوں مینہ بر سدا (ڈھولامانی)

“My heart has longings and countless likings for you. I am heaving sighs without finding any outlet. The tears are flowing from my eyes, my beloved friend.”

He communicates with his beloved friend about the longings and countless likings of his heart, his heaving sighs in grappling with the problem of transcendence and his crying for vision and union with his beloved. The intimate communication with the beloved essentially helps him in understanding the dynamics of love.

یار فرید نہ و سرم شالا اوڑک لہسی آپ سنبالا
میں بے وس بے کس دا (ڈھولامانی)

“Farid! I pray that I never become oblivious of my friend. Ultimately, my friend will take care of me. I am just helpless and without any support, my beloved friend.”

He prays never to become oblivious of his friend even in the most testing times. He has hope in the responsiveness of his beloved. He is helpless and without any support. His only help and support rests with his beloved. It is an element of hope, which keeps the flame of love burning in ‘the dark night of the soul.’

Kafi-228

سجُن سدھائے وے میاں ساتھ وِسن شالا جیون مُج مٹھل متوارے

“My friends who have gone may dwell in togetherness. I pray that the friendly, sweet and the enchanted ones may live forever.”

The path of love is so intricate, difficult and hazardous that all those who successfully traverse it deserve heartiest congratulations. She sends good wishes to her friends who have realised union. She prays for the immortality of the friendly, sweet and loving souls.

سج برُ لدی ول ول بُھل دی دُسم نہ چانگے چارے

“I am wretchedly wandering in wilderness and forgetting the turnings of the way. I can't see pastures and the routes of the herds.”

She wanders wretchedly in wilderness and forgets the turnings of the way. She does not discern any indications of her transcendent beloved.

جلدی گلدی ہتھری ملدی 'گئے ہوت پیارے'

“My beloved Punna has deserted me. I am burning, rotting and rubbing my hands in vain.”

She considers transcendence as act of desertion by her beloved. She suffers in considering that all her efforts of realising union with her beloved have not fructified.

ڈکھدی جکھدی ماری لُو کھدی تھی کڑا اندا نگارے

“I am suffering, bearing tribulations and caught in the gusts of hot wind. I am the crushed stone turned into molten fire.”

The painful times of separation and disunion burn her to ashes.

منگاں دعائیں سنبھ صبا حیں آوم وصل دے وارے

“I am praying day and night for the moments of union.”

She realises that it is only by the Grace of God that she can transcend the servant-Lord axis and thereby unite with her beloved. Her ontological prayer reveals the dynamics of union.

سٹ بے واہی تھی گیاراہی دلڑی پارے پارے

“The traveller (my beloved) has left me without support. My heart has been crushed to pieces.”

The transcendence of her beloved leaves her without any immanent support. Her heart is ravished by the times of separation and disunion.

چھندی جھوکاں سہندی نوکاں کٹڑیں پودم توارے

“I sheepishly enter my dwellings and bear the sneers of people just to overhear any news about my beloved.”

She is very conscious of the contradiction that exists between her and the society. But even at the cost of being awkward, she still prefers the company of these sneering people just to overhear any news of her beloved.

یار پُئل دی سک پل پل دی روزا زل دی کارے

“The constant desire of my friend Punnaal is with me ever since the primordial day.”

The ontology of love finds its roots since the primordial day. It is not a momentary romance but her permanent love with her beloved.

برہوں بھنوالی الٹی چالی سکھ بوڑے ڈکھ تارے

“The whirlpools of love are paradoxical. Peace sinks (the boat of love) whereas sufferings make it afloat.”

She brings out the paradoxical nature of the whirlpools of love. The boat of love sinks in calm or stagnant waters whereas the tides of suffering keep it afloat. The alchemy of sufferings removes the dross, which helps the lover realise union with the beloved. If the dross were not removed by virtue of suffering, then the lover would simply drown by dint of the weight of his self. Doesn't suffering protect love?

سوز فریدنوں روز سوا یا لُوں لکھ چنگارے

“Farid's passion is on the increase day by day. There are countless sparks in each and every pore of my being.”

Love is not static but essentially dynamic. It is not a rational exercise involving cold logic. It is a burning, which burns the inmost chambers of one's being. The passion of love constantly increases with the passage of time. He experiences the sparking of fire of love in his bones and flesh, which is a positive sign of realising union with his beloved.

Kafi-229

کچھ ڈھوں ہن ہن وے سسی کر ہوں قطار

“O’ Sassil! Saddle the camels and hasten towards Ketch. The cry of the leaving caravan is so audible (at the imaginative level).”

Love prompts her to make preparations for grappling with the transcendence of her beloved.

جھاگ جبل تھل بار نال پُئل بن تن وے

“Go across the waters, mountains, deserts and forests and be united with Punnal.”

She has to face the hazards of transcendence in order to unite with her beloved.

پڑے ڈوہ گناہ نہ میڈے وے ہے ہی بروچل ید مفت کیتون بن وے

“I am neither liable to censure nor am I sinful. My Barochal friend! You have developed animosity with me for nothing.”

She is at a loss to understand the animosity (form of transcendence) of her beloved without her faltering or being in fault.

ہک کلہڑی بنی پیت کلڑی وے روواں زار و زار گلے دن دن وے

“I am all alone and further unintelligible love has fallen to my lot. I cry profusely by embracing each and every tree.”

She experiences loneliness that is intensified by the unintelligible love fallen to her lot. She wretchedly cries in wilderness.

نیں باری تے ٹانگ ابھاری وے رات لندھل غبدا جھڑینہ دی کن کن وے

“The stream is full and the bank is on the upper side (beyond my reach). It is a dark and cloudy night with rain.”

The transcendence of the beloved is so intricate that she finds it beyond her reach to capture it.

کیڈے کجل مساک گیو سے وے کیڈے ہد سنگار گہنے دی گھن گھن وے

“Where are my collyrium and twig (of the walnut tree) as tooth powder and lipstick (for its darkening effects)? And where are my makeup and the sound of my ornaments?”

She becomes oblivious of her beautification in separation and disunion from her beloved.

دلڑی چست نہ تھیویں پکڑی وے مطلب ہئی دیدار مونیں جیندیں تن تن وے

“My heart! Be active and do not show any weakness. The meaning (of all this effort) is to remain steadfast in witnessing, while living or dying.”

She counsels her stout heart not to show weakness in the arduous path of love but remain concentrated on achieving beatific vision of the beloved in the terrestrial world or the celestial one.

رہبر شوق شفیق سنجیں داوے جلدی موڑ مہل پریں ڈول کھن کھن وے

“Love is the kind guide of the ravished one. Hasten to turn the reins and keep on going towards my beloved.”

The fondness of love provides her guidance to quickly turn her face towards the beloved and continue her search of transcendence. The search of transcendence ultimately fructifies in immanence. She has to continue his journey of love till end.

برہوں فرید ہے بو جھا کو جھاوے بیشک باری بار رتی رتی من من وے

“Farid! Love is a disagreeable burden. Undoubtedly, it is a heavy burden whereby every ‘rati’ (a small measure) equals the weight of a maund (big measure).”

He finds the onerous burden of love very overbearing. It has no parallel with ordinary measures. Love assigns heaviness to even lightness. He wishes to end his life in separation and disunion from his beloved.

Kafi-230

سک ساڑے دل تا نگ پچالے وطن نہ و سرم را نجن والے

“The desire of my beloved is burning me and the longing of my heart is grilling me. I am not oblivious of my beloved’s city.”

The desire and longing of his beloved ravishes his heart. He does not remain oblivious of his beloved’s dwellings.

بجر فراق دا کو جھاقصہ ساہ منجھائے تے ہاں ڈالے

“The tale of disunion and separation is hideous. It makes me lose my breath and tears my chest apart.”

The hideous tale of separation and disunion of his beloved makes him fall in a deplorable state.

راہ اولڑے لکھ لکھ و لڑے ڈونگر کالے پیریں چھالے

“The ways are intricate with countless turnings. I got boils on my feet, while walking through the black mountains.”

The path of love is paved with intricate ways and countless turnings. He suffers a lot in facing difficulties of the way.

دلڑی جڈڑی ڈکھڑیں لڈڑی کینویں ہوش حواس سنبھالے

“My heart is incapacitated and burdened with sufferings. How could it sustain the sense and sensibility?”

His heart is incapacitated and affected by the onerous burdens of sufferings and thereby loses its poise.

جیندیں ڈیکھاں جھوک سجن دی قادر بار غماں دے ٹالے

“I wish to dwell with my beloved during my life time.
I beseech the Almighty to remove the burden of
sorrows from me.”

He beseeches the Almighty to remove the sorrows of
separation and disunion by granting him vision and union
with his beloved.

عشق سو غامتاں میں دل بھیجیاں درد اندیشے روگ کشالے

“Love has sent me the gifts of pains, anxieties,
malaise and adversities.”

Love has sent the gifts of pains, anxieties, malaise and
adversities to him. Aren't these gifts as mediums of attaining
realisation of love?

ہے سوہنیں دی ہے عادت اصلوں کوڑے پیچ فریبی چالے

“False pretensions and deceitful moves are the
essential habitual modes of the beautiful ones.”

He thinks that it is the habit of the beautiful ones to make
false pretensions and deceitful moves. He reflects on these
lines in the act of grappling with the transcendence of his
beloved.

یار فرید نہ اُترم دل توں لطفوں بھالے خواہ نہ بھالے

“Farid! My heart cannot be oblivious of my friend,
whether he casts the glance of love at me or not.”

He categorically wishes that his heart may never become
oblivious of his friend, irrespective of his positive or negative
response. Love has no conditionality. It is essentially
unconditional. It is not hypothetical. It is a form of
categorical imperative. He has to remain sincere to love for
the sake of love. The behaviour of the beloved, in a certain
sense, becomes irrelevant for him since he is committed to
love itself. The spiritual value of love consists in remaining
true to love, in principle, without setting eyes on its results.

Kafi-231

سک ٹولیں ساڑیں ساری وہ عشق دی اڈاواڑی

“Desire is characterized by all burnings. I laud the fraternity of love.”

He uses sarcasm to laud the world of love. The desire for vision and union with the beloved painfully burns his embodied self.

دل جل بل کیری کو لے دکھ رگ رگ سوز سمولے
ہک سینہ سو سو شعلے بن برہوں تے دوزخ ہاڑی

“The perpetual burning has reduced my heart to ashes. The suffering is storing passion in my each and every vein. I have one chest with hundreds of sparking. Love has become so hellish.”

His heart by virtue of perpetual burning is reduced to ashes without any trace of otherness. Suffering permeates his embodied self. The fire of love becomes so hellish. The fire of hell is not an end in itself. It is means toward wiping out the sins of duality or otherness so that the Reality is able to contemplate itself in the mirror of the sinner's heart. It is removing the rust from the heart or polishing the mirror of the heart (Sufi terminology). The concept of eternal damnation finds no place in the tradition of Islam. Likewise, the fire of love as an alchemy of suffering awakens consciousness in the lover regarding his ontological nothingness. The attainment of this consciousness corresponds to the end of his suffering. He, in a certain sense, is himself responsible for his suffering. The metaphysical law of things has been devised by the Almighty Wise. The

necessity of the law creates freedom. There can be no freedom bereft of law. The lover realises in fullness the wisdom of the law at the moment of his vision and union with the beloved.

جیں ڈینہ اکھیں میں لاتیاں کل آس امیدیں لاتھیاں
کیا پھسکن جیڑھیاں پھاتھیاں بیاہر کوئی ماری تاڑی

“My all hopes and expectations have withered away since I experienced love. How the fluttering of a captivated one is of any avail? All people are making fun of me.”

Love is such a heavenly blessing that his hopes and expectations of the world wither away. He becomes detached from all worldly attachments. He realises that the fluttering of a captivated bird is of no avail. The divine grip of love cannot be loosened by human efforts. It is only the beloved, which can offer some respite. But the beloved is so gracious as not to offer any respite during the ripening of love. Any respite offered at this stage is so disastrous for the lover. The inmates of hell fire will beseech God for some respite, which will be rightfully not granted by the Merciful God. Any temporary respite, internal or external, from the intensity of heat or period of burning will bring to naught the alchemical process of purifying the heart. It could not be started again. The lover is at odd with society. Ordinary people do not understand his higher consciousness and they exhibit their own ignorance and pettiness in making fun of him. Aren't they befooling themselves by mocking the wisdom of love?

میں کراں تنی کیا کاری ہن زخم پٹھے پھٹ کاری
گل کاتی پیٹ کٹاری سر بر چھی تبر کو ہاڑی

“I am the inept one and what effort should I make? My sore and deep wounds are in a terrible state. The knife is on my throat and the dagger has pierced my

belly. And there is a spear, lance and axe on my head.”

She realises the futility of her effort in the face of the tremendous might of love. She does not become passive but remains receptive. She exercises patience in adversity. Religiosity cannot understand the passion of love, which shakes the lover’s fabric of being. It contents itself in being purely dogmatic, ritualistic and moralistic. It has no road map for affecting a spiritual contact with God (Allah), his prophet (nabi) and his friends (awliya) including spiritual master (murshid). It can only offer them courtesy (adab) bereft of spiritual reverence. Resultantly, it remains oblivious of the spiritual perspectives, which make the Reality (God) manifest, pulsate and act through these mediums, which do not exist beside Allah for it tantamount to placing divinity beside Him. They are the manifestation of Allah in their being and having to the respective degree of their receptacles. Allah contemplates in the mirrors of their hearts. He feels, speaks and acts through them. The awakening of spiritual consciousness makes this metaphysical reality and truth become openly manifest.

ہن پھول نہ دل دے پھولے	تھیادس رس کو لے اولے
گھ سیواں ڈوہتھ پاڑی	اتھ پئے جو لہندے بھولے

“My beloved happily dwells with me so near and hidden. Do not ask me to delve on the states of my relationships. Here, the old contradictions are not resolved but I enter into graver contradictions.”

He experiences the transcendence and immanence of his beloved in simultaneity. He finds his beloved happily dwelling with him. The transcendence and immanence of his beloved is not spatial. It is a veil, constitutive of brilliance of light. He becomes inept in expressing the paradoxical nature of his relationship. He finds greater paradoxes in attempting to express the Inexpressible.

مل مونجھیں ڈولیاں وٹیاں گئی فرحت شادیاں ہٹیاں
غم خوشیاں پاڑوں پٹیاں دوکھ سکھ دی بیخ اکھاڑی

“The anguishes have gathered and are in a war like states with me. My serenity and happiness have vanished. The sorrows have uprooted my joys. Peacefulness has been incapacitated by sufferings.”

He battles with clusters of anguishes. He loses serenity and happiness. Sorrows uproot his joys. Sufferings incapacitate the states of his peacefulness. Isn't it a paltry sum for transforming the psychic into the spiritual?

آئے لوکاں ہتھ بہانے کئی ڈیوم ہنیں طعنے
کئی مارن کاٹھیاں کانے ہے بیایا ظلم ڈھاڑی

“People got many pretexts. Some is rebuking and taunting me and some are uttering offensive remarks against me. The cruelties are on the increase each day.”

His vocation is to divest himself of his individual and social self in order to attain consciousness of his ontological nothingness. His task is eased by people who find pretexts of rebuking, taunting and offending him. The cruelties at the hands of the outsiders remain on the increase. Doesn't love destroy the self-image of the lover, which he has formed in conjunction with his own self and the world?

سن یار فرید دیاں دھائیں کرناز و شوخ نگاہیں
ول آکھے سانول سائیں ہے راڑا کون پھچھاڑی

“Farid! Listen to the imploring of your friend. Well, my charming beloved in a state of priding with sprightly eyes asks: Who is this uncouth who is creating such a fuss?”

His imploring fully reaches her charming beloved who is so happy to hear these calls of distress signifying his

steadfastness on the path of love. The Omniscient beloved, in a prideful style, questions the identity of the uncouth lover creating such a fuss. The differentiation between the human and the divine love, among other things, pertains to the Omniscience of the divine beloved. The modern man has lost the capacity and strength of communication. It is one of the patterns of modern alienation that a person is not understood. The other always remains for him an outsider. Alienation is the bitter fruit of otherness. If there is no otherness, then there is no alienation. Divine love leaves no room for otherness. The very act of his imploring implies that his state is fully known to his beloved who is Omniscient, Omnipresent and Omnipotent.

Kafi-232

سکھی کر لیو ہار سنگار سبھی سیاں رمل دھوم چائی

“My friends are embellishing themselves. My friends are enjoying in togetherness.”

The polarisation of union and disunion is with a cosmic purpose. Being is realised through nothingness. The sweetness of immanence can only be tasted in fullness once the lover has faced the bitterness of transcendence. A person dying of thirst knows the worth of a few drops of water. The testing times of separation and disunion, which the lover faces, makes him really enjoy the times of vision and union. The ushering of the times of union makes her companions embellish themselves. Her friends are enjoying in togetherness.

گر جت بدرہ لکت بجلی رت سانوں ٹھیک سہائی

“There are flashes of lightning and thundering of clouds. The rainy season has made the weather fine.”

There flashes of lightning and thundering of clouds symbolising the advent of her beloved. The heavenly blessings have made the weather of love so fine.

اغن پیہے کرن بلارے رس کوئل کوک سنائی

“The call of crested cuckoos is audible. The nightingale is singing in a sweet voice.”

The finer sentiments are awakening within her being.

ملک ملہیر وسایم موئی سب گل پھل خنکی چائی

“My lord has made the area of Malheer blossom. There is freshness on flowers and fruits.”

Her inner self starts blossoming, by the Grace of the Lord.
The fresh sentiments of love are flowering and fructifying.

مل مل سیاں ڈیون مبارک مُدبھاگ سہاگ دی آئی

“My friends in togetherness are congratulating me on
the dawning times of nuptial fortunes.”

The dawning of the nuptial times is such a precious gift
that her friends are congratulating her on this festive
occasion.

مدتاں پچھے رانجھن ملیا رب اُجڑی جھوک و سائی

“I have met Ranjhan after a very long time. My
Sustainer has enlivened my deserted dwellings.”

She has met her beloved after such a long time (the
transcendent beloved has become immanent). She is grateful
to the Sustainer for enlivening her deserted dwellings with the
holy presence of her beloved.

آکر کان دوارے دل دے سدھ بنسی پر م بجائی

“Krishan has visited the inmost chamber of my heart.
He has perfectly played the flute of love.”

The beloved has perfectly played the flute of love by
unveiling himself in the inmost chamber of her heart.

سمجھ فرید نہ کر دل مونیجی کل لاج پئے گل پائی

“Farid! Understand and do not anguish your heart.
My entire honour is in the hands of my beloved.”

He counsels his heart to be free from anguishes. It has not
to bother about any thing since nothing is in his hands. His
entire honour is in the hands of his beloved. His realisation
that all is in the hands of his beloved is not a psychological
fact purporting to give psychological satisfaction or false
consolation but is a metaphysical truth. The Infinite
Attributes of the beloved cannot be exhausted by finiteness.
Romance is just psychic but love is essentially spiritual.

Kafi-233

نکھ سمہن سدہایم یار نہ نیتم سنگ وے

“My peaceful sleep has gone. My beloved did not take me along with him.”

People enjoy peaceful sleep in being oblivious of their ontological nothingness. Isn't he yet asleep in not realising that he cannot be with his beloved; it is his beloved who is with him? The one, who falls in love, wakes up.

سیجھ رنگیلی سٹیم پسلی دھانہ کرم انگ انگ وے

“I have thrown away my colourful nuptial bed. There is imploring of each and every part of my being.”

Her colourful nuptial bed has no meaning without her beloved. Her bones and flesh achingly implore for vision and union with her beloved.

نکلن آہیں سنچھ صباہیں ڈکھڑیں کتیم تنگ وے

“I heave sighs of distress day and night. My sufferings have made me tense.”

She constantly heaves sighs of distress at being separated and disunited from her beloved. She has no freedom from her vexing sufferings.

سجن سدھائے ول نہ آئے وہ قادر دارنگ وے

“My beloved went away and did not turn back. I laud the ways of the Almighty.”

The beloved became transcendent and did not appear in immanence. He lauds the intricate ways of the Almighty.

Doesn't the human, at times, fail to understand the Divine?
How could the human be the measure of Divinity?

کول نہ نیتم ڈھول دیندے روہی زلیم ک رنگ وے

“The beloved of my heart did not take me along with him. I have wretchedly wandered in the desert reduced in the form of a skeleton.”

She again laments that her beloved did not take her along with him. It is search of transcendence that makes her wander in the wilderness of the self till she is reduced to a wretched skeleton. She is surely stepping towards attaining the consciousness of her ontological nothingness. Isn't she lucky in being emaciated, which ultimately strengthens the spirit within her?

ٹلیم نہ سختی تے بد بختی گیانا موس تے ننگ وے

“My hard times and misfortunes did not end. I lost my honour and prestige.”

Her hard times and misfortunes on the path of love did not end. She lost her honour and prestige as well. Love makes social honour and prestige dwindle into insignificance. She earns infamy and notoriety, instead. She is perpetually pushed to the wall in order to realise that her entire honour and prestige is in reference to her beloved. She has no independence or autonomy in the affairs of her life. The sooner she realises, the better it is for her union.

درد اوڑے سول کلڑے تن من چور چرنگ وے

“My pains are intricate and my afflictions are unintelligible. My body and soul have been targeted for victimization.”

Intricate pains and unintelligible afflictions fall to her lot. Her embodied self becomes the target dot of sufferings.

زُلدی تھل وچ یار نہ ولوچ دلڑی لکڑی جنگ وے

“I am wretchedly wandering in the deserts but my beloved does not take care of me. There is warfare within my heart.”

She wretchedly wanders in wilderness at the transcendence of her beloved. There is warfare within her heart to disband love or continue under adverse circumstances. Reason and Intellect are constantly on war path with each other. The spiritual literature of mankind reveals that ultimately the Intellect (Heart or Spirit) wins the game of love.

عشق فرید چھکاموئیں جیندیں ڈے سر مول نہ سنگ وے

“Farid! Remain true to love with grace in good or bad times. Do not hesitate at all but sacrifice your head (for the sake of love).”

He counsels his heart to be graceful in love irrespective of good or bad times. He has no hesitation in sacrificing his being and having for the sake of love. Isn't romance merely hypothetical and love so categorical?

Kafi-234

سون سگون سہاندا ہے متاں سانول اسانول آندا ہے

“The rites of auguries seem pleasant to me. May be my beloved is coming to meet me.”

He is pleased at the rites of auguries of his beloved's unveiling in the inmost chamber of his heart.

فال وصال دی کرے چبولے لالی لوے تے کانگا بولے
سہجوں انگ نہ مانوم چولے سیجھ سے گھر بھاندا ہے

“The omen is giving good news of my meeting with my friend. The starling is singing sweetly and the raven is crowing. My inner happiness knows no bounds. My nuptial bed is flowering and my dwellings seem pleasant to me.”

The omen of his meeting with his beloved creates inward and outward happiness.

سوز اندوہ تھئے آزاری سول کریندے نالہ زاری
ہجر ڈوہاگ نوں مونجھ منجھاری دردالم غم کھاندا ہے

“The passion and grief themselves are in a state of distress. The afflictions are making lamentations. Disunion and misfortunes are in anguishes. The pains and torment are in a sorry state of affairs.”

The negative thoughts and feelings dwindle into insignificance. The dawn of light makes darkness vanish like a phantom.

آس امید نوید ہے شادی
عید سعید مبارک بادی
راحت ہر دم واد ہو وادھی
سکھ سکھڑا ڈکھ ماند ہے

“My hope and expectations have got the message of union with happy greetings. My fulfilments are on the increase at each moment. My peaceful state is on the increase and sufferings have become weary.”

The era of joy ushers in leading to the end of sufferings undergone by him in the state of separation and disunity from his beloved.

لانے پھوگ بھلارے وہ وہ
کنڈڑی کرڑ سنگارے وہ وہ
چنڑکی گھنڈ توارے وہ وہ
جھوکاں مال نہ ماند ہے

“The desert plants, thorny shrubs and bushes, the sound of bells around the necks of the herd and the songs of the shepherds seem so laudable. The dwellings cannot house the herds (there are plenty of herds in these dwellings).”

The spiritual joy leads to inner expansion. The self spreads in leaps and bounds. The whole world seems to dance on the tune of love.

گیا فرید ڈوہاگ دا دیلھا
صحن سو ہیلا گھر البیلا
آپے دلبر کیٹم میلا
جیس بن جی تڑ پھاند ہے

“Farid! The times of misfortune have ended. My courtyard is marvelling and my house is lively. My beloved has himself come to meet me without whom I was restless.”

The times of misfortune end for him. His inner self becomes so vibrant. The beloved unveils himself by giving peace to his restlessness. The initiative of responsiveness entirely rests in the hands of the beloved. Doesn't the lover weep on this very account?

Kafi-235

سوہنا نحن اقرب ڈسداڑی ساڈے نال نہ ہس رس و سداڑی

“The beautiful discloses that he is nearer to me than my neck-vein but he is not intimate and friendly with us (the mystery of immanence and transcendence).”

The beautiful is nearer to us than our neck-vein but he remains transcendent in not being intimate and friendly with us. The concept of nearness is not spatial and it breaks down when it comes to explaining the nearness of the beloved to the lover. The Reality is nearer to man than he is to himself yet it is so far away (non-spatial sense). The metaphysical reality of nearness is a form of identity but it still remains a mystery. The mystery is resolved in the act of metaphysical realisation. The lover realises his own ontological nothingness in the face of the Being itself. Isn't He more nearer to man than the mirror is to its reflected image? The lover questions the nearness of his beloved. He finds it so difficult to be near nearness. He realises that it is not possible to be near Him. The Prophet is reported to have said: God is, and no thing is with Him. If no thing is with Him, then the question of lover's nearness with the beloved does not arise. Metaphysically speaking, God is as near man as His Essence is with His Attributes.

کینوں ڈکھ دی گالھ سناواں کلہڑی سیجھ ستی تڑپھاواں
تارے گن گن رات نبھاواں ہے جی اوکھا بے وس داڑی

“To whom should I communicate my tale of suffering? I am suffering alone, while lying restless on the nuptial bed. I pass the night in vain. My heart is constricted and I am helpless.”

She suffers transcendence. She finds no one to understand her suffering.

یار پُنل ڈوں دِلڑی تا نگے اوکھے لاکھے راہ اڑا نگے
مشکل پینڈا ملن مہا نگے کنیں پووم آواز جس داڑی

“My heart longs for my friend Punnal. The paths are intricate and the way is hazardous. The route to him is so difficult and demanding although the tinkling of a bell around the camel’s neck is audible.”

She longs for her beloved. She feels the presence of her transcendent beloved but the paths leading to Him are intricate, hazardous, difficult and demanding. It is so testing for her to feel the presence of her beloved but at the same time failing to have a direct contact with Him. Isn’t it, as if by Providence, so hard for her to realise that unveiling is absolutely and totally in the hands of her beloved?

کو لے وسدا بھیت نہ ڈسدا دِلڑی کھسدا اول ول نسدا
ڈیکھ کے حال ایہیں بیکس دا کر ٹہہ ٹہہ دوروں ہسداڑی

“He dwells near but does not disclose the secret. He grabs the heart and remains on the run. He roars with laughter from a distance after seeing the state of the helpless (transcendence and immanence).”

He dwells near but shrouds it in mystery. He wins the heart in immanence and then becomes transcendent. He laughs in transcendence at her state.

نازک ڈھنگ عجائب ون دا سانول ڈھولے من موہندا
مان کراں کیا یار سجن دا او دلبر ہے ہر کس داڑی

“These are delicate ways and strange forms of my charming and bewitching beloved. How could I be possessive of my beloved friend alone? He is the beloved of every one.”

He experiences delicate ways and strange forms of his charming and bewitching beloved. He ceases to be possessive of his beloved friend since he is the beloved of every one.

Psychic love is possessive in nature. It desperately desires to possess the object of its love as a thing. It considers the beloved as the other devoid of freedom. It gives rise to symbiotic attachments. The whole romantic literature of mankind remains tied to the world of the psyche. It is only when it transcends the psychic world that it becomes spiritual. And it is such a rare happening. Spiritual love is non-possessive. It does not desire to possess the object of its love as a thing. It considers the beloved as person exercising real freedom. This is one of the reasons that it does not instil jealousy in the lover. He is spiritually contented in knowing that his beloved is loved by all.

اے بیکار فرید نبھایا لوہے وانگ بہوں بے مایا
فخر پئے دی صحبت آیا تھیا ہمسایہ پارس داڑی

“The useless Farid did not catch the eye of others. He was like scrap having a little price. He entered the splendid fold of Fakhr. It was the philosopher’s stone, which turned him into gold (the spiritual company of the master acted as an alchemy that turned base metal into gold).”

The great metaphysical and religious traditions of the world assign a pivotal role to the spiritual master in the quest of the Real. The disciple friend thinks that he was useless to catch the eye of the other. He was like a worthless scrap. It was his initiation at the hands of his spiritual master that transformed his psyche into spirituality. God manifests in the higher degree in the medium of the spiritual mentor. Love and reverence of the guru is essentially love and reverence of God. God leads the one to pir and, in turn, he leads him to God. God bestows knowledge of things (ilm) and knowledge of events (khabr) on the spiritual master, who guides his disciples accordingly. It is necessitated by the logic of the spiritual situation that he as a disciple submits sincerely, wholeheartedly and in wholesomeness to his murshid in order

to be blessed with metaphysical realisation, which is affected by the Grace of God.

Kafi-236

سوہنے یار جھوں میڈی نہیں سردی تا نگھ آوے دھدی سک آوے چڑھدی

“I cannot pass my life without my lovely friend. My longing for him is increasing and my desire for him is mounting.”

He finds it impossible to pass his life without his lovely friend. His longing perpetually increases and the desire of his beloved remains mounting. Love is not a static affair. The dynamics of love is such that his longing and desire for vision and union with his friend is greater than ever.

کیتا بجر بڑے میگوں زار و زارے دل پارے پارے سردھار و دھارے

مُو نچھ وادھو وادھے ڈکھ تار و تارے رب میلے ماہی بیٹھی دھانہہ کردی

“Your disunion has distressed (exhausted) me. My heart is crushed into pieces and my mind is highly incapacitated. Anguish is on the increase and sufferings are beyond my bearing. I am imploring that the Sustainer grants me union with my beloved.”

She is distressed by the disunion of her beloved. Her heart and mind are adversely affected. Her anguishes increase and the suffering become so overbearing. She implores her Sustainer to grace her with union with her beloved. Her entreating for Divine intervention brings to light the purity and spirituality of love. It implies the Grace of the Sustainer for the initiative and sustenance of love.

سوہنا یار ماہی کڈیں پاوے پھیرا شالا پاکے پھیرا کچھے حال او میرا

دل درداں ماری ڈکھاں لایا دیرا راتیں آہیں بھردی ڈینہیں سولاں سڑدی

“My lovely friend may come to meet me some day. I pray that he comes back and asks me about my condition. My heart is abject with the abode of

sufferings. I heave sighs at night and burningly bear afflictions in the morning.”

She is caught in the web of afflictions and sufferings. She wishes her friend to visit her, and ask her about her madness in love. Love attempts to integrate the human and the Divine perspectives.

پنوں خان میرے کیستی کیچ تیاری میں منتاں کردی تروڑی ویندا یاری
کئی نہیں چلدی کیا کیجئے کاری سٹ باندی بردی تھیں باندی بردی

“My Punnaal Khan is making preparations to move towards Ketch. I keep beseeching but he is going by ending friendship. I am powerless without knowing what to do. Now, I will leave my own maid servants and bonds women and shall become myself the maidservant of the deserts.”

She reads the signs of her beloved assuming the form of transcendence. She beseeches him not to become transcendent, meaning thereby not to end friendship. She becomes powerless without knowing what course of action would be befitting in these circumstances. She resolves to leave her supports and wander in wilderness of transcendence.

یرو فرید افریاد کر سہاں غم باجھ اسدے بیساہانہ بھر سہاں
جا تھیں سم میلا یا لڈی مرساں کہیں لاڈ کھائی دل چوٹ اندر دی

“Farid! I will beseech while crying. I will not take any breath except in sorrow for him. I will meet him or die in a wretched state. He has made me see within me his inflicted wound.”

He has been inflicted with inner wound by his beloved. He is entreating his friend with tearful eyes to heal his wound. He will breathe sorrowfulness without any breath of peace. He will affect union with him or die in a wretched state. His absolute, permanent and wholesome commitment keeps him steadfast on the path of love in spite of testing times.

Kafi-237

سجھ سہاوم بلی سکی بانہہ چوڑیلی

“My arm wearing set of bangles is longing for my friend to come and honour the nuptial bed.”

Her colourful sentiments of love long for her friend to affect union. Doesn't the inward and outward beauty attract one's beloved?

یار نہ ملد اعالم کھلدا حال اڈلڑا اوکھڑے دل دا

سج بر صحن حویلی

“The whole world is laughing at my separation from my beloved. The condition of my complex heart is intricate. My mansion and courtyard are so desolate.”

Her agony increases when the world laughs at her in being separated from her beloved. Her heart is filled with complexities and intricacies. The transcendent plenitude of her beloved makes her feel so empty.

بلبل بھنورے خوشیاں پاوان رل مل دوست بسنت سہاوان

آئی رت الیسی

“The nightingale and moths are manifesting happiness. My friends are celebrating Bas'ant. It is such a lively season.”

The sentiments of love are sprouting with happiness. The lovers are harvesting their love. The dawn of the lively season is making everyone happy.

کھڑکے سی سیالے بیٹے سیگیں زیور تریور کیتے

ہک میں محض ڈوہیلی

“The cold days and the winter season have passed away. My same age friends have worn jewellery and apparel. I am the only one in a state of sombreness.”

The times of separation and disunion have whisked away. Her companions are ornamenting themselves. She experiences sombreness in being deprived of realising union.

پیت پریں دی سبک متراں دی سینے سو سوسانگ ڈکھاں دی
سیندھ دھڑی تھئی میلی

“The love of my friends and desire of my companions is just like the spears of sufferings devouring my chest. My dressed hair has become unfastened and the line separating the hair on my head has become untidy.”

The love of her friends and the desire of her companions devour her embodied self. She becomes oblivious of her appearance and becomes lost in search of transcendence.

کچلے بادل مینہ برساتیں گا جاں لکھمنیاں کالیاں راتیں
رُلدی روہ اکیلی

“I am all alone wandering in wilderness and darkness of nights amidst black clouds, rain, thundering and lightning.”

She experiences a deeper loneliness amidst the signs of ushering of her beloved. It is only union with her beloved that can satiate her being.

نازنواز دے وقت وہانے بچھل گل ہار سنگار کمانے
بٹھ راہیل چنبیلی

“The times of priding and elegance have fled. My blooming flowers, necklace and makeup have faded away. I don't care a fig for the jasmine and its species.”

The times of her pride and elegance have become realities of the past. The colours of her life have faded away. She remains unconcerned with outward beauty. Her thirst for inward beauty remains insatiable.

یار فرید نہ آیم ویڑھے اجڑے گانے گہنے سہرے
پھر دی میل کچلی

“Farid! My friend has not stepped in my courtyard. The colourful threads around my wrist (symbolising marital bond) ornaments, and chaplets have been ravished. I am just roaming untidily.”

The beloved has not unveiled himself in the infinite depths of his being or consciousness. Things signifying nuptial union have lost their lustre (meaning). He wanders without caring about his untidy appearance. What is the significance of appearance bereft of reality?

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شہ رانجھا البیلا جوگی جادو گروے

“My majestic Shah Ranjha is an enchanted Yogi.”

The majestic beloved bewitches her in the form of a Yogi.

راول بنی جوڑ سنائی و سرگیم گھروے

“My beloved played on the flute and fully enchanted me. I have become oblivious of all my dwellings.”

The beloved played on the flute of love. She became so enchanted that she became forgetful of her being and having.

یارر گھٹھے مرلی واہی کر کر پیچ ہروے

“My friend Ranjhan played on the flute with great expertise and mystery.”

Her beloved played intricately on the flute of love with great mastery.

انہد بین بجا من موہیں زلدی بوئے جھروے

“My beloved has captivated my heart by playing on the divine flute. I am wretchedly wandering in forests and desolate places.”

Her friend captivated her heart by playing on the divine flute.

کنے کنے بندے گل جھپ ماہاں رہندے حسن نگر وے

“He came from the city of beauty and had earrings and a string of beads around his neck.”

He manifested from the Beauty itself in the form of her beloved with earrings and string of beads around his neck.

تخت ہزاروں رانجھن آیا ہیرتی وے گھروے

“Ranjhan came from Takht Hazara in the house of the inept Heer.”

The transcendent beloved assumed immanence to make love possible with the inept Heer (lover).

جو گن تھسیاں خاک رمیاں رلساں شہر بجدے

“I will become a Yogi and apply dust on my body. I will lead a wretched existence in land and sea.”

She will become an ascetic by soiling her body. She will wander wretchedly on land and sea.

ماہیو چھوڑ گئی لڑ بڑے سانول کاری کروے

“I have left my parents and have become completely subjected to you. My beloved! Do steer me across these difficult times.”

She has foregone her parents and has become wholly attached to him. She beseeches her beloved to finish her hard times of separation and disunion by granting her his vision and union.

باجھ پر بندے باجھ نہ کائی بٹھ زیور بٹھ زروے

“I have no support except that of my beloved. I cast away my jewellery and I don't care a fig for my wealth.”

She has no friend except her beloved. She has cast away her having purely for his sake.

اتنا ظلم مناسب ناہیں رب کولوں کچھ ڈروے

“Such a magnitude of cruelty is not fair. Do have some fear of the Sustainer.”

It is not fair on his part to be so cruel to her. He transcends, no doubt, her human dimension of cruelty but how should she leave her human dimension at this stage of love. She beseeches him to take into consideration his Attribute of being Sustainer of the heavens and the earth.

رانجھا جو گی میں جو گیانی ڈٹڑی عشق خبروے

“Ranjha is my Yogi and I am his Jogiani (completely subjected to him). This message has been communicated by Love.”

Love itself has polarised in the forms of the lover and the beloved. She is inspired to be her lover.

یار فرید نہ و سرم ہر گز سیکدی ویساں مروے

“Farid! I will never be oblivious of my friend. I will die in an insatiable state of desiring him.”

He commits never to be forgetful of his friend even for a moment. His insatiable state of desiring him will not end till his death.

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شہ رانجھا البیلا ہیں دلیندا ٹھگ وے

“My majestic Shah Ranjha is the swindler of hearts.”

The majestic beloved is the swindler of hearts.

ہے طعنہ منیں سہنیں ڈیوم سارا جگ وے

“The entire world taunts, rebukes and satires me just because of you.”

The entire world has gone against her just for the reason that she loves him.

جھوک نہ آواں کیں ول جاواں ہیر تتی دی تگ وے

“Where should I go instead of your dwellings? You are the support of the inept Heer.”

Where should she dwell without him? He is the only support of the inept Heer (lover).

کیڈے ہار سنگار گیوے کیڈے گئی جھگ مگ وے

“Where my makeup has gone? And where is my ceremonial apparel?”

Her embellishments and fine apparel have become meaningless for her without him.

نیرے جیرا جوڑ نہیویم دھانہ کریم رگ وے

“Love has stringently tightened my self. My each and every vein is imploring.”

Love has constricted her being. Her veins in the state of suffering are imploring her beloved to end the night of transcendence and dawn the morn of immanence.

سول اولڑے مول مٹھی دے دکھ آون کروگ دے

“I am the hapless ones with intricate afflictions. The sufferings are storming my being.”

She is the hapless one encountering intricate afflictions. The sufferings have thronged her being.

برہوں لہی جڑ کر لائی لوں لوں دُوکھ دی آگ دے

“Love has ignited a great fire. Here, each and every pore of my being is aflame.”

Love has ignited a great fire in her being. Her bones and flesh are aflame.

روندیں کھپدیں آتن بہندیں تھئی پیار آگ دے

“I sit in to spin my wheel, while crying and raising hue and cry. I have also become sick.”

She sits to spin the yarn of love while crying and raising hue and cry.

یار فرید نہ کیتم کاری جیواں کیندے لگ دے

“Farid! My friend did not take care of me. How can I live without his support?”

His friend did not alleviate his sufferings. How could he live on the support of the other when there is no otherness? The plenitude of the beloved's being leaves no possibility or room of otherness. It is He who manifests Himself in the mediums (immanence) and outside the mediums (transcendence). Nothing is over and above Him. If He chooses to bless him then the whole world cannot thwart His blessings (because the whole cosmos is ontologically nothing) and if He chooses straitening him then no one except Him can do away with it (because there is no one beside Him).

Kafi-240

صبح صادق خاں صاحبی مانے پاسہرے گانے گہنے

“I wish you royal status Suba Sadiq Khan with chaplets, colourful threads around your wrist (symbolising marital bond) and ornaments.”

The administration of Bahawalpur State was in the hands of the agent of the British crown. Sadiq Muhammad Khan was the fourth Nawab in the royal lineage. He was the most illustrious disciple of Khawaja Ghulam Farid. It was prior to 1879, when he was in the prime of his youth, that Khawaja Ghulam Farid prayed for his ascension to the seat of power with all pomp and show.

سہجوں پھلوں سیجھ سہاتوں بخت تے تخت کوں جوڑ چھکاتوں
اپنے ملک کوں آپ وساتوں پٹ انگریزی تھانے

“You readily choose to grace your seat and with fortune establish yourself in full power. You make your dominion prosper with your own hands and uproot the seats of colonial oppression.”

Khawaja Ghulam Farid, being born and nurtured in the Saraiki tradition, has made everlasting contributions in enriching Saraiki language, art and culture. He experienced life in wholesomeness. An in-depth study of his works reflects his deep understanding not only of the transcendent but also of the anthropological, social, economic, political, psycho and cultural conditions of his times. He inculcated values of freedom, justice and equality in his oppressed people and gave the message of struggle against the British colonial oppressors. It was before the year 1879 that he

addressed Suba Sadiq Khan, his disciple belonging to the Nawab (royal) family of Bahawalpur, and sensitised him to make his people prosperous with his indigenous efforts (negating even prosperity at the hands of foreign domination) and to uproot the citadels of oppression (apney mulk koon aap wasa toon put angrezi thaney). This single historical verse proved historic not only in developing the political consciousness of the Saraiki people at that nascent stage but of other people as well. Its local political reference notwithstanding, it purported to give a universal message of political freedom, which remained shining forth in the freedom movement and eventually led to the creation of Pakistan in 1947. It was a principled message of political freedom against political bondage. It was a call of cultural freedom from all forms of cultural oppressions. It is not only what is said but when and by whom that takes precedence in a tradition. The saint's word of mouth flashed like light and broke the magical spell of darkness. It struck like lightning at the roots of colonialism. It is still so deeply inspiring in the era of neo-colonialism.

سُن اقبالؔ! آپے ڈردے راجے دہشت کھا کر مردے
میر نواب تھے آبر دے بے زر مفت و کانے

“The sovereigns fear in hearing your might and are spiritless in a state of dread. The chiefs and princes have subjected themselves to you without getting any riches or anything in return.”

He inspires him by saying that the sovereigns fear his might and become dreadfully spiritless. The chiefs and princes subject to him unconditionally.

پیر فقیر تیکوں سب چہندے صوبیدار ملازم رہندے
گردا گرد کچہری بہندے آفلاطون سیانے

“The saints and holy men are fond of you. The army officers are your employees. The wise men of the status of Plato are present in your court around you.”

The saints and holy men have great fondness for him. The men of state authority are his employees. The wise men of the status of Plato are readily available to him for advice on the conduct of the state.

فیض بے دے جگ وچ قے زالاں مرد گئے لہن حصے
نینگر تکرے بڈھڑے لے نڈھڑے بال ایا نے

“The world is narrating the tales of your benevolence. All people including women and men, young boys and stout men, old people and weak ones and small children and those with less understanding got their due shares.”

His benevolence is spread far and wide. All sections of the society including the poor, feeble and weak get their due shares.

خوب ہنڈائیں چند جوانی ہر دم کول و سیں دل جانی
یار پیارا یوسف ثانی ناز بے من بھانے

“I wish that you pass your life in animated fullness. The beloved of my heart! You may ever dwell with me. My beautiful friend of Yousaf countenances! Your prides has enchanted my heart.”

He wishes him a long life with prosperity. He desires that the beloved of his heart dwells with him may forever. He likens his beautiful friend to the prophet Yousaf since his gracefulness has enchanted his heart.

کرے فرید ہمیشہ دعائیں سانول جیویں چر جگ تائیں
بے ساڈے سوہنا سائیں لگڑے نینہہ پرانے

“Farid constantly prays: “My beloved, you may live forever”. My lovely friend! Your and mine

relationship of love has been ever since times immemorial.”

He constantly prays for the long life of his beloved friend. He refers to the primordial love that exists between him and his disciple. The love of the disciple for his murshid reaches a stage when the murshid starts loving him. The mystery of love notwithstanding, the disciple has to earn the love of his murshid with reverence. Once the murshid falls in love with his disciple it tantamount to God falling in love with him. The wishes, desires and prayers of the murshid are granted by the Almighty in His Infinite Wisdom, Beneficence and Graciousness. The spiritual relationship between the murshid and murid reaches its climax when the murid considers God in the form of his murshid. Nothing less is acceptable in the spiritual way.

Kafi-241

عشق انوکھڑی پیڑ
سو سوسول اندر دے
نیں وہاوم نیر
الڑے زخم جگر دے

“Love is a novel pain with countless inward afflictions. The eyes are flowing with tears and there are fresh wounds of the self.”

The pain of love is qualitatively different from all other pains. The ambiguity of love pain is that the lover wants to get rid of it but at the same time develops a taste for it. He faces innumerable passionate afflictions. The eyes remain tearful for the lack of vision of the beloved. The wounds of the self remain ever fresh.

برہوں بکھیرا سخت اوڑا
خویش قبیلہ لاوم جھیرا
مارم مایو ویر
دشمن لوک شہر دے

“The incongruities of love are very peculiar. My kith and kin are having brawls with me. My parents and brothers thrash me. The people of my city have turned into my enemies.”

The peculiar incongruities of love, among other things, are the turning of his primary and secondary ties as nooses around his neck.

تاگ اوڑی ساگ کلڑی
جنڈی جلڑی دلڑی گلڑی
تن من دے وچ تیر
مارے یار ہنر دے

“My longing is intricate and the spear of love too is so unintelligible. My life is burnt and my heart is

rotten. My friend has swiftly shot the arrow in my body and soul.”

His longing is intricate. It remains constantly on the increase. Its search for transcendence makes it detached from everything around. The mystery of ontological love is not intelligible. It is initiated by the beloved who swiftly shoots the arrow of love in his embodied self and then leaves him on his own.

غمزے سحری رمز ایں دیری اکھٹیاں جادو دید لٹیری
ظلمیں زلف زنجیر چکی پتھر دے

“The enticements of my beloved are captivating and its expressions are my adversaries. The eyes are magical and the vision is capturing. The captivating long hair is a chain with ravishing furls.”

The beauty of the beloved with its seductiveness entices him to the arena of sufferings. He realises when ‘the shades of night have already fallen.’ There is no turning back. He cannot retrace his steps. The road is not there.

پیت پُنل دی سک پل پل دی مارو تھل دی ریت پجل دی
ڈکھ لاؤن تڑ بھیڑ جو سردے سو کر دے

“My love of Punnal is a constant desire of him. The sand of the deadly desert is fateful. The flocking sufferings impose themselves on me to the utmost extent.”

The love of her beloved makes her constantly desire the object of her love. The feelings of the deadly desert of her self are fateful. The hordes of sufferings take no pity on her. They do what they are capable of doing or they do what the beloved has commanded them to do (roughly analogous to the inmates of the fire of hell). Symbolically speaking, the keepers of the hell are bereft of pity for the inmates of hell. They are completely subject to the command of their Lord. The process of alchemy is such that any pity showered, by

any one, to the inmates of hell would be so spiritually disastrous. It is deeper love, which makes the process of alchemy reach its fruition in 'deliverance and union' without any intervention.

تول نہالی ڈین ڈکھالی
لُوں لُوں لکھ لکھ چیر
صبر آرام دی و سرم چالی
کاری تیغ تبر دے

"My nuptial quilt and mattress haunt me. The ways of patience and peace have been forgotten. The severe hits of the axe have made hundred thousand deep cuts in each and every pore of my being."

The signs of nuptial union haunt him. He becomes incapacitated even to exercise patience in order to achieve some peace in life. He is completely ravished from within.

یار فرید نہ پائیم پھیرا
سڑ گیم سس سریر
لایا درواں دل وچ دیرا
نیساں داغ قبر دے

"Farid! My friend has not come back to meet me. The pains have settled in my heart. My head, body and soul have been burnt. I will take these marks to my grave."

His transcendent beloved has not assumed immanence. His heart has become abode of sorrows. His embodied self has been burnt. He will carry these marks of sufferings till his death.

Kafi-242

عشق او لڑی پیڑو لوکاں خبر نہ کائی

“Love is an intricate pain. People are not aware of it.”

People are not aware of the intricate pain of love. Pain is not conceptual, it is purely existential. One has to experience pain in order to realise it. Ordinary pain indicates that something is wrong. The pain of love indicates that something is so right.

زلف ڈنکندیں مول نہ سگی چشمیں سرہوں بہادر جنگی
ناز نگاہ دے تیرو نت کرن لڑائی

“My tresses give me snake bite without any hesitation. The eyes are essentially courageous and warlike. The arrows of prideful eyes are ready to make strife at each moment.”

The bewitching beauty of the beloved ignites love in her heart. The intensity of love corresponds to the degree of beauty. It is not a mathematical equation but it does represent the Pythagorean qualitative understanding of numbers.

شالا نیز اکوئی نہ لاوے درد اندیشے سوز سوائے
دم دم دل دِ لگیرو سرتے سختی آئی

“I pray that no one may fall in love. It leads to increasing pains, anxieties and passions. My heart is constantly in state of grief. Hard times have befallen me.”

She expresses the hardships of love. Her prayer that no one may fall in love, in fact, is a deeper call to love but with the consciousness that the lover has to exercise patience in adversity in order to have vision and union with her beloved.

مُنْجھ منجھاری گل دی چائی ہک بیواہی بیا پھٹ جاہی
روندیں مویم اجائی تک تک راہ ملہیر وو

“I am shelterless, stricken and wounded. The anguishes have tightened the noose round my neck. I will die in vain by watching the path of Malheer.”

She is stricken and wounded by the arrow of love shot by the beloved. She has nowhere to go. The anguishes of separation and disunion from her beloved have straitened her. She is sure to die in vain in her search of transcendence.

بشیر بد بگھیاں بکھیلے سنج برچترے شینہہ مریلے
غم سکڑے بھائی ڈکھ ڈکھڑے تھئے ویر وو

“There are tigers, ferocious lions, black snakes, wolves and wild animals in these desolate and deserted places. My sufferings have become my brothers and I have established real fraternal ties with my sorrows.”

She faces negativities in the wilderness of herself. She has become susceptible to sufferings and sorrows. Aren't sufferings and sorrows fraternal in ultimately affecting union with her beloved?

ویرن ویری سخت ستاؤم سینیں بھینیں وین الاؤم
اے بیدرد کسائی مارم بے تقصیر وو

“My close relatives and sisters give me bad wishes. My brothers are inimical to me and they highly vex me. They are pitiless butchers, who ravish me without any fault of mine.”

She feels herself like a sacrificial animal butchered ruthlessly and brutally at the hands of her kith and kin, who act as cruel butchers without any of her fault. Isn't the sweet punishment of love inflicted on the one who is right? Hasn't rightness itself in ontological love been considered as a 'fault'? It is not the hunter but the hunted that is at 'fault' in the sanctuary of love. Doesn't her pitiable condition demonstrate that the alchemy of suffering is so wondrous?

سولیں مول نہ ڈترم سہی قادر اینویں قلم و ہائی
کیٹم اے تقدیر وو سوہنے نال جدائی

"My afflictions did not let me have even some breathing space. The Almighty has written this with pen on the tablet of my destiny that I will remain separated from my beloved."

She has no breathing space against pouring afflictions. The Almighty (God) has destined separation from her beloved. Isn't it the law of things that the lover faces separation, which ripens his love to fruition?

جندڑی بکھدی چیز ا دکھدا ویلھا وقت نبھایا سکھدا
رنج والم دی بھیڑ وو آفت پیم سہائی

"My life is in tribulations and my self is emitting smoke (burns). I did not get even a few days of peace. Grief and torments have flocked together. It is a cosmic catastrophe."

She considers her love as catastrophic characterised by tribulations, burnings, grief and torments. Her self (shattered) in pieces has no peace.

مژگیں نشتر ہاں دی ماری پلکیں لائی کیبر کاری
زخم کللڑے چیر وو ویندیں چوٹ چلائی

"The eyebrows of my beloved captivate me. The eyelids have shot such fierce arrows that my

unintelligible sores cannot be healed. It is the injury that my beloved infested me with, while going away.”

The beloved bewitches her by the spell of his beauty. The sore wounds of love are so unintelligible. Only a wounded lover can qualify love. The beloved infests her with the wound of transcendence. Unlike ordinary healing, the wounds of love can only be healed by the one who inflicts it. It is vision and union, which heals the sore wounds.

لُوں لُوں سڑدی ہڈچم گدا دلڑی جلدی سینہ بلدا
رگ رگ چھڑی سیڑھ دو بے برہوں چھڑائی

“My each and every pore of being is on fire and my flesh and bones are rotting. My heart is burning and my chest is constricted. My beloved! Your love has made my blood gush forth from my each and every vein.”

Her very being is set on fire by her beloved. Her bones and flesh are reduced to ashes. There are no remedial measures against the fire of love. The wind of separation increasingly enkindles it. Isn't it the only way to make her conscious of her ontological nothingness?

صبر قرار آرام گیوسے بار ملامت مفت چتوسے
کانی بے تدبیر وو جانی لاڈ کھلائی

“I have lost my patience, peace and rest. I have taken reproaches on my self just for nothing. My beloved shot the arrow of love without realising its consequences for me.”

She loses her patience, peace and rest. She innocently takes upon herself the reproaches of others. The beloved did not realise the disastrous consequences she would face in the course of love.

کچھ گیارہ گھرنہ آیا
کیٹس خوب بھلائی

یار فرید نہ کھڑا مٹلایا
ڈٹس جڑ تعزیر وو

“Farid! My friend did not stop for a while to bid me goodbye. He went to Ketch but did not return to my home. He has so chastised me. What a great goodness he has done to me.”

He persistently grapples with the problem of transcendence. The beloved assumed transcendence and did not assume immanence within the infinite depths of his being or consciousness. It is considered as a form of chastisement inflicted upon him. He questions the very goodness of transcendence in reference to his deplorable state?

Kafi-243

عشق چلائے تیر ڈاڈھے ظلم قہر دے
یار ملیا بے پیر لوں لوں سو سو دردے

“Love shoots arrows of severest cruelty. I have found an unruly friend. There are immeasurable pains in each and every pore of my being.”

He faces the arrows of love of severest cruelty as a dot target. The beloved has no consideration in infesting him with countless pains permeating his being.

عشق اجاڑی جھوک امن دی نظر نہ آنوم جوہ جتن دی
سوز ڈٹس جاگیر جیڑا مولائ سڑدے

“Love has destroyed my peaceful dwellings. I can't find a way to reach my destination. I have been invested with the wealth of passion. My self is burning with afflictions.”

Love destroys the peace of everydayness of existence. He does not find out a way entrapped in the tunnel of love. He is enwrapped with heightened passions. His self burns with afflictions.

تول ڈکھاندی سیجھ نہ بھاندی سول براندی درد پواندی
رگ رگ وچ ہے پیڑ ڈسدے روگ اندردے

“My nuptial quilt is knitted with sufferings and the nuptial bed is not appealing. The affliction is on the side of my head and pain is on the side of my feet. There is pain in my each and every vein. I can witness my inward malaise.”

He faces nuptial sufferings. His embodied self becomes highly afflicted. Pains settle in his veins. He witnesses his inner malaise in separation and disunion from his beloved.

رہن نہ ڈیندی پیڑ پرائی سک مہینوال دی روز سوائی
کیجولوڑ ہم سیرٹھ بوڑم کن کپر دے

“The pain of my beloved is becoming unbearable.
The longing of my beloved is increasing every day.
What, if this deadly whirlpool of love drowns me?”

What she understands as the unbearable pain of the other is essentially the pain of not seeing or meeting her beloved. Isn't it to make her realise that the beloved is not the other but her own Self? The longing of her beloved is constantly on the increase. The deadly whirlpool of love is bound to drown her.

سکھ سمھن دا وقت وہایا باربر ہوں داسرتے آیا
گزر گئی تدبیر نبھ گئے وقت ہنر دے

“The times of sound sleep are gone away. The burden of love has fallen on my head. The phase of an effort is over. The times of doing something perfectly with one's own hand have fled away.”

The times of ignorance have passed away. He has to bear the onerous burden of love. The mode of his effort and reliance on his resources comes to an end. The modes of the terrestrial world are qualitatively different from the modes of the celestial world. Even in the terrestrial world the effort is made by the Grace of God and the results entirely rest in His hands. There is no cause-effect relationship in love. He realises that ultimately his effort or resources cannot win the beloved on his side. It is pure blessing of the beloved to respond to his calls. How great to realise that effort does not count since nothing is in his hands, nay even hands don't belong to him!

نہجن فرید اے ڈکھ ڈوہیلے
 شالاناں وصال سہیلے
 ہوواں شکر شیر
 گزرن ڈینہہ سفر دے

“Farid! These days of sombre sufferings may come to an end. I pray that I become one and attain unity with my beloved. My days of journeying may fructify.”

He wishes the end of his sombre sufferings. He prays for the Grace of the Lord in affecting union with his beloved and thereby fructifying his journey of love.

Kafi-244

غزے کر دے جنگ لڑے مول نہ اڑے
نیزے تیر تفنگ قہری ناز نظر دے

“The enticing are warring and never retreat. The prideful vision is fighting with spears, arrows and muskets.”

The mighty and vibrant beauty initiates love in his heart. How could love of such a magnitude be initiated otherwise? Religiosity has no answer. The ordinary religious life is content with faith in God and acting in consonance with His will. It has no roadmap of love. He encounters beauty at the very first instance and then burns with love for his beloved. He has found God and then seeks to find Him. It is paradoxical but it simply means that unless one has envisioned his beloved, the question of affecting union with Him does not arise.

زلف ہے بشیر ابو بچھوے مارن ڈنگ نَسنگ
چکدے زخم جگر دے

“The lock of hair is a black snake and the eyebrow is a scorpion. They are biting freely leading to the bleeding of wounds in my being.”

The manifestation of Beauty itself in brilliance blinds the eye of love. Love becomes blind due to the recurrence of majestic beauty. It ravishes his being. Love implies beauty.

سانول دی ہے طرز انوکھی تن نازل دل سنگ
ذرہ مہر نہ کر دے

“The style of my charming beloved is so novel. His body is delicate but his heart is stony. He does not shower even an iota of pity.”

The style of the charming beloved is so queer. His appearance is delicate but the reality behind appearance is so stony. He does not shower even an iota of pity on him. Isn't it that if the reality of the beloved would have been identical with his appearance then the lover would have never succeeded in affecting vision and union with him?

برہوں اسانول خلعت بھیجی
سہاویلا رنگ
سو سوسول اندر دے

“Love has sent us a robe of honour coloured in green and yellow. There are hundreds of afflictions wrapped in it.”

Love infests him with a robe of honour coloured with pains, sufferings and countless afflictions wrapped in it. How fortunate is the person whom love infests with such a robe of honour!

عشق و نجایم شرم بھرم توں
گیانا موس تے ننگ
گذرے وقت صبر دے

“Love has made us lose our prestige and honour. My grace and respect have been finished. The times of forbearance have passed away.”

Love divests him of prestige and honour. It ends his grace and respect. It does not let even a trace of otherness remain. He finds it impossible to exercise patience in the adversity of love.

حال فرید دا دکھ ڈوہیلا
دلڑی کیٹس ننگ
نہ جیندے نہ مردے

“Farid is in a state of sombre sufferings. His heart has vexed him so much that he is neither living nor dying.”

He remains in the state of sombre sufferings. His vexing heart does not make him live or die. Doesn't the state between living and dying make him experience the zenith of suffering in which he can neither live without his beloved nor die without Him?

آس آئی تے یاس سدھائی
جھڑ بادل آجھر مر لائی

اجڑیاں جھوکاں خنتکی چائی
غم ڈر ڈر لگ پوندا ہے

“Hope has dawned with the end of despair. The raining clouds have started to rain. The deserted dwellings have become fresh (inhabited). Sorrow is fearfully trying to hide itself.”

One of the signs of happy times is that the night of despair ends with the dawn of hope. Nuptial blessings start to pour. The deadness of his self is transformed into liveliness. There remains no room for sorrow.

میںہ برسات خوشی دے ویلھے
چھیڑن چھیڑو چھانگ سویلے
آپے دلبر کیتے میلے
جیں بن جی تڑپھوندا ہے

“This rainy season is the time of happiness. The shepherds take their herds for grazing in the early morning. My beloved has himself come to unite with me. My heart was restless without him.”

The pouring of nuptial blessings is the period of happiness. His sentiments feed on the freshness of love. His transcendent beloved takes initiative in assuming immanence for his sake so that his restless heart finds peace.

ٹپے ریخاں تھل تے ڈہر
کل گل ڈسدے احرا صفر
ڈکھ کشالے گزرے یکسر
نکھ رگ رگ وچ دھوندا ہے

“There are sand dunes, sandy tracts, deserts and the areas between dunes spread with red and yellow flowers. The sufferings and adversities have all disappeared. Peace refreshes itself in my each and every vein.”

The wilderness of his self gives way to the sprouting of beautiful flowers symbolising happiness. The light of vision and union vanish the darkness of sufferings and adversities. The veins of suffering become the veins of peace.

ڈکھ ڈوہاگ دا وقت وہایا
بھاگ سہاگ دا ویلھا آیا
یار فرید انگن پوں پایا
ہار سنگار سہوند اے

“The days of sufferings and misfortunes have gone away. The times of good fortunes and union have dawned. Farid! My friend has stepped in my courtyard. My makeup seems so pleasant to me.”

The mystery of time is one of the greatest mysteries encountered by man. There are numerous dimensions of time and eternity. One of the greatest blessings of time is that it does not stop or stand still. It builds civilizations and razes them to the ground when they are metamorphosed into ‘sensate cultures’. It moves in majestic silence without creating any hue and cry. People live in time and die in time but time never dies but lives on. It goes its way in different patterns in order to reach its source. No moment of life and thereby no situation of life is static. Dynamism pervades all situations. Patience in adversity by remembering God and acting in consonance with His will is the traditional lesson forgotten by the modern man. He is so desperate that he wants dawn at midnight. He has intensified the pace of life. He has no space for time. Time has also no space for him. Despair errs in considering time as static. Hope understands the dynamic reality of time. Modern alienation is essentially alienation from time. The traditional man understands the reality of time. He creatively struggles within the parameters of time without losing his poise. There is easiness after difficulty says the Qur’an. It is a moment of great happiness for him to see the passing away of the difficult times of sufferings and misfortunes. The times of good fortunes and nuptial union begin to dawn. How could time remain static in the face of dynamism? The beloved steps in his courtyard (unveils within the lover’s heart). He finds the taste of his embellishments so relishing. God is Time, says the tradition. How great!

Kafi-246

گزر گئی گذرانِ غمِ دے سناگِ رلیو سے
ڈٹھڑا جمل جہاں نا کجھ پلڑے پیو سے

“My life has been spent in togetherness with sorrows. I have experienced the world but it has offered me nothing of significance.”

He spends his life in the midst of sorrows. He finds nothing of significance in the world. The world with all its attractions and lures is worthless. The only thing valuable is vision and union with his beloved.

ویندیں یار نہ کھڑ مٹلایا
چکچوں کوئی پیغام نہ آیا
چندڑی دا جھمان
گل دا گٹر تھیو سے

“My friend did not bid me a farewell, while parting from me. I have not received any message from Ketch. The subjection of my life to love has become a noose around my neck.”

She is shocked by the suddenness of her beloved's transcendence. She does not receive any message from the transcendent abode. Love ties the noose around her neck.

نہ ماہی نارنگ مہیں دی
جھوک اجاڑ ڈسم تہیں ڈینہہ دی
بیلا تھیا ویران
تھی بے آس رلیو سے

“My dwellings are deserted since the day my beloved left. The voices of the herd are no more audible. The green pastures have become desolate. I am in a wretched state without any hope.”

Her dwellings become deserted with the transcendence of her beloved. She hears no inner voices. The green pastures of her life are deadened in separation and disunion from her beloved. She wretchedly wanders in state of hopelessness.

لانیس لہندیس پیم وچھوڑا کھارے چڑھدیس آیم وھوڑا
مہندی سرخی بان نیلارنگ وٹیوسے

“I got separation and set back, while performing my nuptial rites. Henna, rouge and frankincense (the red colours of happiness) changed into blue (the colour of sorrow and sadness in contradistinction to the red colour).”

She was united with her beloved (immanence) when suddenly she experienced separation from her beloved (transcendence). The colours of immanence and happiness changed into the colours of transcendence and sorrows.

وین سیاپے ماتم گاہنے ڈکھ ڈوہاگ دے تول وہانے
سولاں داسامان، آزلوں ڈاج ڈھیوسے

“My jewellery consists of wailing, chest beating and mourning. The quilt and pillows are my sufferings and misfortunes. This is my dowry of afflictions that I have received ever since the primordial day.”

She gets violently shaken from within while facing her beloved's transcendence. She undergoes sufferings and misfortunes. It is her dowry of afflictions that she has received in affecting nuptial love since primordial times.

چھوٹی عمر رنڈیا آیم کھوٹی قسمت کھوٹ کمایم
ڈوجھا اے آرمان ویندیں نامکلیوے

“I have become a widow in such a tender age. My bad luck (destiny) brought misfortunes. And further my beloved did not fulfil my wish of bidding me a goodbye.”

She considers herself as the widower of love at such a tender age. It is her bad luck, which has brought misfortunes for her. She had an earnest desire that her beloved should have at least bidden her good-bye while going away. It is a strange feeling which recurs in her mind. It is a form of projecting human to the divine. She, in fact, is not mentally prepared for parting with her beloved. She wants to know the road map of love. She wishes a strong foothold on the path of love. But she is face to face with the suddenness of her beloved's transcendence, instead. It is so difficult for her to face this bolt from the blue.

جیندیں تیں اے درد نبھیاں
پٹ پٹ تھیا خفتان
مردیں داغ قبر وچ نیساں
رور و خلق روو یوسے

“I will bear my pain till I live in this world. I will take these marks to my grave. I have mourned so much that my heartbeat has affected my mind. I have cried and made other people cry.”

She resolves to bear the pain of love till she lives. Her mourning at the widowhood of her love has affected her mental faculties. She has cried and made other people cry at her awful condition.

جیں بن ہک پل مول نہ وِستے
وہ تقدیر دا شان
باقی کرنے آئے قسے
کیا ہا کیا تھی گیوسے

“I was never in peace even for a moment without my beloved. Now, only the tales (of my friendship with my beloved) are left. I laud the glory of destiny. How (good) times have changed (the state of union has become the state of separation).”

She recounts the times when she was always with her beloved. She did not have even a moment of peace without him. Now, it has all become history. She lauds the glory of destiny, which has changed the times of union into the times

of disunion. Doesn't her concept of destiny symbolise circumstances beyond her control?

کر کر یاد فرید سجن کوں لاگل روواں ہک ہک ون کوں
جان جگر وچ کان جانی جوڑ مریو سے

“Farid! I cry by folding my arms around every tree by constantly remembering my beloved. My beloved has perfectly shot the arrow in my self.”

He cries in helplessness by constantly remembering his beloved, who perfectly shot the arrow of love piercing his embodied self.

Kafi-247

کرن نظارے تیز نظر (شلاجیویں) نور وجود عیانی

“I pray for the people to live long, who witness the manifest light of Being with their sharp vision.”

He prays for the ones whose heart-perception witnesses the manifest light of Being.

سر سبجانی راز انا الحق رندی ورد لسانے

“The ecstatic utterances, unravelling the mystery of ‘Glory to Me’ and the secret of ‘I am the Truth’ are on my tongue.”

He reaches the spiritual stage of ontological nothingness whereby the ecstatic utterances of Mansur Hallaj and Bayazid Bistami are on his tongue. It is essentially the Reality, which takes over his medium and speaks through him.

ورد مہانی کشف معانی اہل دلیند اشانے

“The discovery of hidden meanings in the ordinary recitals is the glory of the people who have heart-knowledge.”

The ones who have heart-knowledge discover the apparent and hidden meanings contained in the recitals. It is at the highest level that the subject and the object of recital become identical. It is the Reality, which recites on the human tongue.

سمجھ سبجانی غیر نہ جانی سب صورت سبجانے

“Do have a deeper understanding and never consider it as the other because the Reality (Transcendent) is manifest in all forms of immanence.”

The Reality is manifest in all forms. There is nothing other than the Reality since there is no otherness.

اول آخر ظاہر باطن یار عیان بیانے

“The First, the Last, the Outward and the Inward are the open-manifestations of my friend.”

The Reality is openly evident in the forms of the Origin, the End, the Manifest and the Unmanifest. The four dimensions of the Reality are not only non-spatial and non-temporal but are spatial and temporal as well. Religiosity commits a cardinal error in constricting and isolating these four fundamental dimensions of the Reality. One of the dimensions of the Reality or God is the Manifest (Zahir), which is rightly understood as the Omnipresence of God. But religiosity due to imaginary fear of pantheism (by-product of modern philosophy) denies the metaphysical reality and truth of ‘Seeing God Everywhere’. It fails to realise that the dimension of the Manifest (immanence) does not deny the transcendence of the Reality or God. “Is God One at specific places and times or One at all places and all times,” questions Baba Husayn Shah, a notable mystic. The answer is that God is One at all places and at all times. And if it is so, then man has no place beside the plenitude of the Absolute Being. The desperate attempt of religiosity to assign him a place beside God is placing divinity beside Him, which is the very negation of the principle of tawhid or unity. Speaking ontologically, Man is simply nothing. The doctrinal truth of the four dimensions of the Reality is witnesses in the act of metaphysical realisation.

کہ منصور تے طیفوری کہ سرمد صنعانے

“He is Mansuri and Taifuri at times and at times is Sarmad and Sanaan.”

The Reality, at times, manifests in the forms of Mansur Hallaj and Bayazid Bistami and at times in the forms of Sarmad and Sana'an (the murshid of Fariduddin Attar). It is through the principle of Oneness that one can understand the Reality and doctrines of the Sufi-saints.

حسن پرستی شاہد مستی ساڈا دین ایمانے

“The adoration of beauty and ecstatic witnessing is our religious tradition.”

The lover's religious tradition is to adore Beauty and ecstatically witness it in all beautiful forms. It is not an ordinary seeing. It is contemplating Beauty itself in all forms of beauty. The first part of the Islamic Shahadah: There is no beauty except the Beauty and the second part of the Shahadah: Muhammad is the manifestation of the Beauty make one understand the source and manifestation of the Beauty.

رہ توحیدی ریت فریدی اپنے آپ دا دھیانے

“The way of unity and the Faridi tradition is watchfulness of one's inner self.”

The way of unity and the Faridi tradition consist in the traditional dictum: Know thyself. The modern man has become exceedingly outward. He is enmeshed in the world of multiplicity and diversity. He has severed the identity between knowing and being. He has lost his inwardness. He has to look within the infinite depths of his being or consciousness in order to realise the metaphysical truth of the principle of Unity or Oneness. The Faridi tradition essentially is the metaphysical tradition of Oneness of Being (wahdat al-wujud).

Kafi-248

کس دھرتی سے آئے ہو تم کس نگرہی کے باسی رہے
پر م نگر ہے دیس تمہارا پھرتے کہاں اوداسی رہے

“Which is the place of your origin? Where are your dwellings oh? Your habitation is in the city of love. Why are you wandering forlorn, oh?”

The concept of Man in the great metaphysical and religious traditions of the world is grounded in pure and traditional metaphysics. It gives due place to the inward and the outward aspects of human personality. The modern concept of Man has divested him of his inwardness and robbed him of his spiritual treasures. Modern psychology and psychotherapy, for example, have weaved hundreds of theories of personality but they have not been able to fathom the infinite depths of his being or consciousness. The modern man bereft of transcendence is condemned to consider his human finitude as final. He faces the crises of identity not only in the psychic realm but essentially in the realm of spirituality. The tradition makes him remember his ‘Forgotten Truth’. It makes him bear in mind his ‘origin’ and ‘centre.’ He primordially belongs to the city of love. He has become oblivious of the cosmic purpose of his existence and has chosen finite purposes, instead. He has become alienated from his self, which has made him alienated from the world. He has lost the ultimate meaning of life. The metaphysical and the traditional world, under the spell of modernism and postmodernism, tend to become oblivious of the metaphysical and traditional principles of knowledge and being. Modern times are the times of solar and lunar eclipses.

کیوں ہوتے ہو جو گی بھوگی روگی طرح براگی رہے
انگ بھبھوت رہا کے کیونکر رکھتے بدن سنیا سی رہے

“Why do you become ascetic or beggar, sick and dressed in Hindu ascetic’s attire, oh? Why do you soil your body like that of Hindu abstinent, oh?”

The votaries of the metaphysical and religious traditions have fallen short of the metaphysical and religious truths enshrined in their own respective traditions. The truths of pure metaphysics pertaining to Hindu metaphysics have degenerated into mere rituals devoid of spirituality. The entire exercise is geared to outwardness at the expense of inwardness.

اپنا آپ سنبھال کے دیکھو کر کے نظر حقیقت کی
فکر نہ کیجو یارو ہر گز اسی یا نہ اسی رہے

“Realise your self by virtue of casting a real glance (within). My friends do not worry at all about his coming or not, oh.”

One has to develop a doctrinal understanding of his being and plunge in the infinite depths of his consciousness. It is up to his beloved to unveil himself or not. His relationship with his beloved has to be unconditional. It is one of the most illuminating guidance in the path of love. The lover does expect positive results of his efforts. But they do not accrue according to his hopes and expectations. He may have a feeling of perpetual emptiness, instead. It is here that he may get discouraged and as a reaction engross himself in worldly activities, which ultimately make him more empty. He may finally abandon the path of love. The safest course in love is to remain concentrating on the Real for the sake of it beyond results. Apparently, the regular response of the beloved seems to inspire the lover in remaining fastened in the tracks of his beloved but in reality it does not happen. The period of transcendence becomes so unbearable. The lover who remains steadfast in love without concerning about the vision

and union of his beloved is surely to reach his destination. But it is so difficult to sustain love during the long periods of transcendence. Doesn't one require courage to love?

تم ہو سا کی تم ہو سا کی
وا کی ذرہ نہ وا کی رے
اپنی ذات صفات کو سمجھو
اپنی کروشناسی رے

“You are the real and you are the truth. You are neither fake nor there is an iota of a counterfeit in you, oh. Do understand the reality of your essence and attributes. Realise yourself from within, oh.”

Man is real because he is the manifestation of the Reality. He is truth because he is the manifestation of the Truth. How could he be fake or counterfeit? His essence and attributes are the manifestations of His Essence and Attributes. His task is to realise his ontological nothingness in order to let the Being itself contemplate in his mirror of nothingness.

بات فریدی سوچ کے سنیو
لا کر دل کے کانوں کو
دونوں جگ کے مالک تم ہو
بھولے اللہ راسی رے

“Listen to the Faridi discourse with reflection and attentiveness of heart. You are sovereign in both the worlds. Why have you forgotten to put your trust in Allah, oh?”

Faridi discourse has to be realised with spiritual understanding. Man is the apex of both the worlds. He is the mirror in which the Reality or God contemplates Himself. And this act of contemplation will continue in the next world as well. One should not forget to put his trust in Allah. He will not throw you ‘as a thing of no use’.

Kafi-249

کُل غیر کنوں جی واندے مٹھی ریت انوکھی راندے

“My heart is absolutely emptied from otherness. It is a sweet tradition and a novel way of love.”

It is such a sweet tradition and way of love that his heart is emptied of otherness. Love and gnosis gift him with spiritual treasures.

سٹ کر خویش قبیلہ تھیوے بردے پڑے نال دے

“I have left my kith and kin. I have become a slave of your name.”

He leaves his ephemeral relationships and purely concentrates on the Real.

سب صورت وچ ڈھول سجانو تھیو نہ در ماندے

“Witness your beloved in all forms. Do not be dejected.”

The Reality as the beloved is manifest in all forms. One should not be dejected in perceiving Him even in ugly forms. He is transcendent and immanent in simultaneity. The ugliness of a medium does not affect Him. To delimit His manifestation violates the metaphysical concept of unity.

سینے جھوکاں دیدیں دیرے سوئے دوست دلاندے

“The beloved of my heart dwells in the infinite depths of my being.”

The beloved of his heart dwells in the inmost chambers of his being.

ہر پل پل وچ کول بغل وچ یار مٹھے من بھاندے

“My sweet and enchanting beloved resides within me at each and every moment.”

His sweet and enchanting beloved is constantly with him. His presence with him is the metaphysical proof of His Omnipresence.

اکھیاں دے وچ قطر نہ ماوے سارے سجن سماندے

“My beloved fully dwells in my eyes, where even a straw cannot reside.”

His eye cannot bear even a straw but his beloved dwells in it in His fullness. Isn't the spiritual all-pervasive and immeasurable? He sees through his eye. How wonderful!

شالاونج کر حضرت روہی ڈیکھوں گھر متراں دے

“I pray to God that I may instantly go to the reverend desert and see the dwellings of my friends.”

He prays for visiting the dwellings of his friends within the reverend desert of his self. Isn't it a prayer for the realisation of all the possibilities of one's higher self?

سٹ کر ورد فرید ہمیشہ گیت پر م دے گاندے

“Farid always sings the songs of love beyond the rituals.”

He transcends rituals and sings the songs of love, instead. A person deeply immersed in love is free from the discipline of rituals.

Kafi-250

کہیں ڈکھڑی لایم یاری روندیں عمر گزاریم ساری

“I have contracted such a love of suffering that my whole life has been spent in crying.”

She spends her entire life in crying as a consequence of contracting love full of sufferings.

سوہنے ہوت بلوچ اوڑے ڈاڈھے کیتے سخت نکھیرے
نہ سدھ سلام سنہیرے کیڈے ویساں سولاں ماری

“My awkward Baloch beloved has oppressively resorted to absolute separation. He informs me neither of his states of affairs nor sends me any felicitations or messages. What should I do since I am ravished with afflictions?”

She discerns awkwardness of her beloved in resorting to oppressive and lengthy transcendence. There is absolute no response from the transcendent. She finds no way out in being ravished with afflictions.

ایہو راول را نجھن ماہی کھس دلڑی تھیند اراہی
ول کردا بے پرواہی وہ ظلم تے بے زواری

“Look towards the cruelty and injustice of my beloved Ranjhan. He captivates my heart and walks away without caring at all.”

She points to the cruelty and injustice of her beloved friend who captivated her heart in immanence and then became transcendent without tendering her.

اکھڑی نال نہ نیتم
پیش آئی شہر خواری

مہینوال نہال نہ کیتم
بھر جام ڈکھاں دا پیٹم

“My beloved did not make me happy. He left me forlorn and did not take me with him. I took the cup of suffering and faced notoriety.”

She would have been happy if her beloved had affected permanent union with her. He transcended leaving her in the lurch. She was condemned to drink the cup of suffering. She faced notoriety, at the hands of her primary and secondary relationships, for contracting love with the transcendent.

سر آیا برہوں بکھیرا
ڈینہ رات ہمیشہ جھیرا
ڈھولے اصلوں محض وساری
بیا کھاؤں آوم وھیڑا

“The incongruities of love have fallen on my head (to my lot). There are constant brawls being faced by me, day and night. The courtyard of my house haunts me. My beloved has completely forsaken me.”

She encounters incongruities of love. She faces constant brawls. She lives with her haunted self with the feeling that her beloved has completely forsaken her.

غم درد الم نیت کو ہندا
سر سہرے مونیجھ منجھاری
جی جانی کارن لو ہندا
گل ہار غماں دا سو ہندا

“My self is intensely longing for my sweet heart. Sorrows and torment slaughter me. The garland of sorrows is in my neck and the chaplet of anguishes is on my head.”

Her inner self intensely longs for her beloved. She feels slaughtered by sorrows and torments. Her embodied self is ravished by sorrows and anguishes.

کیوں کرن سیالیں ٹوکاں
ونجاں واری لکھ لکھ واری
ماہی آن وساوے جھوکاں
میڈیاں سبز تھیون ول سوکاں

“My beloved may come and inhabit my dwellings.
Why should the Sial women sneer at me? My
dwellings may become evergreen. I may sacrifice
myself countless times (for the sake of my beloved).”

She beseeches her beloved to unveil himself in the inmost chamber of her heart. She does not want to give any opportunity to her adversaries to sneer at her. She wants the deadness of her self to be transformed into liveliness. She resolves to sacrifice her being and having for the sake of her beloved.

سے روگ ہزار کشالے بے کارن چندڑی گھالے
تھل مارو پر بت کالے لاچار تھی ہن ہاری

“I am bearing hundreds of malaises and thousands of
adversities in the deadly desert and black hills for you.
I am helpless and inept. I have lost (and you have
won).”

She has borne countless malaises and adversities for the sake of her beloved. She is so helpless and inept that she finds herself lost in the deadly and tedious wilderness of her self. Doesn't a streak of light break the spell of darkness?

جیں دل بردی دل بردی تہیں باجھ فرید نہ سردی
جڑ لیس چوٹ اندر دی وہ زخم کلڑا کاری

“I have become the slave of my beloved. Farid! I
cannot pass my life without him. He perfectly shot
and made a terrible unintelligible wound in my
being.”

He has become the slave of his beloved. He cannot pass his life without him. It was his beloved who perfectly stirred terrible and unintelligible love within his being. The inseparability of beauty and love characterises the whole spiritual journey. Aren't the beloved sun and the lover moon in the game of ontological love?

Kafi-251

کھسی اوہا جو رب گنی

کیا تھیا جو ی نہ بنی

“If your wishes have not been realised, then do not worry. It is so because it has been destined by the Sustainer.”

Man wishes and desires so many things in life. He has an ever growing wish-list with him. But it is not possible that he gets what he wishes or desires. The oppressive structure of the society or the inner and outer limitations of his self may deprive him even of his genuine needs. It is the way he chooses to give meaning to his predicament that ultimately designs the pattern of his behaviour. He may choose to act or react. His action or reaction may be in the air or grounded in reality. The one who considers human finitude as final (modern) may have an altogether different perspective from the one who has faith in the Infinite (traditional). The traditional man has to realise that if he has not got what he wanted---at multidimensional levels--- it is because of the implicit or explicit will of the Sustainer (God). His implicit will is reflected in the scheme of things. He has given freedom to man. It is by virtue of freedom that good and evil are realised as possibilities. God does not create evil directly. It indirectly arises due to the freedom inherent in the human. If the human were deprived of freedom, then there would not have been any possibility of good. And the possibility of good posits the possibility of evil. Man has to be good and shun evil. God, in His Infinite Wisdom, has measured all things (destiny or ‘the inner reach of a thing’) and has full control over them (Al-Qadir, Al-Qadeer). His implicit will containing all His Attributes is imbibed in the law of things.

The law of things are not lifeless. They are lively by His Presence. The person, who acts respectfully, invokes His Attribute of Al-Muiz but the person who acts disrespectfully invokes His Attribute of Al-Muzil. Thus, it is for man as to which Attributes of God He chooses to invoke. God's responsiveness to man, by virtue of His law of things, does not end with His implicit will. His explicit will, over and above His implicit will, directly intervenes in the cosmic affairs. He is directly concerned with the affairs of every individual. He is not an outsider or a spectator but participant in the life of every one. He is not unjust to any one. The underlying principle of His behaviour is Mercy. He is Omnipresent, Omnipotent and Omniscient. He knows what a particular or general thing is beneficial or harmful for a certain person at all levels. Many things, which are good and apparently beneficial to a particular person, may be in reality harmful for him. The Sustainer knows but that particular person does not know. Thus, man is advised to leave his affairs in the hands of the Sustainer--- consciously and willingly--- in pure receptivity.

دولت کوں چوچی لا اڑا	ٹھگ بازداؤ ٹکونہ کھا
آزاد تھی صفّا صفّا	چین گھن سنجائی دی انی

“Commit your insatiable quest of wealth to flames and never be deceived by this swindler. Become absolutely free. Do away with all those things that bring misfortunes.”

Wealth is blessing of God but it becomes a curse when it is earned and spent against the will of God. Man is advised to commit his insatiable hunger of wealth (“infinite gold hunger”) to flames. It is to divest oneself from the craving of wealth. It deceptively robs man of his inwardness. Wealth as an end in itself destroys the spiritual quest of man. The Qur’an mentions Qarun (a fabulously rich man in the times of the Prophet Musa) whose hoarded wealth was of no avail to him and he was buried with it as a chastisement from the heavens.

The psychic ties of wealth imprison the person in a golden cage by captivating his freedom. The quest of wealth and amassing it for its own sake is counter productive. It is not man who possesses wealth but it is ultimately wealth, which possesses him. A possessed man becomes essentially alienated from his own self. Man should free himself from the misfortunes of wealth.

دنیا دانہ تھی آشنا ہے اے مکارہ بے وفا
کھانویں نہ موذن دادغا ہے بیخ کنی تیکوں گھنی

“Do not commit yourself with worldliness. It is cunning and faithless. Do not be seduced by its dubiousness. Remain contented with your small share.”

One should not develop his ties with worldliness. It cunningly deceives one in thinking that his possessions will always remain with him. It is faithless in changing hands. A person has to be aware of its power of seduction. He has to remain contented with his legitimate share in the world.

دھج وچ دی جھگ مگ تر وڑوے ڈورے تے ملل چھوڑ دی
ہے ڈلھ پتھر دی بھور دے تیں کان ہیڑے دی کنی

“Break away from the seduction of honour and fame. Leave aside costly apparel. Consider a piece of diamond nothing more than a stone.”

Save yourself from the allurements of honour and fame. They inflate your ego at the expense of your real personality. They lead you to compromise with Truth. They veil you from your beloved. Never strive to achieve them. If God bestows honour and fame on you, then be humble and thank Him for His blessings. Leave your desire of costly apparel. You can only wear it by robbing so many people of their dresses, which could hardly cover even their bare bodies. Never forget the traditional wisdom that simplicity is beauty. Do not

value a diamond more than a stone, nay a crushed stone. All these things act as obstacles in the way of spiritual realisation.

ملاں نہیں کہیں کار دے شیوے نہ جانن یار دے
سمجھن تے بھیت اسرار دے ونج کٹ دے بھرنے تھئے دنی

“The clerics are just for nothing. They do not understand the ways of the friend. They do not understand the intricacies of mysteries. They fall on their backs (they can’t rise to the occasion and fail to disclose the intricacies of reality and truth).”

One cannot get any benefit from the clerics. They are inimical to the sentiment of love. They deny the possibility of experiencing God. They do not understand the ways of the beloved. They cannot unfold the mysteries of esoterism. They cannot face the truth. They turn their backs on it.

ایں راہ ڈو آنویں نہ ہا جے آئیں قدم ڈینہو ڈینہو دھا
پچھوں تے نہ ڈیکھیں منہہ ولا حیلہ کریں سرتیں تنی

“You should not have entered the way in the first instance. Now, when you have stepped in, do not turn your face backwards. Keep striving till you have consciousness.”

One should not have entered the realm of love and gnosis for there are intricacies, pains and sufferings of the way beyond his imagination. He should have contented with paradise and not vouchsafed for the paradise of Essence. However, once he has entered it, he should never envisage the possibility of leaving it. He must keep striving to realise ‘deliverance and union’ till end.

نوہی ترس بارو چل رتی روہیں پہاڑیں وچ تتی
شودی سستی زلدی وتی نیہنیں اکھڑی ہک جنی

“My beloved Brochal! You have not even an iota of pity. The inept and poor Sassi due to her being in

love is wandering alone and wretched in the mountainous terrains.”

She beseeches her transcendent beloved to have pity on her and assume the form of immanence. The love of the inept Sassi is making her wander in the wilderness of her self.

ہے دل قہر دی مبتلا ہے او غضب دابے وفا
من 'اتے من ڈے وی آ آپت دے وچ کھڑ بڑ بنی

“There is terrifying love (of Sassi), on the one hand, and on the other hand is the presence of (Punnal), who is absolutely faithless. There is a great contradiction between the creditor and the debtor.”

The contradiction between the terrifying love of the lover and the cold response of the beloved reaches such heights that the lover considers himself as a debtor facing the cruelties of the creditor. Isn't all love on credit?

سن بے وفادی گالھ وے بچھدا نہ ہر گز حال وے
اصلوں نہ لہم سنبھال وے ڈیوے نہ چولی دی تنی

“Listen to the tale of the faithless one. He never enquires about me. He does not favourably share with me. He is not ready to give me even a thread (to tie the collar of shirt).”

He depicts the absolute transcendence of his beloved and its impact on his life.

تھی خوش فرید تے شادول ڈکھڑیں کوں نہ کریا دل
آجھو تھیوم جھوک آبادول ایہا نیں نہ وہی ہک منی

“Farid! Be glad and happy and do not remember your sufferings. Your world will flourish soon (will unite with your beloved). The stream does not flow at one bank (it flows at the other bank also).”

He is sustained by hope even during the unresponsiveness of his beloved.

Kafi-252

کیا ڈکھڑا نیہہ لیو سے ڈکھ باجھ پلے نہ پیو سے

“Why I have contracted love impregnated with sufferings? Nothing fell to my lot except sufferings.”
She questions her love replete with sufferings.

عشق نہیں ہے نار غضب دی تن من کیتس کو لے

سولاں سڑ دیں آہیں بھر دیں ساری عمر بھیسو سے

“It is not simple love but a horrible fire that has turned my body and soul into ashes. I have spent my whole life in burning afflictions by heaving cold sighs.”

The fire of love ravishes her embodied self.

نہ غمخوار نا کوئی ساتھی نہ کوئی حال و نڈاوے

عشق جیہاں ڈکھ ہو نہ کوئی مایو ویری تھیو سے

“I have no comforter or companion. There is no one to share with me. There is no suffering greater than love. My parents have become inimical to me.”

She feels ostracised from her social self.

خویش قبیلہ ہر کوئی جانے منزل یار دیاں جھوکاں

سینگیاں سرتیاں کر دیاں ٹوکاں سارا بھرم لوڑھیو سے

“My kith and kin and everyone know that my destination is in the dwellings of my friend. My same age friends sneer at me. I have lost all my honour.”

People know about her object of love. But still her friends sneer at her. She has lost her honour.

گلیاں کوچے شہر بزاراں لوگ مرینداکانے

ننڈھڑے وڈڑے ڈیون طعنے شرم شعور و نجیوسے

“People pass offensive remarks against me in the city, streets, lanes and markets. The younger and the older ones taunt me. I have lost my awareness and intelligence.”

She has to face offensive remarks and taunts everywhere. She loses her ordinary sense of the self.

گالھ نہیں آج کل دی سنجڑی مسٹھڑی روز ازل دی
بے نشان سجن دے کیتے نام نشان گنویوسے

“It is not a recent occurrence of damnation. I am miserable ever since the primordial day. I have lost my identity for the sake of my nameless beloved.”

Her damnation is traced back to the miseries since the primordial day. She loses her identity for the sake of her nameless beloved. Isn't it one of the greatest achievements in the path of love?

ہار ہنجوں دا گل وچ پانواں بیٹھی رور و حال و نجاواں
پیت سوانی ریت نہ کائی ڈے سرمفت گدھیوسے

“I wear the garland of tears. I have worsened my state by crying. I have nothing to do except remaining in the state of love. I have sacrificed my being for the sake of love in return for nothing.”

She suffers terribly without gaining union and vision of her beloved.

مُونجھ منجھاری درد و چھوڑا لکھی باب تتی دے ڈوڑا
یار فرید خرید نہ کیتا رور و خلق روپوسے

“I am the inept one who has been destined for greater anguish, pain and separation. Farid! My friend did not own me. I made the whole world weep by crying.”

He faces anguish, pain and separation in consonance with the pre-eternal covenant (alast). He cries and makes the world cry with him for he has not been owned by his beloved.

Kafi-253

گیارول راول وچ روہ راوے نہ یار مل دانا موت آوے

“My beloved has left me wretched in the hard mountainous passages. I neither unite with my friend nor does death overtake me.”

The beloved's transcendence makes her wander wretchedly in wilderness. She terribly suffers the ambiguity of neither living in union nor dying in disunion.

آتن کیندیں سینکیاں ستاون جگتاں عمریندیاں بولیاں سناون
کئی کئیں کردیاں کئی نوک لاون جیرا ہمیشہ صدمے اٹھاوے

“My same age friends vex me, while spinning the wheel. Some of them make me a laughing stock, while others pass insulting remarks against me. Some make me woeful, while some resort to gambols. My self always bears these shocks.”

She faces shocks of ridicules, puns and insults at the hands of her friends while spinning the yarn of love.

بھنیں نہ بھاواں امڑی الاوے پیکے سورہجے ہر کوئی دکھاوے
جانی اوڑا پھیرا نہ پاوے ہک سبھ ساڑے بیاتول تاوے

“I am not pleasing to my sisters and my mother scolds me. All my house inmates and my in laws make me suffers. My peculiar beloved does not come to meet me. My nuptial bed burns me and my quilt sets me aflame.”

She suffers at the hands of her mother, sisters, inmates of her house and in-laws for contracting such a queer love. She

further suffers the transcendence of her beloved. The nuptial emptiness of her self haunts her in the absence of her beloved.

ڈکھڑے سسی نوں ڈینہو ڈینہ سوائے جیس ڈینہہ بروچل گھر ڈوسدھائے
مونجھیں منجھائے سولیس ستائے قادر کڈا ہیں وچھڑے ملاوے

“Sassi faced increasing sufferings ever since my beloved left for his dwellings. Anguishes have made me suffer and the afflictions have vexed me. I pray that the Almighty unites the separated ones.”

She faces great sufferings since her beloved assumed transcendence. She suffers in anguish. She is vexed with afflictions. She prays to the Almighty to unite the separated ones.

مٹھڑی اکیلی سانول نہ بیلی البھل نہ کردی سرتی سپہلی
نظرے حویلی سنجڑی ڈوبیلی مارو تھلاں دی والی سہاوے

“I am miserably alone without my beloved or any companion. My youthful companions and friends do not welcome me. My mansion seems damned and sombre. The sand of the deadly desert seems pleasant to me.”

She faces miserable loneliness in the absence of her beloved. She has not even a companion to share her plight. Her friends and companions welcome her no more. They are offended by her independent stance of love as against their advice to leave her beloved and settle for a peaceful domestic life. Her self seems damned and sombre without her friend. The sandy deadly desert of the self seems so pleasant to her, in spite of its being negatively related to her beloved for it gives her a sense of belongingness.

قسمت فریدا ڈٹڑی نہ واری اصلوں پیل ول کیتھم نہ کاری
کیڈے ونجے دل درداندی ماری رورونجھائی جگ نوں راووے

“Farid! Fortune did not let me take my turn (I was unlucky). My Punnaal essentially never shared with me. Where should this abject one go? My life has been spent in crying and making others cry.”

He is conscious about his being unfortunate in the matters of love. The crux of the matter is that his beloved did not nurture love with him. He as an abject lover has nowhere to go. He has nothing to do except suffer his pathetic love and make others sympathise with him. Could mere sympathising help in solving his problems?

Kafi-254

کیا ریت پریت سکھائی ہے سب ڈسدا احسن خدائی ہے

“What a tradition love has made me realise. The Divine beauty is manifest everywhere.”

The realisation of the metaphysical tradition of love has worked wonders. The divine Beauty is openly manifest. The great metaphysical and religious traditions of the world are born of experience. They understand the experience of their founders in metaphysical and religious senses. They explain the nature of the experience in respective terminologies. The votaries of a respective tradition not only understand the terminology of their own tradition but they may also become familiar with the terminologies of other traditions as well. The family resemblance of terminology helps in attaining transcendent unity of multiple traditions. The tradition essentially is fully equipped with doctrines and the corresponding means of their realisation. It is due to the onslaught of modernism that the traditional world has imbibed certain bad habits of philosophy. It has not only metamorphosed metaphysical truths into philosophical categories but has also become oblivious of the means of realisation. All the metaphysical and religious traditions of the world, more or less, are infested with the virus of modernism excepting a few noble exceptions here and there. The tradition of Islam has suffered the same fate in the hands of different schools of thought including the Clerics and the Rationalists, who are the products of modernism in their respective ways. They have, among other things, denied the spiritual dimension of Islam. They do not envisage the possibility of experiencing God. The radicals amongst them

even deny the prophet of Islam having experience of God. They understand the act of revelation (wahy) in a very restricted and constricted sense. The Sufis have made one of the greatest contributions to Islam and World Spirituality by restoring the doctrinal understanding of religion and by demonstrating the possibility of doctrinal realisation. The driving force of love is not only behind the creation of the cosmos but it is equally involved in its sustenance. It is the intensity of the loving eye, which unveils the Omnipresence of Beauty. Doesn't love lead to gnosis? Aren't love and gnosis identical?

ڈس دی یار مسہل دی صورت گل تصویر اتے گل مورت
ہر ویلھے ہے شگن مہورت غیر دی خبر نہ کائی ہے

“I see the sweet form of my friend in its complete picture and full face. It is a good omen to see the form of my friend every time. There is no trace of otherness (or non divine).”

The figure, picture and form of his sweet friend are visible in total plenitude. He considers it such a good omen to constantly witness the face of his friend. He finds no trace of otherness.

ناز نہورے یار سجن دے عشوے غمزے من موہن دے
ہر ہر آن انوکھڑے ون دے وہ زینت زیبائی ہے

“The prides and coquetries, amorous glances and enticements of my beloved friend are strangely manifest at each and every moment. I laud this adornment and propriety.”

The constant beautiful and vibrant expressions of his beloved are so creative. He lauds the grand prettification of his friend.

نخرے نخرے نوکاں ٹوکاں دلڑی جوڑ چو بھیندیاں چوکاں
سوکاں سبز تھیاں ول جھوکاں خوبی خنکی چائی ہے

“The blandishments, disdainful air, gambols and playfulness of my beautiful beloved perfectly stir my heart. The dried up plants have again turned green. Well, the temporary dwellings have again come to life.”

The vibrant beauty of his beautiful beloved is instrumental in fully nurturing love in his heart. His deadened self transforms in liveliness.

نازک چالی نور نول دی رمز اں بانگی طرز جدل دی
دھار کجل دی دھاڑا جلدی سرخی بھابھڑکائی ہے

“The tender moves of the embodied light are intricate signs of strife. The line of a collyrium is so fateful. Redness intensifies the flame of love.”

The tender, vibrant and colourful beauty of the beloved strives to conquer him. He has no defence against the onslaught of beauty.

ڈکھ ڈوہاگ تے درد جدائی رملیل ویدے ساتھ لڈائی
عشق فرید تھیو سے بھائی عشرت روز سوائی ہے

“The sufferings and misfortunes along with pain and separation have all together gone away. Farid! Love has developed fraternal ties with me leading to the increasing delights each day.”

The sufferings, misfortunes and the pains of separation jointly go away. Love becomes so friendly that his delights know no bounds.

Kafi-255

کیا عشق آڑاہ مچایا ہے ہر روز ایہہ سُوز سوا یا ہے

“What a stir love has created? The passion is on the increase each day.”

Psychic love is a storm in tea cup. But the spiritual love once stirred in the heart of the lover stirs the entire sea of love with mounting waves touching the sky.

سرتن من پھوک جلا یا ہے مٹھا جو بن مفت گنوا یا ہے
بھیڑی دلڑی مار مٹھا یا ہے دم دم وچ درد سوا یا ہے

“It burned my body and soul into ashes. My hapless youth has gone for nothing. My despicable heart has ravished me with anguish. My pain is perpetually on the increase.”

Love burns his embodied self to ashes. His hapless youth is spent in struggling for the vision and union of his beloved. His despicable heart ravishes him with anguish. The pain of love remains on the increase.

سٹ سیجھ اکیلی ہوت نئے غم پا کر جھولی عیش کھتے
گل ہار بھلاں دانا نگ ڈسے ڈکھی قسمت سب ڈکھ لایا ہے

“My beloved ran away by deserting the nuptial bed. He gave me sorrows and snatched away my joys. The garland in my neck gives me a snake bite. My misfortune has brought me these sufferings.”

The beloved becomes transcendent instantaneously from his posture of immanence. It is just like the switching off light. He made her sorrowful by depriving her of the nuptial

joys of union. Her embellishments seem so deadly without her beloved. She suffers because of her misfortunes in being separated from her beloved.

سوہنا سنگ ہجر دی مار گیا یکباری یار و سار گیا
کر زار نزار خوار گیا تی بے وس بار سہا یا ہے

“My lovely friend speared me with separation and forgot me so soon. He left me distressed and disgraced. I am the inept and the helpless bearing this burden.”

She is pierced by the spear of separation. The unexpected transcendence was as a bolt from the blue. She is distressed by the state of separation and disunion. She is disgraced by her near and dear ones at the loss of her beloved. She as an inept and helpless lover bears the burden of love.

ایہا دل لڑی عشق دی گھڑی ہے غماں موٹھڑی تے ڈکھاں لٹڑی ہے
ما ڈتڑی شوق دی گھڑی ہے جیں صبر آرام و نجایا ہے

“My heart is the victim of love. The sorrows made me miserable and the sufferings stringently got hold of me. My mother gave me the first feed of fondness leading to the loss of my patience and peace.”

Her heart becomes victimised by love. She becomes miserable by sorrows and sufferings. Her mother gave her the first doze of love at her birth (ontological love since the primordial day). It has lead to the loss of her patience and peace.

دل لانون حال و نجاون ہے سکھ ڈیون تے ڈکھ پاون ہے
غم کھاون درد نبھاون ہے نیرا بے شک کوڑا جایا ہے

“To fall in love is to make one’s condition deplorable. It is to barter peace for suffering. It is to bear sorrows and pains. Love is undoubtedly, false and valueless.”

Love makes him so deplorable. He barter peace for suffering. He bears sorrows and pains. He becomes desperate in calling names to love. He doubtlessly calls it false and valueless. It is false because it creates the abiding impression of union but gives disunion, instead. It is valueless because the world attaches no value to it. The worldly people even consider love as a disvalue.

سوئے باجھ فرید قرار گیا	کم کار گیا گھر بار گیا
سب ناز نواز سنگار گیا	سر بار ڈوہاگ سہایا ہے

“Farid! I am discontented without my friend. All my worldly commitments have fallen in oblivion. My entire pride, elegance and beautification have been reduced to nothing. I have taken the burden of misfortunes on my head.”

He loses his peace of mind without his friend. His commitments of life fall in oblivion. His pride, elegance and beauty count for nothing. He bears the onerous burden of misfortunes.

Kafi-256

گئیوں لوڑھ کلھڑی وچ کن کپر دے رودھے ڈتونی پچھلی عمر دے

“My beloved! You left me alone in to face the storms
and whirlpools in old age (the final phase of my life).”

She has been left by her beloved alone to face the storms
and whirlpools of love at her old age. Love is not cognizant
of any age.

تیں باجھ جیواں اصلوں نہ جیواں بے اکھیں دے سہیے پوریواں
مارو، مر یلا، تول بن نہ تھیواں بٹھ ڈینہہ ہجر دے اوکھے گزر دے

“You may live forever but I can’t live without you. I
wish to be buried in your presence. I do not want to
exist without you, my ravisher. I don’t bother about
these difficult days of separation.”

She affirms the Attribute of the Living (Al-Hayy) to her
beloved. But she cannot live without him. She wants to be
buried in his presence. She can’t exist without her ravisher.
She wants union with him on her own right, notwithstanding
the difficulties she faces in spending these days of separation.

ملاں مردلاں دھڑکے تے دھوڑے بھجیاں سوغاتیں بے وچھوڑے
ڈکھڑے ڈینہہ ڈینہہ ڈیڈھے تے ڈوڑے ہے نہ جیندے جیڑانہ مردے

“The gifts of your separation are blessed with blows,
punches, pushes and kicks. The sufferings are
intensifying and are on the increase each day. Alas!
My self neither lives nor dies.”

The gifts of separation shake the very fabric of her being. It constantly increases her sufferings. She stands strung between life and death.

گئے وقت ویسے یارو بھلیڑے ڈکھڑے ڈوکھی تے کیتے ویرے
شالہ ڈھاڑے تھیوم تھلیڑے پاڑے گزاروں سجنیں دے گھر دے

“The good times have gone away, my friend. I have been assaulted by sufferings. I pray that these days (of separation) lessen, so that I spend my days in nearness with my beloved.”

She addresses her friend and shares with him the fleeting away of her good times. She prays for the lessening of the period of separation so that she could spend her life in company of her beloved.

گھولی تسیڑی گولی تسیڑی ڈے کن سنیں سیں ڈکھ پیڑ میڑی
پانی اساڈا تھتی رت اسیڑی روٹی ہے ٹکڑے ہاندے جگر دے

“I am sold in your name and I am your maidservant. Listen with attentiveness to the tale of my sufferings and pains. My water is my blood and my food is parts of my being.”

She is sold in the name of her beloved. She is completely subject to his will. She wants her beloved to register the intensity of suffering she is undergoing during his transcendence.

مونڈھ لاوی چندڑی ڈکھڑی ندی ڈوہڑی دردیندی بدھڑی سوزیندی روہڑی
ہک توں تتی دی دل نہ لدھڑی بے سول صدے چوتھے پہر دے

“My life is in sufferings since the primordial day. It is tied by pains and ravished by passions. You did not care for the inept one. You gave me afflictions and shocks in the last years of my life.”

The sufferings of ontological love are pre-eternal. The passion of love is so painful and ravishing. The beloved did

not care for the inept one. She has been infested with afflictions of love and shocks of transcendence in the last years of her life, when her waning strength could not bear them.

رہ گئو تم خوشیاں و سرے ہنڈھیے دہانہ دہانہ کریندے آئے بُڈھے
بے بینوائی ڈٹے رنڈھے آئے بار سرتے باری قہر دے

“My happiness has remained unfulfilled and my youthfulness has ebbed away. Old age has come with a big bang. My destituteness has widowed me. Heavy and severe burden has fallen on my head.”

She has lost the prime of her youth without nuptial happiness. The signs of old age are so visibly marked. Her destituteness has made her widow of love. She has to bear the onerous burden of love. Hasn't every lover to carry his own cross?

جوگی براگی تھیکر ڈھونڈیاں کفنی ڈکھاندی پاگل سوسیاں
اینویں فرید ائمران نہجھیاں جے تیں ناتھیاں داخل قبر دے

“I will search you by being yogi and ascetic. I will adorn myself with the coffin of sufferings. Farid! I will spend my life like this till I enter my grave.”

He tries so many ways to pierce through the transcendence of her beloved but in vain. He resolves to be yogi and ascetic in search of transcendence. He will adorn himself with the coffin of sufferings till he dies. The search of transcendence or the search of the beloved is the basic vocation of the lover. He faces initial transcendence as struck by sudden lightning. Then, he uses different ways to search transcendence. He often becomes desperate in his search. It is when the beloved finally unveils himself that he understands the rationale of transcendence.

Kafi-257

مٹھڑی دلڑی ڈکھڑیں کٹھڑی ہے ناز آدای لٹڑی

“My miserable heart is butchered by sufferings. It has been looted by the prideful style (of my beloved).”

Her heart is butchered by sufferings. The prideful beauty of her beloved ravishes her heart.

ہن زخم جگر دے آ لے دل پر زے اکھیاں نالے
سے سینے پون ابا لے جنہار ہٹی میں مٹھڑی

“The injuries of my being have freshened. My heart has been cut to pieces and there is flow of tears from my eyes. My chest is becoming heavier. I am the miserable one who has lost in exhaustion.”

Her embodied self is shaken by the tremendous force of love. Love hurts afresh. She is miserably exhausted by bearing the onslaughts of love at the hands of her beautiful beloved.

تے درد اندوہ اوڑے لائے دلڑی جھوکاں دیرے
ہن حضرت عشق نوڑے ڈتی پیڑ پرانی پٹھڑی

“The inept pain and grief are settled in my heart. Now, the majestic love is so new that it has restored my old overturned pain.”

Her loving heart becomes abode of pain and grief. The freshness of love restores her intricate pains of love.

سر چھترے نینہ لیوے سب شرم شعور گنو یوے
دل ڈھولے یار لیوے سس مام امڑی رٹھڑی

“I was a child when I fell in love. I lost all my awareness and intelligence. My beloved friend has captured my heart. My mother-in-law thrashes me and my mother has cooled towards me.”

She recounts her tenderness when she contracted love. The force of love made her lose her normal ways of thinking and understanding. Her beloved friend has ravished her heart. The aggressiveness of her mother-in-law and the indifferent behaviour of her mother take a heavy toll on her.

مل مائی عارویاروں تھی فارغ کل کم کاروں
رل راول ڈاگاں چاروں ہے آج کل روہی وٹھڑی

“My beloved! Do meet me without being ashamed of public opinion. I am absolutely free from all works. My Raval (friend), come and join me in shepherding the herd. These days there is rain in the desert.”

She gathers many reasons for her beloved's transcendence and explores many possibilities of his return to immanence. Work will strengthen their togetherness. They will join together in realising love in times of heavenly blessings.

تھی کھیر و کھیر چریاں آئیں نال اگاڑنیاں
پاہ پکاں نال بوڑھیاں گھر باروں سنگت پھڑی

“I will shepherd your herd along with you. I will manage all this with the winks of my eye (perfectly and easily). I will prepare the dung of the herd and clean the place with my eyelids. I have broken ties with my family.”

She commits with the shepherd of her heart to shepherd the herd (sentiments of love) whole heartedly and in wholesomeness since she has become absolutely free from her family concerns. It is clearing ground for his beloved to unveil himself in the purity of herself.

تھیاں سنج بر صحن حویلیاں گیاں سینگیاں و سر سہیلیاں
البیلیاں بانہہ چوڑیلیاں ما بھین کنوں دل ترڑی

“The mansions and courtyards have become deserted. My same age friends are no more with me. My welcoming friends who were laden with set of bangles

in their arms have gone away. My heart has become
free of any love of my mother and sister.”

Her heart becomes so deserted. It becomes free from the
love of her companions, friends, mother and sister. Doesn't
the beloved unveil himself only in the heart, which is free
from otherness?

گھر سَنول یار نہ آیا	گیا چیز فرید اجایا
تھی دشمن قسمت کھڑی	سرِ صولیں سخت ستایا

“Farid! The spring has just gone for nothing. My
beloved friend did not come home. I have been
highly vexed by the burden of afflictions on my head.
My misfortune is my greatest enemy.”

He did not have vision of his beloved nor united with him
in spite of the fact that the times were so ripe for such
happenings. Transcendence did not assume immanence. The
unveiling of the beloved is beyond any measurement. He
becomes highly vexed by the overbearing burden of
afflictions. His misfortune is his greatest enemy. If he were
fortunate, then he would have certainly affected union during
these times.

Kafi-258

نیڑالاون حال ونجاون مفتے پور پرائے

“To fall in love is to ravish one self. It is taking others problems as ones own.”

The one who wishes to contract love must be mentally prepared to get his self ravished by the acts of love. It is to see through the window and take problems of others as one own. It is to reach out from one's 'narrow circuits of individuality'.

ہمنیں کھاندی سٹھنیں سہندی دلڑی چا برمائے

“I bear rebukes and satires. My heart has seduced me.”

Her heart is seduced by love. She has to bear rebukes and satires of her family, friends and adversaries for contracting love.

کرن شکایت سینگیاں سٹیاں گلڑے حق ہمسائے

“My youthful companions are protesting against me. My neighbours are complaining about me.”

Her youthful companions protest against her transcendent love, which bestows such terrible sufferings on her (one of their companions). The neighbours complain about her whimpering day and night, which disturbs their peace.

عارویاں پچار کریندے سکڑے مایو جائے

“My relatives, brothers and sisters make me feel ashamed and raise objections against me.”

Her relatives, brothers and sisters feel ashamed in the public eye for her contracting love. They raise objections against her for contracting such a love, which has made her oblivious of everything worthwhile in the world.

ویر نہیڑے امڑی جھیڑے بابل نت دڑکائے

“My brother shakes me rudely and my mother picks up a brawl with me. My father terrifies me all the times.”

The rudeness of her brother, the brawls of her mother, and the angriness of her father persist in trying to make her desist from love.

سُس نناناں کرم بکھیڑے روز بروز سوائے

“My mother in law and my sisters in law are increasingly creating incongruities.”

The increasing incongruities of her mother-in-law and her sister-in-law are there to make her return to her marital bond at the expense of her primordial love.

باندیاں بردیاں محض نہ ڈردیاں دائی وین الائے

“My maidservants and bonds women do not fear me. My governess tunes maledictions on me.”

Her maidservants and bondswomen do not fear her because they know that she does not enjoy any respectable place in her house; rather everyone criticises her for such a queer love. The governess tunes maledictions on her because she knows that she cannot do anything harmful in return.

اصلوں سدھڑامو نہ نہ ڈیندے مامے چاچے تائے

“My maternal and paternal uncles are not ready to talk to me.”

Her maternal and paternal uncles stop talking to her because she makes her parents suffer due to her strange love.

کارنگا قاصد پٹھ پٹھ ہٹڑی یار نہ واگ دلائے

“I have become tired of sending so many letters. My friend has not turned back his reins.”

She has tried to search her transcendent beloved in vain but her friend has not assumed immanence.

نازنواز نمائے شودے ہارسنگار اجائے

“My prides and elegance are so modest and ineffective. My embellishments have been of no use.”

Her pride, elegance and embellishments have been in vain in attracting the beloved on her side. Her beautification has counted for nothing.

مارو موڑ ملیر ملہاراں آپے آبلوئے

“I wish my ravishing beloved leaves the rainy season of Malheer and take the initiative of talking to me on his own.”

She wishes that her transcendent beloved assumes immanence in the times of heavenly blessings and communicates to her with love.

زل مل ٹوبھے تے تڑتاڈے ساڈے آن وسائے

“He may join me in making desert ponds, passages and habitations lively.”

She wishes that her beloved joins her in realising love.

قسمت جاگے بخت بھڑائے قادر دوست ملائے

“I wish that I am lucky and the fortunes smiles on me. The Almighty makes me unite me with my friend.”

She earnestly desires to be lucky enough for the fortune to smile on her by fructifying her efforts. She prays that the Almighty affects her union with her friend.

سہجوں لیٹے تول نہالیں سوہی سیجھ سہائے

“He may fondly lie with a nuptial quilt and mattress
and grace the colourful nuptial bed.”

She wishes to accomplish nuptial rites with her beloved.

بھگم سختی تے بد سختی بھاگ سہاگ ملہائے

“The hard times and misfortunes may end. My good
fortunes and happiness of union may become
identical.”

Se desires that hard times and misfortunes of separation
and disunion come to an end. She may be fortunate enough
to unite with her beloved. Her fortune and happiness may
become identical.

سانول بانہہ سراندی ڈے کر ساری رات نبھائے

“My charming beloved may spend the whole night
with me in the state of intimacy.”

She desires her beloved to intimately spend whole night
with her.

چھوڑو نجن دی دور رہن دی نار کھ را نجھن رائے

“My Ranjhan! Do not think of leaving me or being
far away from me.”

She beseeches her beloved to never assume any form of
transcendence.

توں بن راول جوگی دلدے ڈکھڑے کون مٹائے

“My beloved Yogi! Who will end my heart’s
sufferings without you?”

She communicates with her beloved about the sufferings
of her heart, which are due to his separation and disunion.
There can be no one to remove these sufferings since it is
only he who can affect union with her.

نہ کوئی سگتی ناکوئی ساتھی نہ کوئی حال و نڈائے

“I have no friend or companion. There is no one to share my being.”

She expresses her state of solitariness. She has no friend or companion. There is no one to share her sufferings.

سچ ہے کون پرائے ڈکھڑے اپنے گلڑے پائے

“It is true that who bothers to bear the sufferings of others.”

It is a maxim of truth that no one is ready to consider the sufferings of others as one's own.

جس تن لکڑی سوئی تن جانے بُوراں کیا پروائے

“Only a person who suffers knows about his suffering. The others have no concern.”

It is the one who suffers knows about it. Others do not bother about the sufferer. They do not show any concern about his deplorable state.

اپنے بارے آپ اٹھیاں دلڑی نت فرمائے

“My heart says repeatedly that it will bear its own burdens.”

Heart-knowledge points out to the individuality of every person. Every lover has to carry the cross of love on his shoulders.

کر بے واہی سٹ ندرائی پیچی کچ سدھائے

“He has deceitfully gone to Ketch by making me lonely and sleepy.”

She imputes deceit to her beloved who assumed transcendence casting her in the world of sleep.

سنجڑی دے سنجڑیے کیا کیا پیش تہی دے آئے

“I am the inept one who has faced many a type of damnation.”

She faces many types of inner and outer damnations during the period of her beloved's transcendence.

سر خیں میندیں تک تلویں پھکڑے رنگ دکھائے

“My rouge, henna, brow colour- mark and mole have faded out.”

The colours of her life start fading out. The happiness of her union fades away into the sorrowfulness of her disunion.

ہک دکھ سئے سئے ساگ خوشی وے سارے صاف و نجائے

“The one suffering of love has made me loose countless opportunities of happiness.”

The single suffering of love has made her lose many occasions of happiness. Her happiness is tied to her beloved. She cannot be happy without him.

چولی چڑی سوزوں بھڑی آس نہ پڑی ہائے

“My clothing has been burnt by the flame of passion but my hopes have not been fulfilled.”

The passionate flame of love has burnt her. But her hope of realising union with her beloved has remained unrealised.

عشقوں مول فرید نہ پھر ساں تو نیں مونہ نہ لائے

“Farid1 I will not be retracing my steps of love at all even if my beloved is not ready to respond to me till the end.”

He firmly resolves not to betray his love at any cost irrespective of the beloved's unresponsiveness to his call of love. His unconditional commitment to love is the only driving force, which keeps him traversing the path of love without retracing his steps. It is never an either/or for him. Isn't it the wisdom of love to continue struggling without eyeing on results? It is the 'wisdom of the ages' that effort is by His Grace (tawfiq) but the results are purely in His hands.

Kafi-259

نیناں نہیں رہندے، ملے

“My eyes do not restrain themselves (from the yearnings of witnessing the beloved) in spite of my best efforts.”

Her eyes bear no restrain in witnessing their beloved. The inner urge of love is expressed through eyes.

نین نیناں ساں اڑدے لڑدے لا کرناز دے لٹکے

“The eyes of the lover and the beloved are pridefully at warfare with each other.”

They are pridefully at warfare with the eyes of the beloved. It is the contact of eyes, which deepens love to its infinite depths.

گلڑیں کوچیں شہر بازاراں لگڑے نینہ دے چٹکے

“Love is being tasted in lanes, streets, cities and markets.”

The force of love is widespread in its manifestations.

ناز نہورے نوکاں نخرے لانون جڑ کٹکے

“Love strikes by virtue of priding, coquetries, gambol and blandishments.”

The bewitchments of beauty strike love in the hearts of lovers. The vibrant beauty takes its toll on love.

مہنیں ستھنیں طعنے تبرے گھڑے لوکاں بکے

“People have created animosity (against the lovers) by resorting to rebuke, complaints, taunts and curses.”

People are adamant to love, which is exhibited in their rebukes, complaints, taunts and curses against the lovers. The spirituality of love is beyond ordinary understanding. People

adjudge spiritual love on psychic standards. They impose the limitations of their own mental constitution in understanding the realities of higher realms. Their inability to understand love makes them react against the reality of love. The lovers are targeted by the blind hearts of people bereft of love.

سہساں ٹوکاں ویساں جھوکاں خویش قبیلے سٹ کے

“I will accept this blame and go to the dwellings of my beloved by leaving behind my kith and kin.”

She who becomes apologetic or defensive in the face of public opinion fails in the path of love. She reiterates love for her beloved. She traverses the path of love by severing her family and social ties.

یار بناں چھوک اگ اڑیاں ہار حمیلاں پٹکے

“I will break my necklace and neck ornaments and throw them in the fire in the absence of my beloved.”

The presence (immanence) of her beloved is the only meaningful thing in her life. She has no need of ornaments during the transcendence of her beloved. She commits them to flame. She has no inner urge to wear them because they are only worn for the sake of the beloved.

ڈکھڑے سہندے نین نہ رہندے بے وس تھیکر آئے

“My eyes have fallen in love. They do not disengage themselves in spite of bearing all sufferings.”

Her eyes which have tasted love always remain true to love in trying and testing times.

نیرے باجھ فرید نہ بھاوے بٹھ گھت کوڑے کھٹکے

“Farid! There is nothing that suits me except love. Discard false apprehensions.”

Nothing suits him except love. He discards all apprehensions against love as false. How could the philosophies of hatred understand the wisdom of love?

Kafi-260

نہیں نرا لے نیر
ساڑن سول سریر
نکھڑے نور نظر دے
ساگی سوز سقر دے

“The eyes are flowing novel tears that are splitting the light of my vision. They intensely burn the body like the intense and scorching fire of hell.”

Her eyes are flowing with the tears of love, which are so unique. The splitting of the light of her vision symbolises the separation of her beloved. The fire of love like the fire of hell burns her embodied self. Doesn't it burn to purify her of otherness?

کھڑے برہوں کٹاری کٹھڑے
چوچک چلک ویر
ناز نہورے نخرے موٹھڑے
ویری دل دل گھر دے

“The deplorable lover is butchered by the miserable pride, coquetries and blandishments. My father and brother are boiling with anger. All my near and dear ones have become my adversaries.”

The ravishing beauty of the beloved makes her state miserable and deplorable. Her father and brother boil with anger in seeing her. Her near and dear ones become her adversaries. They fail to understand the heights of her love. They react to her condition in the state of love.

سیجھ سہاگ دی سڑ گئی ساری
تک تک مارن تیر
ڈوڑے ڈکھ ڈوہاگ ڈھاڑی
زہری زور زبردے

“My nuptial bed has been entirely burnt. It has led to the increase of my sufferings and misfortunes. The

poisonous arrows are being severely shot with perfection.”

She experiences despair at the transcendence of her beloved. It increases her sufferings and misfortunes which act as poisonous arrows severely piercing her entire being.

پورے پلے دے پلے دے
جندڑی جکھدی جیڑا جلدے
پیت پرانی پیڑ
ویری درد اندر دے

“I am getting perpetual fits due to the absence of my beloved. My life is bearing tribulations and my self is burning. The primordial pain is my love and the inward pain is my adversary.”

She undergoes perpetual fits during the transcendence of her beloved. Her self burns and her life become full of tribulations. Love is a primordial pain. The pain of love felt inwardly becomes one's adversary because it makes her so restless.

سٹ کر سجن سدھایوں سوہنا
ملک ملہیر ملیو من موہنا
چڑھ چڑھ چک دے چیر
جاری جرح جگر دے

“My lovely friend! You just discarded me and went towards the area of Malheer. My wounds are a sore, which are hurting my self.”

Her beloved friend cast her away and assumed transcendence. The sore wounds of her self hurt her so much.

ساگ سنجی نوں سک سانول دی
مُونجھ مُٹھی نوں مونہہ مُٹھل دی
ہار ہوئی ہُن ہیر
ہوس گئے ہوش ہنر دے

“The spear of a desire of my beloved is piercing the damned one. The hapless one has anguish of her sweet beloved. Heer has now lost the game of love. All my sense and sensibility has withered away.”

She is being pierced by the spear of desire. She is in anguish at the transcendence of her sweet beloved. She has lost the game of love. She has become devoid of sense and sensibility.

نہنہ نواں نت نالہ زاری فکر فراق فرید دی یاری
رگ رگ روگ دی ریر روندیں روح نجر دے

“There are novel ways of lamentations in love. Farid!
I am in friendship with the (worrying) thought of
separation. There is a malaise in my each and every
vein. My spirit becomes spiritless by such crying.”

Love incurs novel ways of lamenting the state of disunion with his beloved. He is constantly engrossed in the reality of separation. He finds malaise penetrating and settling in all his veins. He feels His spirit becoming spiritless in the act of crying.

Kafi-261

گھن گھوراں لا کے

وسووی اکھٹیاں

“My eyes, while assuming the form of dark colouring
clouds are weeping profusely.”

Her eyes weep profusely at the separation and disunion of her beloved. The tears manifest her suffering. They don't go waste. They purify her heart of otherness. They strengthen her bond with her friend.

تھئے بادل طوفان بلا کے

سانون آیا یار نہ آیا

“The rainy season has approached but my friend has
not come. The sky is overcast with clouds of a
dreadful storm.”

Her friend remains transcendent in spite of the signs of immanence. The looming dreadful storm is in the air.

دل نوں مفتی چوٹ چلا کے

آنون کہہ گئے ول نہ آئے

“He promised but did not come. He has hurt my
heart for nothing.”

The beloved promised to unveil himself but has not yet blessed her with his vision and union.

دھن سن بنسی پھوک بجا کے

دل برمائے راول جوگی

“My beloved Yogi has seduced my heart by playing
the flute of love.”

The beloved enchanted her by playing on the flute of love.

دھن سن بنسی پھوک بجا کے

دل برمائے راول جوگی

“Your cruelty of such magnitude is not justified ever since you contracted friendship with me on your own.”

She beseeches her friend not to be so cruel with her since he himself initiated friendship with her. It again refers to the inseparability of beauty and love. It is Divine initiative, which nurtures love in the heart of the lover.

روہ جبل وچ مارو تھل وچ مارو گیا پردیس رُلا کے

“My beloved left me wretched in mountains, terrains and deadly deserts.”

The beloved became transcendent making her wander wretchedly in the wilderness of her self.

مارو ملک ملہیر دامالک لڈنہ جاویں جھوک و سا کے

“My beloved! You are the custodian of Malheer. Do not desert me after dwelling with me.”

She entreats her ravishing transcendent beloved not to assume transcendence after remaining in immanence.

جو گن تھیاں ملک ڈھونڈیاں ویساں انگ بھوت رما کے

“I will cover my self with dust and become a Yogi in a search of my beloved far and wide.”

She makes up her mind to become a Jogan (Yogi) with dusty appearance in search of her transcendent beloved.

اڑے زخم نہ چول پیہا ساڑنہ کوئل کوک سنا کے

“O’ Crested cuckoo! Do not touch my fresh wounds. O’ Cuckoo! Do not burn me with your cooing.”

The cooing of the cuckoo calling her mate makes her suffer so much in longing of her friend.

کروٹیاں لے ہٹ ہٹ جاندی بیوس ڈکھڑے سول سہا کے

“I become tired by sleeplessness. I become destitute by bearing sufferings and afflictions.”

She keeps awake awaiting her beloved. She becomes tired by sleeplessness. She turns destitute by bearing sufferings and afflictions.

تم بچھڑت موہے چین نہ آوے پاپ مٹاؤ ان گن سہا کے

“I have no peace after your separation from me. Do visit my courtyard and erase my sins.”

She loses her peace in separation from her beloved. She beseeches her beloved to unite with her for erasing the sins of duality. The polarisation between the lover and the beloved remains a yawning chasm. It becomes more profound in the states of separation and disunion. Her identity, in a certain sense, tends to assume independence and autonomy, which is equated with the sins of duality. It is at the stage of metaphysical realisation that she rightfully loses her identity. It leads to the attainment of ‘the Supreme Identity’. The beloved does not meet the one in sinfulness. ‘He will not come to meet you, unless you are not there’, says the one who knows.

گر جت بدرہ لست بجلی رم جھم بارش زور گھٹا کے

“The sky is overcast with thick clouds. There are flashes of lightning and thundering of clouds with continuous rainfall.”

The signs of the beloved’s transformation from transcendence to immanence are visible and audible. It increases her anxiety.

ساجن باجھ فرید ہے جینا مشکل ایسے بار اٹھا کے

“Farid! It is so difficult to live by bearing the burden of my friend’s separation.”

He finds it so difficult to bear the burden of separation from his friend.

Kafi-262

وصل ہجر یکساں وسدا دوست قریب دلیں دے

“Union and separation are essentially the same. My friend dwells within my heart.”

The identity of union and separation, in a certain sense, is identical since the friend dwells near Man's neck-vein. The Omnipresence of the beloved leaves no room for separation both in the spatial and the non-spatial sense. The metaphysical concept of nearness and identity is essentially the same.

علوی سفلی یار دیاں جھوکاں خبر نہیں انہاں کملیاں لوکاں
اے دل جان پہچان ہر جا دیرے چاک ہیندے

“My friend is stationed in the terrestrial and celestial worlds. These naïve people are not aware of it. The omnipresence of my shepherd of the herd is witnessed by my heart with absolute certainty.”

The naïve people with their low levels of knowledge do not understand that the dwellings of the beloved comprise the terrestrial and the celestial worlds (the manifest and the Unmanifest). His heart witnesses the Omnipresence of the beloved in absolute certitude. Heart-knowledge or realised knowledge is imparted in absolute certainty. Love and gnosis become identical.

ڈکھ ڈوہاگ تے بیت حزن میں شکھ سہاگ تے ملک امن میں
عاشق سمجھ سُنجان سبھ مظہر میں یار چہیندے

“O' Lover! Do understand and have knowledge that all is the manifestation of the sought out beloved in

sufferings, misfortunes, abode of angst, city of peace and happiness.”

He has to understand that the friend he seeks is manifest in sufferings, misfortunes, angst, peace and happiness. Spiritual phenomenology of consciousness reveals the ‘intentionality’ of consciousness that relates consciousness to its object. The object of love is the beloved. It is in relatedness to the beloved that he undergoes different states of consciousness. Aren’t union and separation identical?

چاک ببا نہ من نوں بھانا تن من اس دے راہ دکاتا
کیاوت دین ایمان شرم بھرم سب ملک تہیں دے

“The shepherd who has been appointed to look after the herd of my father has become my beloved. I have sold my soul and body to him. What to talk of my faith and tradition? He is the custodian of all my honour and prestige.”

She falls in love with her beloved in immanent form. She barter her embodied self for the sake of her friend. He has full rights on her inward and outward, which absolutely belong to him.

عشق فرید تصرف کیتا لائیں جڑ کر پریم پلپیتا
سب صورت سُبجان ظاہر اکھیاں نال ڈسینیدے

“Farid! Love has fully captivated me. It perfectly burnt the wick of my love. He is manifest in all forms. I witness him with my eyes.”

He is fully captivated by love. He perfectly nurtures love in his heart. The transcendent is openly manifest in all forms of immanence. He is witnessed by the eyes in the form of the ‘transparency of the phenomena.’ It is brilliance of light, which darkens his vision. Light has to be mixed with darkness in order to be seen. The Reality assumes forms of immanence in order to be witnessed.

Kafi-263

وَلَسْ وَسَاوِہے ٹول وے کر لاڈ مٹھڑا بول وے

“My beloved! Do come and enliven my dwellings.
Shower your love on me and talk to me sweetly.”

He implores his transcendent beloved to enliven his inward dwellings, shower love on him and communicate with him in sweetness.

ہر وقت سانول ڈھول وے پیسا ہوا ساڈڑے کول وے
ان سو نہیں گھنڈڑی کھول وے ان سنگ میں سنگ بول وے

“My charming beloved! You are with me at all times.
Remove the veil of otherness between us and communicate with me without any reservations.”

He experiences his charming beloved to be always with him. But in spite of his presence there is a veil between them. He asks him to remove the veil of otherness (veil of transcendence) between them and directly communicate with him. Isn't it the mystery of love that at times one does not understand whether it is veil of transcendence or veil of immanence?

اُتھوں ناز دے نک ٹول وے لکھ لکھ آلول مَنول وے
اتھاں مٹھڑی جان سڑول وے تھئی ڈکھڑیں دی کچول وے

“There are increasingly enchanting expressions of priding, fun and puns (of my beloved) but here my miserable life is wretched. It has become a bowl of sufferings.”

The vibrant beauty is full of enchanting expressions but his miserable life is experiencing wretchedness. It has become so susceptible to sufferings.

کیا ڈکھڑیں لدھڑم گول وے تھے چور زرہ تے خول وے
ماریا ہے کیا جڑ تول وے ابرو غلیل غلول وے

“Have the sufferings found me to strike in spite of my defences? It has shot me with such swiftness that I have utterly become defenceless.”

He is struck by sufferings to an extent that all his psychic defence mechanisms fall to the ground. The strike is so swift that he becomes defenceless. How could he put any defence against the onslaughts of beauty?

پے ہوش دے وچ بھول وے زیرے اندر سوپول وے
تھیا جسم چپچی ٹھول وے دل ڈترے کئی گھر رول وے

“My consciousness has become blurred. My being has been ripped apart. My body has been reduced to the size of a little finger. Love wretched many a home.”

His consciousness becomes blurred. The fabric of his being tears apart. His body shrinks by facing the sufferings of love. The passion of love, residing in his heart, has wretched many a homes.

جے اے فرید دا ڈول وے ایہا ٹورتے ایہا جول وے
کئی ڈینہ نہ پھولا پھول وے آجھو شہریں و جسن دول وے

“Farid! If these are your ways and you persist in actualizing them, then you need to wait not long but you will soon find the beat of drums in the city about it.”

He becomes oblivious of his appearance and surroundings while achieving heights of love and gnosis. He remains talk of the town. It is the sign of ordinary people to remain engrossed in the pettiness of life and negatively talk about

people. Ridiculing the lover becomes their favourite pastime. They do not ascend to the heights of truth but descend to the pits of illusions of everydayness of existence. Doesn't love save him from the meaninglessness of life by making him meaningfully concentrate on his beloved?

Kafi-264

وہ حضرت عشق مجازی سب رازر موزدی بازی

“I laud the majestic and shadow love. It is the whole game of symbolism.”

The lover lauds the celestial game of love symbolically played in terrestrial forms.

بہوشا ہد اصلی جانیں ہے واحد پر م کہانی
ہے وحدت سمنجھ سنجانی وچ پردے کثرت سازی

“Consider all things as manifestation of the Real. Unity is the story (expression) of love. Seek knowledge and understanding of unity in diversity.”

One has to develop doctrinal understanding in considering everything as the manifestation of the Real. The manifestation is not absolutely real but it is also not absolutely devoid of the real. Things are attached to the Real. The story of love is the story of unity. One has to understand the principle of unity manifest in diversity. It is the One, who is manifest in manyness. Isn't it 'the dust of multiplicity,' which makes the eye oblivious of unity? Could the question of multiplicity arise if there were no unity?

کر رفع ملال کدورت ٹک سمنجھ سجن بے صورت
تھیا ظاہر وچ ہر مورت چھپ او لے نور مجازی

“Cleanse yourself (the mirror of your heart) from anxiety and animosity of forms (dust of multiplicity) and fully understand that your beloved is (essentially) formless. He has become immanent in each form,

while maintaining His transcendence by virtue of the Muhammadan Light.”

Man has to cleanse the mirror of his heart from anxiety and animosity of otherness. He has to fully understand that the beloved is formless but manifest in every form (in simultaneity of his transcendence and immanence). The Essential Light remains hidden and invisible, while manifesting itself in the Light of Muhammad, which is instrumental in the creation or manifestation of the cosmos.

سُن حسن ازل دی چالی سب ناز نہورے والی
کھہ خالق خلق دا والی کھہ عابد ریت نیازی

“Reflect on the moves of the primordial beauty. They are prideful with coquetries. He manifests as the Creator, the custodian of the whole universe at times and at times He assumes the posture of humility and exhibits himself in the form of a devotee.”

The prideful moves of the primordial beauty characterised by coquetries have to be doctrinally understood. He manifests, at times, as the Creator and custodian of his entire creation. But, at times, He manifests Himself in the forms of devotee and in the tradition of humility. Religiosity fails to understand the manifestation of the Creator and Lord of the universe in the forms of devotee and the tradition of humility. It seems so scandalous to it. It has no means to understand that His manifestation in any medium-higher or lower- is the direct consequence of His being the Absolute, Infinite, Universal Possibility and the metaphysical Whole. There is no room for anything, spatially or non-spatially- to exist with Him. The very idea of anything beside Him tends to create divinity (ilah), which is worst form of blasphemy and polytheism. The truth is that the cosmos is the ever recurring theophany (tajjali) of the Reality. There is nothing else. He is manifest in all things, in their all dimensions, and at all times in simultaneity. The attempt of religiosity to reduce God to His absolute transcendence delimits Him. It is the perspective

of immanence, which complements the perspective of transcendence and succeeds in presenting God in His Wholeness.

کھٹھ عاشق درد کُشالے کھٹھ حُسن ملاحت چالے
تھی ہار سنگار ڈکھالے خوش سیرت ناز نوازی

“He manifests in the form of a lover in pain and adversity at times and at times He manifests in charming beauty. He exhibits in a makeup, nobility and prideful elegance.”

He manifests, at times, in the form of the lover suffering pains and adversities. He manifests, at times, in the form of the beloved with charming beauty. He manifests in embellishments, nobility and prideful elegance. All things are modes of His manifestation including ideas, feelings, words or acts. Everything is subject to His law. If we identify Him with His law, then it becomes easier for us to understand His manifestation in every medium irrespective of the higher or lower category of the medium.

کھٹھ مطرب تے میخانے کھٹھ رندی رسم یگانے
کھٹھ صوم صلوات اذانے کھٹھ زاہد نیک نمازی

“He manifests, at times, in the form of musician and tavern. He manifests, at times, in the form of the inebriate and in the tradition of drunkenness. He manifests, at times, in rituals and, at times, as a devout and pious worshipper.”

It is by virtue of His immanence that He manifests in different forms or mediums but He simultaneously maintains His transcendence. It is precisely the reason that no medium-pure or impure-can affect Him. It is appreciation of this metaphysical truth that clears many a doubts of religiosity regarding the doctrine of Oneness of Being (wahdat al-wujud).

پاورشرکھ صدیقی
بن مرد معلیٰ غازی

ہے غیریت زندگی
کر جہد جہاد حقیقی

“Otherness is sacrilegious. Discover the treasure of truthfulness. Make a true and meaningful effort to become a perfect and universal man.”

Otherness is sacrilegious. It is the vocation of Man to remain sincere to the tradition of Truth considering the Reality as the Absolute, Infinite, Universal Possibility and the Metaphysical Whole that leaves no room of otherness. There is the Principle and its Manifestation. There is Oneness, which is all-dimensional and all-pervasive. There are no two irreducible principles. There is the principle of unity. It is unity, which manifests in diversity. Diversity has no self-subsistent, independent or autonomous reality. It is the One, which reflects in the many. He has to make meaningful efforts and realise the doctrinal truth in the infinite depths of his being or consciousness. It will make him perfect and Universal Man.

سٹ نحوی فعل تے فاعل
ہے فقر فقط جانبازی

ٹھپ فقہ اصول مسائل
بٹھ علمی بحث دلائل

“Discard jurisprudence, its principles, issues and problems. Leave aside syntax and accident. Discard knowledge, mode of argumentations and proof. The consciousness of one’s ontological nothingness is to sacrifice ones life for the sake of love (union).”

The mediate knowledge with all its methods and modes has to be discarded in order to attain immediate knowledge by virtue of intellectual intuition. Love and gnosis fall to the lot of the one who has readiness to sacrifice his life for the sake of his beloved.

ہے ریت عجب توحیدی
المیر ڈور درازی

اے سلک سلوک فریدی
پر ذوق لذیذ جدیدی

“Adopt this Faridian way. It is a strange tradition of oneness. It is full of taste and fresh (creative) relishing. Leave all the distant ways and modes.”

One has to adopt the way of Faridi tradition. Contemplative tawhid or the tradition of Oneness is unique. It is inspiring, tasteful and creative. A person has to leave all the indirect ways and modes of knowledge and being. He has to realise doctrinal truth of Oneness in the inmost chambers of his heart.

Kafi-265

وہ وہ دلبر دی یاری لایاری کرم نہ کاری

“I laud the friendship of my heartiest friend that after contracting friendship he did not cast a glance of love at me.”

He lauds (sarcastically) the friendship of his heartiest friend who contracted friendship with him and then assumed transcendence.

تھی رُو کھڑا ر لُھم بریت نہ بچھدا حال حقیقت
نہ سنداؤیدن ساری

“He is very indifferent and keeps a distance from me. He does not enquire about my welfare. He does not listen to the tale of my love.”

He equates the transcendence of his beloved as acts of indifference towards him. He does not enquire about his welfare nor listens to his tale of sufferings on the path of love. He desperately desires his beloved to assume immanence so that they could communicate with each other.

میں مُٹھڑی ڈکھڑیں کٹھڑی سے تیریں غم دیں چوٹڑی
دل لٹڑی سولاں ماری

“I am miserable and butchered by sufferings. I am subjected to countless arrows of sorrows. My heart is looted and has become the victim of afflictions.”

She expresses misery at the hands of sufferings, sorrows and afflictions she encounters in separation and disunion from her beloved.

نہ ڈٹھڑم مٹھڑا کھنا گیا سانوں صاف سلکھنا

گئی موسم چیتڑ بہاری

“I have not seen my sweet and tender friend. The rainy season has just passed away and the spring season has ended.”

She was deprived of his vision in spite of great nuptial times. She could not realise times of union with her transcendent beloved. She constantly grapples with the mystery of transcendence. She becomes so dejected in not seeing him even in such good times.

نہ ہوت نہ کھوب اٹھاں دے سب پر بھت پندھ تھلان دے

دل رُل رُل رور وہاری

“There is neither my beloved nor any signs of the camel hoofs. There are all hills and vast spaciousness of the desert. I have exhausted myself by crying wretchedly.”

She finds no signs of her beloved in the wilderness of herself. She exhausts herself by crying wretchedly in desolations.

میں سندھری کیویں جالاں پردیس بیٹھی تن گالاں

تھئے روہی ڈینہہ ملہاری

“Why should I go and dwell in Sindh and rotten myself as an alien, when there are rains in the desert and the weather is so fine?”

Her quest is to find her beloved in the inmost chamber of her heart in order to realise the possibility of union. She does not want to search him in the external world (outward) and become rotten and alien for nothing. Her search in the outward does not lead to fruition.

دل کھسدا بھیت نہ ڈسدا تھی اوپر ادوروں ہسدا

لاہو ہوشہر خواری

“My beloved grabs my heart and does not disclose the mystery. He acts as a stranger and distantly watches with a laugh the situation of my infamy and notoriety.”

The beloved grabs her heart but does not disclose the mystery of his transcendence. He becomes transcendent but remains aware of the infamy and notoriety fallen to her lot. He laughs at her inability to understand the mystery of transcendence.

ہک یار فرید اوڑا بیاسس ننان دا جھیرا
پئی پلڑے مونجھ منجھاری

“Farid! My friend is peculiar and also my mother-in-law and my sister-in-law have brawls with me. Anguish is fallen to my lot.”

He falls in constant states of anguish in trying to discern meaning behind the peculiar moves of his beloved and in facing the brawls of his adversaries who also take a heavy toll on him. He faces the vicissitudes of his inner self and the animosities of his social self.

Kafi-266

ہک دم ہجر نہ سہندی ہے دل دلبر کارن ماندی ہے

“My heart is weary without my beloved. It cannot bear disunion even for a moment.”

There are times when her heart becomes weary without her beloved. She finds it impossible to bear her disunion even for a moment.

سوز گداز دی تول وچھاواں ڈکھ ڈوباگ دی سیجھ سہاواں
ہار غماں دا گل وچ پاناواں درد دی بانہہ سر اندی ہے

“I lay the bedding of sensitive passions. I set my nuptial bed of sufferings and misfortunes. I wear the garland of sorrows around my neck. I keep the hand of pain under my head.”

She remains in the grip of sensitive passions of love. She undergoes sufferings, misfortunes, sorrows and pains in the transcendence of her beloved.

ماہی بے پرواہ ملیو سے پلڑے سوز فراق پیو سے
حال کنوں بے حال تھیو سے جندڑی جھوک غماں دی ہے

“I got my carefree beloved. Passion and separation have fallen to my lot. My condition has worsened. My life has become an abode of sorrows.”

She considers her beloved carefree who does not respond to her passionate sufferings of separation. Her condition worsens and she remains constantly in the state of sorrowfulness.

ڈینہ نہانواں سڑدیں جلدیں رات و نجانواں جلدیں گلدیں
ساری عمر گئی ہتھ ملدیں ہے ہے موت نہ آندی ہے

“I spend my day in burning and scorching. I spend my night in flaming and rotting. I have been at a loss throughout my life. Alas, death does not overtake me.”

She constantly faces the burns of love, which rotten her self. Her whole life has been spent in lamenting at the transcendence of her beloved. She has even been spared by death to face the sufferings of love.

سوئے کیتی کچ تیاری آیا باربر ہوں سرباری
سینگیاں سرتیاں کرن نہ کاری بے وس پئی گر لاندی ہے

“My beloved is prepared to go to Ketch. The burden of love is on my head. My youthful companions and friends are unable to solve my problem. I am groaning in helplessness.”

The transcendence of her beloved in the offing puts onerous burden of separation on her. Her friends and companions cannot stop this occurrence. She groans in the state of helplessness. The uniqueness of love does not sanction any inner or outer help. She is both inwardly and outwardly helpless in arresting the transcendence of her beloved. What, if she succeeds. Wouldn't it be a premature end of the game of love? Isn't the transcendence of the beloved necessary for ripening love into fruition?

یاد کریساں یار دیاں گا لہیں سو ہنیاں رمزاں موہنیاں چالیں
تو نہیں مہنیں ڈیوم سیالیں تانگ فرید نہ جاندی ہے

“I will remember the discourse of my beloved filled with lovely symbolism and enchanting intricacies. Farid! My longing for the beloved does not diminish even when the Sial women rebuke me.”

He ever remembers the discourse of his friend. The heavenly discourse is couched in lovely symbols and enchanting intricacies. He keeps longing for his beloved. The rebukes of the outsiders cannot diminish his desire for his friend. Doesn't rebuking help in intensifying the fire of love already enkindled in his heart?

Kafi-267

ہکوالف مینوں برمانوم ژئی تتی بے تے مول نہ بھاوم ژئی

“Only one alphabet Alif (Allah) has captivated me. I am the inept one whom no other alphabets (realities) are acceptable.”

The alphabet Alif (A) symbolising Allah (Oneness) captivates the lover. It is doctrinal understanding and realisation of the principle of unity, which is enough for him. His drowning in love makes him oblivious of diversity as such. He fully concentrates on the Real. All else is otherness.

سوہنی وحدت پر م پریتاں نیں ذوقی گھاتاں عشقی گیتاں نیں
کو جھی کثرت کو جھاں ریتاں نیں دل غیروں غیرت کھاوم ژئی

“The beauty of unity is characterized by depths of love. There are enchanting tunes and songs of love. Multiplicity is ugly and its ways are hideous. My heart with priding shuns otherness.”

The beauty of unity is so lovable. It is punctuated by enchanting tunes and songs of love. Unity is manifest in multiplicity. The ugly multiplicity with its hideous ways is the result of denying the principle of unity manifest in diversity. It is considering multiplicity or diversity as independent and autonomous. It tends to sever it from its roots. His heart takes pride in shunning otherness (not denotatively but in a connotative sense since otherness is not there).

ہر چالوں ناز نواز ڈے سب حُسن ازل داراز ڈے
کل عالم عالم ساز ڈے ہکو نور نظر وچ آوم ژئی

“There is the pride and elegance in its each move. It is the mystery of primordial love. I see the whole world instrumental in manifesting the essential Light.”

The moves of Beauty are filled with pride and elegance. There is an intimate linkage between beauty and love. It is the mystery of the primordial love, which has caused the cosmos and sustains it. The whole world is constitutive of the essential Light and seems instrumental in spreading it in the cosmos.

غیرت محض محال ڈے چو طرفوں حُسن جمال ڈے
ہر ویلھے وصل وصال ڈے ڈینہہ رات پُئل گل لاؤم ڈی

“I see no possibility of otherness. I see divine beauty everywhere. I find union at each and every moment. Punna is embracing me day and night.”

He realises the doctrinal truth of Oneness. He sees the impossibility of otherness. He perceives unity in diversity at all times. There are loving embraces day and night.

کیوں کردی ہار سنگار مٹھی کیوں سرخی کجہ دھار مٹھی
جے جاناں سانول یار مٹھی دل ملک ملہیر سدھاؤم ڈی

“Why I would have done a makeup being so hapless and why I would have applied rouge and drawn the line of a collyrium in the hapless state if I had known that my beloved would leave for Malheer?”

She as a hapless lover questions her embellishments in the wake of her beloved's transcendence. She would not have been happy if she knew that her beloved would assume transcendence. She faltered in considering the permanence of her beloved's immanence.

تادرد جدید شدید تھیا ہر روزاے سوز مزید تھیا
کے دید فرید خرید تھیا بن ڈھولن گھرور تاؤم ڈی

“My inept pain has multiplied and my passion is intensifying each day. Farid! I have sold myself at the behest of one gaze of my beloved. My dwellings are making me fiery without my beloved.”

His pain multiplies and his passion intensifies every day. He recounts the act of selling himself at one gaze of his beloved. His dwellings have become fiery in the absence of his beloved.

Kafi-268

ہک دی دم دم سیک ہے ہک ہے ہک ہے ہک ہے

“It is the unified oneness. The desiring of the One is at each and every moment.”

The One is the Absolute and the Infinite. There is constant desiring of the One from within the One since there is nothing outside the Metaphysical Whole.

ہک دے ہر جا وچ دیرے کیا اُچ ہے کیا جھک ہے

“The One dwells at each and every place whether it is high or low.”

There is the Omnipresence of the One irrespective of heights and depths.

ہک ہے ظاہر ہک ہے باطن بیاسب کجھ ہالک ہے

“The One is manifest. The One is unmanifest. All else is perishable.”

The One is the Manifest. It is the same One, which is the Unmanifest. The Manifest or the Outward and the Unmanifest or the Inward are there in their absolute fullness without any trace of otherness. All else is being perpetually annihilated. But there is nothing outside the Infinite. Thus, it is the process of re-creation that is taking place at every moment within the Infinite.

مقناطیس تے لو ہے وانگن ہوں ڈو دل دی چھک ہے

“My heart is attracted (to my beloved), the same way as iron is attracted to a magnet.”

The force of love travels in the veins of the cosmos. His heart is magnetically attracted to his beloved.

جیڑھاک کوں ڈوکر جانے اوکا فر مشرک ہے

“A person who considers the One as two veils the truth and places divinity beside Allah.”

A person who delimits the One by negating its metaphysical wholeness provides space for otherness and thereby creates duality of irreducible principles. He veils truth and places divinity beside Allah.

مطلب ڈاڈھاستخت نزیکی پر رہتے چل چک ہے

“The meaning (of oneness) seems so absolutely understandable but to traverse this muddy and marshy way is so difficult.”

The meaning of Oneness is self-evident but to doctrinally understand and realise it is so difficult. One has to traverse the path of love and gnosis in order to understand and realise it.

ساڈے سر سرواہ داسارا فخر پیاماںک ہے

“My beloved Fakhr is the complete custodian of my being and its commitments.”

He places his whole being and having in the hands of his spiritual master for attaining the highest metaphysical stage of ‘the supreme identity’.

درد دابار اٹھانہ سگدی دل شودی نک ترک ہے

“My heart is poor and delicate. It cannot bear the burden of pains.”

His heart is so fragile that it cannot bear the onerous burden of the pain of love.

روز ازل دی دلڑی میڈی رَاہ حق دی سالیک ہے

“My heart ever since the primordial day is subject to the way of Truth.”

The primordial tradition demonstrates the innateness of truth in the heart (Intellect)

جند دے نال خیالِ خدائی کیا پورا گیا یک ہے

“The imagination of the Divinity has completely become identical with my life (being).”

He reaches a stage where he completely concentrates on the Real. It leads to the identity of knowledge and being.

یار فرید سنجان کیتے اے نسخہ یک تک ہے

“Farid! This formula (prescription of oneness) is absolute in order to have an essential understanding of my friend.”

The concentration on the Real is his patent prescription on the road to gnosis.

Kafi-269

ہن میں رانجھن ہوئی رہیا فرق نہ کوئی

“Now, I have become Ranjhan. The polarization has been withdrawn (by the Self).”

She traverses the arduous path of love. She attains ontological consciousness of her nothingness. She becomes transformed in the form of her beloved. The polarisation between the lover and the beloved ceases to exist. But the question remains that once the lover ceases to be, the beloved also ceases to be. The cessation of the lover and the beloved is in simultaneity. The lover either becomes identified with love itself or the Reality (Self) withdraws this polarisation. Doesn't the gnostic come to subsist in the Divine Consciousness as a realised possibility?

جیں سنگِ دلڑی پیت لگائی آخر بن گئی سوئی

“My heart ultimately became the same (united) with whom it cultivated love.”

Her heart becomes united with her beloved. The subject and the object become identified.

ہیر سلیٹی چوچک بیٹی دُج کس جا کھڑوئی

“Heer, the daughter of Choochak, reached such (sublime) heights.”

Heer, the daughter of Choochak, reaches such sublime heights by virtue of remaining sincere, resolute and steadfast in love.

ہیروں ہیرا تھیسیں جیکر سرہیں راہ ڈتوئی

“If you sacrifice yourself for the sake of love, then you will also be transformed from Heer to a diamond (will become priceless by the process of alchemy).”

The one who adopts the love tradition of Heer in sacrificing everything for the sake of love will become invaluable.

پہلے کھا کر درد کُشالے اُوڑک تھی دِل جوئی

“I had to bear pains and adversities in the early phases but at last my efforts fructified to my heart’s content.”

She has to face pains and adversities in the path of love. But ultimately the beloved becomes responsive and affects union with her.

شائیں اصلوں محض نہ ہاریوں جتنا بار چتوئی

“It is commendable that you did not lose your heart in spite of bearing such pressures.”

She commends the one who does not lose her heart in spite of bearing onerous burdens of love.

جو کوئی سلکِ محبت دے دے وچ مرن توں اگے موئی

“The one who dies before dying in the tradition of love (succeeds).”

The tradition of love makes the one succeed in love who dies before dying. She is the one who has completely subjected herself to the will of her beloved.

سیچھ سہاگ سہائیں تھی خوش شام سندر سنگ سوئی

“The person attains happiness by being in the nuptial bed with his beloved.”

She who attains consciousness of her ontological consciousness in the face of her beloved succeeds in affecting nuptial union with her beloved.

نال خیال انا دے جیں نے میل دوئی دی دھوئی

“They cleanse themselves of the dust of multiplicity by virtue of ‘I am the Truth’.”

She cleanses herself of the dust of multiplicity by realising that her I amness is an objective illusion. It is the Divine I amness, which is manifest in the human one. It is the Reality, which says ‘I am the Truth’, through human tongue.

سارے جگ وچ پک میں رہ گئی نہ توئی نہ اوئی

“I remained solely in the world without otherness.”

She becomes conscious of her ontological nothingness. Her sense of separateness ceases to be. All polarisations are withdrawn. She sees the working of the Divine fully within her.

تھیا منصور فرید ہمیشہ جیں اے راز لدھوئی

“Farid! He always remained a victor who found this secret (realised his self in fullness).”

The one who found the secret of realising his self in fullness achieved permanent victory. He purified the mirror of his heart (mirror of his ontological nothingness) from otherness and provided the Reality to contemplate itself.

Kafi-270

ہئے عرب شریف سدھائی بوسندھ پنجاب دی آئی

“I am nearing Sindh and Punjab after departing the holy land of Arabia.”

He is returning from the holy land of Arabia symbolising his return to the outward from the inward.

بن عرب اے اکھیاں رُوون روہار ہنجوں دے پوون
کر نیرے کھڑادھوون دل در دیں چوٹ چکھائی

“My eyes are weeping and stringing the garlands of tears that are washing my face (countenance). My heart has made me taste the pain of departing Arabia.”

He suffers in returning from the celestial world to the terrestrial one. It is heart, which makes him taste the pain of love characterised by separations and disunions.

اے پہلی منزل حدے بنی شہر مبارک جدے
کل بجدی شدے مدے اج عدن ویندی مگلائی

“Heddah was the first point of destination after Makkah. The next is the blessed city of Jeddah. The sea is in high and low tides. We are leaving behind Adan and bidding it a good bye.”

He is bidding good bye to the spiritual stations he encountered in the way of his spiritual journey.

کر سعی طواف زیارت لہہ لطفوں عفو اشارت
گھن عشقوں ذوق بشارت دل و طنین واگ دلائی

“I have made an effort (walking between ‘safa’ and ‘marwa’) and accomplished circumambulation and witnessing. I got the subtle signs of my salvation. I have turned the reins towards my country after tasting the Divine messages of love.”

He makes spiritual efforts and receives spiritual blessings. He returns to his ordinary self after tasting the responsiveness of his beloved.

کیوں گانے گاہنے پاواں کیوں سرخیاں میندیاں لاواں
کیوں کجلہ دھار بناواں ہے کھیم نصیب جدائی

“Why should I wear colourful threads around my wrist (symbolising marital bond) and ornaments? Why should I apply rouge and henna? Why should I draw the line of a collyrium? It has fallen to my lot to depart.”

He is not inspired to embellish himself since he is departing from his beloved. He is sad at facing the situations of separation and disunity.

گل سہرے ہار کمانے کل ناز نوادہانے
گئے جوش جوانی مانے گئی دھج وچ فخر وڈائی

“All my chaplets and garlands have lost their freshness. All my pride and elegance have been reduced to naught. My animating youthfulness has disappeared. My distinction and self-conceitedness have gone away.”

The days of separation and disunion fade the colours of his life. He finds himself reduced to nothingness.

توں باجھوں سانول گھر وچ ہاں بے شک سخت سفر وچ
تھل مارو سنجر دے بر وچ ہم سختی روز سوائی

“My charming beloved! House of God! I am undoubtedly undertaking hazardous journey in

inwardness without you. I am (symbolically) in deadly deserts, forests and desolate places with increasing hardships each day.”

He traverses the hazardous and difficult path of love to search his beloved in the inmost chambers of his heart. His hardships of love increase during the transcendence of his beloved.

جی جلیا دلڑی بُھڑی	کئی آس فرید نہ پُڑی
گل دردوں چولی پائی	سر سوز فراق دی چڑی

“Farid! None of my hopes could be realised. My self is burning and my heart is being grilled. I have the covering of passion and separation on my head and the shirt of pains on my body.”

His hope of vision and union with his beloved remain unrealised. His embodied self is burned and grilled by the fire of love. His passion of love has to bear separation of his beloved. He suffers pains of love for the sake of his beloved.

Kafi-271

یاد آنون یار دے رلے نت پو ون کروپ کللے

“I am remembering the days of togetherness with my friend. I am facing unintelligible difficulties at each and every moment.”

She recounts the moments spent with her beloved in togetherness. She constantly faces intricacies of separation and disunion with her beloved.

کیوں چٹھدی چندری کھارے کیوں کردی زیور بارے
جے جانڈی ہجر دے وارے آئے نیڑے سخت سولے

“If I had known that union would be so short lived and I would have to bear disunion so soon then, why would I have accomplished the nuptial rites and worn heavy jewellery?”

She would not have agreed to accomplish nuptial rites and ornament herself if she knew that the immanence of her beloved was so short-lived and she will have to bear his transcendence so soon.

ڈکھ یار، سکھاں دے ویرن لائے سولاں سینے دیرن
مونہہ کالا نیلے پیرن وہ ہوت پنل دے بھلے

“The sufferings are my friend and peace is my adversary. Countless afflictions have encompassed my being. I have lost my honour and respect. I laud the blessings of my beloved Punnal.”

She lives amidst the company of her sufferings. She finds peace beyond her reach. She is encompassed by countless afflictions. She loses her honour and respect. She lauds (sarcastically) these blessings of her friend.

کیوں ڈکھڑی عمر بھادواں ہُن موت داملک و ساواں
وچ گورستان سہاواں بٹھ جیون کوڑ تسلاوے

“Why I should bear a life of sufferings? I would go and dwell in the city of death. I will inhabit the graveyard. I don’t care a fig for the false consolations of life.”

She thinks of dying than bearing the life of sufferings. She does not care about her life or the false consolations of her beloved. The yawning chasm between human timings and the divine ones widen in the states of separation and disunion. She becomes desperate in her search of transcendence. Doesn’t the Divine timings finally prevail and she realises that the Divine hand of time was in her ultimate interest?

گل پیچ بجر دے ولے دل زخم اوڑے لے
ایہہ نینہ لانوں دے بھلے پئے میں مٹھڑی دے پلے

“The entanglements of disunion have fallen to my lot. My heart is stricken with intricate and fresh wounds. They are the blessings of contracting love that have fallen to the share of the miserable one.”

She experiences disunion of her beloved. She is struck by intricate and fresh wounds of love. She calls these as blessings (sarcastically) of contracting love, which have fallen to her miserable lot.

سب زور ہوس و س لایم پر یار فرید نہ آیم
غم درد اندر سر پائیم کر آپے گلے گلے

“Farid! I have made my efforts and tried my utmost but my friend has not come to meet me. Sorrows and pains have been all embracing and they have come to reside within me.”

He makes all out efforts in search of transcendence but all in vain. He remains engulfed in sorrows and pains of love. There is no relationship of causal necessity between effort and its result. His efforts do count but they cannot force the transcendent beloved to assume immanence. The keys of efforts cannot open the door of transcendence. The opening has to come from the Heavens.

Kafi-272

یار گراڑا حال وے سانوں مار نہ طعنے

“My friend! My condition is deplorable. Do not taunt me.”

He as a deplorable lover asks his friend not to taunt him since the transcendence of his beloved is not in his hands. His condition worsens at taunting by his friend.

ساگ سنجوک رلائے قسمت ساگے دوست یگانے

“It is my destiny that I have united with my friend who is unique.”

Destiny has made him encounter such a unique friend.

جاں جاں سو نہ بنواں تانتاں ڈسدے دور بیگانے

“The more my familiarity increases with him, the more he seems far away (transcendence).”

The more he familiarises with his beloved the more his beloved seems transcendent. Isn't it the mystery of transcendence that his intensity of love increases the transcendence of his beloved?

آنون کان نہ مٹنیں دلڑی کچڑے کرن بہانے

“He makes petty excuses but in fact his heart does not yearn to meet me.”

He thinks that his beloved does not yearn to meet him and thereby remains transcendent. All else are lame excuses.

بے درداں دی پریت نہ بھلی مولیٰ موت کوں آنے

“Love of the heartless is of no benefit. I pray for death.”

He finds no benefit of vision and union at the hands of his heartless beloved. He prays for death. Life is elsewhere.

روواں رورولوک سناواں جی نہ آوم خانے

“I cry and narrate my tale to the folk. My heart is not at its place (is not in the state of peace).”

He narrates his tale of suffering to the people around him, while in state of agony. His communication with the outsiders is of no consequence to him.

کوئی آکھے من مچل کوڑی کوئی آکھے دیوانے

“Some people think that I am false-hearted and deceitful, while others think that I am frantic in love.”

People as outsiders have no access to his inwardness. They impute false motives to him. Some people call him frantic in love.

سولیس نال سنجی دی جالے سخ صباح گزراں

“I spent my days and night in afflictions.”

He spends his time bearing inner and outer afflictions.

آنویں دیر نہ لانیں ماہی جندووں ڈینہہ مہمانے

“My beloved! Do come soon and don't be late since my life is going to end soon.”

He entreats his transcendent beloved to assume immanence without any delay since the span of his life is going to end soon.

عشوے غمزے ناز نہورے کیا کیا حسن داشانے

“Witness the multiple glories of beauty in amorous glances, enticements, pride and coqueties.”

The majesty of Beauty is manifest in its bewitchments.

مارن داسامانے

جو ہے شان فرید دی ساری

“Farid! All this glory is to ravish my being.”

The glories of bewitching beauty are there to ravish his being. The bewitchments of beauty stir love in his heart. They intensify his love and nurture an insatiable quest for his beautiful beloved. They embark him on the hazardous journey of love.



Divan of Farid

Beauty Unveiled